

TĀMAKI MAKĀURAU | AUCKLAND

Final Report

An assessment of wellbeing and prosperity

April 2022





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PREFACE

This report has been prepared for the NZ Government Auckland Policy Office by EeMun Chen, Stephen Knuckey, and Sharyn Jones, from MartinJenkins (Martin, Jenkins & Associates Limited).

MartinJenkins advises clients in the public, private, and not-for-profit sectors. Our work in the public sector spans a wide range of central and local government agencies. We provide advice and support to clients in the following areas:

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

We thank the following people and organisations for providing us with data:

- Auckland Unlimited: Christoph Guenter.
- Department of Internal Affairs: James Kilbride.
- Heritage New Zealand Pouhere Taonga: Emma Clifford.
- Lincoln University: Ken Hughey and Geoff Kerr.
- Ministry of Business, Innovation and Employment: Hugo Bussell.
- NZ Police: Obert Cinco.
- Stats NZ: Andrew McLaren, Dean Edwards, Ewan Jonasen, and Liya Liyanage.
- Te Kawa Mataaho Public Service Commission: Enquiries team.

Many of the indicators are based on customised Stats NZ's data which are licensed by Stats NZ for re-use under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International licence.





Foreword

The NZ Government Auckland Policy Office (APO) was created in 2005 when several government agencies combined resources to establish a joint policy presence in central Auckland. The APO network has grown to 20 government agencies who work together to develop public policy that is good for Auckland and good for New Zealand as a whole.

A critical part of our work is building a shared understanding of Auckland. In 2021, the APO commissioned MartinJenkins to compile an Auckland evidence base. The evidence base is drawn from a wide set of indicators to help develop a systems wide view covering the economic, social, environmental and cultural wellbeings. With 90 indicators we have consciously traded depth for breadth, with the option for interested parties to dig deeper into those areas of greatest interest.

This report includes a pilot assessment framework. It is based on the Treasury's Living Standards Framework and has been modified for the Auckland environment. The framework helps us easily navigate to the key indicators and assists in tracking changes over time. The framework is a new innovation and explores an alternative approach to assessing the data sets.

The APO asked MartinJenkins to provide their own insights based on the information collected. The insights are well considered and provide valuable context to the numbers. While the insights do not represent government policy, they will assist the APO in its own thinking as we develop a shared narrative on Auckland later in 2022.

I am grateful to everyone who has contributed to this report, whether in providing data, or in giving their time to discuss the many issues raised during the course of the research. Thank you in particular to the report's authors, EeMun Chen and Stephen Knuckey, for bringing the research together and providing sharp insights to Auckland's opportunities and challenges.

Michael Quinn
Head
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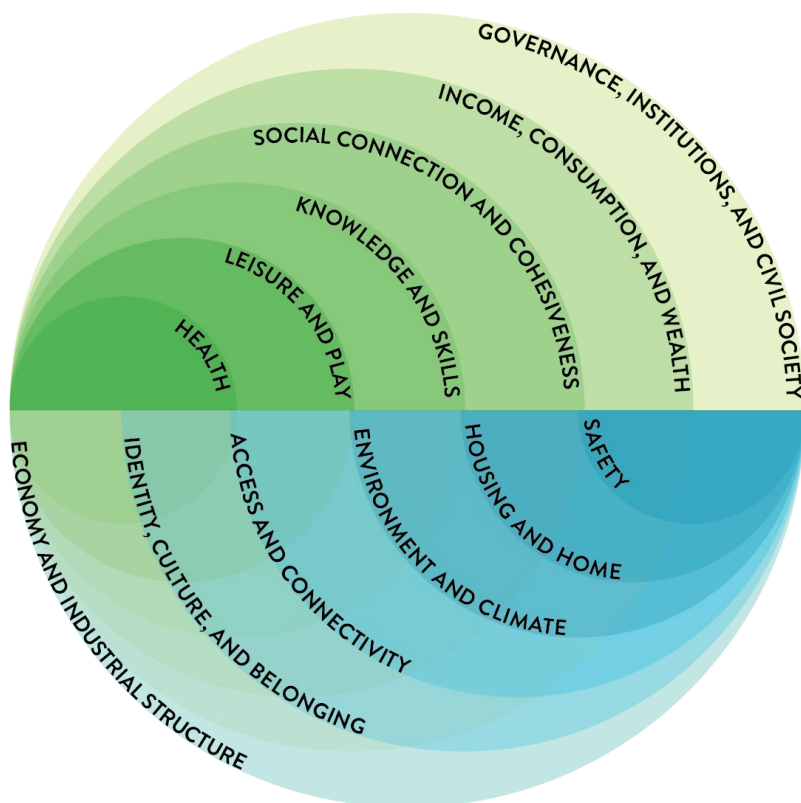


EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Tāmaki Makaurau | Auckland presents both public policy opportunities and challenges. The response needs to be systems-led and integrated. This requires a shared evidence base of data, information, and insights to inform decision making.

There are many different measures and indicators that can be used to show Auckland's performance over time. Using the 2021 Living Standards Framework (LSF 2021) as its base, the Auckland Wellbeing and Prosperity Framework (AWPF) was developed to better understand how Auckland is performing across the different domains of wellbeing, and in relation to other regions.

The AWPF is illustrated by a sphere recognising the interconnectedness of many domains, capabilities and resources of a region as place of people, infrastructure, natural environment, and institutions.



The Framework has 12 themes, and we have grouped them into 4 broad areas (in no particular order):

Social capital

- Social connection and cohesiveness
- Governance, institutions, and civil society
- Safety



Human capital

- Identity, cultural capability, and belonging
- Knowledge and skills
- Health

Natural capital

- Environment and climate
- Leisure and play

Economic capital

- Economy and industrial structure
- Income, consumption, and wealth
- Housing and home
- Access and connectivity.

Each theme has a set of indicators which are used to assess Auckland across the range of dimensions the theme covers. The majority of indicators are used in LSF 2021, with replacements for where there is no regional data and/or additional indicators to round out dimensions and themes that are not well recognised by the LSF 2021.

This report presents Auckland's performance on the range of indicators selected for each theme. At the start of each theme, a traffic light system shows how Auckland performs relative to other regions, and over time. Where possible, we compare Auckland to main urban areas, regions that have similar characteristics to Auckland, and regions that are near Auckland: Northland, Waikato, Wellington, Canterbury, and Otago. Where data is available, Auckland is also compared to the city-regions of Adelaide, Brisbane, Copenhagen, Dublin, Helsinki, Melbourne, Portland, Stockholm, Santiago, Sydney, Toronto, and Vancouver.

Figure 1 shows how Auckland performs on all the themes and indicators. Green means that Auckland is performing at the top of all and/or comparator New Zealand regions; orange means Auckland is at the New Zealand average; and red means Auckland is performing towards the bottom of all regions. Grey means that data is not currently available.



Figure 1. Auckland's performance on the Auckland Wellbeing and Prosperity Framework



The Auckland Wellbeing and Prosperity Framework is comprehensive – we have traded depth for breadth

This report contains high level observations of how Auckland performs on a comprehensive set of indicators. It provides a wide range of information on the various dimensions that make up a city-region. Taking this approach means that we cannot go deeper into why and how something performs. Depth has been sacrificed for breadth. A large data set accompanies this report, and we encourage interested stakeholders to delve deeper into the data and individual indicators, and undertake cross-theme and cross-indicator analysis.

Auckland's population has grown fast, mostly due to net migration

Auckland's population has grown about 1.8% a year over the previous 20 years, higher than the national rate of 1.4% a year. In the wake of the COVID-19 pandemic, Auckland's population fell for the first time in 2021. COVID-19 border restrictions are likely the key contributor to this decline.

Auckland has a more youthful population than the rest of New Zealand, and is more ethnically diverse. Almost 40% of Aucklanders were born overseas, compared to 20% for the rest of New Zealand (excluding Auckland). Urbanisation sets Auckland apart too – Auckland is much more urbanised than the rest of New Zealand.

Auckland is a significant part of New Zealand – a third of New Zealand's residents live in Auckland.

Auckland has many strengths, including in knowledge and skills; income, consumption and wealth; health and economy and industrial structure; but has weaknesses in a range of areas

As a region, Aucklanders enjoy high levels of household income, wages and wage growth, and disposable income. This is related to the high level of skills of Auckland residents, and subsequent employment. Auckland has one of the highest levels of Skill Level 1 occupations, such as chief executive or managing director, engineering manager, laboratory manager, arts administrator and production manager.

Compared to other regions, Auckland households have the highest household net worth. Additionally, Auckland's median hourly earnings have tracked relatively steadily upwards over the last 15 years, consistently being around 5%-6% higher than the New Zealand median.

At the regional level, high perceptions of family wellbeing and whānau wellbeing, as well as positive performance on a number of health-indicators – life expectancy, mental health, suicide rate, and unmet health needs – suggest that the social, physical, and psychological wellbeing of Auckland's residents is, on the whole, superior to that experienced in other regions. Although these are current strengths, the flow-on effects of the COVID-19 pandemic and pandemic-related mitigation strategies may impact these in future.

Auckland plays an important economic role for New Zealand, accounting for close to 40% of New Zealand's GDP and over a third of employment. It holds 35% of all businesses and 61% of the top 200 companies. Its economic performance has been mixed – achieving strong outcomes in terms of value add and incomes but more limited employment outcomes, particularly for some populations.



Auckland's GDP has grown more strongly than New Zealand's over the last decade. GDP per capita is relatively high and is around \$8,000 higher than the New Zealand average. GDP per capita growth has been one of the highest of all regions over the last decade. Auckland's median hourly earnings is currently the second highest of all regions but earnings growth has been below most other New Zealand regions. Auckland's GDP per capita is below the OECD average and most comparable cities internationally but the gap has been shrinking.

Although employment growth has been relatively strong, Auckland's employment and labour force participation rates have tended to be below New Zealand's and other major urban regions over time. Similarly, Auckland's unemployment rate has tended to be higher than New Zealand's. Auckland's unemployment rate for 2021 was 5.1%; above the New Zealand rate of 4.7% and higher than many other regions. Auckland's youth not in employment, education and training (NEET) rate of 13.8% was also higher than the New Zealand rate of 12.5%. Conversely, Auckland's under-utilisation rate of 11.7% rate was slightly below the New Zealand rate of 11.9% and one of the lowest of all regions. COVID-19 has generally adversely impacted labour market outcomes in Auckland over 2020 and 2021.

Auckland's industry-mix is different from other regions in New Zealand. Relative to national employment shares and growth, strong performers in Auckland are knowledge intensive service sectors such as financial and insurance services, administrative services, information media and telecommunications, and professional and technical services. However, an increasing proportion of businesses, over time, indicate that it is getting harder to be successful in Auckland. Although COVID-19 will have been a contributor to this sentiment, traffic congestion and recruiting labour are the main barriers reported by businesses operating in Auckland.

Close to 20% of the Māori asset base and Māori enterprises can be found in Tāmaki Makaurau. The region has a significant proportion of Māori assets and enterprise in knowledge-intensive industries such as information media and telecommunications (for example, 50% of the value of Aotearoa's Māori assets), wholesale trade (44%), professional and technical services, construction services, and financial and insurance services. This provides a strong base for growing enterprise and labour market opportunities for Māori and the region in future.

Auckland has one of the lowest greenhouse gas emission intensities in New Zealand. Although in absolute terms Auckland is a high emitting region of carbon dioxide equivalents, carbon dioxide and fluorinated gases, it is New Zealand's largest economic region (accounting for 38% of New Zealand's GDP in 2020). Taken together, Auckland has one of the lowest emissions intensities across regions, and emissions have decreased over time.

However, other parts of Auckland's environmental performance are concerning, especially water quality and residents' access to green spaces. Relatedly, Aucklanders' participation in sport and recreation is moderate and, from a health perspective, not enough Aucklanders undertake regular physical activity.

Although Auckland has one of the highest number of listed heritage places, and the highest proportion of not-for-profit institutions in the culture, sport and arts sector; levels of arts and sports engagement are average.



Housing quality, affordable housing and congestion continue to be areas of poor performance

In the AWPF, one of the areas where Auckland has weak performance is in the housing and home theme. Aucklanders, whether buying or renting, pay more for housing than most other New Zealanders.

House price and rent increases also mean some households find themselves in unsuitable accommodation. Some live far from jobs, schools and other facilities due to limited availability of affordable options. This trade-off between the cost of housing and proximity to jobs and facilities is a driver of spatial inequalities and social exclusion in Auckland.

It is not just affordability that is a challenge, but also quality. With low levels of affordable housing, Auckland also experiences high levels of household crowding, high levels of homelessness and low levels of home ownership. Note that Aucklanders also face low perceptions of financial wellbeing and high household debt.

Auckland also has weak performance on transport indicators. Public transport boardings in Auckland have declined – particularly in light of COVID-19 and more passengers opting for private cars and/or working from home. Congestion on the roading network is also high. In 2020, Auckland's congestion was the worst of all Australian and New Zealand cities, and did not improve over the COVID-19 pandemic period to the extent it did in Australian cities.

Weak performance in citizen engagement in local democracy and civil society may be related to reported low levels of ability to express one's individual identity and sense of belonging

Auckland also performs relatively poorly on the governance, institutions, and civil society theme and the identity, cultural capability, and belonging theme. There have been persistent low voter turnouts in Auckland local government elections. This, coupled with low participation in local government decision-making, moderate levels of trust in government institutions and low public service satisfaction suggest further analysis is required to understand the low levels of engagement in local governance.

It is possible that reported low levels of a sense of belonging to Auckland, and low ratings on the ability to express one's identity, may be contributing to this disengagement. Auckland's significant diversity of people is a strength but may mean it is challenging to stimulate a singular sense of cohesiveness and there may be many enclaves or ingroups.

Regional analysis masks underperformance in certain localities and cohorts of people

Regional level indicators mask patterns observed at the local board level, within different age groups, and between and within ethnic groups.

Māori are persistently at a disadvantage across many indicators

Māori participation and contribution to industry and enterprise in Tāmaki Makaurau is becoming more significant. The value of the Māori asset base in Tāmaki Makaurau is estimated to be around



\$12.5 billion or close to 19% of the total Māori asset base. However, in many indicators, Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau are persistently at a disadvantage.

- Fewer Māori in Aotearoa have higher life satisfaction than non-Māori. Fewer Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau have higher life satisfaction than Māori in almost all other regions.
- The proportion of adult Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau who can speak conversational te reo Māori is low, relative to other regions, and has declined over time.
- Māori connection with their ancestral marae is low, but likely related to the high proportions of mataawaka ¹ in Tāmaki Makaurau.
- The percentage of Māori in Auckland who had good (or better) self-rated health was significantly lower than the national percentage for Māori.
- Māori are significantly more likely to die from non-communicable diseases, and/or their complications than European New Zealanders.
- Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau have lower labour participation rates, higher unemployment and high youth not-in-employment, education and training (NEET) rates.
- Māori and Aucklanders in general, report high rates of unaffordable housing. Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau also experience high levels of household crowding, and houses of low quality. There has been no increase in Māori home ownership levels over the past 30 years.
- Rates of homelessness are highest among Māori young people.
- Māori participation in general election and local government election voting is generally lower than non-Māori participation.
- Māori in Auckland continue to rate their family and whānau wellbeing much more poorly than Aucklanders and Māori in other regions.
- Māori are more likely to report they do not have enough money to meet their everyday needs. Hardship withdrawals from KiwiSaver were more likely to be Auckland residents and Māori.
- More Māori tamariki are living in poverty compared to non-Māori tamariki.
- Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau have lower levels of qualifications than non-Māori. Māori are more likely to be studying at lower levels of vocational education training than non-Māori. School attendance of Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau has been affected by COVID-19.

Younger people in Auckland are not doing as well as they could be, compared to how young people fare in other regions

The COVID-19 pandemic, lockdowns and the learning and employment effects have exacerbated the impact of existing vulnerabilities and disadvantages for young people:

- There has been a rapid increase in Auckland's youth NEET rate over 2019-2021. Auckland's youth NEET rate is typically higher than those of other urban regions.

¹ Māori living in the Auckland region who are not in a Mana Whenua group.



- The people experiencing homelessness are disproportionately young, with nearly 50% aged under 25 years of age.
- Young people and Auckland residents were more likely to consider hardship withdrawals from KiwiSaver, than other age groups and regions.

Residents of West and South Auckland are more likely to experience lower levels of wellbeing, than those living in East or North Auckland

Local board areas in West and South Auckland tend to have relatively weak performance on the indicators than other local board areas. This is partly related to demographics, with higher proportions of Māori, Pacific People and younger people living in these local board areas.

Labour market outcomes in Auckland vary significantly across ethnicity, age, and location, and these play an important part in explaining Auckland's relativities to New Zealand. In particular, the significant proportion of Pacific people in Auckland have lower labour participation rates, lower employment rates, higher unemployment rates, and higher youth NEET rates, than other major ethnic groups in Auckland, and compared to Pacific peoples across New Zealand. Māori in Auckland also have lower labour participation rates and higher unemployment and youth NEET rates. These outcomes are also more heavily concentrated in West and South Auckland, reflecting the larger populations of Pacific people and Māori in those areas.

Performance also relates to industrial differences in these local board areas.

The following local board areas tend to have weaker performance than other local board areas:

- Māngere-Ōtāhuhu
- Ōtara-Papatoetoe
- Manurewa
- Papakura
- Maungakiekie-Tāmaki
- Henderson-Massey
- Whau.

Compared to international regions, Auckland performs poorly on income and productivity measures but has superior performance in quality of living indicators like air quality, life expectancy, and anti-government corruption

Auckland is compared to city-regions in Australia, Canada, US, Chile and Europe. On many indicators of wellbeing and prosperity, Auckland performs at about the midpoint – for example, youth NEET, urbanisation, patent applications, voter turnouts, and social networks.

While Auckland performs less well on economic indicators like income and productivity, it does well on quality of living indicators. These include being the best air quality of all comparable international regions, and superior performance in life expectancy and perceptions of government corruption. Auckland also has low unemployment relative to other international regions.



INTRODUCTION

There has been a focus on Tāmaki Makaurau | Auckland's economic performance

In the last decade, central government has implemented more place-based approaches to policy making and policy action, including a focus on Tāmaki Makaurau | Auckland. This has ranged from governance reforms and fora for central government-local government decision making, to the establishment of the NZ Government Auckland Policy Office and dedicated investment in infrastructure.

Much of the work to date has been driven from an economic development lens, with some but not equal, attention on social and environmental outcomes.

Various reports and indicator-based overviews have been provided on Auckland's economic performance. This includes:

- The Auckland chapter of the joint Ministry of Economic Development, The Treasury and Statistics NZ Economic development indicators 2007
- The technical background document for Auckland's economic development strategy 2011
- Regional Economic Activity Reports 2013-2015
- The 2017 Auckland Story.

A shared evidence base will inform policy responses

Auckland presents both public policy opportunities and challenges. The response needs to be systems-led and integrated. This requires a shared evidence base of data, information, and insights to inform decision making. Given the range of policy issues that need to be considered, the data and measures need to go beyond economic indicators.

There are many different measures and indicators that can be used to show Auckland's performance over time, and existing frameworks that can be adopted or modified.

This evidence base should help stimulate further analysis. In-depth sub-regional analysis and cross-theme analysis is beyond the scope of this report

Sitting alongside this report is an MS Excel workbook of all the raw data for each of the indicators. There are 90 indicators in total.

The majority of the discussion in this report relates to how Auckland, as a region performs, relative to other regions in New Zealand and to the New Zealand average. There is some drilling down into performance at the territorial authority and local board level where data is available, but comprehensive analysis at this level is beyond the scope of this report. For example, we do not provide detailed information at all levels of interest – ethnicity, age, local board areas, functional urban



areas, and gender. For those interested in further detail at this level, we encourage interrogation of the data set that accompanies this report.

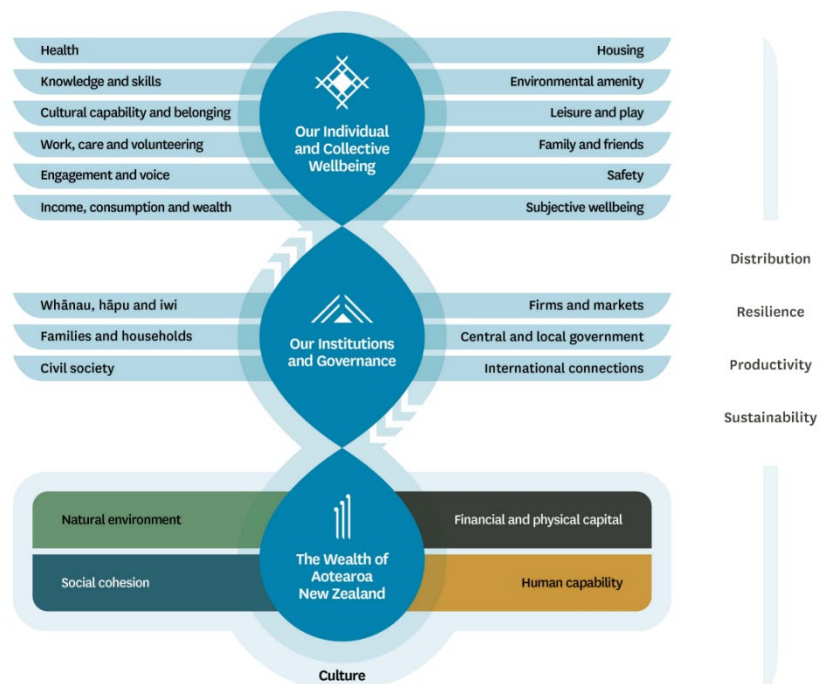
We have not undertaken cross-theme analysis. This would require statistical analysis of the relationships between and within the indicators, and isolating mediating and moderating variables. This is beyond the scope of this report. Again, the accompanying data set could be used for that purpose.

COVID-19, and associated mitigations, have had great impact on the performance of some indicators where we have the most up-to-date data. Where appropriate and relevant, we discuss some of these impacts and their implications.

The Auckland Wellbeing and Prosperity Framework has been developed to account for the range of themes that are particular to Auckland

There are a number of different frameworks that are used in New Zealand, and internationally, to understand wellbeing:

- OECD's How's Life?
- The Treasury's 2018 Living Standards Framework, and 2021 Living Standards Framework
- Indicators Aotearoa New Zealand developed by Stats NZ which supports many cross-government initiatives and international reporting requirements, including the Treasury's Living Standards Framework and the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)
- Wellington Region Genuine Progress Index (WR-GPI)
- Independent Māori Statutory Board's Māori Plan for Tāmaki Makaurau
- [Canterbury Wellbeing Index](#)



- Auckland Story 2017
- Infometrics Regional Wellbeing Framework
- Taituarā | SOLGM Community wellbeing indicators.

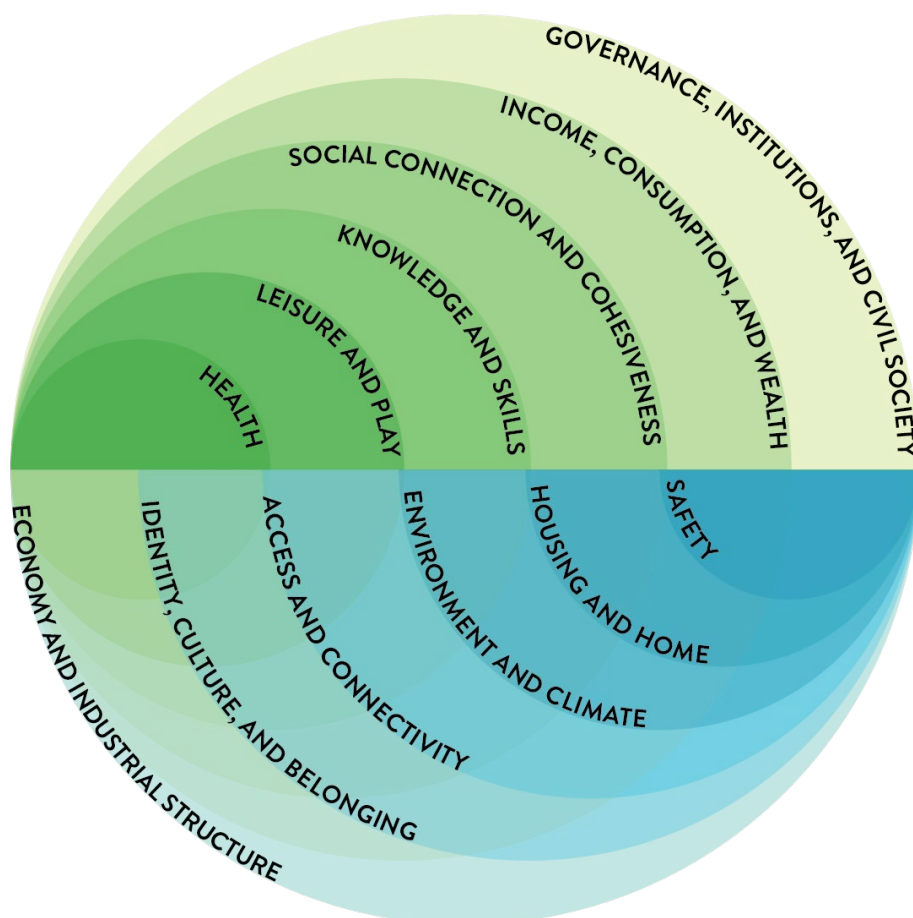
Given that the LSF 2021 has been generally adopted across government, the Auckland Wellbeing and Prosperity Framework (AWPF) uses the LSF 2021 as its foundation.

The LSF 2021 has three levels. Level 1: Our individual and collective wellbeing has 12 wellbeing domains. Level 2: Our institutions and governance is a new level. It captures the role of political, economic, social and cultural institutions. Level 3: The wealth of Aotearoa New Zealand concentrates on 'capabilities' rather than 'capitals' (as in the LSF 2018. Culture now underpins all aspects of wealth.

In total there are now over 100 wellbeing indicators.

A workshop in Tāmaki Makaurau, with 17 government agencies, discussed the potential framework and indicators that are required to understand Auckland's performance.

The AWPF is the culmination of that workshop and existing wellbeing frameworks. The Framework is illustrated by a sphere recognising the interconnectedness of many domains, capabilities and resources of a region as place of people, infrastructure, natural environment and institutions.



A key distinction of AWPf is the inclusion of “access and connectivity”. One aspect missing from LSF 2018 was transport. LSF 2021 now includes transport networks as part of the built environment and under “environmental amenity”. In LSF 2021, transport networks are a feature of the built environment as are sportsgrounds, playgrounds, and buildings. It is also recognised that transport is important for wellbeing, enabling access to services, work, and learning, and to whānau, family, and social connections. In the AWPf, “access and connectivity” includes transport networks as well as international connections which support social wellbeing, and firms and markets.

It is important to future-proof any wellbeing framework. LSF 2021 does not explicitly include reference to climate change. Climate regulation is an indicator within “natural capital” and young people engaging on issues of the day, like climate change, is discussed in relation to “engagement and voice”. We thought it important to give prominence to climate change and the associated policy challenges. As such, one of the themes is “environment and climate”.

The Framework has 12 themes. We have grouped the themes into four broad areas (in no particular order):

Social capital	Social connection and cohesiveness	This theme considers the extent to which Aucklanders feel they are loved and supported by close friends, family and community members, and love and support them in turn. Beyond the intrinsic pleasure that people derive from spending time with others, social connections have positive spill-over effects for individual and societal well-being. People with extensive and supportive networks have better health, tend to live longer, and are more likely to be employed. At a society-wide level, social connections can generate shared values – such as trust in others and norms of reciprocity – which influence a range of outcomes, including economic growth, democratic participation, and crime. It is the willingness of diverse individuals and groups to trust and co-operate with each other in the interests of all, supported by shared intercultural norms and values.
	Governance, institutions and civil society	Civic engagement allows people to express their voice and to contribute to the political functioning of their society. In turn, in well-functioning democracies, civic engagement shapes the institutions that govern people's lives. This also considers the extent to which Māori, iwi/hapū and whānau have a strong voice, are decision makers on issues that impact them, and lead in the achievement of positive life outcomes. Even if all citizens enjoy fundamental civic rights, they do not necessarily exercise them effectively, particularly in the case of the poor, the less educated, and the youthful.
	Safety	This theme is about the ability of Aucklanders to be kept safe from harm and the fear of harm. Personal security and safety are key components of people's well-being. Although many factors influence personal security, crime is one of the most common ones. Crime may lead to the loss of life and property, physical pain, post-traumatic stress, and anxiety, both in the short and in the long run. Living in safe communities is essential to people's well-being, as feelings of insecurity will limit people's daily activities and functioning.
Human capital	Identity, cultural capability and belonging	This theme is about the extent that Aucklanders feel proud of the region, are able to express identity, feel a sense of belonging, and participate fully in society. Everyone can participate on equal terms, regardless of age, gender, sexual orientation, cultural background, or disability. It includes having the language, knowledge, and connections to be able to participate, as well as helping others grow their cultural capability and feel a sense of belonging.
	Knowledge and skills	Education and skills have a strong influence on people's well-being. Education opens opportunities for people and brings a wide range of benefits to society, including higher economic growth, stronger social cohesion, and less crime. By investing in education, families and governments can reach many economic and social goals at the same time.



		Strong disparities remain in the quality of educational outcomes, and educational attainment and students' skills are strongly influenced by the incomes and socio-economic backgrounds of their families, with educational disadvantage cumulating over the life course. Knowledge and skills overlap somewhat with the identity, cultural capability and belonging theme. It is kept separate to highlight the particular importance of certain types of cultural knowledge for the wellbeing of people.
	Health	Being healthy is one of the most valued aspects of people's lives, and one that affects the probability of having a job, earning an adequate income, and actively participating in a range of valued social activities. People's health status is, however, difficult to measure, as it encompasses a variety of dimensions, such as the length of people's lives, the presence and severity of chronic conditions, and the many aspects of physical morbidity and mental health. Inequalities in health status are pervasive, with women, Māori, Pacific peoples and older people reporting lower satisfaction with their health status, and with large health disparities across income groups.
Natural capital	Environment and climate	People's lives are strongly affected by the healthiness of their physical environment. The impact of pollutants, hazardous substances, and noise, on people's health is sizeable. Environmental quality also matters intrinsically, as most people value the beauty and healthiness of the place where they live, and care about the degradation of the planet and the depletion of its natural resources. Climate change has been described as "the biggest global health threat in the 21st century"². Preserving environmental and natural resources is also one of the most important challenges for ensuring the sustainability of wellbeing over time. Environmental policies have a critical role to play in dealing with global health priorities and in improving people's lives.
	Leisure and play	The ability to combine work, family commitments, and personal life, is important for the wellbeing of all household members. It is also important for society as a whole, as it ensures that people have sufficient time to socialise and participate in the life of the community. This theme looks at the distribution of people's time between work and play, and their participation and access to recreation. It is the ability to use free time to rest, recharge, and engage, in personal or shared pursuits.
Economic capital	Economy and industrial structure	Having a job that matches one's aspirations and competencies and that pays adequate earnings is a universal aspiration of people around the globe and underpins wellbeing. This theme also considers earnings inequalities, which have increased in most countries and regions. Women, youth, Māori and Pacific peoples and older workers face relatively high job insecurity, pay inequities, and weaker ties with the labour market. As enterprises generate jobs and earnings for people, this theme includes the value generated by different enterprises in Auckland and the ease of conducting business in the region.
	Income, consumption and wealth	Income and wealth are essential components of individual well-being. Income allows people to satisfy their needs and pursue many other goals that they deem important to their lives, while wealth makes it possible to sustain these choices over time. Both income and wealth enhance individuals' freedom to choose the lives that they want to live, though there are some aspects of their lives that cannot be bought by money.
	Housing and home	Housing is a major element of people's material living standards. It is essential to meet basic needs, such as for shelter from weather conditions, and to offer a sense of personal security, privacy, and personal space. Good housing conditions are also essential for people's health and affect childhood development. Housing costs make up a large share of the household budget and constitute the main component of household wealth. Housing costs are a major concern for households' finances, and income is an essential driver of housing conditions.

² A Costello et al., "Managing the Health Effects of Climate Change," *The Lancet* 373, no. 9676 (2009): 1693–1733, [https://doi.org/10.1016/S0140-6736\(09\)60935-1](https://doi.org/10.1016/S0140-6736(09)60935-1).



	Access and connectivity	This theme is about the ability of Aucklanders to get around to places they value and access the services they need. Planning, mobility, and service systems, allow people to move around and outside of the region, and access the types of places and services they need, when they need them. Access is not just about how people move around physically – connecting online is becoming increasingly important to our wellbeing. Accessing the benefits of the digital world requires timely and reliable access to digital services, regardless of where people work or live.
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Appendix 1 outlines the 12 thematic areas of the Framework, and the specific indicators that are included under each theme.

Auckland is compared to similar regions in New Zealand, and where possible, internationally

Auckland’s performance is presented on a range of indicators selected for each theme. At the start of each theme, a traffic light system shows how Auckland performs relative to other regions, and over time.

The following icons are used. Because high performance on some indicators is a negative attribute, the main feature of the icons to note is the colour. For example, high unemployment would be a negative aspect of a region and this would be shown by:  .

Green indicates positive performance, orange indicates medium performance and red indicates negative performance.

	High relative to New Zealand average, and positive		Increasing over time
	High relative to New Zealand average, and negative		No change over time
	Medium performance, at the New Zealand average		Decreasing over time
	Low relative to New Zealand average, and positive		No data available
	Low relative to New Zealand average, and negative		

In each chart, Auckland is shown as  and New Zealand as  .



Where possible, we compare Auckland to main urban areas, regions that have similar characteristics to Auckland, and regions that are near Auckland:

- Northland
- Waikato
- Wellington
- Canterbury
- Otago.

For each chart we also show the highest and lowest performing region. Where possible, we include comparisons with international city-regions. Appropriate international comparisons can be difficult due to different (and incomparable) measures used, data not being available at the right geographic level, and the distinctive political, social, economic and cultural contexts in which other city-regions exist.

Where data is available and from a single source, Auckland is compared to the city-regions of Adelaide, Brisbane, Copenhagen, Dublin, Helsinki, Melbourne, Portland, Stockholm, Santiago, Sydney, Toronto, and Vancouver.

There are a number of limitations to the indicators used, and caution should be exercised

We reviewed a range of criteria for selecting indicators recommended in various guidelines and social, environment, and economic development monitoring reports.³ Collectively, these reports provided us with the following selection criteria:

- relevant to wellbeing and the theme of interest – the indicator should be the most accurate statistic for measuring both the level and extent of change in wellbeing and the theme of interest, and it should adequately reflect what it is intended to measure (that is, it should be valid)
- based on broad support – there should be wide support for the indicators chosen so they report on a broadly shared understanding of wellbeing [acceptability]
- grounded in research – there should be sound evidence on key influences and factors affecting wellbeing and the theme [relation to causal factors]

³ Ministry of Economic Development, "Economic Development Indicators: 2011" (Wellington: Ministry of Economic Development, 2011); Ministry of Social Development, "The Social Report 2016" (Wellington: Ministry of Social Development, 2016), <http://socialreport.msd.govt.nz/index.html>; New Zealand et al., *Environment Aotearoa 2019*, 2019; Ministry for Culture and Heritage, "Cultural Indicators for New Zealand 2009" (Wellington: Ministry for Culture and Heritage, 2009); Stats NZ, "Indicators Aotearoa New Zealand – Ngā Tūtohu Aotearoa: Key Findings from Consultation and Engagement" (Wellington: Stats NZ Tatauranga Aotearoa, April 2019), <https://www.stats.govt.nz/assets/Uploads/Indicators-Aotearoa-New-Zealand-Nga-Tutohu-Aotearoa-Key-findings-from-consultation-and-engagement/Downloads/indicators-aotearoa-new-zealand-nga-tutohu-aotearoa-key-findings-from-consultation-and-engagement.pdf>; Ministry of Social Development, "Children and Young People: Indicators of Wellbeing in New Zealand 2008" (Wellington: Ministry of Social Development, 2008); S. Milligan et al., "Family Wellbeing Indicators from the 1981–2001 New Zealand Censuses" (Wellington: Statistics New Zealand in conjunction with The University of Auckland University of Otago, 2006); Statistics New Zealand, "NZ Social Indicators" (Wellington: Statistics New Zealand, 2017); Ministry of Transport, "Transport Monitoring Indicator Framework (TMIF)," Ministry of Transport, 2010, <http://www.transport.govt.nz/ourwork/tmif/>; Ministry of Economic Development, The Treasury, and Statistics New Zealand, "Economic Development Indicators 2007" (Wellington: Ministry of Economic Development, 2007); Statistics New Zealand, "Indicator Guidelines" (Statistics New Zealand, 2005); Statistics New Zealand, "Housing Indicators 2008" (Wellington: Statistics New Zealand, 2012), http://archive.stats.govt.nz/browse_for_stats/people_and_communities/housing/housing-indicators.aspx.



- able to be disaggregated – ideally, it should be possible to break the data down by age, sex, socio-economic status, ethnicity, family or household type and region, so we can compare outcomes for different population groups
- consistent over time – the indicator should be able to be defined and measured consistently over time to enable the accurate monitoring of trends
- statistically sound – the indicator uses high-quality data and the method used to construct it is statistically robust [sample size]
- timely – data should be collected and reported regularly to ensure indicators are providing up-to-date information
- regionally significant – the indicator reflects progress at a regional level and is not confined to particular areas
- internationally comparable – as well as reflecting the wellbeing of Aucklanders and New Zealanders, indicators should be consistent with those used in international monitoring programmes so we can make comparisons
- representative – representative of a story told by any relevant indicators not included.

An important consideration is that there will likely be trade-offs. That is, it is unlikely that an indicator would meet all criteria and judgment needs to be exercised. For example, an indicator might be used because it's the only one available for an essential dimension, even though another indicator (as yet undeveloped or available) is preferred. Costs of producing a new indicator must be balanced against existing sources.

The indicators used in this report vary in quality, timeliness, and robustness due to their different sources. In addition, the causal relationships between the indicators and wellbeing are complex and not always clear cut. For both reasons, the individual indicators need to be interpreted with care. The report should also be read with the following considerations in mind:

The indicators should be viewed collectively

As a set, these indicators provide a picture of the factors influencing wellbeing in Auckland. Viewed together and over time, they provide useful information about trends, Auckland's future direction, and how different parts of society, institutions, and systems relate to each other. Individually they provide, at best, only an indication of change in a particular area.

Change takes time

While some indicators show change over 10 years or more, others may only have one or two years of data. The efforts of the public and private sectors to improve wellbeing will only be apparent in the indicators over long periods of time.

The linkages between indicators, the themes, and wellbeing are complex

We have based our selection of indicators on what theory and empirical evidence tell us about the likely determinants of wellbeing. However, the relationship between these underlying dimensions and overall wellbeing is not straightforward. There is not necessarily a simple causal relationship between performance on a particular indicator and aggregate performance.



Furthermore, indicators are generally only a proxy for the underlying dimension or factor we are interested in. For example, educational attainment is a proxy for, but not a perfect measure of, a person's knowledge and skills. This means it is important to be cautious about drawing policy conclusions from the indicators: while poor performance on a particular indicator may signal the existence of a problem to be addressed through policy, this is not necessarily the case.

Attributing changes in indicators to specific policies is difficult

It is difficult to attribute changes in indicators to specific policies, as a variety of government initiatives will act on each indicator. In addition, government policy is only one of a number of factors that influence the behaviour of the indicators, people, society, the environment, and the economy. For example, the COVID-19 pandemic and the resulting mitigation strategies have had a profound effect on wellbeing at a number of different levels. However, the indicators should help stimulate further analysis where appropriate.



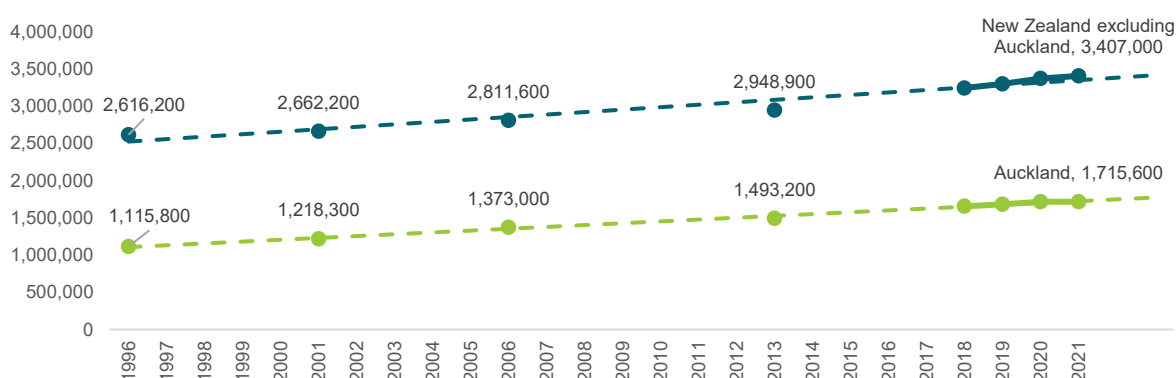
IF AUCKLAND WERE 100 PEOPLE

It is the people that make up Auckland. The health and wellbeing status of a population is influenced by population structure and demographic change. Changes in the size and structure of the population can also have significant impacts on natural, physical, economic, and social environments, including the demand for health and social services, cultural and recreational services, schools, transport, water, waste management, energy, and housing.

Demographics are quantifiable characteristics of a given population. The following narrative and charts provide a picture of Auckland's current population – age structure, sex, ethnicity, disability status, household structure, place of birth, sexual identity, local board of residence, and urban accessibility. To aid understanding, this section discusses Auckland's population as if it were made up of a 100 people.

Auckland's population has grown about 1.8% a year over the previous 20 years, higher than the national rate of 1.4% a year (Figure 2). In the wake of the COVID-19 pandemic, Auckland's population fell for the first time in 2021. COVID-19 border restrictions are likely the key contributor to this decline.

Figure 2. Population estimates, at 30 June 1996-2021 (2021 boundaries), Auckland and rest of New Zealand



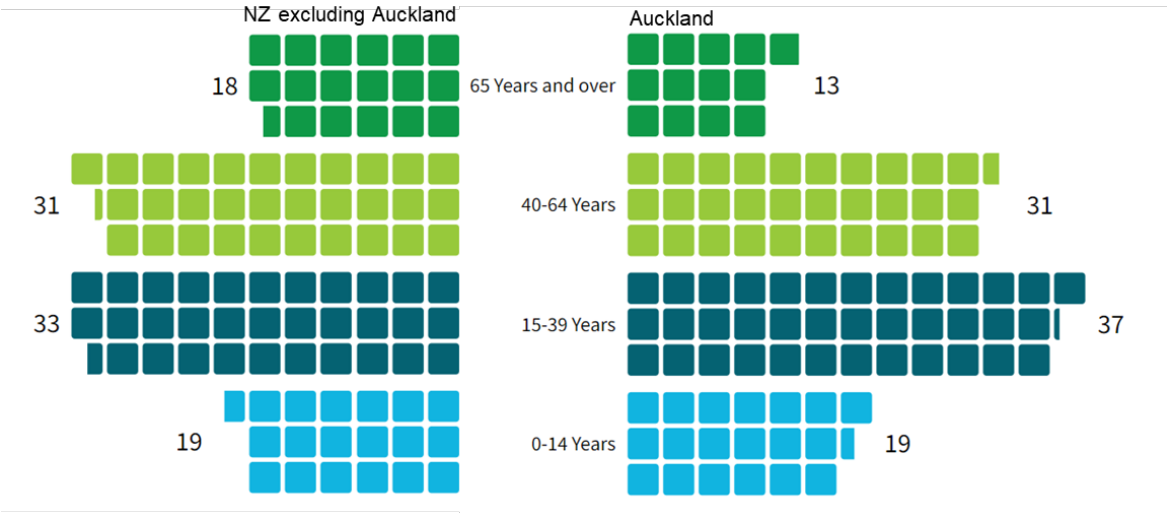
Source: Stats NZ, Sub-national population estimates

Compared with most other regions in New Zealand, Auckland's population is relatively young. If Auckland were 100 people:

- 19 would be aged 0 – 14 years old
- 37 would be 15 – 29 years old
- 31 aged between 40 – 64 years
- 13 aged 65 years and over.



If the rest of New Zealand was 100 people, there would be five more people aged 65 years and over, and four fewer people aged 15 – 39 years old.



Source: Stats NZ sub-national population estimates, 2021

In 2020, there were slightly more females than males, and for every 100 people there was one person who identified as transgender and non-binary. The Household Economic Survey 2019/20 was the first household survey where Stats NZ asked respondents to describe their gender. Combined with a question about sex at birth, this information was helpful to better reflect gender minorities in New Zealand’s population.

The rest of New Zealand has the same proportions of males, females and transgender/non-binary people as Auckland.



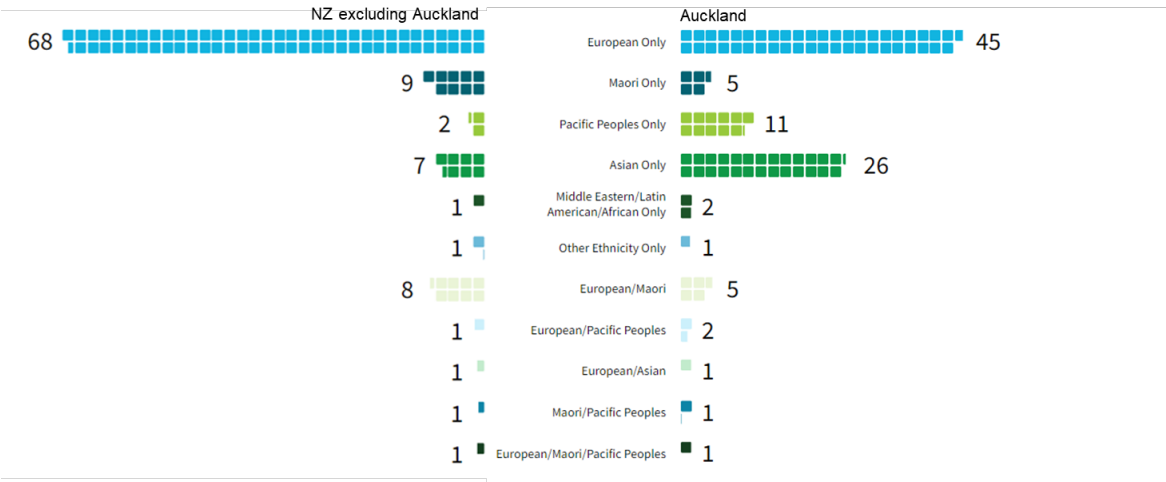
Source: Stats NZ Household Economic Survey, 2020

Gender will asked for the first time in a Census in 2023.



Together, people who identify as European only and as Māori only make up about half of Auckland's population. This contrasts with the rest of New Zealand where 77 out of 100 people are European only or Māori only.

Over a quarter of people in Auckland are of Asian only ethnicity, and over 10% are of Pacific ethnicity. In the rest of New Zealand, 1 out of 100 people are Middle Eastern, Latin American or African only, while in Auckland there are 2 out of 100 people of this ethnicity.

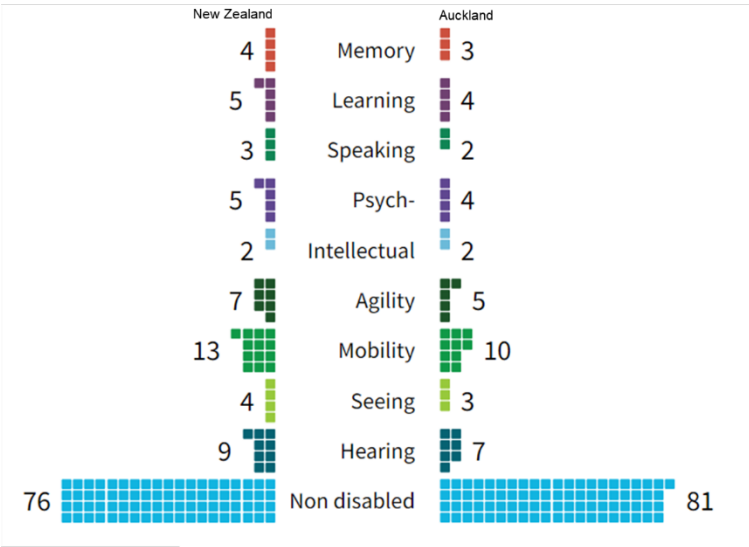


Source: Stats NZ Census of Population and Dwellings, 2018

There are no official recent disability statistics at the regional level. In 2013, 10 out of 100 people in Auckland had a mobility disability and 7 out of 100 people had a hearing disability.

In New Zealand as a whole, for every 100 people, there are a few more people with mobility, agility and hearing disabilities, than in Auckland.

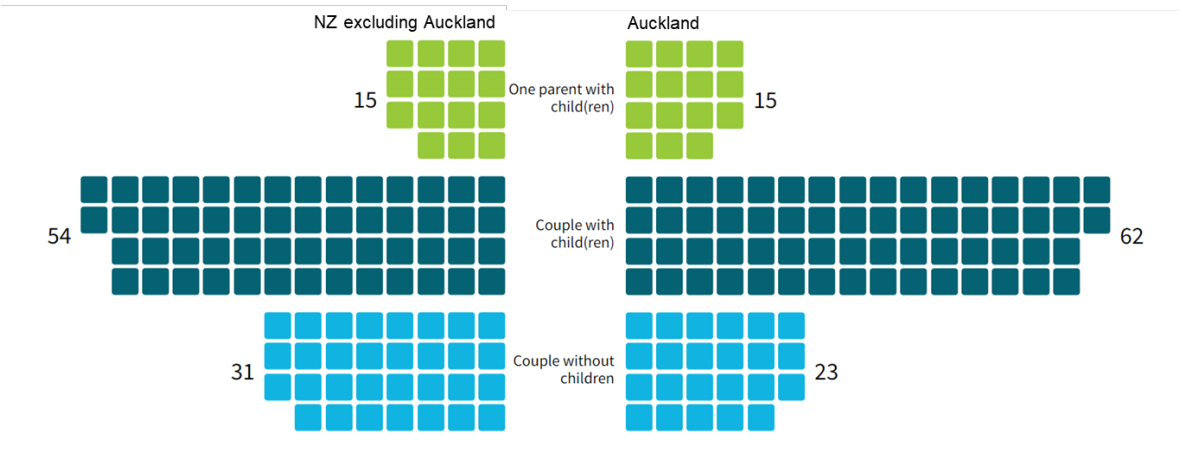
More detailed and recent disability information will be collected in the Disability Survey 2023.



Source: Stats NZ Disability Survey 2013

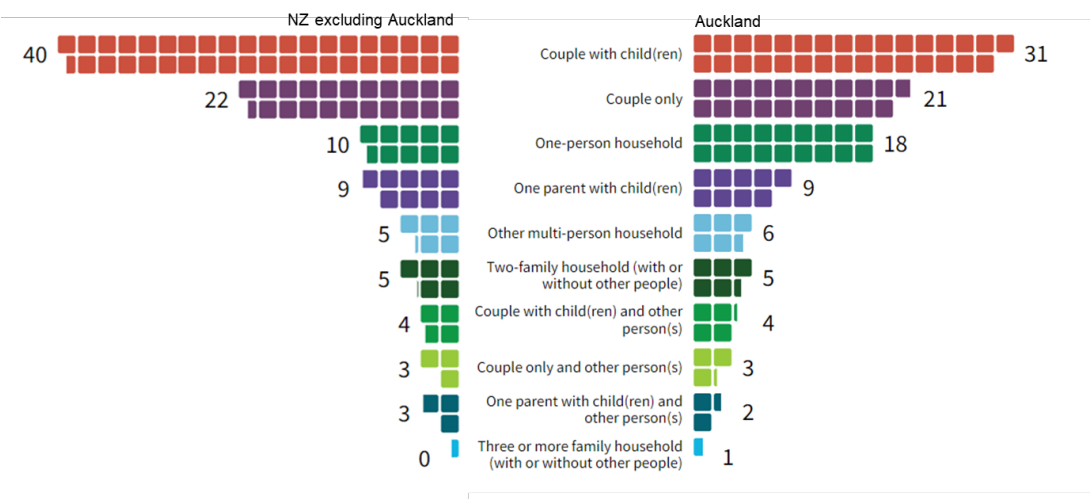


In Auckland, the most common family type is “couple with child(ren)” – 62 of 100 families in occupied private dwellings consist of this type. The next most common is “couple without children” – 23 of 100 families. The rest of New Zealand has less families consisting of “couple with child(ren)”, but more “couple without children”.



Source: Stats NZ Census of Population and Dwellings, 2018

The household type “couple with child(ren)” occurs in 31 of 100 households in Auckland, and rises to 40 of 100 households in the rest of New Zealand. There are almost double the number of one-person households in Auckland, compared to the rest of New Zealand – for every 100 households in Auckland there are 18 one-person households, but only 10 in the rest of New Zealand.

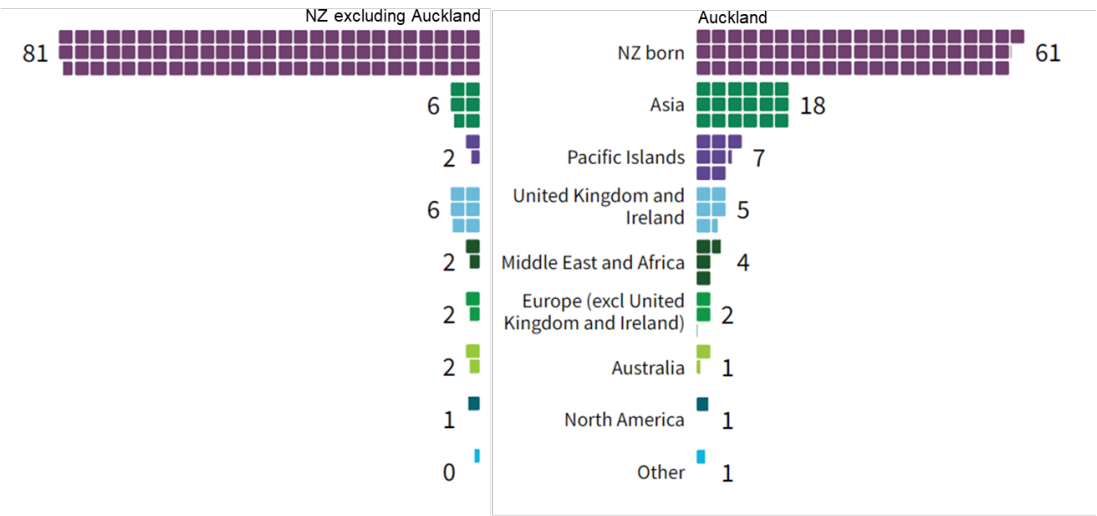


Source: Stats NZ Census of Population and Dwellings, 2018



While the number of people born overseas has been increasing across New Zealand, the pattern in Auckland is even more pronounced. In 2018, for every 100 people in Auckland, 18 were born in Asia, 7 were born in the Pacific Islands, 5 born in the UK and Ireland and 4 born in the Middle East and Africa.

In contrast, just under a fifth of people in the rest of New Zealand were born overseas.



Source: Stats NZ Census of Population and Dwellings, 2018

Sexual minorities include people who are sexually attracted to the same sex or gender, people who are sexually attracted to more than one sex or gender, including their own, and other sexual identities (for example, asexual).

Of the adult population, 3.7% of New Zealanders identified with a sexual minority. This consisted of 1.2% gay or lesbian people, 1.7% bisexual people, and 0.8% of people who reported another sexual identity.

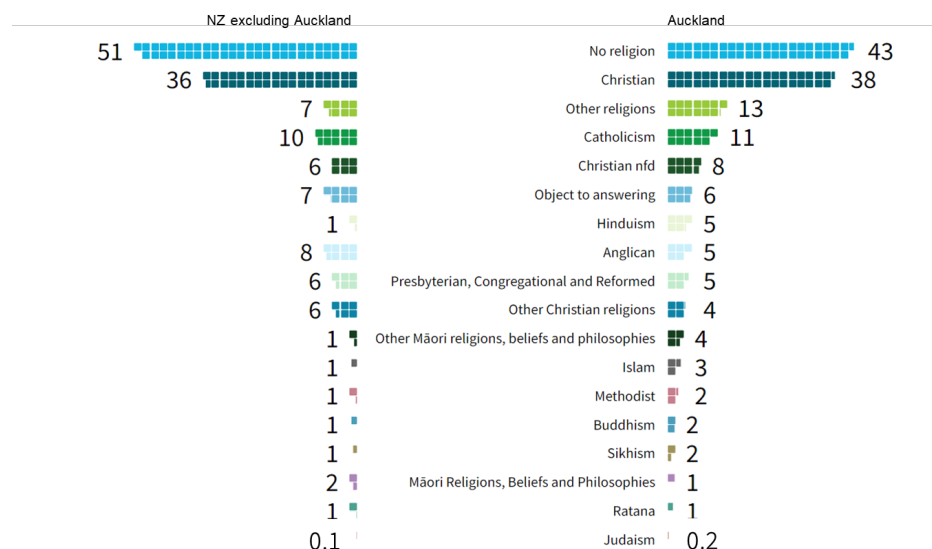


Source: Stats NZ Household Economic Survey, 2020

In Auckland, 5% or 5 in every 100 people identified with a sexual minority. In the rest of New Zealand, this falls to 4% or 4 in every 100 people.



In 2018, almost half of New Zealanders stated they had no religion. Separating out Auckland, this decreased to 43 out of 100 people. Christianity remains the most common religion in Auckland and the rest of New Zealand, but Auckland has more religious diversity.



Source: Stats NZ, Census of population and dwellings

Note: Will add up to more than 100 as respondents were able to select more than one religious affiliation

Numbers have been rounded to the nearest whole number

Other Christian religions include Latter-day Saints; Evangelical, Born Again and Fundamentalist; and Baptist.

In particular, for every 100 people:

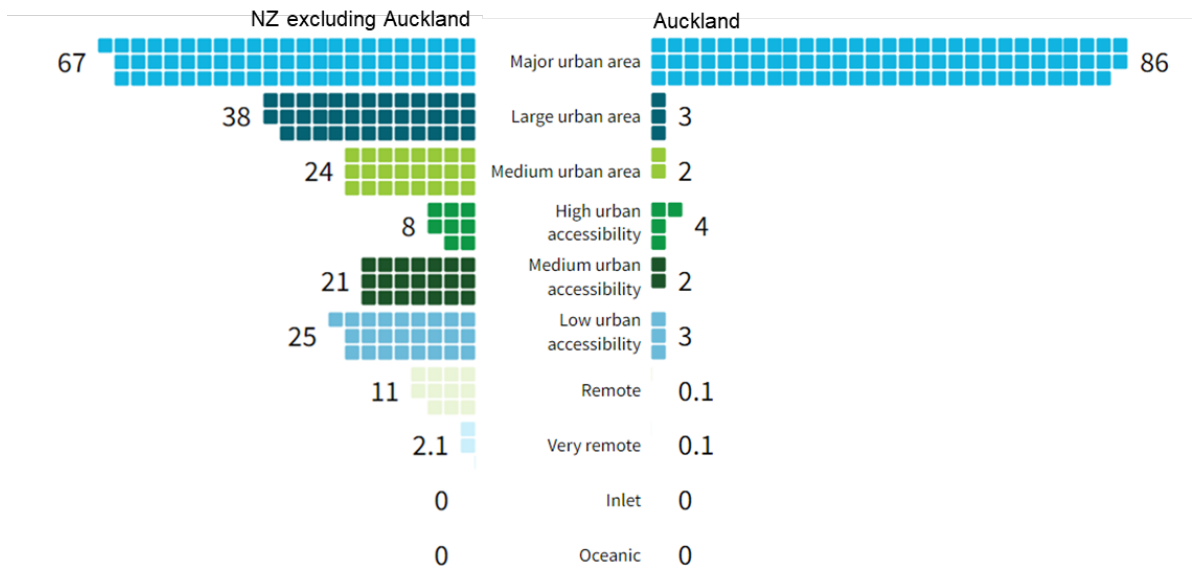
- 5 people in Auckland are affiliated with Māori religions, beliefs and philosophies, 3 people in the rest of New Zealand
- 5 people identify with Hinduism, 1 in the rest of New Zealand
- 3 people in Auckland affiliate with Islam, 1 in the rest of New Zealand
- 2 people indicate affiliation with Buddhism in Auckland, 1 in the rest of New Zealand
- 2 people in Auckland indicated Sikhism, 1 in the rest of New Zealand.

Urban accessibility measures the degree of urban influence New Zealand's urban areas have on surrounding rural areas.

Auckland is highly urbanised. 86 of 100 people live in a major urban area (classified as an area with 100,000 or more residents). This compares with 67 of 100 people in the rest of New Zealand.

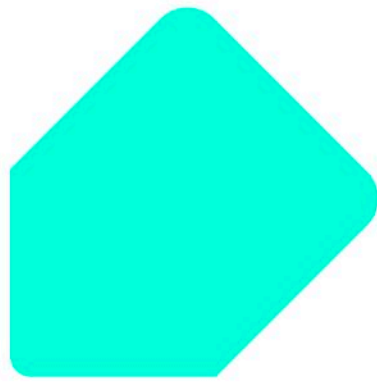
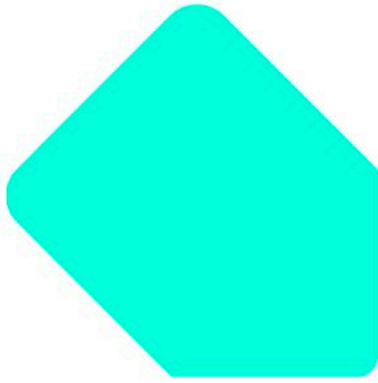
4 people out of 100 in Auckland live with "high urban accessibility" – small urban areas (1,000 to 9,999 residents) and rural areas within 0 to 15 minutes from major urban areas. 8 out of 100 people in the rest of New Zealand live in the same type of area.



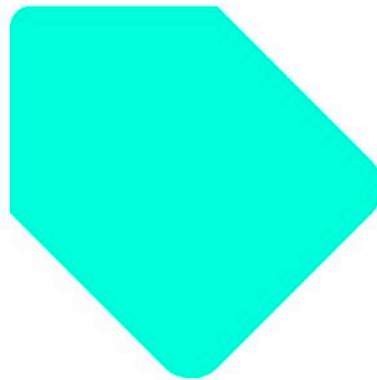
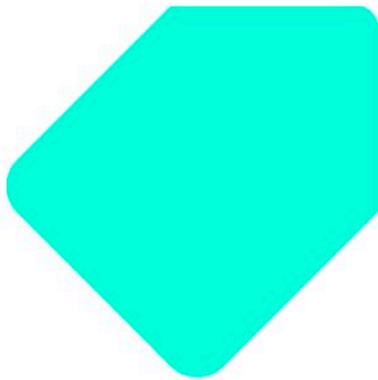


Source: Stats NZ 2018 Census urban accessibility dataset





SOCIAL CAPITAL



SOCIAL CONNECTION AND COHESIVENESS

The willingness of diverse individuals and groups to trust and co-operate with each other in the interests of all, supported by shared intercultural norms and values.

Beyond the intrinsic pleasure that people derive from spending time with others, social connections have positive spill-over effects for individual and societal well-being. People with extensive and supportive networks have better health, tend to live longer, and are more likely to be employed.

At a society-wide level, social connections can generate shared values – such as trust in others and norms of reciprocity – which influence a range of outcomes, including economic growth, democratic participation and crime. This reflects the willingness of diverse individuals and groups to trust and co-operate with each other in the interests of all, supported by shared intercultural norms and values.

Summary

A higher proportion of Aucklanders had high perceptions of family wellbeing than in New Zealand and other major regions between 2016 and 2021. Perceptions of family wellbeing have been relatively constant over time. During the course of the pandemic, high perceptions of family wellbeing dipped from 86.7% of Aucklanders in June 2020, to 84.0% in the September 2020 quarter. This has since improved, but hasn't yet rebounded to pre-pandemic levels.

In Auckland, the percentage of adults who felt lonely at least some of the time in the last four weeks, has fluctuated over time, and tended to sit at the lower range of the scale pre-COVID. In 2018, 15% of adults in Auckland indicated that they felt lonely at least some of the time, compared to 21% of adults in Northland. Recent data suggests that COVID-19 mitigations have meant that Auckland went from having the lowest proportion of people who felt lonely to having one of the highest proportion of people who felt lonely.

Over time, less Aucklanders are having face-to-face contact with friends who do not live with them at least once a week. When last measured in 2018-2019, a higher proportion of Aucklanders (74.8%) reported this contact than the proportion nationally (73.7%).

Family and whānau wellbeing	H	~
Loneliness	H	▲
Social network support	M	▼
Someone to count on	Data not available in time for publication ⁴	
Feeling loved	Data not available in time for publication ⁵	
Trust in others	M	~
Discrimination	M	~

⁴ Relies on Whataboutme? Youth Health and Wellbeing Survey. As at April 2022, results had not been released.

⁵ Relies on Whataboutme? Youth Health and Wellbeing Survey. As at April 2022, results had not been released.



Levels of trust in Auckland have remained stable over the COVID-19 pandemic, as have New Zealand's. A similar proportion of people across Auckland and New Zealand reported high levels of trust in other people in New Zealand in the March 2021 quarter.

The percentage of Auckland adults who experienced discrimination in the past 12 months in New Zealand stayed relatively stable between 2014 and 2018, and is near the New Zealand average. Over half of Māori, Pacific people and Asians said that incidents of racism in New Zealand had increased following COVID-19.

Aucklanders believe their family wellbeing to be high, relative to other regions. Perceptions of high family wellbeing have not yet recovered to pre-pandemic levels

It is generally agreed that the wellbeing of the family or whānau unit is important for maintaining healthy, happy and productive individuals.⁶ Healthy, happy and productive individuals form the backbone of a flourishing country and region. There is growing understanding of the significant contribution that families make to generating productive workers and bringing up the next generation. Families and whānau provide for the basis for raising children, caring for family members, providing and receiving love and the intergenerational transmission of culture, values and knowledge. As social, economic and demographic changes are putting new pressures on families, it becomes ever more important to review how they are doing.⁷

The official source of wellbeing data in New Zealand is the New Zealand General Social Survey (NZGSS). The NZGSS shows that, over time, Aucklanders had consistent and higher perceptions of family wellbeing than New Zealand and other major regions (Figure 3).

Over 2020-2021, when Aucklanders were asked how they felt their family was doing, 85% of Aucklanders rated family wellbeing a score of 7/10 or higher (on a scale of 0–10, where 0 is doing extremely badly and 10 is doing extremely well) (Figure 3).

When asked in March 2021 to rate how well their families were doing at the time, 84.7% of Aucklanders gave a rating of 7 or above (on a 0–10 scale) compared to 84.1% of New Zealanders, with an average rating of 7.8 out of 10. This was unchanged from the December 2020 quarter.⁸

⁶ K Bogenschneider and T. J Corbett, "Family Policy: Becoming a Field of Inquiry and Subfield of Social Policy," *Journal of Marriage and Family* 72, no. 3 (2010): 783–803.

⁷ Superu, "Families and Whānau Status Report 2014" (Wellington: Social Policy Evaluation and Research Unit (Superu), 2014), <https://thehub.swa.govt.nz/assets/Uploads/Families-and-Whanau-Status-Report-2014-1.pdf>.

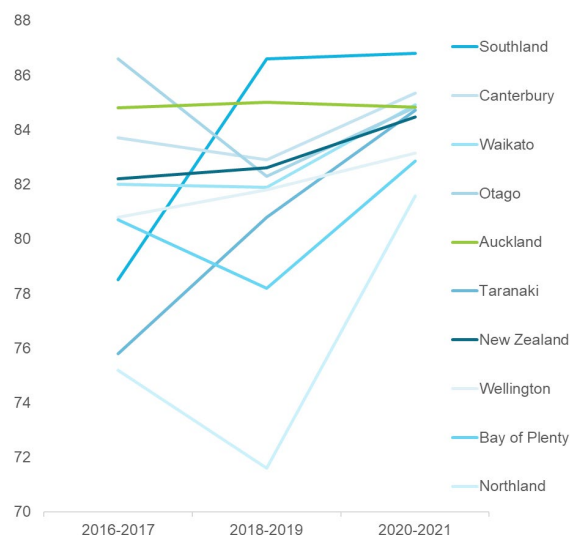
⁸ Stats NZ, "Wellbeing Statistics: A Year in Review (June 2020 to March 2021 Quarter)" (Wellington: Stats NZ, June 2021), <https://www.stats.govt.nz/reports/wellbeing-statistics-a-year-in-review-june-2020-to-march-2021-quarter>.



The following groups, however, continued to rate their family wellbeing more poorly (0–6)⁹:

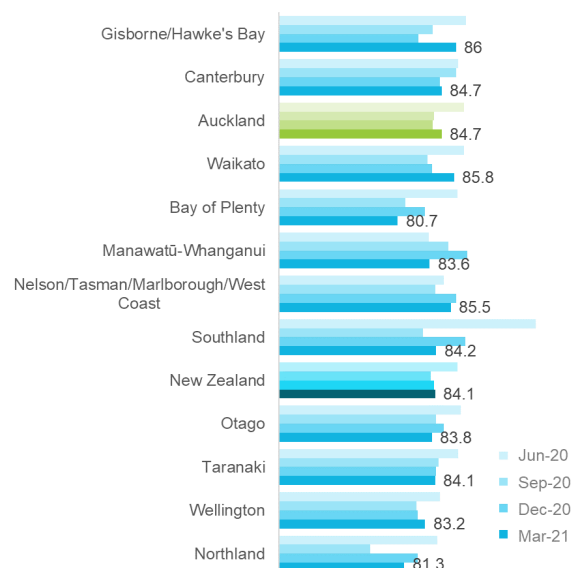
- people with low overall life satisfaction of 0–6 (44%)
- sole parents of dependent children (27%)
- people not in the labour force due to their own illness, sickness, injury, or disability (25%)
- people with an almost certain or high chance of losing their job in the next 12 months (24%)
- Māori (22%).

Figure 3. Percentage of people with a score of 7/10 or higher for how their family is doing, selected regions, 2016-2017 – 2020-2021



Source: Stats NZ, New Zealand General Social Survey including customised data from Stats NZ

Figure 4. Percentage of people with a score of 7/10 or higher for how their family is doing, regions, 2020-2021 quarters



Source: Stats NZ, New Zealand General Social Survey

Aucklanders' mean family wellbeing rating has remained steady around 7.8 and 7.9 over the last few years, and roughly the same proportion of people (85%) indicate that their families are doing very well. In other regions, family wellbeing appears to have risen over time, with most dipping over 2018-2019 and then climbing over 2020-2021. Waikato, Wellington and Southland have seen more consistent improvements in family wellbeing over time.

There were slight falls in family wellbeing after the first lockdown (Figure 4).

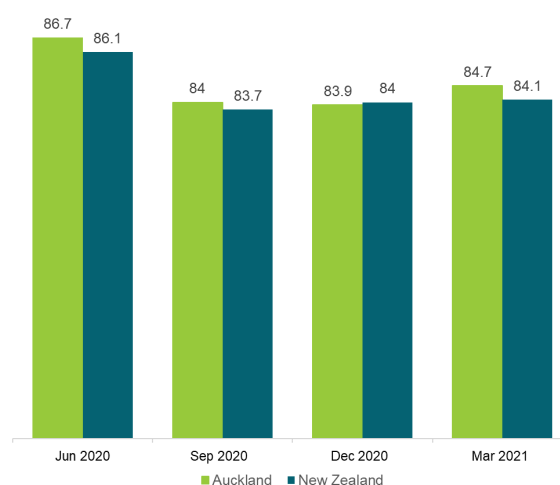
⁹ Stats NZ.



In the June 2020 quarter, 86.7% of Aucklanders indicated that their families were doing very well (Figure 5) and this fell to 84.0% by the September 2020 quarter and 83.9% by the December 2020 quarter. However, it rose to 84.7% by March 2021. Nationally, the proportion of people who rated high family wellbeing has tended to be slightly lower than Auckland's over 2020/21.

At the national level, ethnic differences have been found. Over the four quarters, Pacific peoples and people with Asian ethnicity had a higher mean family wellbeing rating when compared with Europeans and Māori.¹⁰

Figure 5. Percentage of people with a score of 7/10 or higher for how their family is doing, selected regions, 2016-2017 – 2020-2021



Source: Stats NZ, New Zealand General Social Survey

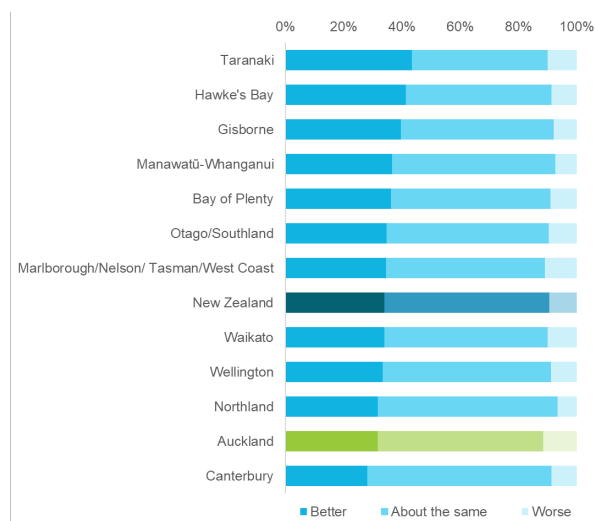
In Te Kupenga, Stats NZ's Māori wellbeing survey, Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau generally had lower levels of whānau wellbeing than Māori in other regions (Figure 6). In 2018, 31.7% of Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau indicated that whānau wellbeing was better than 12 months ago, 56.9% about the same, and 11.5% thought it was worse. This compares with 34% of Māori reporting it was better across New Zealand. In the best performing region, Taranaki, 43.3% of Māori reported it was better than last year.

Between 2013 and 2018, Auckland and Wellington were the two regions that saw improvements in whānau wellbeing, while the proportion of Māori who thought things were better fell in all other regions (Figure 7).

¹⁰ Stats NZ.



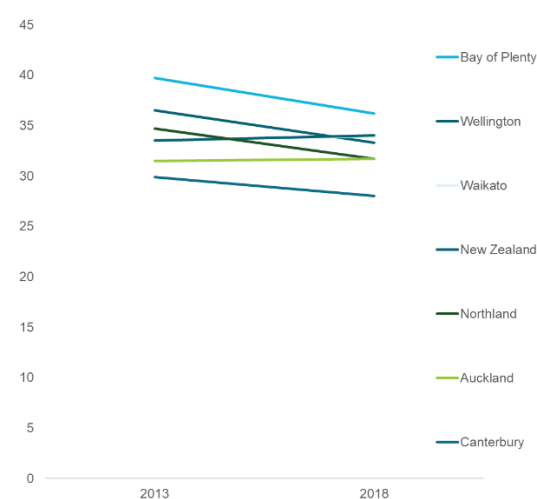
Figure 6. Percentage of Māori who indicate whānau wellbeing is better or worse than 12 months ago, regions, 2018



Source: Stats NZ, Te Kupenga

Note: People aged 15 years and over of Māori ethnicity and/or descent

Figure 7. Percentage of Māori who indicate whānau wellbeing is better than 12 months ago, available regions, 2013 and 2018



Source: Stats NZ, Te Kupenga

Note: People aged 15 years and over of Māori ethnicity and/or descent

Pre-pandemic Auckland was one of the least lonely regions, but is now one of the loneliest regions

Interacting with others is an important part of what it is to be human, and to live in a society. Social participation and connectedness are correlated with wellbeing, whereas social isolation, loneliness and lack of strong social networks are viewed as contributing causes of depression and suicide.¹¹

Many studies have shown that a sense of community and supportive relationships enhance wellbeing.¹²

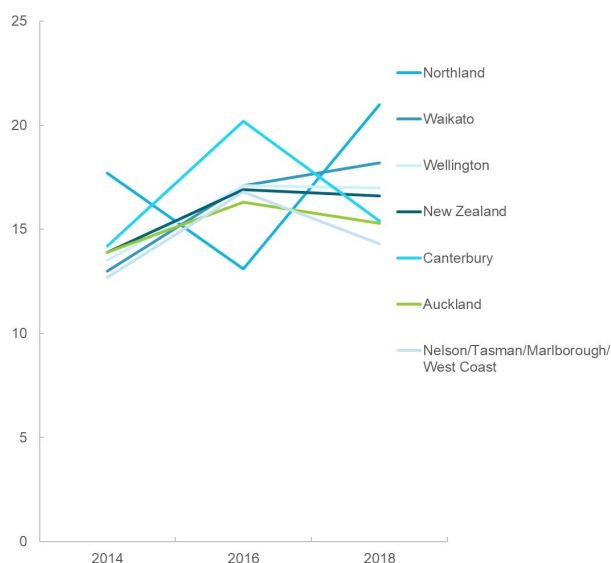
In Auckland, the percentage of adults who felt lonely at least some of the time in the last four weeks, has fluctuated over time (Figure 8), and tended to sit at the lower range of the scale pre-COVID. In 2018, 15% of adults in Auckland indicated that they felt lonely at least some of the time, compared to 21% of adults in Northland (Figure 9).

¹¹ D W Nangle et al., "Popularity, Friendship Quantity, and Friendship Quality: Interactive Influences on Children's Loneliness and Depression," *Journal of Clinical Child and Adolescent Psychology* 32, no. 4 (2003): 546–55.

¹² T J Scheff, "Shame and Community: Social Components in Depression," *Psychiatry* 64, no. 3 (2001): 212–24.

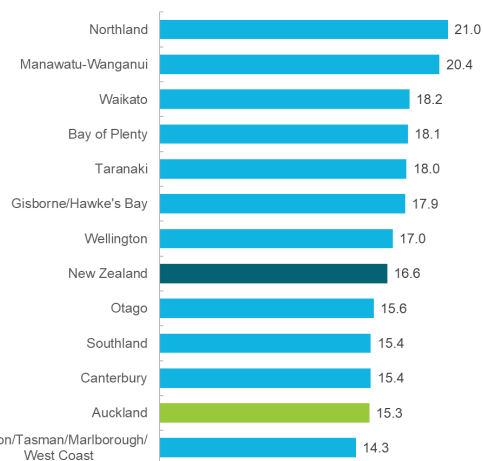


Figure 8. Percentage of adults who felt lonely at least some of the time in the last four weeks, selected regions, 2014–2018



Source: NZGSS, Stats NZ

Figure 9. Percentage of adults who felt lonely at least some of the time in the last four weeks, regions, 2018



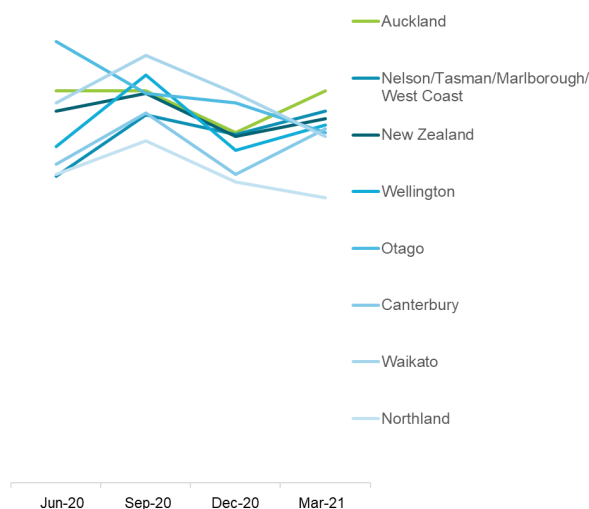
Source: NZGSS, Stats NZ

Nationally, some measures of psychological distress and loneliness seem to have increased slightly during the early COVID-19 public health response but then have recovered quickly.¹³ More recent data suggests that subsequent COVID-19 mitigations have meant that Auckland went from having the lowest proportion of people who felt lonely to having one of the highest proportion of people who felt lonely (Figure 10). Over 2020/21, the national proportion has also increased.

¹³ Sibley, C G et al., "Effects of the COVID-19 Pandemic and Nationwide Lockdown on Trust, Attitudes toward Government, and Well-Being.," *American Psychologist* 75, no. 5 (2020): 618–30.

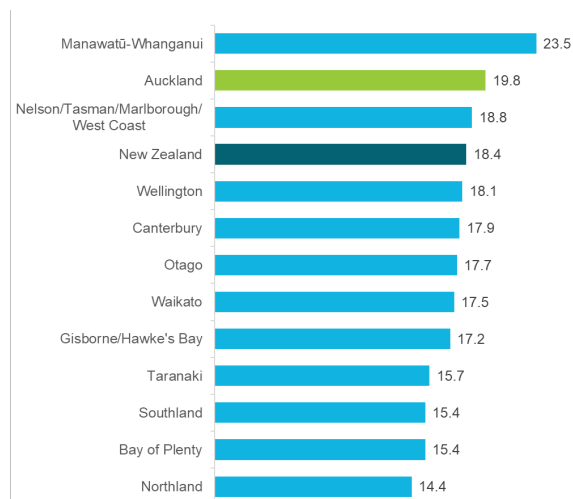


Figure 10. Percentage of adults who felt lonely at least some of the time in the last four weeks, selected regions, 2020/2021 quarters



Source: HLFS supplement, Stats NZ

Figure 11. Percentage of adults who felt lonely at least some of the time in the last four weeks, regions, March 2021 quarter



Source: HLFS supplement, Stats NZ

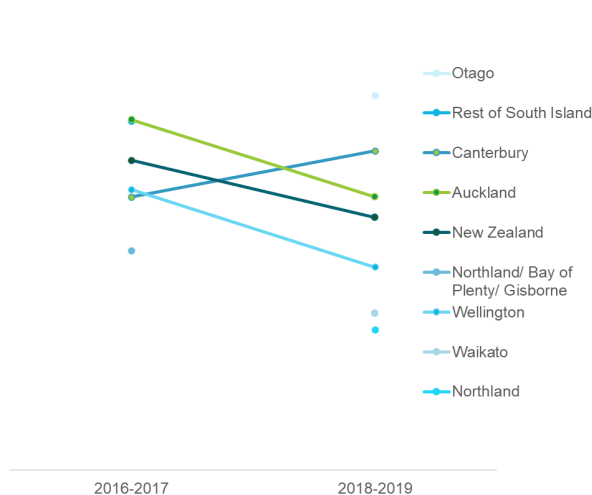
Aucklanders are not meeting up with friends as frequently, but this is about the same as the national average

Over time, fewer Aucklanders are having face-to-face contact with friends who do not live with them at least once a week (Figure 12). This trend is occurring across New Zealand, excepting Canterbury where a larger proportion of people are having face-to-face contact with friends. However, when last measured in 2018-2019, a higher proportion of Aucklanders (74.8%) reported this contact than the proportion nationally (73.7%) (Figure 13). Otago had the highest proportion of people that reported having face-to-face contact with friends and Northland the lowest.

Encouragingly, when comparing at the international level, most Aucklanders believe that if they were in trouble, they would have relatives or friends they could count on to help if needed. In 2014, 93.7% of Aucklanders indicated that this was the case (Figure 14). This was about the midpoint of comparable regions. 97% of people from Dublin thought they could count on friends and family to help, while the least proportion of people (86%) indicated the same in Santiago.

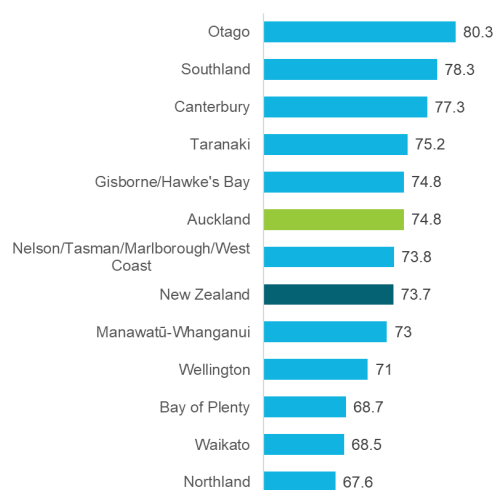


Figure 12. Percentage of adults who had face to face contact with friends who do not live with them at least once a week, selected regions, 2016-2017 and 2018-2019



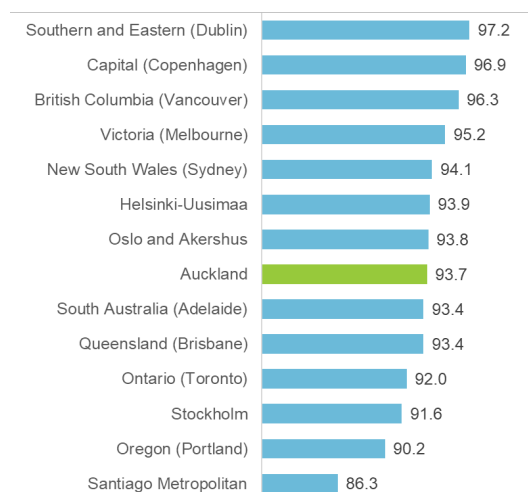
Source: NZGSS, Stats NZ

Figure 13. Percentage of adults who had face to face contact with friends who do not live with them at least once a week, regions, 2018-2019



Source: NZGSS, Stats NZ

Figure 14. Perceived social network support, 2014



Source: OECD.Stat, Regions and Cities

Note: OECD classifies the geographic units in this chart as large regions (territorial level 2 or TL2) to help in assessing differences in socio-economic trends in regions, both within and across countries



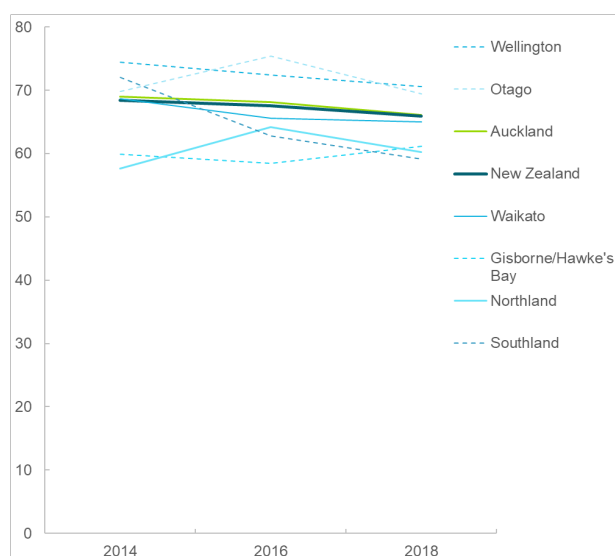
The proportion of people in Auckland who have high trust in others is about the same as the national average

The literature consistently finds that strong social cohesion and networks within communities, and high levels of trust and of social capital as a whole, are strongly predictive of the trajectory of a community's response to an adverse event.¹⁴

Trust is the “glue” that holds communities together¹⁵, and building trust and social inclusion across fragmented groups and communities can be difficult.

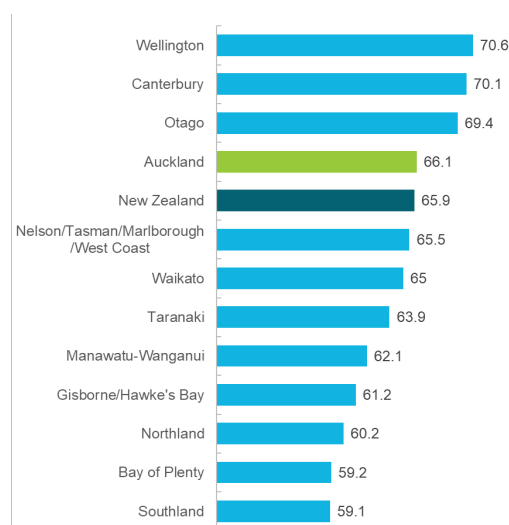
Trust held in others is measured using a question from the NZGSS which asks people to select a score between 0-10 about their trust in other people in New Zealand. Pre-pandemic, a similar proportion of people in Auckland and across New Zealand have a score of 7/10 or higher for trust in other people (Figure 15). There has been a slight decline over time, but is unlikely to be significant.

Figure 15. Percentage of people with a score of 7/10 or higher for trust in other people in New Zealand, selected regions, 2014–2018



Source: NZGSS, Stats NZ

Figure 16. Percentage of people with a score of 7/10 or higher for trust in other people in New Zealand, regions, 2018



Source: NZGSS, Stats NZ

¹⁴ Daniel P. Aldrich and Michelle A. Meyer, “Social Capital and Community Resilience,” *American Behavioral Scientist* 59, no. 2 (February 2015): 254–69, <https://doi.org/10.1177/0002764214550299>; O. Alonge et al., “Understanding the Role of Community Resilience in Addressing the Ebola Virus Disease Epidemic in Liberia: A Qualitative Study (Community Resilience in Liberia),” *Global Health Action* 12, no. 1 (January 1, 2019): 1662682, <https://doi.org/10.1080/16549716.2019.1662682>; Robert Bach et al., “Policy Challenges in Supporting Community Resilience” (Multinational Community Resilience Policy Group, 2010); Catherine C. Slomp et al., “Applying an Innovative Model of Disaster Resilience at the Neighborhood Level: The COPEWELL New York City Experience,” *Public Health Reports* 135, no. 5 (September 2020): 565–70, <https://doi.org/10.1177/0033354920938012>.

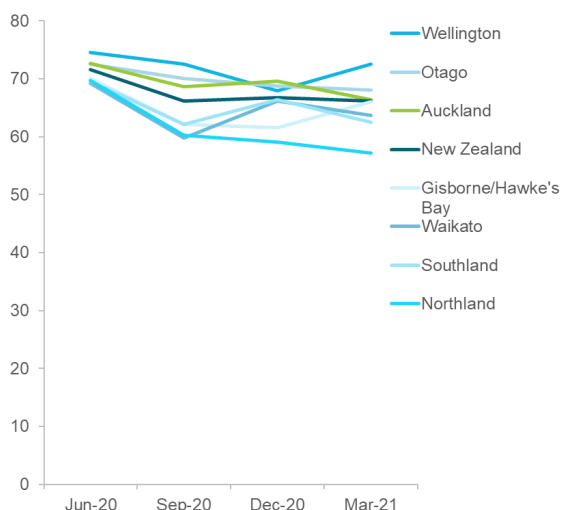
¹⁵ Bach et al., “Policy Challenges in Supporting Community Resilience.”



In 2018, 66% of Aucklanders and New Zealanders had high levels of trust in other people, compared to 70% of Wellingtonians at the high-end of regions and 59% of Southlanders at the low-end (Figure 16).

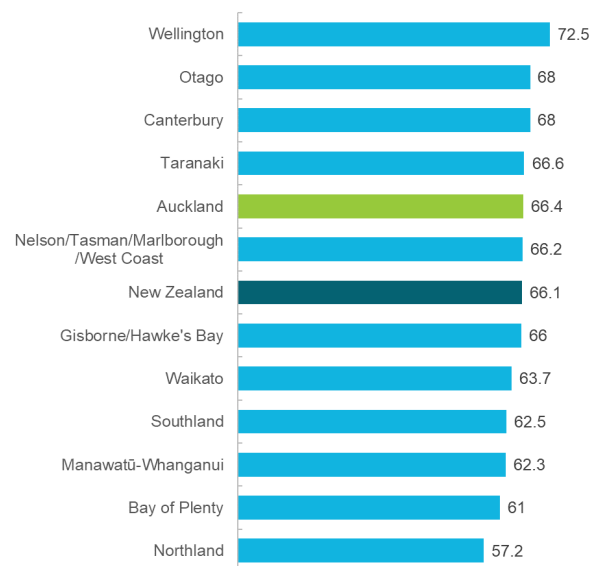
Levels of trust in Auckland have remained stable over the COVID-19 pandemic (Figure 17), as have New Zealand's. Again, a similar proportion of people across Auckland and New Zealand reported high levels of trust in other people in New Zealand in the March 2021 quarter (Figure 18).

Figure 17. Percentage of people with a score of 7/10 or higher for trust in other people in New Zealand, selected regions, June 2020 to March 2021 quarters



Source: HLFS supplement, Stats NZ

Figure 18. Percentage of people with a score of 7/10 or higher for trust in other people in New Zealand, regions, March 2021 quarter



Source: HLFS supplement, Stats NZ

Discrimination is experienced by Aucklanders at a similar rate to New Zealanders. However, research suggests that discrimination and racism has increased for communities within Auckland during the pandemic

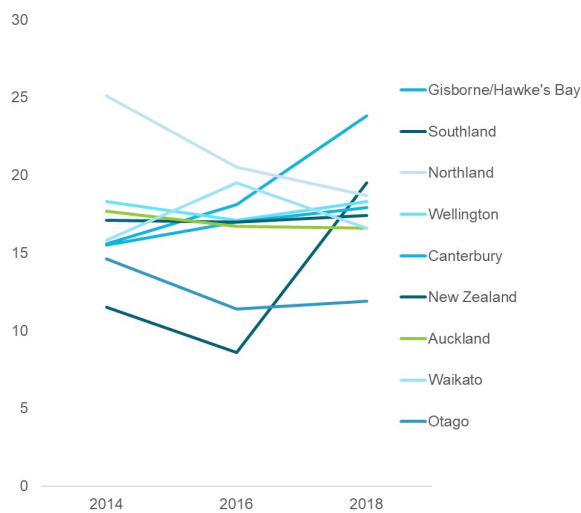
The percentage of Auckland adults who experienced discrimination in the past 12 months in New Zealand stayed relatively stable between 2014 and 2018, and is near the New Zealand average (Figure 19). In 2018, 17% of Aucklanders indicated that they had experienced discrimination in the past 12 months (Figure 20). Almost a quarter (24%) of people in Gisborne/Hawke's Bay indicated that they had experienced discrimination, while 12% of people in Otago indicated the same.

During the COVID-19 pandemic, discrimination experienced by Aucklanders appears to have stayed relatively static (Figure 21). However, there does appear to be a lot of movement amongst other regions in the North Island (Figure 22).



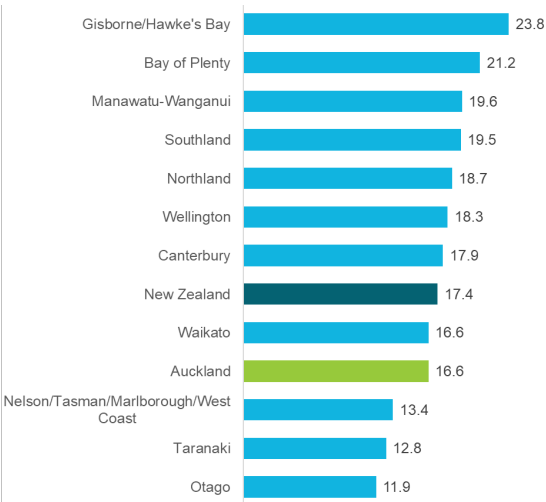
Regional data masks sub-regional trends. A national survey found that about a third of New Zealanders (32%) have either sometimes (20%), often (7%) or very often (5%) experienced discrimination when dealing with government departments and services.¹⁶ Additionally, 41% of respondents felt that incidents of racism in New Zealand had increased following COVID-19. Over half of Māori, Pacific people and Asians said that incidents of racism in New Zealand had increased following COVID-19.

Figure 19. Percentage of adults who experienced discrimination in the past 12 months in New Zealand, selected regions, 2014–2018



Source: NZGSS, Stats NZ

Figure 20. Percentage of adults who experienced discrimination in the past 12 months in New Zealand, regions, 2018

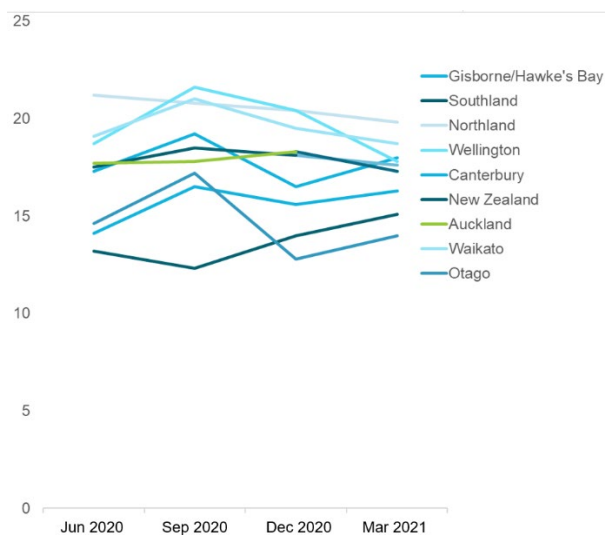


Source: NZGSS, Stats NZ

¹⁶ J Thaker, “Aotearoa New Zealand Public Responses to COVID-19: March 2021” (Wellington: Massey University, 2021).

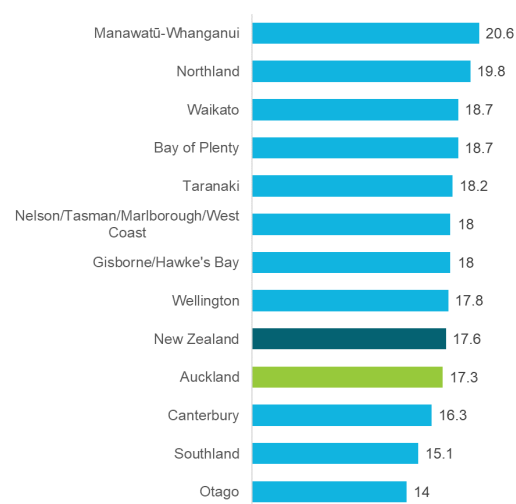


Figure 21. Percentage of adults who experienced discrimination in the past 12 months in New Zealand, selected regions, 2020-2021



Source: HLFS supplement, Stats NZ

Figure 22. Percentage of adults who experienced discrimination in the past 12 months in New Zealand, regions, March 2021 quarter



Source: HLFS supplement, Stats NZ



GOVERNANCE, INSTITUTIONS, AND CIVIL SOCIETY

The extent to which people can express their voice and contribute to the political functioning of their society. In turn, civic engagement shapes the institutions that govern people's lives.

Government plays several important roles in relation to wellbeing. Central government has tended to provide most health, education and justice services and local government has provided most sanitation and recreation services. Infrastructure spending has been split between the two.

Government is also an employer. In the same way that firms hold some responsibility for the wellbeing of their employees, so too does government. This includes ensuring good working conditions for people who work directly or indirectly for government, including our many frontline public servants such as police officers, nurses, teachers and so on.

Government also invests in national and regional wealth. For example, education and health services also double as investment in human capability, which benefits everyone. Government also funds research activity, particularly primary research.

Government also has the power to create and enforce laws and associated regulations. Government tends to inherit any risks that grow in scale beyond what other actors in society can manage, or where only a national or regional level of response is adequate. As recent crises such as the GFC, Kaikoura and Canterbury earthquakes, and the ongoing pandemic demonstrate, wellbeing is more readily sustained when central and regional government has the fiscal headroom to invest rapidly in response to sudden and unexpected challenges.

Voter turnout	L	▲
Trust in government institutions	M	▲
Public service satisfaction	L	▲
Local authority net worth	M	▼
Participation in local government decision-making	L	▲
Volunteering	L	N
Economic contribution of non-profits	No data available ¹⁷	
Culture, sport, and arts non-profits	H	~
Non-profit sustainability	No data available ¹⁸	
Donations	M	N

¹⁷ Stats NZ indicated that it wasn't feasible using the Non-profit institutions satellite account. Constructing an alternative indicator is beyond the scope of this project.

¹⁸ Stats NZ indicated that it wasn't feasible using the Non-profit institutions satellite account. Constructing an alternative indicator is beyond the scope of this project.



The LSF 2021 recognises that civil society includes a diverse range of organisations. There are a number of different types:

- **Religious organisations**, such as churches and mosques. These institutions are particularly important for many sub-populations, such as Pacific peoples, and refugee and migrant communities. Many churches, particularly those well-connected internationally like the Mormon and Catholic churches, hold significant amounts of financial and physical capital and often deploy it towards social ends.
- **Professional organisations and unions** such as the NZ Educational Institute, the Royal Australasian College of Surgeons, Law Society and Council of Trade Unions.
- **Sporting and cultural institutions** such as Te Papa, the NZ Symphony Orchestra, Te Matatini, NZ Rugby and so on.
- **Philanthropic funders** such as the Tindall Foundation and Foundation North.
- **Not-for-profit social service providers** such as community health and housing providers, including urban marae and other kaupapa Māori organisations. This fifth group often combines funding from multiple sources and usually relies also on labour provided voluntarily by local people for the benefit of the local community.

Civil society plays an important role in creating and sustaining social cohesion and providing a vehicle for people to exercise voice and engagement. This is most obviously the case with political parties, but there are also many other ways people can participate in democratic self-governance, such as by starting or signing a petition.

Summary

In the 2020 General Election, the majority of Auckland electorates had a lower proportion of voting than the national average. While Māori participation in general election voting is generally lower than non-Māori participation, the difference in voting participation in Auckland is not as large as the participation gap at the national level. Younger age groups have lower engagement and participation than older age groups, and this is particularly marked for Māori.

In Auckland, trust in the public service based on experience has fluctuated over time. Since 2016, trust levels have tended to be below national averages – only surpassing the national average in 2021. Aucklanders' satisfaction with the quality of public services has increased over time but tends to be at the lower end of all regions or groups of regions.

In August 2020, Auckland Council reported that Auckland could have a shortfall of more than half a billion dollars in revenue over the next financial year as a result of the pandemic. At the same time, Auckland Council has a large capital investment programme – in infrastructure and environmental initiatives. Auckland Council Group's net worth, as a proportion of GDP, is near the national average, and has decreased over time, following regional trends. Auckland Council Group's absolute equity has increased over time.

Perceptions of participation in Auckland Council decision-making are typically low. The percentage of Māori residents who feel that they can participate in Auckland Council decisions has not shifted considerably since 2017.



Data suggests that Aucklanders volunteer at a lower rate than residents of other regions.

Auckland has the highest absolute number of paid employees in culture, sport, and recreation non-profit institutions (NPIs) and growth in NPI employment over time has been fastest in the Auckland region. Of the NPI workforce, Auckland has proportionately more in culture, sport, and recreation at around 12% of the Auckland NPI workforce.

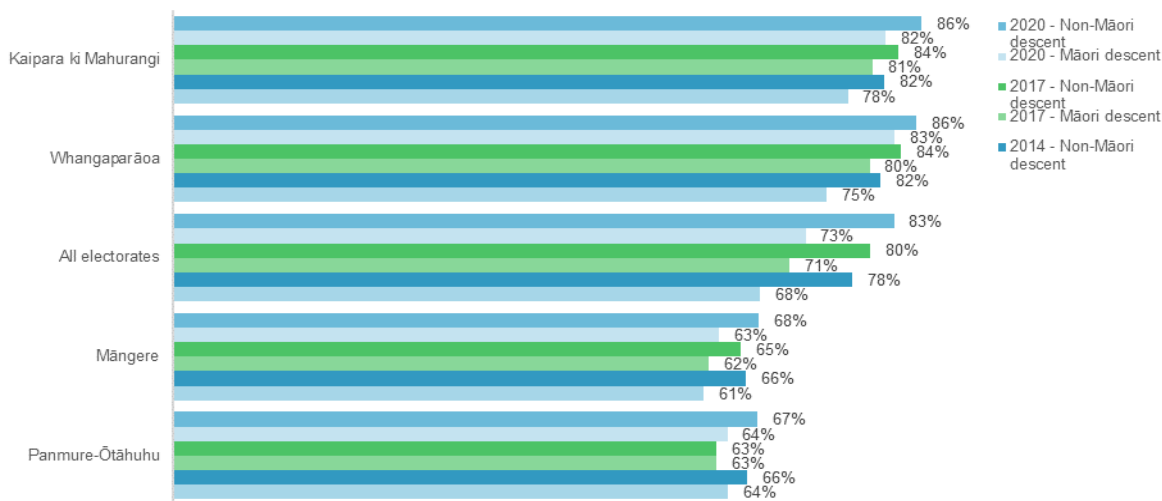
Auckland electorates have low participation in general election voting

There are 23 electorates in the Auckland region, counting Port Waikato¹⁹ which is in both Auckland and Waikato regions. In the 2020 General Election, the majority of Auckland electorates had a lower proportion of voting than the national average, 82% (Figure 24). Only 67% of enrolled voters in Panmure-Ōtāhuhu voted in 2020.

Voting in the general election is an important way in which people can exercise their democratic rights. It also enables Māori to exercise democratic and Treaty rights in Aotearoa New Zealand. The Māori statistics framework identifies participation in political decision-making processes as an important area of interest, related to empowerment and enablement.²⁰

Māori participation in general election voting is generally lower than non-Māori participation (Figure 23). However, the difference in voting participation in Auckland is not as large as the participation gap at the national level. Participation has generally increased over time.

Figure 23. Voter participation rates of Māori and Non-Māori in Auckland electorates, selected electorates, 2014, 2017, 2020



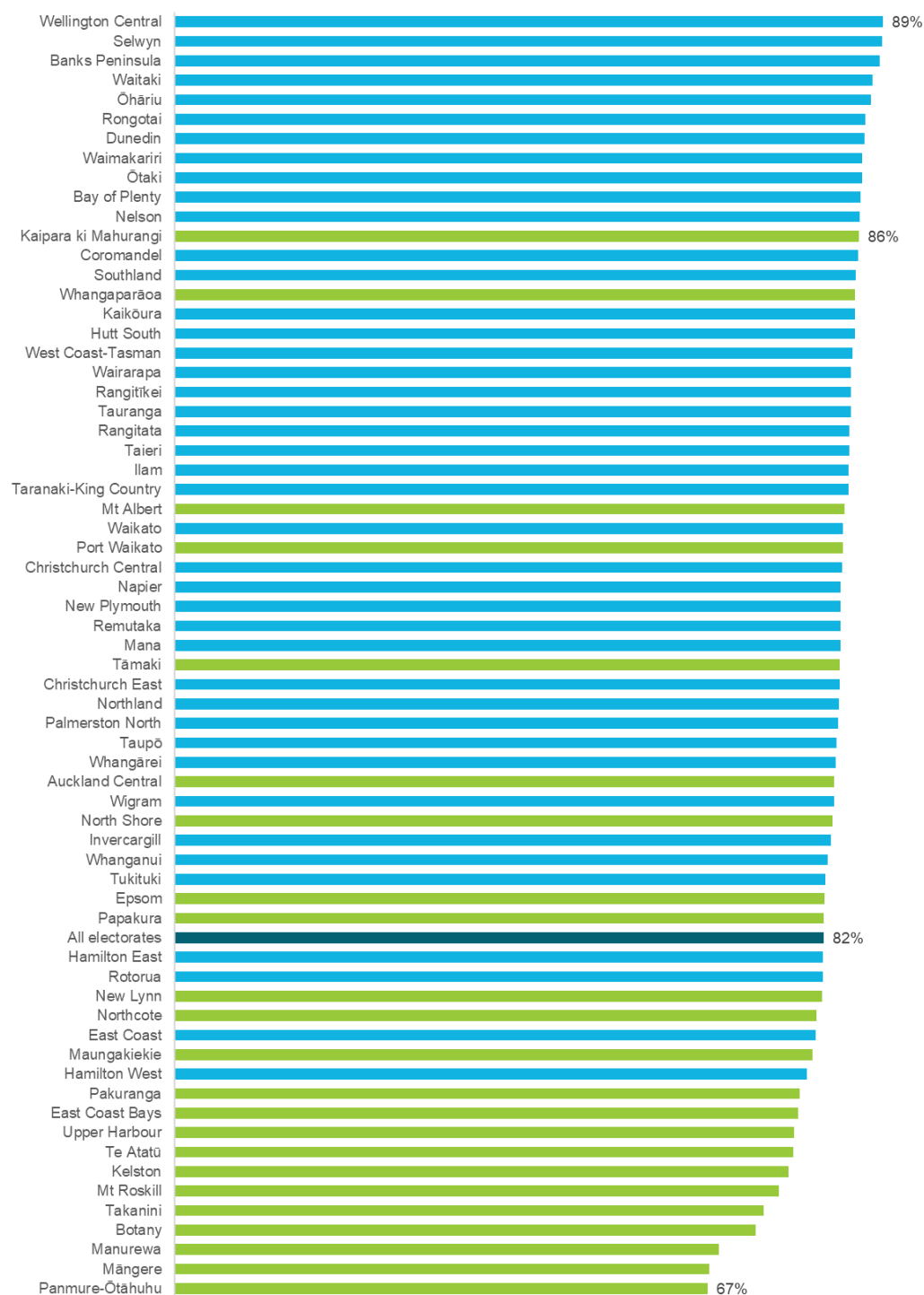
Source: Electoral Commission

¹⁹ Formerly Hunua

²⁰ Statistics New Zealand, “Towards a Māori Statistics Framework: A Discussion Document” (Wellington: Statistics New Zealand, 2002).



Figure 24. Voters as a proportion of total enrolled, all electorates, 2020



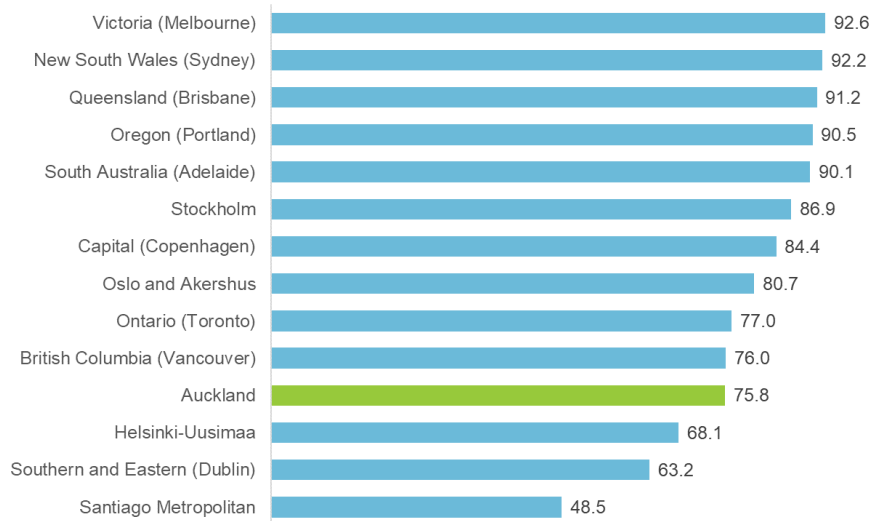
Source: Electoral Commission



There is also a correlation between age and voter participation rates. Younger age groups have lower engagement and participation than older age groups, and this is particularly marked for Māori.

Aucklanders’ engagement with general elections is relatively low compared to international regions. Figure 25 shows that Australian regions have relatively high turnout while Auckland’s is on the lower side of a set of comparable regions, but similar to Vancouver’s.

Figure 25. Voter turnout to general elections (in % of registered voters who voted), most recent year available



Source: OECD.Stat, Regions and Cities
Notes: OECD classifies the geographic units in this chart as large regions (territorial level 2 or TL2) to help in assessing differences in socio-economic trends in regions, both within and across countries
2019 year: New South Wales (Sydney), Victoria (Melbourne), Queensland (Brisbane), South Australia (Adelaide), Ontario (Toronto), British Columbia (Vancouver), Capital (Copenhagen)
2018 year: Helsinki-Uusimaa, Stockholm, Oregon (Portland)
2017 year: Santiago Metropolitan, Auckland, Oslo and Akershus
2016 year: Southern and Eastern (Dublin)

Aucklanders and New Zealanders have similar high levels of trust in government institutions

International rankings and research²¹ show that the trust and confidence of Aucklanders and New Zealanders in the public service is important to effectively operate public services in communities.

Te Kawa Mataaho | Public Service Commission implements the Kiwis Count survey which measures the trust and confidence of New Zealanders in the public service. The survey provides insight into people’s views, trust and confidence in government and its role in society, using a score from 1 to 5.

In Auckland, trust in the public service, based on experience, has fluctuated over time. Trust was lowest in 2019 at 76% (Figure 26). Trust was at the highest level, 82%, in 2014, followed closely by

²¹ Fabrice Martin et al., “Trust and Its Determinants: Evidence from the Trustlab Experiment,” OECD Statistics Working Papers (OECD, June 30, 2018), <https://doi.org/10.1787/869ef2ec-en>.



2021 at 81%. Prior to 2016, the proportion of people in Auckland who trusted the public service, based on experience, was above the national average. Since 2016, trust levels have tended to be below national averages – only surpassing the national average in 2021.

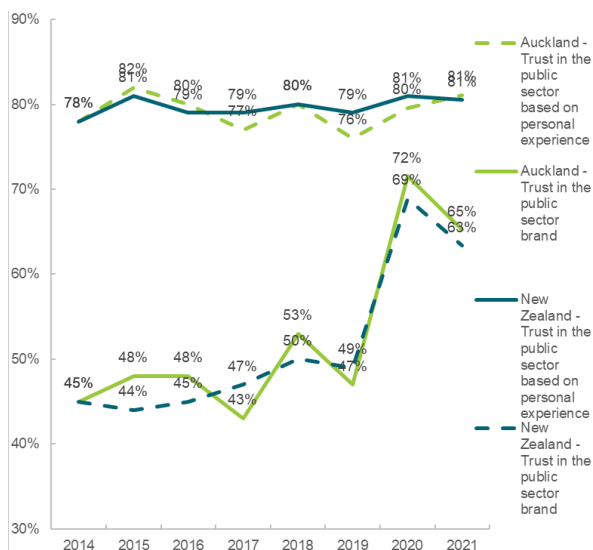
Historically, less people trust the public service brand (Figure 27), but this has climbed in the last two years.

Figure 26. Percentage of adults who trust the public service, based on experience, 2014–2021



Source: Kiwis Count, Te Kawa Mataahi | Public Service Commission

Figure 27. Percentage of adults who trust the public service and the public service brand, Auckland and New Zealand, 2014–2021



Source: Te Kawa Mataahi | Public Service Commission

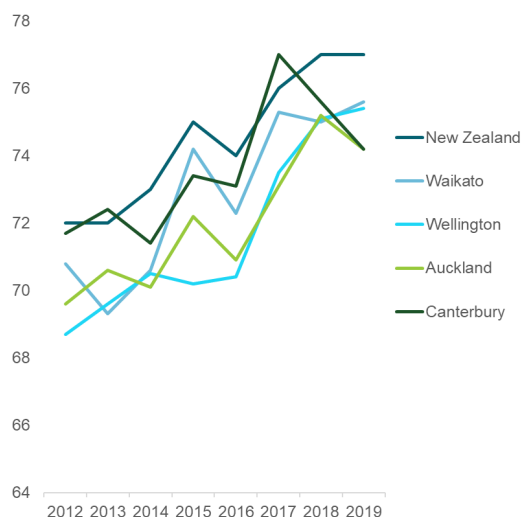
Aucklanders have relatively low satisfaction with the quality of public services, but satisfaction has increased over time

Kiwis Count measures New Zealanders' satisfaction with a range of commonly used services. The results are used to calculate the Service Quality Score (SQS) for each service and an overall SQS across all services.

Aucklanders' satisfaction with the quality of public services has increased over time (Figure 28). The overall SQS has increased five points from 70 in 2017 to 75 in 2018, but fell to 74 in 2019. Aucklanders' satisfaction with the quality of public services tends to be at the lower end of all regions or groups of regions. In 2019, Auckland and Canterbury had the lowest SQS (Figure 29), while Waikato and the rest of the North Island (less Wellington, Auckland and Waikato) had the highest SQS.



Figure 28. Public service quality score, regions and New Zealand, 2012–2019

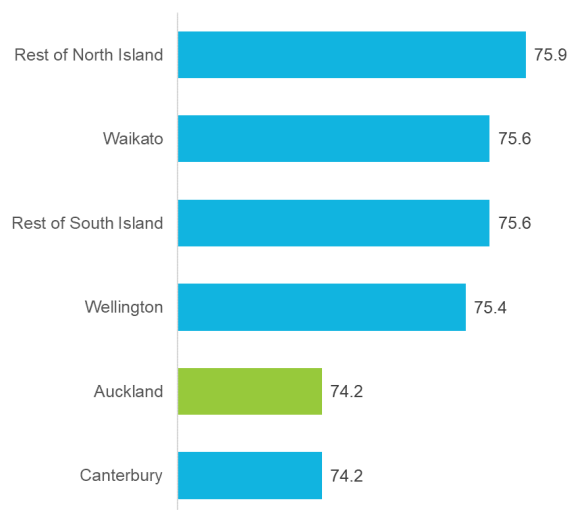


Source: Kiwis Count, Te Kawa Mataahi | Public Service Commission

Note: This indicator was discontinued in December 2019

The Service Quality Score was a weighted, calculated score and the differences between regions and the total (New Zealand) are due to the weighting given to responses.

Figure 29. Public service quality score, regions, 2019



Source: Te Kawa Mataahi | Public Service Commission

Auckland Councils net worth, as a proportion of GDP, is similar to the national average

A local council's financial position indicates the extent to which it can provide services to its community, and weather economic shocks like the COVID-19 pandemic. In August 2020, Auckland Council²² reported that Auckland could have a shortfall of more than half a billion dollars in revenue over the next financial year as a result of the pandemic. 60% of council's revenue comes from sources such as concerts and visitor attractions, pools and leisure centres, operations at Ports of Auckland, dividends from Auckland Airport shares, parking, development contributions and public transport fares. As a result of the pandemic, much of these sources were unable to function and dividends were not expected from investments.

²² Auckland Council, "COVID's Half-Billion-Dollar Hit to Council Finances," Auckland Council, August 14, 2020, <https://ourauckland.aucklandcouncil.govt.nz/news/2020/05/covid-s-half-billion-dollar-hit-to-council-finances/>.

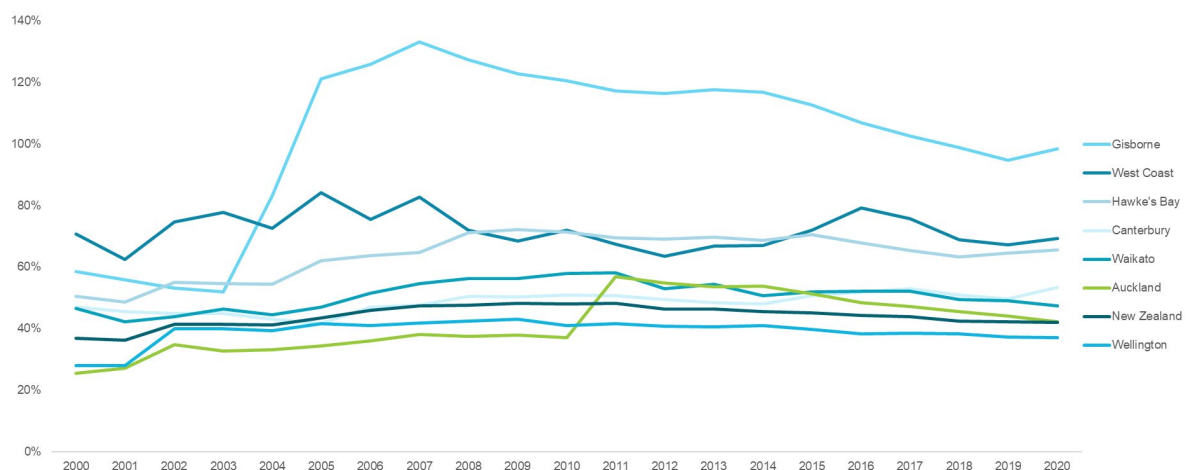


At the same time, Auckland Council has a large, \$2.5 billion capital investment programme – in transport and water infrastructure and ongoing environmental initiatives. In September 2021, Auckland Council reported it was in a strong financial position due to its planning and operational savings in the Recovery Budget.²³

When comparing the net worth of local authorities, as a proportion of their GDP, Gisborne, West Coast and Hawke's Bay regions have the highest net worth (Figure 30). Auckland's is near the national average, and has decreased over time, following regional trends.

Auckland Council Group's absolute equity has increased over time (Figure 31).

Figure 30. Local authority net worth as a proportion of \$1,000 GDP, selected regions, 2000–2020

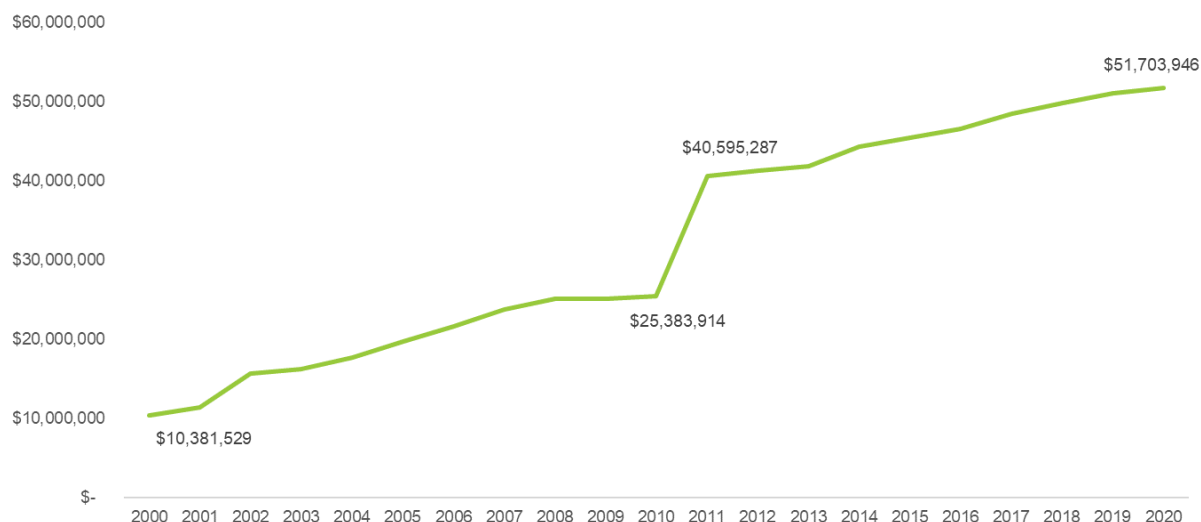


Source: Local Authority Financial Statements, Stats NZ and regional GDP series, Stats NZ

²³ Auckland Council, "Auckland Council Group's Financial Results Pave Way for Recovery," Auckland Council, September 28, 2021, <https://ourauckland.aucklandcouncil.govt.nz/news/2021/09/auckland-council-group-s-financial-results-pave-way-for-recovery/>.



Figure 31. Auckland local authority net worth (equity), 2000–2020



Source: Local Authority Financial Statements, Stats NZ

A low proportion of residents feel they can participate in Auckland Council decision-making

Auckland Council defines an empowered community as “one where individuals, whanau and communities have the power and ability to influence decisions, take action and make change happen in their lives and communities. This includes communities of place, interest and identity”.²⁴ Based on this and their internal definitions regarding empowerment, it is expected that empowered residents and communities would have:

- an increase in the level of control and influence over things they care about and which matter uniquely to them
- a diverse range of people that have more opportunities for meaningful engagement and participation in public and community life
- more ‘bottom-up’ design and delivery
- increased capacity and capability of voluntary and community groups (inclusive, competent, committed to equity and connected to their wider community).

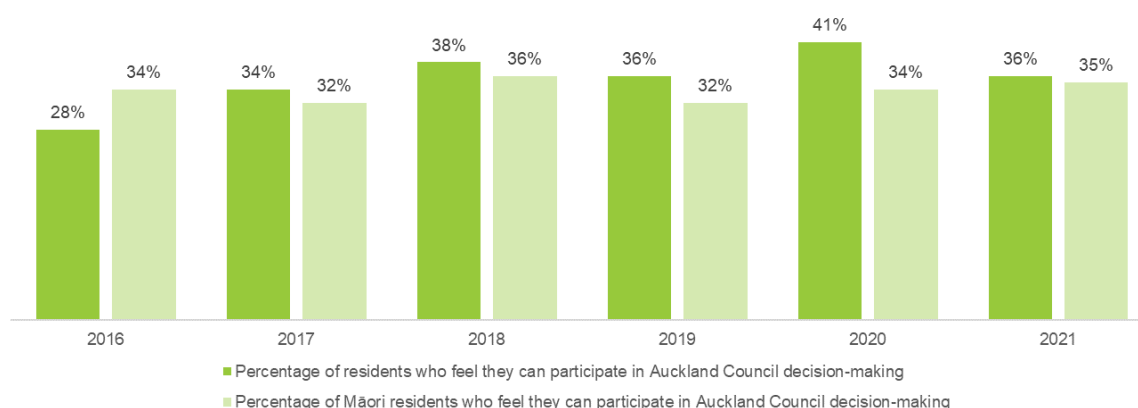
There are no standard indicators across local government for empowerment or participation in decision-making. For the purposes of this report we show results for Auckland Council.

²⁴ Auckland Council, “Empowering Communities Approach” (Auckland: Auckland Council, July 2015), 4 & 8.



Perceptions of participation in Auckland Council decision-making are typically low. Auckland Council has had the target of 50% for the last few years, and has not been able to reach it. In 2020, 41% of residents surveyed felt that they could participate in Auckland Council decision-making – the highest in all years (Figure 32). Feelings of participation have been rising over time, and COVID-19 has meant that some planned engagements couldn't occur, which is a likely contributor to the lower result in 2021.

Figure 32. Percentage of residents who feel they can participate in Auckland Council decision-making, 2016–2020



Source: Auckland Council annual reports

Simon Hope²⁵ states that the aim of self-determination should be to give life to Māori world views in a contemporary context, to take principles of Māori law and adapt them to suit present day realities. In the modern-day context, this can mean taking part in local government decision-making. The Māori statistics framework identifies participation in political decision-making processes as an important area of interest, related to empowerment and enablement.²⁶

The percentage of Māori residents who feel that they can participate in Auckland Council decisions has not shifted considerably since 2017 (Figure 32). The Council has found that perceptions held by Māori communities at large have proven slower and more difficult to shift than anticipated.²⁷

Auckland has low rates of volunteering

A rapid evidence assessment was recently undertaken on the subjective wellbeing impacts of volunteering upon adults involved in formal volunteering through groups, clubs and organisations.²⁸ The assessment included 158 studies from the UK and internationally, from 2008 onwards. Most of

²⁵ Simon Hope, "The Roots and Reach of Rangatiratanga," *Political Science* 56, no. 1 (June 2004): 23–54. Philosophy lecturer at the University of Sterling, particularly interested in distributive justice, Māori political argument and multiculturalism.

²⁶ Statistics New Zealand, "Towards a Māori Statistics Framework: A Discussion Document."

²⁷ Auckland Council, "Auckland Council Annual Report 2020/2021," Volume 1: Overview and Service Performance (Auckland: Auckland Council, 2021).

²⁸ Joanna Stuart et al., "The Impacts of Volunteering on the Subjective Wellbeing of Volunteers: A Rapid Evidence Assessment" (What Works Centre for Wellbeing and Spirit of 2012, 2020).



the evidence, including statistical analysis, points to a positive association between volunteering and wellbeing, including improved life satisfaction, increased happiness and reduced symptoms of depression. Furthermore, a small number of studies find reverse causality; that is, higher wellbeing makes individuals more likely to volunteer, rather than volunteering causing higher wellbeing.

New Zealand research has found that volunteering is related to increased happiness, and this occurs irrespective of ethnicity.²⁹ That is, both Māori and non-Māori who volunteered had increased happiness.

Volunteering activities don't always lead to improved wellbeing, as some activities can lead to anxiety, stress or burnout. However, there is less evidence for the negative effects of volunteering on the wellbeing of volunteers.³⁰

Meaningful regional data on volunteering in New Zealand is scarce. What is available suggests that Aucklanders volunteer at a lower rate than residents of other regions (Figure 33).

This may be related to Auckland's demographic characteristics. Data from the Household Labour Force Survey in June 2018 found that part-time workers, particularly women and those aged 65 years and older, were the workers most likely to do volunteer work.³¹ Auckland's population is more youthful than those in other regions.

Volunteering New Zealand's latest State of Volunteering in New Zealand report raises concerns about the sector's general lack of diversity across ethnicity, culture, sexual orientation and gender identity, and age.³² Of particular concern is the lack of diversity in ethnicity. Over 85% of sector survey participants identified as Pākehā or European.

Figure 33. Proportion of adults who volunteered in the previous 4 weeks, regions, 2016



Source: Customised data from Stats NZ, New Zealand General Social Survey

²⁹ Patrick L. Dulin et al., "Volunteering Predicts Happiness among Older Māori and Non-Māori in the New Zealand Health, Work, and Retirement Longitudinal Study," *Aging & Mental Health* 16, no. 5 (July 2012): 617–24.

³⁰ Stuart et al., "The Impacts of Volunteering on the Subjective Wellbeing of Volunteers: A Rapid Evidence Assessment."

³¹ Stats NZ, "Part-Time Workers Most Likely to Lend a Hand," Stats NZ, September 18, 2018, <https://www.stats.govt.nz/news/part-time-workers-most-likely-to-lend-a-hand>.

³² Volunteering New Zealand, "State of Volunteering Report 2020" (Wellington: Volunteering New Zealand, 2020).



Auckland is the home of paid employment in the not-for-profit culture, sport, and recreation sector

Internationally there has been an increased focus on the arts and heritage sectors, and the creative economy, for their contribution to economic growth. In New Zealand, the social services activity group contributes the most to NPIs' GDP. In 2018 this group's GDP was estimated to be \$1.8 billion, or 22% of the total NPI GDP. Culture, sport, and recreation is the third largest contributor at 15%.³³

The Cultural Indicators Framework adopted by the Ministry for Culture and Heritage identified five broad social outcomes or benefits of arts and heritage.³⁴ These are:

- engagement
- cultural identity
- diversity
- social cohesion
- economic development.

The Cultural Indicators Framework follows a growing body of research on the contribution of cultural activity to social wellbeing.³⁵ There is also a growing body of research on the intersection of art and health.³⁶

Auckland has the highest absolute number of paid employees in culture, sport and recreation NPIs (Figure 34), and the growth in NPI employment over time has been fastest in the Auckland region. Employment growth in the culture, sport and recreation sector in the last 10 years was a compound average growth rate of 1.5%, and 3.2% over the last 5 years. Employment growth across the broader economy was 2.8% compound average growth rate, over the last 5 and 10 years. In terms of paid employees in the sector as a proportion of the total NPI workforce, a slightly different story emerges. Auckland has a proportionately higher NPI workforce in culture, sport, and recreation at around 12% of the NPI workforce (Figure 35). However, the proportion has remained relatively steady over time, and Southland records the fastest growth in employment relative to total NPI employment.

³³ Stats NZ, "Non-Profit Institutions Satellite Account: 2018." (Stats NZ Tatauranga Aotearoa, 2020), <https://www.stats.govt.nz/assets/Uploads/Reports/Non-profit-institutions-satellite-account-2018/non-profit-institution-satellite-account-2018.pdf>.

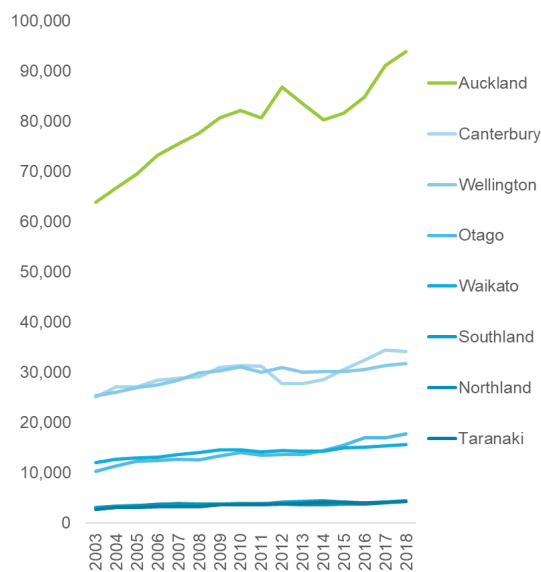
³⁴ Ministry for Culture and Heritage, "Cultural Indicators for New Zealand 2009."

³⁵ Arts Council England, "The Value of Arts and Culture to People and Society: An Evidence Review" (London: Arts Council England, 2014).

³⁶ S Bidwell, "The Arts in Health: Evidence from the International Literature." (Christchurch: Pegasus Health, 2014).

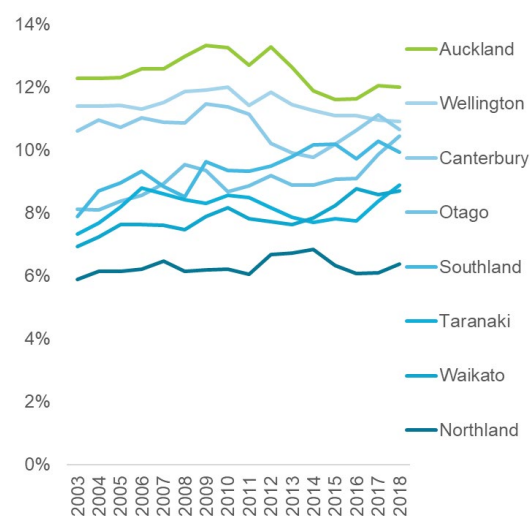


Figure 34. Number of paid employees in culture, sport, and recreation non-profit institutions, selected regions, 2003–2018



Source: Customised microdata from Stats NZ, LEED

Figure 35. Proportion of paid employees in culture, sport, and recreation as a proportion of paid employees in all non-profit institutions, selected regions, 2003–2018



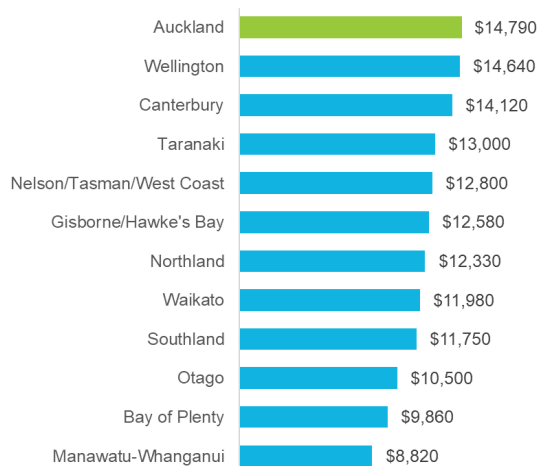
Source: Customised data from Stats NZ, New Zealand General Social Survey

Median quarterly earnings of paid-employees of culture, sport and recreation NPIs differs by region and by institution size. In different institution size brackets, those employed in the Auckland region tend to be the highest paid (Figure 36, Figure 38, Figure 39). However, in culture, sport, and recreation NPIs which employ 20-99 people, the Auckland region is mid-ranked (\$8,050 a quarter). Otago is the highest at \$10,640 a quarter (Figure 37).

For all industries, Auckland's median quarterly earnings in the December 2018 quarter was \$17,890 and New Zealand's was \$16,550. While employees in the Auckland region tend to earn more than their peers in other regions, earnings in this sector are still well below industry averages.

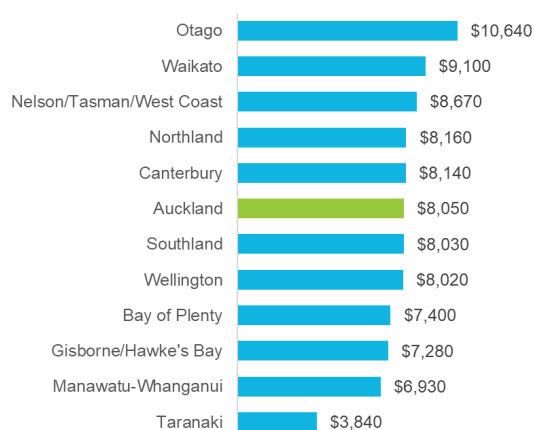


Figure 36. Median quarterly earnings, culture, sport, and recreation non-profit institutions with 100+ employees, regions, 2018



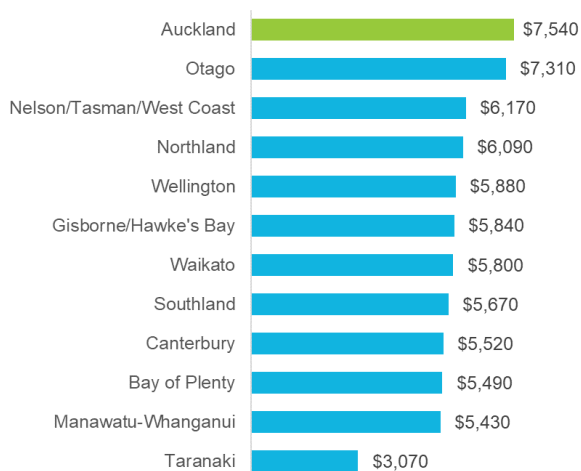
Source: Customised microdata from Stats NZ, LEED

Figure 37. Median quarterly earnings, culture, sport, and recreation non-profit institutions with 20–99 employees, regions, 2018



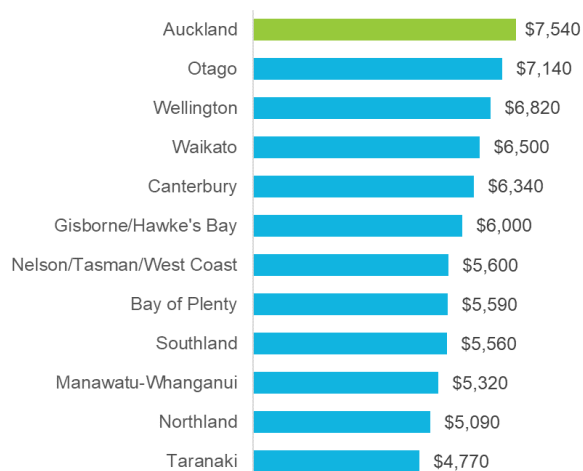
Source: Customised microdata from Stats NZ, LEED

Figure 38. Median quarterly earnings, culture, sport, and recreation non-profit institutions with 6–19 employees, regions, 2018



Source: Customised microdata from Stats NZ, LEED

Figure 39. Median quarterly earnings, culture, sport, and recreation non-profit institutions with 1–5 employees, regions, 2018



Source: Customised microdata from Stats NZ, LEED



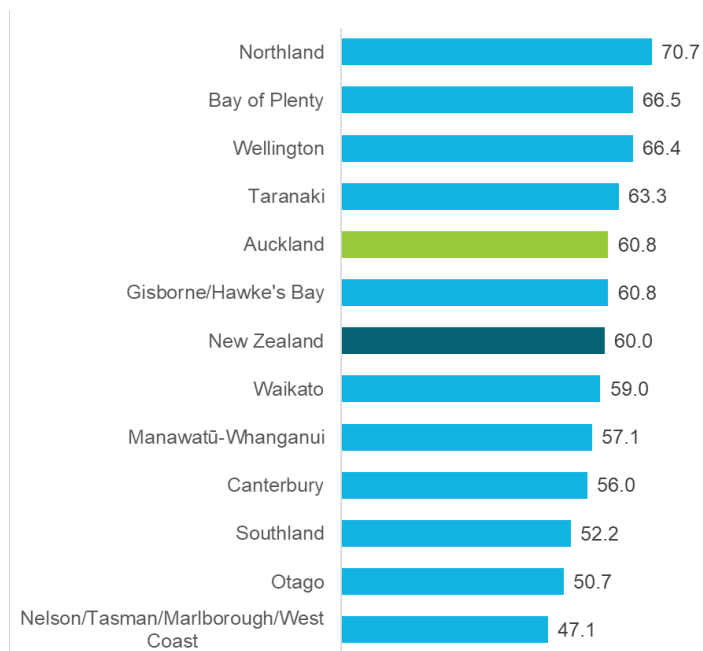
A similar proportion of Aucklanders and New Zealanders donate

Like volunteering, meaningful regional data on donations in New Zealand is scarce. Available data suggests that Aucklanders donate (either money or goods) at a similar rate to the national average (Figure 33).

Those more likely to donate follow the same pattern as those volunteering.³⁷

Monetary donations were most likely given to health organisations and spiritual and religious organisations, and goods were donated to social services and health organisations.

Figure 40. Proportion of adults that donated money or goods over the previous 4 weeks, regions, 2016



Source: Customised data from Stats NZ, New Zealand General Social Survey

³⁷ Stats NZ, "Volunteering and Donations by New Zealanders in 2016" (Wellington: Stats NZ Tatauranga Aotearoa, 2017).



SAFETY

Being safe from harm and the fear of harm, and keeping oneself and others safe from harm.

Personal security and safety is a key component of people's well-being. Although many factors influence personal security, crime is one of the most common ones. Crime may lead to the loss of life and property, physical pain, and post-traumatic stress and anxiety, both in the short and long term.

Living in safe communities is essential to people's well-being, as feelings of insecurity will limit people's daily activities and functioning.

Feeling safe	M	~
Family violence	M	~
Intentional homicide	M	▼
Offending rates	M	▼
Workplace accidents	L	▼

Summary

The percentage of people who feel safe or very safe walking alone in the neighbourhood after dark has fluctuated in Auckland over time, and has been close to the national average.

The percentage of adults in Auckland (2%) who experienced offending by family members was similar to the New Zealand average, and has been stable over time. Adults living in the most deprived neighbourhoods (3.4%) were around twice as likely to be affected than adults in the least deprived neighbourhoods (1.5%).

Murder rates across Auckland have fluctuated over time. In the latest year where data is available (2020), two Auckland police districts recorded a murder rate above the New Zealand average (Waitematā and Counties/Manukau), and one below the New Zealand average (Auckland). The murder rate across Auckland police districts appears to be declining, and is below the New Zealand average.

Auckland's fatal and serious workplace accidents rate fell from 119 claims per 1,000 FTEs in 2002 to 76 per 1,000 FTEs in 2020. Auckland's incidence rate has consistently been below the New Zealand average and likely reflects the dominance of lower risk service industries in Auckland. Results for 2020 also reflect the impact of COVID-19 and associated fluctuations in economic activity.

The nationally declining crime rate has been replicated in Auckland police districts with the crime rate declining across all Auckland police districts, particularly in Central Auckland. In 2020, Auckland and Counties Manukau police districts had higher crime rates than New Zealand, but Waitematā had one of the lowest.

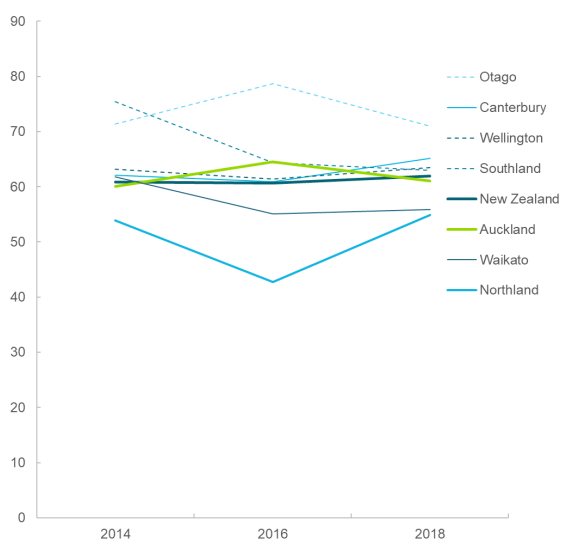


There are similar perceptions of safety in Auckland and New Zealand

Moving to, and being in, a more cohesive and better quality community has been linked to a reduction in violent crime. Research has identified that moving to a better community reduced lifetime arrests for violent crime by 15%.³⁸

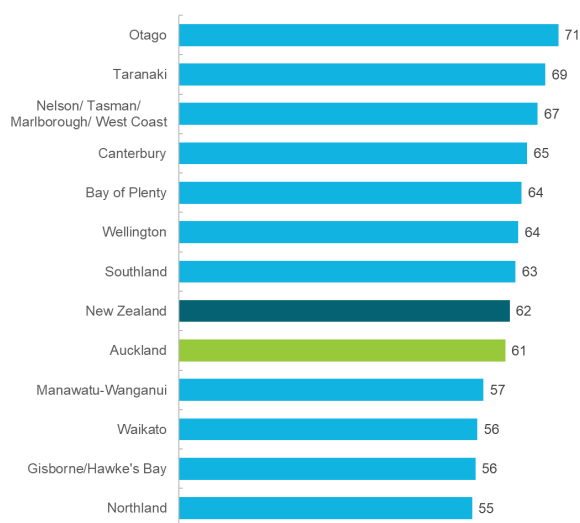
The percentage of people who feel safe or very safe walking alone in the neighbourhood after dark has fluctuated in Auckland over time (Figure 41), and has been close to the national average. In 2018 it was lower than all the other major urban-regions except Waikato. In the same year, the highest proportion of people who felt safe or very safe was in Otago, while Northland had the lowest proportion of people that reported feeling safe or very safe walking alone in the neighbourhood after dark (Figure 42).

Figure 41. Percentage of people who feel very safe/safe walking alone in the neighbourhood after dark, selected regions, 2014, 2016, 2018



Source: NZGSS, Stats NZ

Figure 42. Percentage of people who feel very safe/safe walking alone in the neighbourhood after dark, regions, 2018



Source: NZGSS, Stats NZ

Family violence occurs in Auckland at a similar rate to the national rate

Family violence is a term that describes any violent or abusive behaviour perpetrated by a family or whānau member. In the Family Violence Act 2018, family violence is defined as any behaviour that is coercive, controlling or that causes cumulative harm. This includes a wide range of behaviours, some which are criminal offences and some which are not.

³⁸ J R King, J Ludwig, and L F Katz, "Neighborhood Effects on Crime for Female and Male Youth: Evidence from a Randomized Housing Voucher Experiment," NBER Working Paper (Cambridge, MA: National Bureau of Economic Research, 2004).

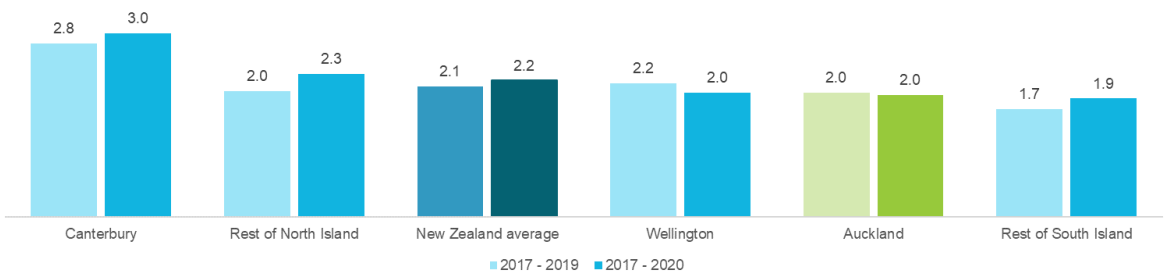


The New Zealand Crime and Victims Survey (NZCVS) collects information about New Zealanders' experience of crime. This survey has run annually since 2018, asking 8,000 New Zealanders from all walks of life about their experiences. In 2020, about 2% of New Zealand adults had experienced one or more offences by family members in the previous 12 months.³⁹ This rate has been stable since 2018. Roughly 40% of all offences by family members were physical violence, 30% were threats and harassment, 20% were sexual assaults, and 10% were property damage.⁴⁰

The percentage of adults in Auckland (2%) who experienced offending by family members was similar to the New Zealand average, and has been stable over time. The percentage of adults who experienced offending by family members appeared to be higher in Canterbury (3.0%) than the New Zealand average (2.2%), but it was not significantly different (Figure 43).

Offending by family members affected people across the country. Adults living in rural areas through to major urban areas had a similar risk of being a victim of offending by family members. The risk was also similar across geographic regions. However, there was a clear association between neighbourhood deprivation and prevalence rate of offences by family members. Adults living in the most deprived neighbourhoods (3.4%) were around twice as likely to be affected than adults in the least deprived neighbourhoods (1.5%).⁴¹

Figure 43. Prevalence rate of adults who were victimised once or more by family members (%), regions, 2018–2020



Source: New Zealand Crime and Victims Survey, Ministry of Justice

Notes: NZCVS provides data by pooled years to increase data robustness. Pooled data for 2017 – 2020 refers to data collected between 1 March 2017 and 18 November 2020. Data collection in 2020 was paused from 21 March–2 July 2020 due to the COVID-19 pandemic.

³⁹ Ministry of Justice, "New Zealand Crime and Victims Survey. Key Findings. Descriptive Statistics. May 2021. Results Drawn from Cycle 3 (2019/20) of the New Zealand Crime and Victims Survey." (Wellington: Ministry of Justice, 2021), <https://www.justice.govt.nz/assets/Documents/Publications/Cycle-3-Core-Report-20210611-v1.5-for-release.pdf>.

⁴⁰ Ministry of Justice.

⁴¹ Ministry of Justice.



Auckland experiences fluctuations in its murder rate over time, as does all regions. Auckland's murder rate appears to be declining and is below the national average

Police in New Zealand investigate all suspicious deaths. Such investigations can take many months to conclude. Statistics for current years (2019 and 2020) include cases where an investigation is still continuing, and are provisional. Although a death may appear suspicious at first, investigations may conclude that the death was not a homicide.

Between 2007 and 2017, approximately 59% of homicides each year occurred in dwellings and 31% in outdoor public places.⁴² In 2018, it was reported that between 2013 and 2015, Canterbury police district had the most murders, with 13 over three years. Counties/Manukau, Hamilton, Manawatu and Otago all had eight.⁴³

NZ Police stated that "Every police district, including Canterbury, experiences fluctuations of serious crime over time, including murder ... The reasons these serious crimes occur can be broad, complex and varied, and are not isolated or specific to any one particular location. We know family harm is a factor in a disproportionate number of murder cases in New Zealand".

The charts show there is a lot of fluctuation in murders per 100,000 population amongst police districts. For example, in Counties/Manukau there was a low of 0.55 in 2015 and a high of 3.17 people per 100,000 people in 2006 (Figure 44).

Figure 44. Murder rate per 100,000 population, Auckland police districts, 1996–2020



Source: www.policedata.nz, NZ Police

Notes: Does not include attempted murder, homicide and related offences not further defined, manslaughter and driving causing death

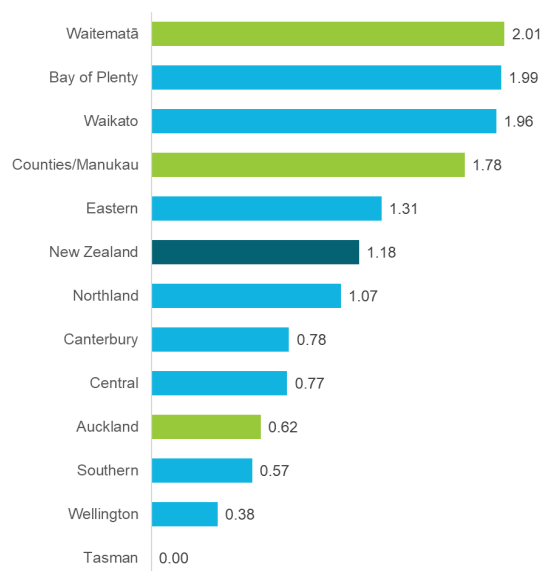
⁴² Police National Headquarters, "Police Statistics on Homicide Victims in New Zealand 2007 - 2017: A Summary of Statistics about Victims of Murder, Manslaughter, and Infanticide" (Wellington: NZ Police, 2019).

⁴³ Newshub, "Official New Zealand Murder Map Revealed," *Newshub*, March 17, 2018, <https://www.newshub.co.nz/home/new-zealand/2018/03/official-new-zealand-murder-map-revealed.html>.



Looking at a single year, 2020, two Auckland police districts recorded a murder rate above the New Zealand average (Waitematā and Counties/Manukau), and one below the New Zealand average (Auckland) (Figure 45). The murder rate across Auckland police districts appears to be declining, and is below the New Zealand average.

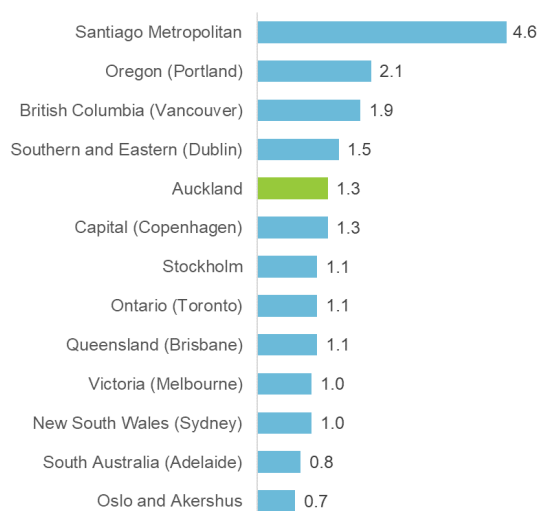
Figure 45. Murder rate per 100,000 population, police districts, 2020



Source: www.policedata.nz, NZ Police

Internationally, Auckland has an “average” murder rate. In 2014, there were 1.3 murders per 100,000 people in Auckland, compared to 4.6 in Santiago and 0.7 in Oslo (Figure 46).

Figure 46. Intentional homicide rate (homicides for 100,000 population), selected international regions, 2014



Source: OECD.Stat, Regions and Cities

Note: OECD classifies the geographic units in this chart as large regions (territorial level 2 or TL2) to help in assessing differences in socio-economic trends in regions, both within and across countries



Over time, the crime rate has declined across all Auckland police districts, as it has nationally

Beginning in the fiscal year 2015, NZ Police discontinued their statistical series on offences and initiated a new monthly statistical series on victimisations.⁴⁴ The Parliamentary Library published a research paper to provide a longer-term perspective on crime in New Zealand, focusing on:

- the incidence of crime (total offences, and total victimisations)
- the crime rate (offences and victimisations per capita)
- offences and victimisations by police district
- the share of crime by offence or victimisation category.

The paper showed that in 1880 there were 344 offences per 10,000 population – a crime rate of 3.4%. The statistics for 1880 remained the peak in the reported crime rate until 1956 when 346 offences per 10,000 population were reported.⁴⁵ The crime rate was then relatively flat for the first half of the 20th century and rose steadily from 1950, reaching a peak of 1,405 offences per 10,000 population in 1992. The total crime rate has decreased significantly since the mid-1990s.

This trend has been replicated in Auckland police districts (Figure 47), with the crime rate declining across all Auckland police districts, particularly in Central Auckland. In 2020, Auckland and Counties Manukau police districts had higher crime rates than New Zealand, but Waitematā had one of the lowest (Figure 48).

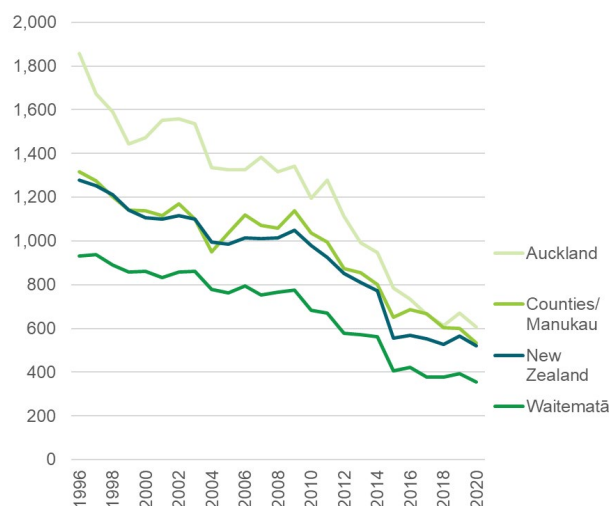
It should be noted that changes in low value serious offences (such as violent or sexual crime) can be obscured by changes in high volume, less serious offences (such as theft).

⁴⁴ Parliamentary Service, "From Offences to Victimisations: Changing Statistical Presentations of Crime in New Zealand 1994-2017," Parliamentary Library Research Paper (Wellington: Parliamentary Service, August 2018).

⁴⁵ Parliamentary Service.

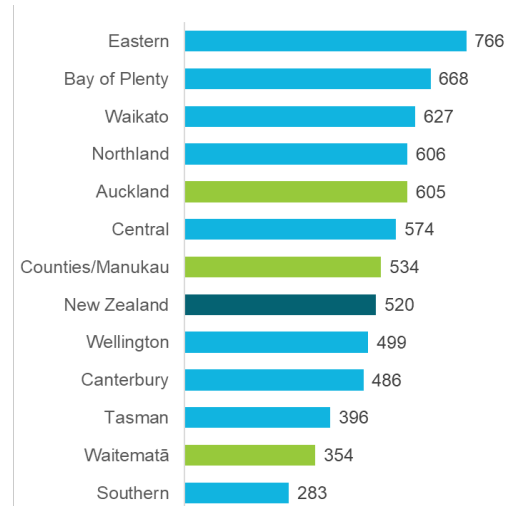


Figure 47. Offences per 10,000 population, Auckland police districts, 1996–2020



Source: Annual Recorded Offences for the latest Calendar Years (ANZSOC), Stats NZ and www.policedata.nz

Figure 48. Offences per 10,000 population, all police districts, 2020



Source: Annual Recorded Offences for the latest Calendar Years (ANZSOC), Stats NZ and www.policedata.nz

Workplace accidents in Auckland are low relative to other regions, mostly due to its industrial structure

In 2013, the Government set a target for New Zealand of reducing fatal and serious non-fatal work-related injuries by the year 2020.⁴⁶ The three work-related acute injury rates:

- Work-related fatal acute injury rate
- Work-related serious non-fatal acute injury
- Work-related acute injury resulting in more than a week away from work,

indicate New Zealand's progress towards the work-related injury reduction target – a 25% reduction from the baseline by 2020.⁴⁷

Performance in this indicator depends in part on the industrial structure of a region. Traditionally, WorkSafe has focused on higher-risk sectors like agriculture, forestry, construction, transport and manufacturing.⁴⁸

⁴⁶ WorkSafe, "Final Progress Report towards the 2020 Acute Injury Target" (WorkSafe, October 2021).

⁴⁷ WorkSafe.

⁴⁸ WorkSafe, "Statement of Performance Expectations 2020/21" (Wellington: WorkSafe New Zealand, 2020).

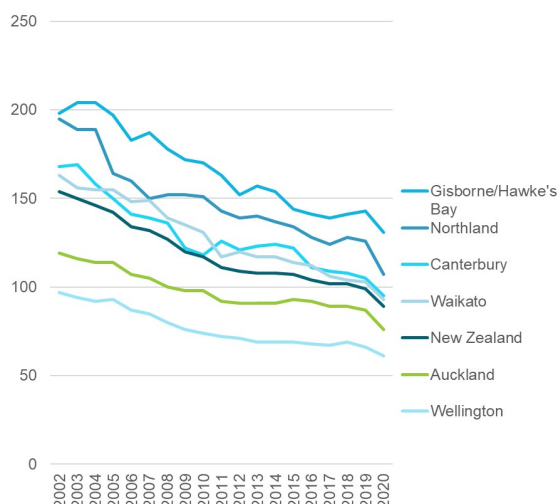


The incidence rate of fatal and serious non-fatal work-related injuries has been declining across regions over time (Figure 49). Auckland's incidence rate fell from 119 claims per 1,000 FTEs in 2002 to 76 per 1,000 FTEs in 2020. Auckland's incidence rate has consistently been below the New Zealand average and likely reflects the dominance of lower risk service industries in Auckland.

In 2020, Gisborne/Hawke's Bay had the highest incidence rate 131 per 1,000 FTEs and Wellington had the lowest – 61 per 1,000 FTEs (Figure 50). Higher risk sectors have a larger presence in Gisborne/Hawke's Bay than in Wellington and Auckland.

Results for 2020 reflect the impact of COVID-19 and associated fluctuations in economic activity. Employment numbers grew in primary and goods producing industries (including construction and manufacturing) but declined in services-related industries. Other factors such as reduced road use during Level 3 and 4 lockdowns may have influenced injury outcomes.

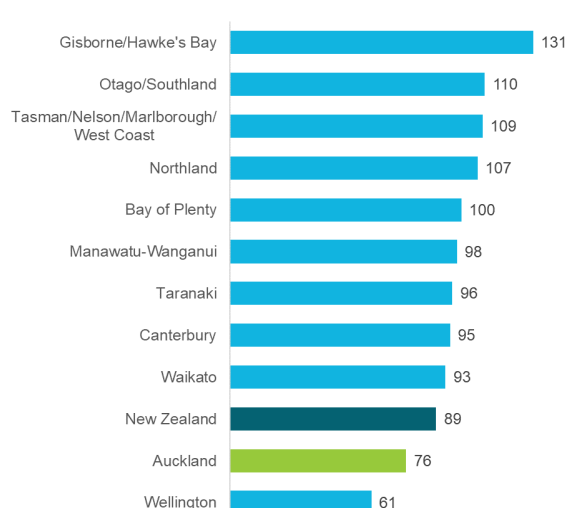
Figure 49. Fatal and serious non-fatal work-related injuries incidence rate, selected regions, 2002–2020



Source: ACC work-related claims, Stats NZ

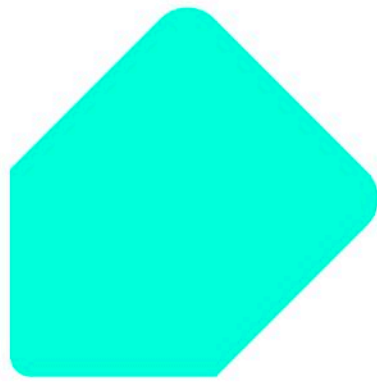
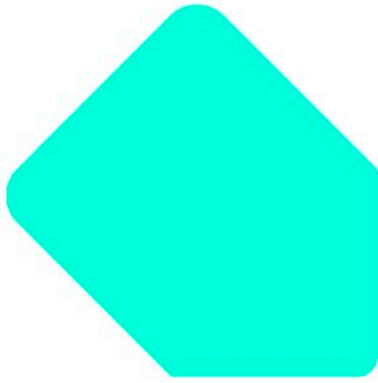
Notes: Incidence rate is the number of claims/1,000 FTEs. The number of full-time equivalent employees (FTEs) is estimated by the Household Labour Force Survey (HLFS) for the relevant year.

Figure 50. Fatal and serious non-fatal work-related injuries incidence rate, regions, 2020

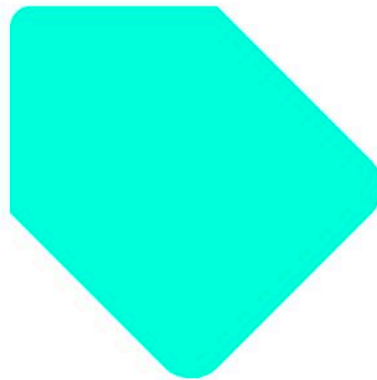
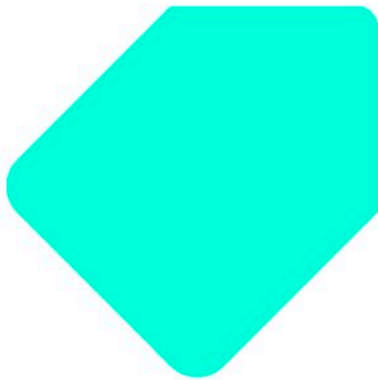


Source: ACC work-related claims, Stats NZ





HUMAN CAPITAL



IDENTITY, CULTURAL CAPABILITY, AND BELONGING

Having the language, knowledge, connection and sense of belonging necessary to participate fully in one's culture or cultures, and helping others grow their cultural capability and feel a sense of belonging.

Feeling a sense of belonging to a group or groups helps people identify who they are as an individual. Feeling like one belongs and is accepted in meaningful social groups has been linked to wellbeing and health-related outcomes.⁴⁹ A sense of belonging is associated with a feeling that members matter to one another and to the group.⁵⁰

One model of Māori wellbeing suggests that the capacity to promote culture, whakapūmau tikanga, is an important component.⁵¹ This can include cultural heritage of whānau, fluency in te reo Māori, cultural values, narratives, song, music and history. Analysis of Stats NZ Te Kupenga survey results finds that there is a small positive relationship between feeling that it is important to be involved in things to do with Māori culture, and life satisfaction.⁵² That is, the more important Māori felt it was to be involved in Māori culture, the higher their levels of life satisfaction.

Positive identity and wellbeing can also be enhanced by the distinctiveness of, and pride in, our environs and our places. Feeling a sense of pride of place is likely to result in increased participation and investment in the areas in which a person lives.

Summary

Aucklanders' perceptions of life satisfaction have decreased slightly over time, from 83% having medium-to-high life satisfaction in 2014, to 80% by 2018. Low levels of Aucklanders have high life

Life satisfaction	L	▼
Sense of purpose	L	▼
Express identity	L	▼
Sense of belonging to New Zealand	M	N
Sense of belonging to region	L	N
Te reo Māori speakers	L	~
Māori connection to marae	L	▼
Pacific language speakers	H	~

⁴⁹ C R Browning and K A Cagney, "Moving beyond Poverty: Neighborhood Structure, Social Processes and Health," *Journal of Health and Social Behavior* 44 (2003): 552–71; S L Syme, "Foreword," in *Social Epidemiology*, ed. L F Berkman and I Kawachi (New York: Oxford, 2000), ix–xii.

⁵⁰ D W McMillan, "Sense of Community," *Journal of Community Psychology* 24 (1996): 315–25; C Sonn and A T Fisher, "Immigrant Adaptation: Complicating Our Understanding of Responses to Intergroup Experiences," in *Community Psychology: In Pursuit of Liberation and Wellbeing*, ed. G Nelson and I Prilleltensky (London: McMillan, Palgrave, 2005), 348–63.

⁵¹ M H Durie, "Measuring Māori Wellbeing," Guest Lecture Series (Wellington: The New Zealand Treasury, 2006).

⁵² Statistics New Zealand, "Ngā Tohu o Te Ora: The Determinants of Life Satisfaction for Māori 2013" (Wellington: Statistics New Zealand, 2015).



satisfaction compared to other regions in New Zealand. In 2018, 72% of Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau had high life satisfaction compared to 78% of Māori across New Zealand.

Aucklanders are at the lower end of New Zealand regions for sense of purpose, with feelings of worthwhileness declining over time.

The percentage of adults in Auckland who indicate that they find it easy or very easy to express their identity in New Zealand has fallen. Aucklanders' perceptions of their ability to express their identity is lower than the national average and is at the lower end of New Zealand regions at 82%.

Aucklanders are just above the national average for feelings of national belonging (88.9% strongly or very strongly felt like they belonged to New Zealand, compared to 88.5% of New Zealanders). Nationally, Asian people were least likely to have a strong sense of belonging to New Zealand and Pacific people were most likely to have a strong sense of belonging to another country.

Older perceptions-based studies find that Aucklanders generally have very positive feelings about the city but non-Aucklanders are less complementary and see Auckland as unapproachable. Auckland does not feature strongly in people's minds at the global level but non-residents do consider the city as unique, dynamic, progressive, trendy, energetic and fun.

In Auckland only 2.4% of the population can speak about a lot of everyday things using conversational te reo Māori. At the Auckland Local Board level, conversational te reo Māori speakers were mostly found in Manurewa, Papakura and Māngere-Ōtāhuhu. When we look at the proportion of residents of Māori descent and their ability to speak te reo Māori, Auckland sits at the lower end of regions.

Aucklanders have a lower percentage of knowledge and connection to ancestral marae. 65% of Māori across New Zealand felt very strongly or strongly connected to their ancestral marae, and 58% of Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau felt the same. This is likely due to the large proportion of resident Māori who are mataawaka (Māori who live in Tāmaki Makaurau but do not belong to a mana whenua group).

Auckland significantly outperforms all other regions on the indicator "percentage of the population who can speak Samoan and Tongan". This reflects the population base of Samoan and Tongan people in Auckland. 30% of residents of Māngere-Ōtāhuhu speak Samoan or Tongan. There are also high proportions in Ōtara-Papatoetoe (22%), Manurewa (16%) and Maungakiekie-Tāmaki (10%).

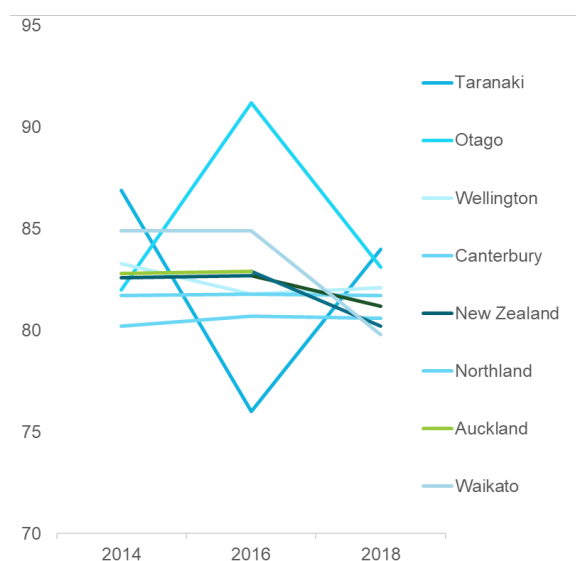
80% of Aucklanders have medium-to-high life satisfaction, which while high, is lower than most other regions

Satisfaction is a frequently used subjective measure of overall individual wellbeing. It's a self-assessed measure that shows how satisfied people are with their lives. Life satisfaction and quality of life/living are generally accepted measures of wellbeing.

Aucklanders' perceptions of life satisfaction have decreased slightly over time (Figure 51). In 2014, 83% of Aucklanders indicated they had medium-to-high life satisfaction and this had decreased to 80% of Aucklanders by 2018. Proportionately, fewer Aucklanders have medium-to-high life satisfaction compared to other regions in New Zealand (Figure 52). Circumstances that may influence life satisfaction include health, education, employment, income, personality, family and social connections, civil and human rights, levels of trust in others, and opportunities for democratic participation.

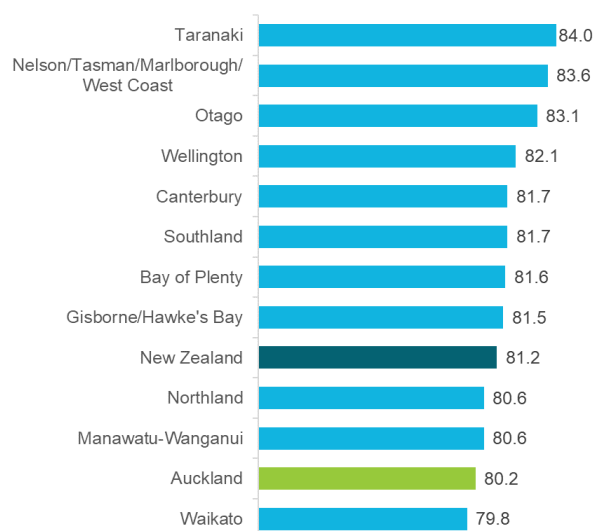


Figure 51. Percentage of people with a score of 7/10 or higher for life satisfaction, selected regions, 2014–2018



Source: Stats NZ, New Zealand General Social Survey

Figure 52. Percentage of people with a score of 7/10 or higher for life satisfaction, regions, 2018



Source: Stats NZ, New Zealand General Social Survey

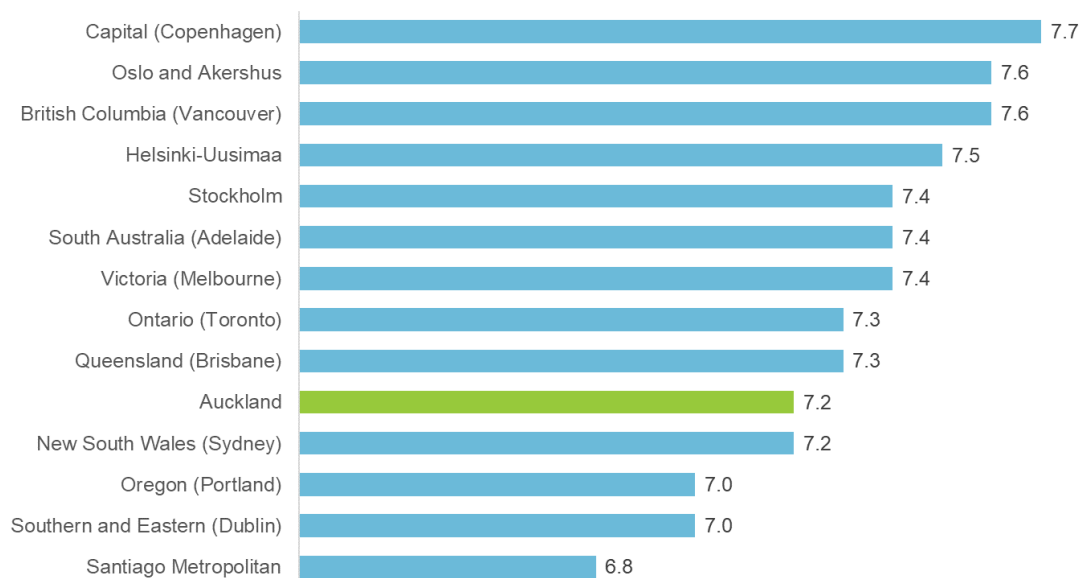
Māori in Aotearoa generally have lower perceptions of life satisfaction than non-Māori. In 2018, 72% of Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau had high life satisfaction compared to 78% of Māori across New Zealand.⁵³

On international comparisons, Aucklanders were just in the lower half of comparable regions on self-rated life satisfaction. In 2014, Aucklanders rated life satisfaction at 7.2, while Copenhagen residents were at the highest life satisfaction level of 7.7, and Santiago was the lowest at an average of 6.8 (Figure 53).

⁵³ Independent Māori Statutory Board, "Manaakitanga," Independent Māori Statutory Board, 2020, <https://www.imsb.maori.nz/maori-wellbeing-in-tamaki-makaurau/manaakitanga/>.



Figure 53. Self-evaluation of life satisfaction on a scale of 0-10, selected regions, 2014



Source: OECD.Stat, Regions and Cities

Note: OECD classifies the geographic units in this chart as large regions (territorial level 2 or TL2) to help in assessing differences in socio-economic trends in regions, both within and across countries

Less people in Auckland have a high sense of purpose than most other regions in New Zealand. But 85% feeling their lives were worthwhile is still a good result

Sense of purpose is the second self-reported measure the Stats NZ General Social Survey uses to look at people's self-rated wellbeing. It tells us whether people felt they had a sense of purpose or meaning in life. Respondents are asked if they felt that the things they did in life were worthwhile, using a 0–10 scale. For sense of purpose, people who reported 0 felt their lives were not at all worthwhile and those who reported 10 felt their lives were completely worthwhile.

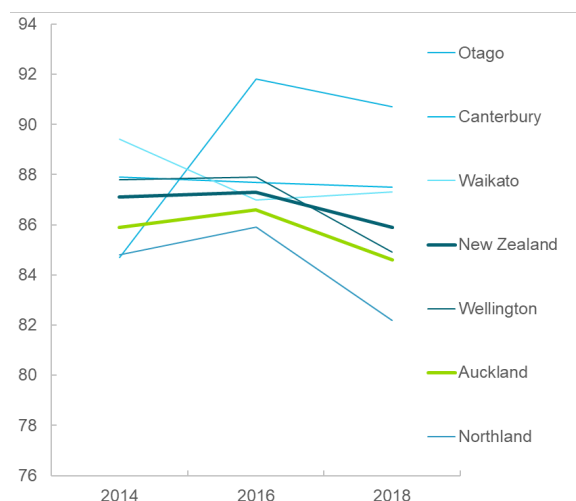
Having a sense of “place, purpose and belonging” can have a powerful effect on wellbeing.⁵⁴ Being connected and valued enables people to know and accept who they are and may well act as a protective factor against other elements that challenge their wellbeing.

In a similar pattern to regional performance on perceptions of life satisfaction, Aucklanders have been at the lower end of New Zealand regions (Figure 55). Feelings of worthwhileness have declined over time, as it has for most other regions (Figure 54).

⁵⁴ Cunningham et al, 2018, as cited in New Zealand Mental Health and Wellbeing Commission, “Te Rau Tira Wellbeing Outcomes Report 2021” (Wellington: New Zealand Mental Health and Wellbeing Commission, 2021), <https://www.mhwc.govt.nz/assets/Te-Rau-Tira-Wellbeing-Outcomes-Report-2021/Te-Rau-Tira-Wellbeing-Outcomes-Report-2021-FINAL-WEB.pdf>.

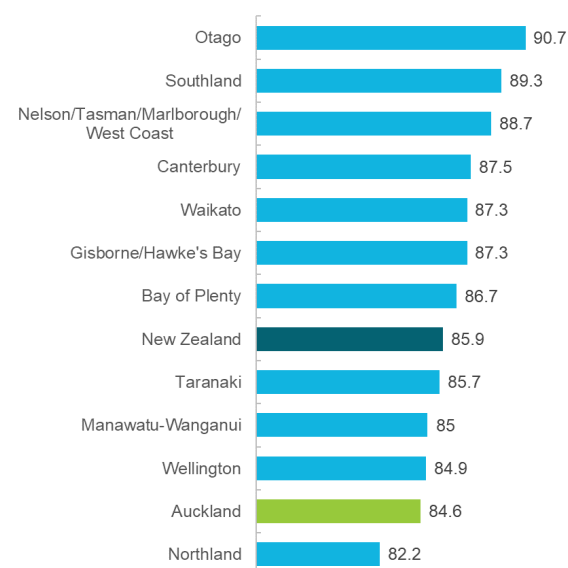


Figure 54. Percentage of people with a score of 7/10 or higher for sense of purpose, selected regions, 2014–2018



Source: Stats NZ, New Zealand General Social Survey

Figure 55. Percentage of people with a score of 7/10 or higher for sense of purpose, regions, 2018



Source: Stats NZ, New Zealand General Social Survey

Aucklanders are finding it harder to express their identity

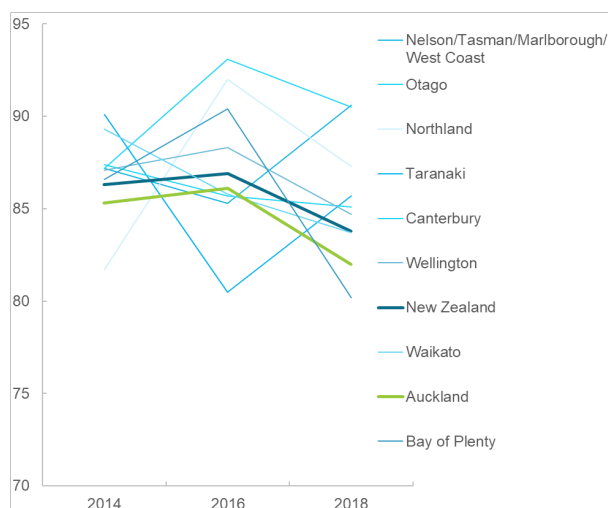
Regional places enable people to undertake activities and actions that are a means of representing their characteristics that are important to them. People have different lifestyles, cultures and ways of expressing their identity. Being able to express who they are is important for people's sense of self and overall wellbeing.⁵⁵ A society which is inclusive of differences is desirable as it enables members to participate fully in life, and gives them a sense of belonging and security.

The percentage of adults in Auckland who indicate that they find it easy or very easy to express their identity in New Zealand has fallen from 85.3% in 2014 to 82.0% in 2018 (Figure 56). The proportion of Aucklanders who believe they have the ability to express their identity is lower than the national average and is at the lower end of New Zealand regions (Figure 57).

⁵⁵ Ministry of Social Development, "The Social Report 2016."



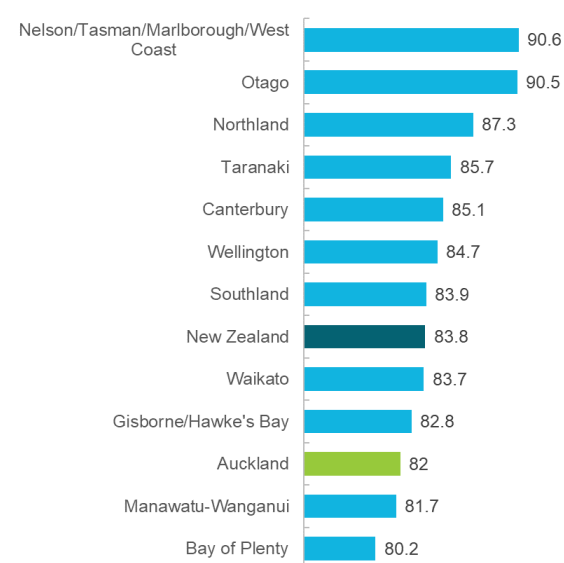
Figure 56. Percentage of adults who find it easy or very easy to express their identity in New Zealand, selected regions, 2014–2018



Source: Stats NZ, New Zealand General Social Survey

Note: The data collection for 2014 took place from April 2014 to March 2015, and for 2018 from April 2018 to March 2019. For 2016, data collection took place from April 2016 to April 2017. Stats NZ collection systems and operations were affected by the 2016 November earthquake, causing the collection of December 2016 sample interviews to be conducted in April 2017.

Figure 57. Percentage of adults who find it easy or very easy to express their identity in New Zealand, regions, 2018



Source: Stats NZ, New Zealand General Social Survey

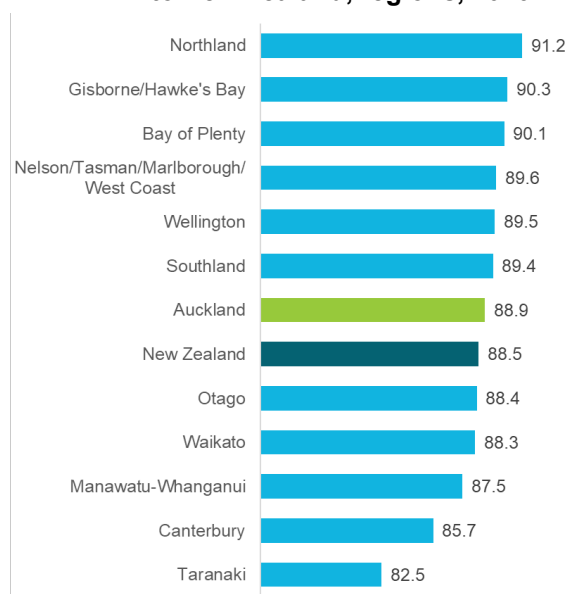
Most Aucklanders feel a sense of belonging to New Zealand, and the proportion of Aucklanders who have a strong sense of belonging is about the same as the national average

In 2016, Kiwis nationally had a strong sense of belonging to New Zealand; on average rating this as 8.6 out of 10.⁵⁶ Asian people were least likely to have a strong sense of belonging to New Zealand – about 33% rated it 10/10, compared with 44% of the total population. Pacific people were most likely to have a strong sense of belonging to another country (49.9% rated it 10/10 compared with 22.8% of the general population).

⁵⁶ Stats NZ, "Well-Being Statistics: 2016," Stats NZ, July 20, 2017, <https://www.stats.govt.nz/information-releases/well-being-statistics-2016>.



Figure 58. Percentage of adults who very strongly and strongly have a sense of belonging to New Zealand, regions, 2016



Source: Customised data from Stats NZ, New Zealand General Social Survey

Aucklanders are just above the national average – 88.9% of Aucklanders strongly or very strongly felt like they belonged to New Zealand, and 88.5% of New Zealanders felt the same (Figure 58). People in Northland most felt like they belonged to New Zealand – 91.2% felt strongly or very strongly a sense of belonging to New Zealand – while those in Taranaki sat at the lower end of this scale (82.5%).

Compared to most other regions, Aucklanders are least likely to feel they have a strong sense of belonging to Auckland

A region's image and/or identity can influence a region's reputation and perceived importance as a place to live, work and do business.⁵⁷ As discussed previously, sense of belonging, feelings of connectedness and sense of purpose all play an interconnected part in individual wellbeing.

In 2016, a smaller proportion of Aucklanders indicated that they “strongly” or “very strongly” had a sense of belonging to Auckland, than most other regions in New Zealand (Figure 59). Southland had the highest proportion with a sense of belonging – 79% compared to Auckland's 71%.

This is likely to be related to feelings of parochialism and the sense that a region has a single, identifiable and common identity. Many of Auckland's residents hail from other countries around the world (see the data on proportion of Aucklanders who are born overseas on page 19 onwards), and are originally from other regions around New Zealand.

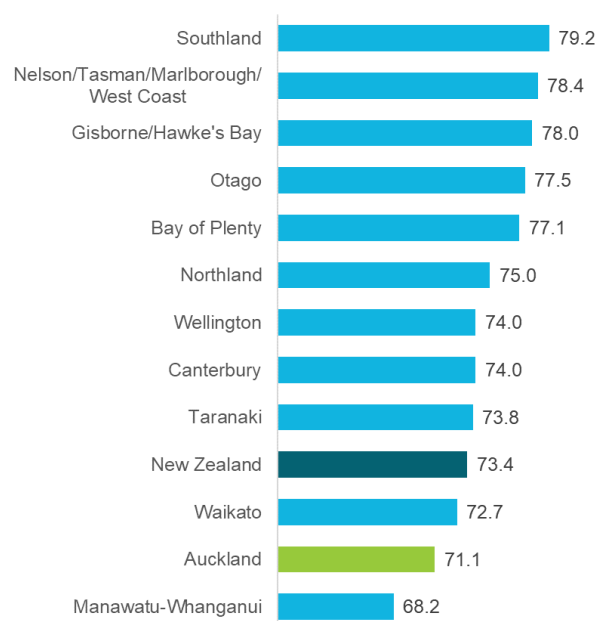
⁵⁷ Ivan Turok, “Cities, Regions and Competitiveness,” *Regional Studies* 38, no. 9 (December 2004): 1069–83.



Regions also deliberately attempt to manage particular images or brands to communicate their “offering” and to influence visitor, worker and investment decisions. These branding exercises attempt to bring together a range of attributes into a coherent whole (for example, the “knowledge city” or “cultural capital”). To be successful they must be based on genuine features or differences.⁵⁸

Older international and national perceptions-based studies find that Aucklanders generally have very positive feelings about the city but non-Aucklanders are less complementary and see Auckland as unapproachable.⁵⁹ In addition, Auckland does not feature strongly in people’s minds at the global level. Positively, non-residents do consider the city as unique, dynamic, progressive, trendy, energetic and fun.

Figure 59. Percentage of adults who very strongly and strongly have a sense of belonging to their region, regions, 2016



Source: Stats NZ, New Zealand General Social Survey

More recently, Auckland won the City/Nation/Place’s Place Brand of the Year 2020, for Auckland Unlimited and Destination Think’s “Tāmaki Makaurau Auckland is Calling” campaign.⁶⁰

Only a very small proportion of Aucklanders can speak conversational te reo Māori, and this hasn’t changed over time

In 2019, Maihi Karauna, the Crown’s strategy for Māori language revitalisation was launched. This sets out te reo Māori language goals through to 2040 that includes:⁶¹

- 85% of New Zealanders will value te reo Māori
- One million New Zealanders will have ability and confidence to speak basic reo

⁵⁸ N Lee, “Ideopolis: Knowledge City Regions: Distinctiveness and Cities – Beyond ‘Find and Replace’ Economic Development.” (London: The Work Foundation, 2007).

⁵⁹ C Meares et al., “City Benchmarking: An Overview of Auckland’s Rankings in the Global Context,” Technical Report (Auckland: Auckland Council, 2015).

⁶⁰ City Nation Place, “Awards Alumni,” City Nation Place, 2022, <https://www.citynationplace.com/awards/alumni-past-winners>; TPBO, “Auckland: A City Branding Success Story from Aotearoa New Zealand,” *TPBO The Place Brand Observer* (blog), March 17, 2021, <https://placebrandobserver.com/auckland-city-branding-success-story/>.

⁶¹ Māori Language Commission et al., “Maihi Karauna: The Crown’s Strategy for Māori Language Revitalisation, 2018–2023” (Wellington: Te Puni Kōkiri, 2019).



- 150,000 Māori aged 15 years+ will use te reo Māori as much as English.

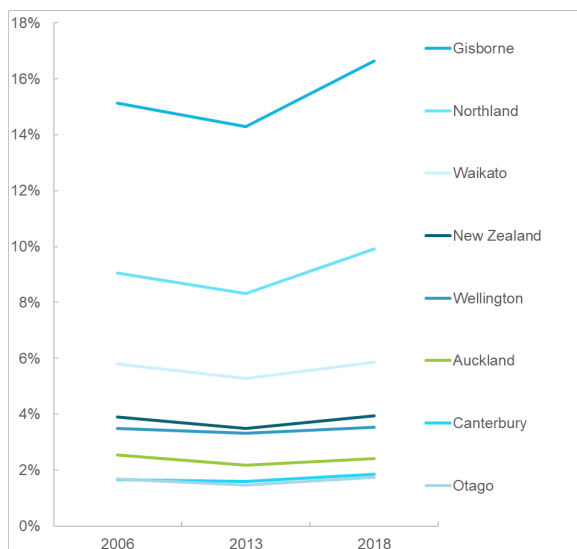
Te reo Māori plays a central role in te ao Māori and is crucial to building culturally strong communities in Tāmaki Makaurau. The use of Māori language is widely regarded as a major indicator of “being Māori”.⁶²

Nationally, the proportion of adults in New Zealand who can speak conversational te reo Māori has remained static at about 4% (Figure 60). The proportion is even smaller for Auckland where only 2.4% of the population can speak in te reo Māori about a lot of everyday things (Figure 61). Gisborne and Northland have significantly higher proportions of te reo Māori speakers, likely due to the high proportion of residents of Māori descent.

At the Auckland Local Board level, as expected, conversational te reo Māori speakers were mostly found in Manurewa, Papakura and Māngere-Ōtāhuhu (Figure 62). However, the percentages are not as high as those in Gisborne and Northland, with Manurewa the highest at 6.3% compared to 16.6% in Gisborne and 9.9% in Northland.

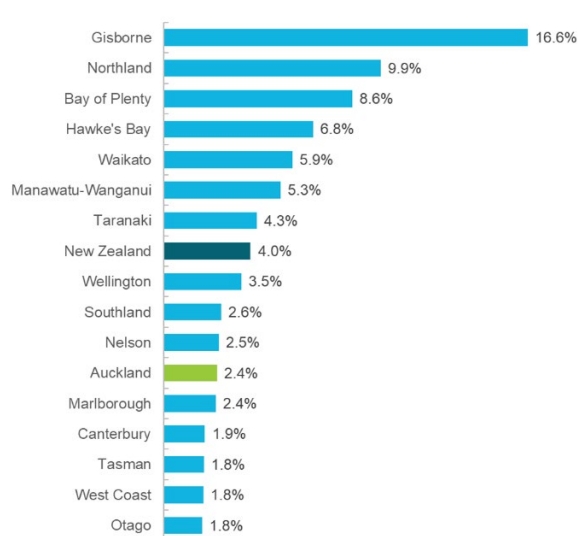
When we look at the proportion of residents of Māori descent and their ability to speak te reo Māori, Auckland sits at the lower end of regions (Figure 63). The proportion of adults has also fallen from 17% in 2006 to 15% in 2018.

Figure 60. Percentage of adults who can converse about a lot of everyday things in te reo Māori, selected regions, 2006, 2013, 2018



Source: Stats NZ, Census of Population and Dwellings

Figure 61. Percentage of adults who can converse about a lot of everyday things in te reo Māori, regions, 2018

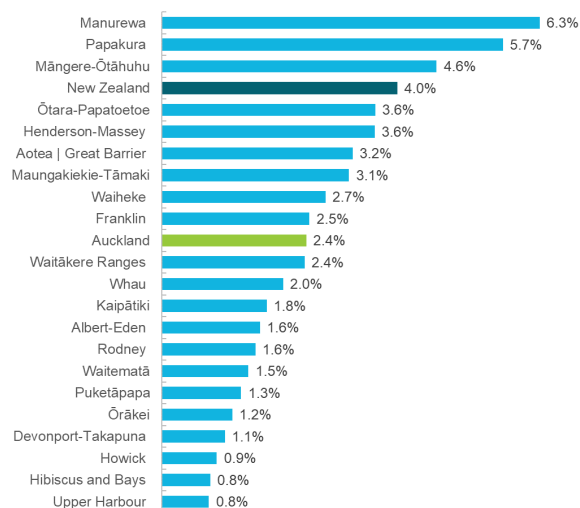


Source: Stats NZ, Census of Population and Dwellings

⁶² Durie, “Measuring Māori Wellbeing.”

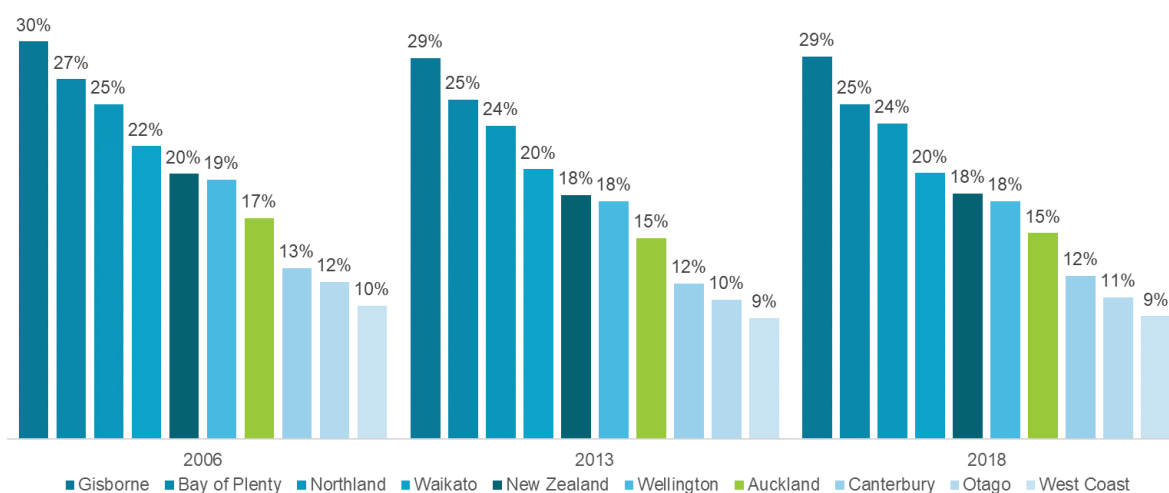


Figure 62. Percentage of adults who can converse about a lot of everyday things in te reo Māori, Auckland Local Board areas, 2018



Source: Stats NZ, Census of Population and Dwellings

Figure 63. Percentage of adults of Māori descent who can converse about a lot of everyday things in te reo Māori, selected regions, 2006, 2013, 2018



Source: Stats NZ, Census of Population and Dwellings



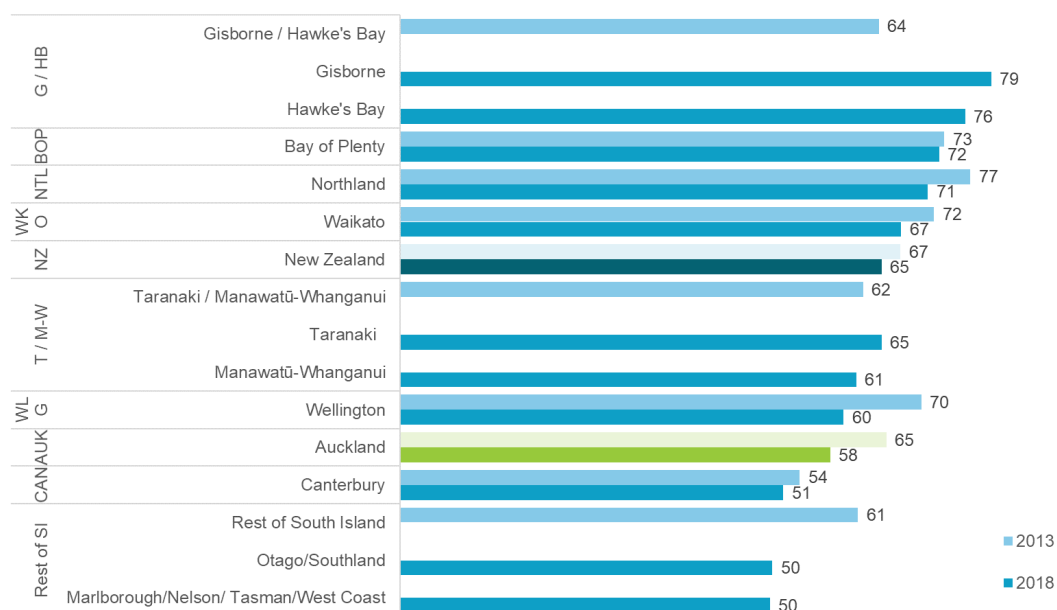
Low proportions of Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau feel a strong connection to their ancestral marae. This is likely due to the large proportion who identify as mataawaka

Māori experience marae as their tūrangawaewae – a place to stand and belong. Marae can be tribal-based (ancestral marae), or non-kin based (urban/community marae). The marae is central to affirming Māori culture, Māori customary practices and providing manaakitanga to visitors.⁶³

In 2018, two-thirds of New Zealand Māori adults (66%) said they knew their ancestral marae, and 63% of Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau knew their ancestral marae or marae tipuna. Knowing ones ancestral marae and visiting marae remains an important and relevant way for Māori to connect with culture, and marae continue to be a vital aspect of Māori culture and identity.

In 2018, 74% of New Zealand Māori considered marae tipuna (if known) as tūrangawaewae, while 72% of Auckland Māori felt the same. This pattern of findings continues when asked about how strongly connected they felt to marae tipuna. 65% of Māori across New Zealand felt very strongly or strongly connected to their ancestral marae, and 58% of Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau felt the same. Māori in Gisborne and Hawke's Bay felt most strongly connected to their ancestral marae (Figure 64).

Figure 64. Percentage of Māori adults who feel very strongly and strongly connected with their ancestral marae, regions, 2013 and 2018



Source: Stats NZ, Te Kupenga

Notes: People aged 15 years and over of Māori ethnicity and/or descent. Only asked of those who thought of their ancestral marae as their tūrangawaewae.

⁶³ Stats NZ, "Whānau and Culture Important to Māori" (Wellington: Stats NZ, 2014), <https://www.stats.govt.nz/news/whanau-and-culture-important-to-maori>.



Auckland’s lower percentage of knowledge and connection to ancestral marae is likely due to the large proportion of resident Māori who are mataawaka. Mataawaka make up 86% of the Māori population in Auckland. Te Kupenga shows that time, distance and cost are the main reasons Māori don’t go to their ancestral marae more often.

For Auckland Māori, urban and community marae, such as Papakura Marae, provide a sense of place, home and belonging. There are 36 marae in Tāmaki Makaurau that are eligible for Auckland Council cultural initiatives funding:

- 20 traditional marae owned by whānau, hapū and iwi and based on whakapapa
- 16 urban marae established as places for whānau Māori living in urban settings (Figure 65).

Figure 65. There are 36 marae in Tāmaki Makaurau, 2020



Source: Auckland Council, Cultural Initiatives Fund (excludes educational and institutional marae)
Note: Icon credit - House by Alexandra Hawkhead from NounProject.com

Auckland has the highest proportion of people who can speak Samoan or Tongan

As with Māori, Pacific languages are vital for Pacific peoples sense of belonging and sense of identity. A draft Pacific Languages Strategy⁶⁴ has just finished its consultation period. It recognises that the proportion of speakers of Pacific languages in New Zealand has declined against a backdrop of the importance of language for wellbeing, particularly during the COVID-19 pandemic.

The Pacific Languages Strategy aims to increase the use of Pacific languages, and to revitalise those most at risk. There are nine Pacific language groups with different needs, strengths and challenges:

⁶⁴ Ministry for Pacific Peoples, “Pacific Languages Strategy – for Targeted Consultation” (Wellington: Ministry for Pacific Peoples, 2021).



	Pacific ethnic group	Total ethnic language speakers 2018 (n)	Total Pacific population stated 2018 (n)	Proportion of specific Pacific language speakers 2018 (%)	
•	Gagana Samoa	Samoa	92,058	182,721	50.4%
•	Te taetae ni Kiribati	Kiribati	1,611	3,225	50.0%
•	Te Gana Tuvalu	Tuvalu	2,250	4,653	48.3%
•	Lea Faka-Tonga	Tonga	33,072	82,389	40.1%
•	Fāeag Rotūmā	Rotuman	333	981	34.0%
•	Vosa Vakaviti	Fiji	4,680	19,722	23.7%
•	Te Gagana Tokelau	Tokelau	2,025	8,676	23.3%
•	Vagahau Niue	Niue	3,777	30,867	12.2%
•	Te Reo Māori Kuki 'Āirani	Cook Islands Māori	7,179	80,532	9.0%

Source: MPP⁶⁵

The publicly available Census data only provides information on the most common Pacific languages – Samoan and Tongan. Auckland significantly outperforms all other regions on the indicator “percentage of the population who can speak Samoan and Tongan” (Figure 67), and this has been consistent over the last three census (Figure 60). This reflects the population base of Samoan and Tongan people in Auckland. The proportion has been relatively stable: 6.5% in 2006, 6.1% in 2013 and 6.4% in 2018.

Auckland has often been described as “the largest Polynesian city in the world” – first in a 1966 article, from a planning perspective⁶⁶, and in Auckland Council Group publications today.⁶⁷ Examining use of Pacific languages by local board area highlights this diversity – 30% of residents of Māngere-Ōtāhuhu speak Samoan or Tongan (Figure 68). There are also high proportions in Ōtara-Papatoetoe (22%), Manurewa (16%) and Maungakiekie-Tāmaki (10%).

Note that Auckland may not in fact be the largest Polynesian city in the world, as a slide from a 2013 presentation suggests (Figure 69).⁶⁸

⁶⁵ Ministry for Pacific Peoples, “Pacific Aotearoa: Status Report, a Snapshot 2020” (Wellington: Ministry for Pacific Peoples, 2020).

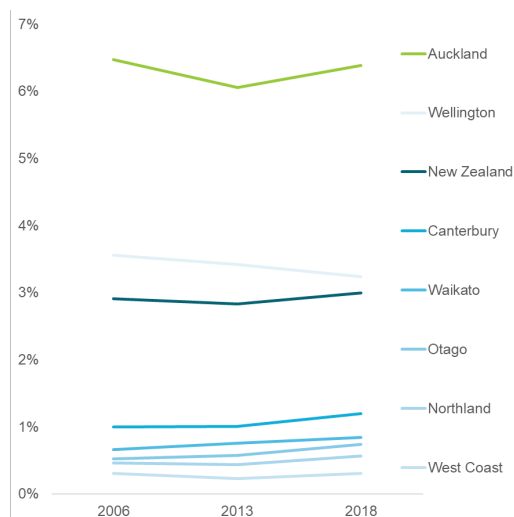
⁶⁶ Lana Lopesi, “So, You Want to Be the ‘Largest Polynesian City in the World’?”, *The Pantograph Punch* (blog), April 6, 2018, <https://www.pantograph-punch.com/posts/largest-polynesian-city>.

⁶⁷ Auckland Unlimited, “Pasifika Research,” A research report about Pasifika people in Tāmaki Makaurau for the Teu Le Vā – Auckland Unlimited Pasifika Work Programme. (Auckland Unlimited, 2021); Auckland Council, “City Centre Masterplan 2020” (Auckland Council, 2022), <https://www.aucklandccmp.co.nz/outcomes/outcome-10-prosperous-city-centre/economic-prosperity-in-aucklands-city-centre/>.

⁶⁸ Lopesi, “So, You Want to Be the ‘Largest Polynesian City in the World’?”



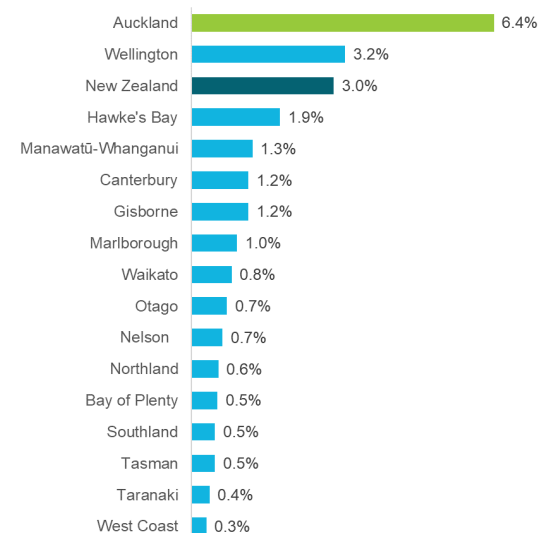
Figure 66. Percentage of the population who can speak Samoan and Tongan, selected regions, 2006, 2013, 2018



Source: Stats NZ, Census of Population and Dwellings

Note: This includes children but excludes "None (for example, too young to talk)"

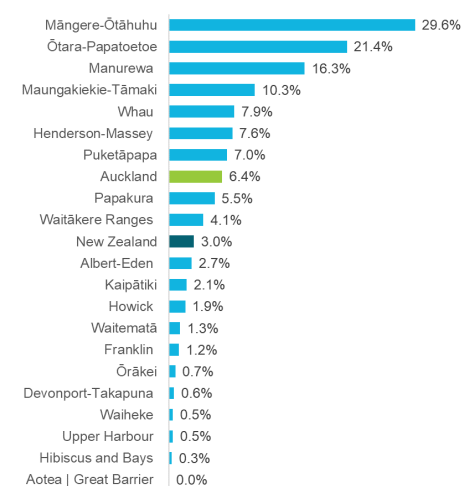
Figure 67. Percentage of the population who can speak Samoan and Tongan, regions, 2018



Source: Stats NZ, Census of Population and Dwellings

Note: This includes children but excludes "None (for example, too young to talk)"

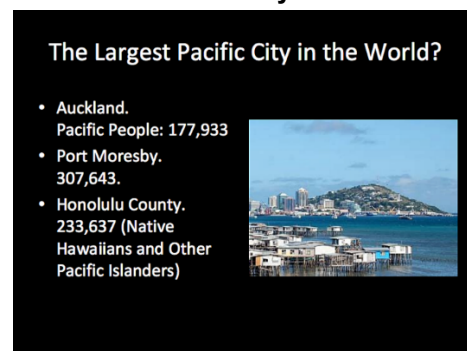
Figure 68. Percentage of the population who can speak Samoan and Tongan, Auckland local boards, 2018



Source: Stats NZ, Census of Population and Dwellings

Note: This includes children but excludes "None (for example, too young to talk)"

Figure 69. Is Auckland the largest Pacific city in the world?



Source: Salesa, D (2013)



KNOWLEDGE AND SKILLS

Having knowledge and skills appropriate to one's life stage and continuing to learn through formal and informal channels.

Education and skills have a strong influence on people's well-being. Education opens opportunities for people and brings a wide range of benefits to society, including higher economic growth, stronger social cohesion and less crime. By investing in education, families and governments can reach many economic and social goals at the same time.

Strong disparities remain in the quality of educational outcomes, and educational attainment and students' skills are strongly influenced by the incomes and socio-economic backgrounds of their families, with educational disadvantage cumulating over the life course.

Knowledge and skills overlap somewhat with the identity, cultural capability, and belonging theme. It is kept separate to highlight the particular importance of certain types of cultural knowledge for the wellbeing of people.

Skill levels	H	▲
Bachelor's and above	H	▲
Level 2+	H	▲
Industry training	M	▼
Regular school attendance	M	▼
Patent applications	H	▲
Research, science and innovation workforce	L	N
Migrant workforce	H	▲

Summary

Auckland has a high proportion of workers with Skill Level 1 occupations (level of skill commensurate with a bachelor degree or higher). Skill levels in Auckland and New Zealand have increased over time.

Although Auckland has the second highest proportion of employed Māori who have Skill Level 1 occupations, the proportion is lower than the total Auckland population (Māori and non-Māori) who have Skill Level 1 occupations. At the local board area level, 59.4% of residents of Ōrākei have Skill Level 1 occupations, while 20.4% of residents of Ōtara-Papatoetoe are in the same types of occupations. It has been identified that Māori, Pacific Peoples and low decile students are less likely to take academic subjects and when they do, they are less likely to pass.

Auckland's percentage of adults with at least an upper secondary education sits well above the New Zealand proportion and rates have increased over time. However, the number of people in Auckland undertaking vocational education and training has declined over time in absolute and proportional terms.

Regular school attendance across the Auckland region is similar to attendance across New Zealand. COVID-19 lockdowns disproportionately affected school attendance rates in Auckland. Attendance rates were most affected in decile one and two schools and for Pacific and Māori students in Auckland.



Compared with most developed countries, New Zealand has low rates of expenditure on R&D and has low rates of patenting per capita. Once New Zealand-specific effects are controlled for, New Zealand has a slightly higher than expected per capita patenting performance. In 2015, Auckland's patent activity was second amongst New Zealand regions.

Auckland has a relatively high number of research, science and innovation (RSI) workers, compared to other regions in New Zealand – over 4,500. However, RSI workers only make up 0.5% of Auckland's total workforce, which is considerably lower than New Zealand's almost 1%.

In 2019, Auckland had the highest absolute number of work-related visa holders entering its workforce. The majority of Auckland's migrant workers approved in 2019 were from India or the Philippines, with workers mostly approved for jobs as technicians and trades workers, and as professionals.

Auckland sits just behind Wellington, as the region with the highest proportion of workers with occupations requiring a bachelor's degree

At the individual worker level, a good match between skills and requirements contributes to greater job satisfaction and motivation.⁶⁹ If people do not have the opportunity to work in their desired field and utilise their skills it can be demotivating and detrimental to both their personal well-being and their productivity.

At the regional economy level, a high level of skills mismatch is negatively related to labour productivity. Firms can encounter difficulty recruiting and retaining talent, learners may not be given clear signals about what skills they should train for, and skills are not allocated in the most efficient and productive way.

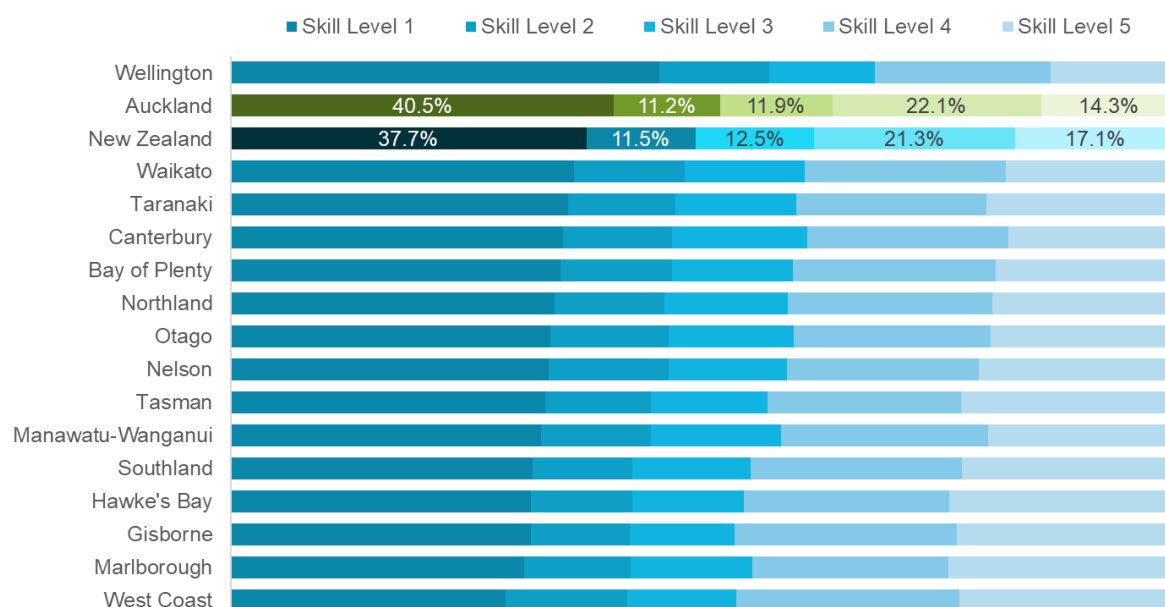
The skills profiles of regions in New Zealand differ. Wellington and Auckland both have a high proportion of workers with Skill Level 1⁷⁰ occupations (Figure 70). Occupations at Skill Level 1 have a level of skill commensurate with a bachelor degree or higher qualification; at least five years of relevant experience may substitute for the formal qualification. In some instances relevant experience and/or on-the-job training may be required in addition to the formal qualification. Examples of Skill Level 1 occupations are chief executive or managing director, engineering manager, laboratory manager, arts administrator, and production manager.

⁶⁹ Rihova, 2016 as cited in Stats NZ, "Skills Mismatch in the Labour Market: Concepts, Data Sources, and Measures" (Stats NZ Tatauranga Aotearoa, 2017).

⁷⁰ In the Australian New Zealand Standard Classification of Occupations (ANZSCO), skill level is defined as a function of the range and complexity of the set of tasks performed in a particular occupation. The greater the range and complexity of the set of tasks, the greater the skill level of an occupation. Skill level is measured operationally by: the level or amount of formal education and training, the amount of previous experience in a related occupation, and the amount of on-the-job training required to competently perform the set of tasks required for that occupation.



Figure 70. Employed adults by skill level, regions, 2018



Source: Customised data from Stats NZ, Census of Population and Dwellings

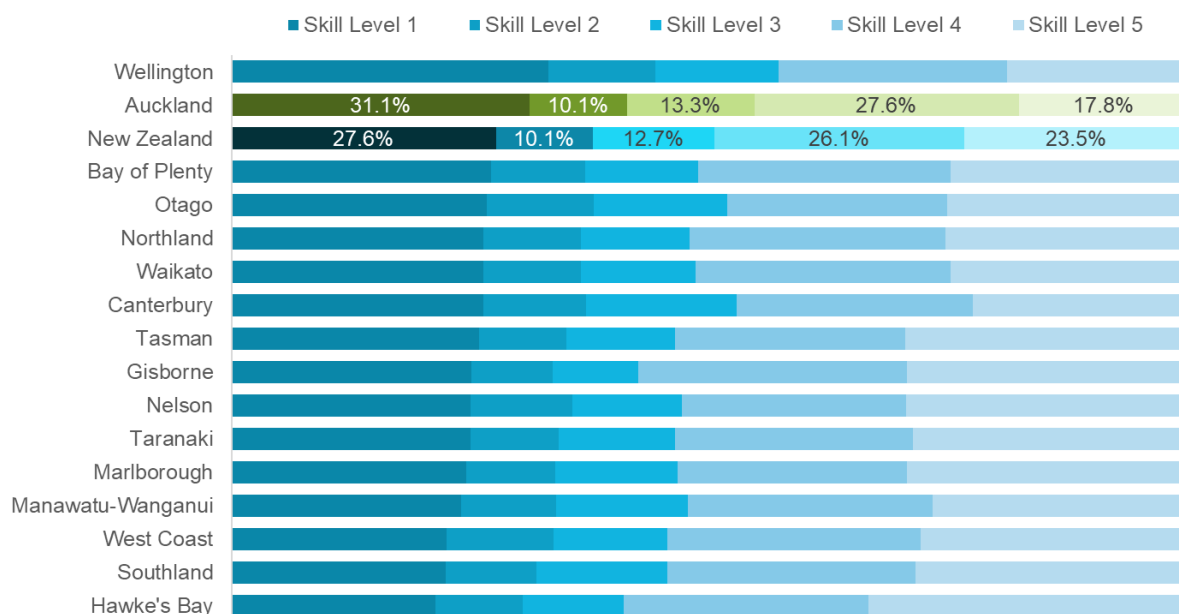
The skills profile of a region differs by ethnicity. Figure 71 shows that although Auckland has the second highest proportion of employed Māori who have Skill Level 1 occupations, the proportion (31.1%) is lower than the total population (40.5%). The proportion of Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau with Skill Level 5 occupations (17.8%) is higher than the proportion across all Aucklanders (14.3%).

At the local board area level, the skill profile differs again. 59.4% of residents of Ōrākei have Skill Level 1 occupations, while 20.4% of residents of Ōtara-Papatoetoe are in the same types of occupations (Figure 72).

Skill levels in Auckland and New Zealand have increased over time. In Auckland, the proportion of workers with Skill Level 1 occupations rose by six percentage points between 2006 and 2018 – as it did across New Zealand (Figure 73). Conversely, the percentage of workers with occupations in Skill Levels 3, 4, and 5 fell.

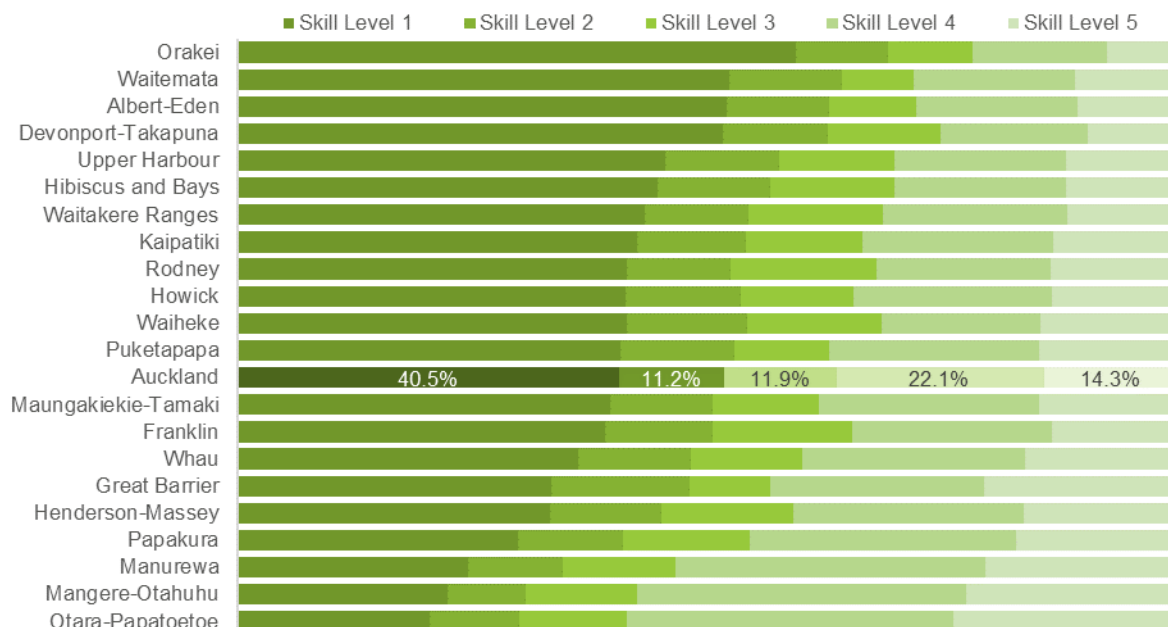


Figure 71. Employed Māori by skill level, regions, 2018



Source: Customised data from Stats NZ, Census of Population and Dwellings

Figure 72. Employed adults by skill level, Auckland local board areas, 2018



Source: Customised data from Stats NZ, Census of population and dwellings



Figure 73. Changes in skill levels over time, Auckland and New Zealand, 2006, 2013, 2018



Source: Customised data from Stats NZ, Census of Population and Dwellings

Auckland is one of the highest qualified regions in New Zealand

Having a population with higher qualifications is important for the economy and society.⁷¹ Education helps people develop the skills needed to reach their full potential. It contributes to better health outcomes and a better quality of life.

Overall, Auckland is one of the highest qualified regions in New Zealand (Figure 74), and the proportion of people aged over 15 who have a Bachelor’s degree or higher has increased over time – for all regions. Auckland’s proportion is well above the national average (28.7% compared to 23.2%), and is second only to Wellington (Figure 75).

However, there are disparities within the Auckland region. NZIER⁷² finds that the subjects and level of qualifications matter. It has been identified that Māori, Pacific Peoples and low decile students are less likely to take academic subjects and when they do, they are less likely to pass. Additionally, Māori, Pacific Peoples and low decile students are more likely to be enrolled in vocational subjects, which are not university-approved.⁷³ This means that the qualifications that Māori students are achieving, are not the same kind of qualification that students from different ethnic backgrounds and higher deciles are achieving.

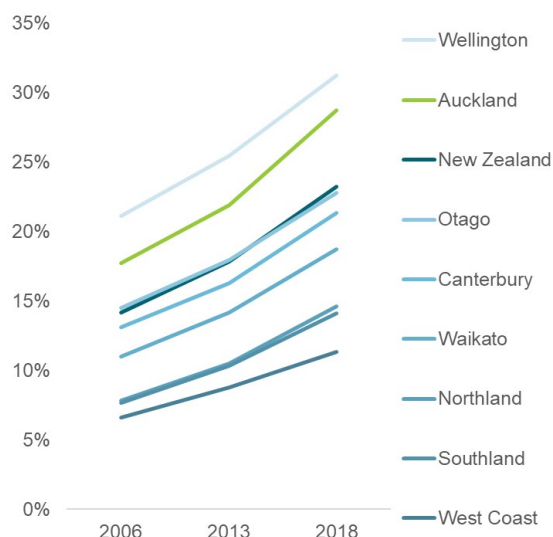
⁷¹ Statistics New Zealand, “NZ Social Indicators.”

⁷² NZIER, “Improving the Lives of Auckland Māori: Evidence and an Action Plan,” Report for the Independent Māori Statutory Board (Wellington: New Zealand Institute of Economic Research, 2016).

⁷³ K Johnston, “NCEA: The Only Brown Kid in the Room,” September 26, 2016, sec. New Zealand, https://www.nzherald.co.nz/nz/news/article.cfm?c_id=1&objectid=11713957.

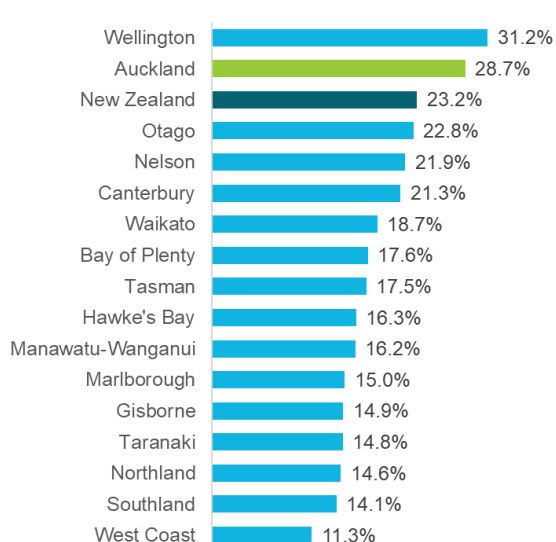


Figure 74. Percentage of adults who have a bachelor's degree or above, selected regions, 2006–2018



Source: Stats NZ, Census of Population and Dwellings

Figure 75. Percentage of adults who have a bachelor's degree or above, regions, 2018



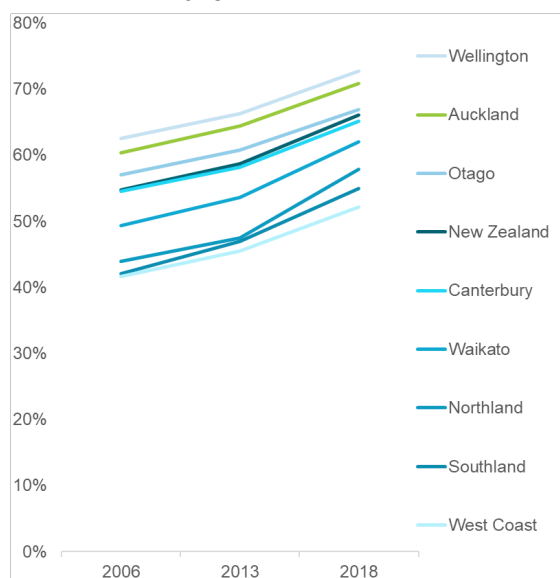
Source: Stats NZ, Census of Population and Dwellings

Auckland has one of the highest proportion of adults with at least a high school education

The regional patterns are similar for the percentage of adults with at least an upper secondary education (equivalent to NCEA Level 2). Auckland's percentage of 70.8% sits just below Wellington (72.8%) and well above the New Zealand proportion (66.1%), and rates have increased over time (Figure 76).

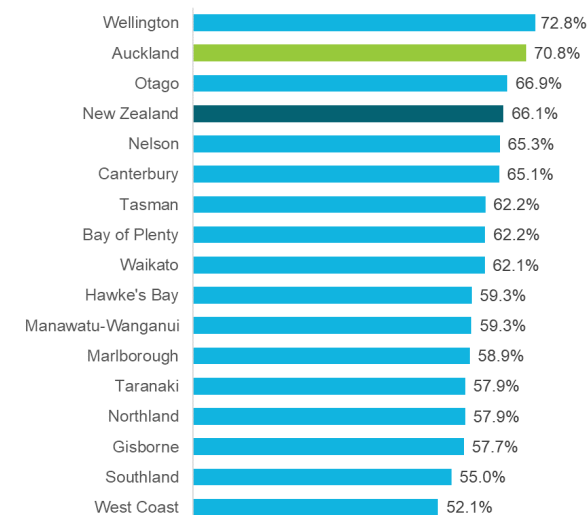


Figure 76. Percentage of adults with at least an upper secondary education (equivalent to NCEA Level 2), selected regions, 2006–2018



Source: Stats NZ, Census of Population and Dwellings

Figure 77. Percentage of adults with at least an upper secondary education (equivalent to NCEA Level 2), regions, 2018



Source: Stats NZ, Census of Population and Dwellings

Less Aucklanders are participating in vocational education and training. Participation has declined over time while other regions have remained steady

Two policy changes have had significant impacts on industry training and apprenticeships in New Zealand:

- The Review of Vocational Education (RoVE) is introducing a new system that is intended to have a stronger focus on employers, delivering skills they need, providing more support for their employees, and ensuring greater consistency in vocational education across New Zealand.
- In response to COVID-19, the Government introduced the Targeted Training and Apprenticeship Fund (TTAF) which covers the fees for selected vocational education and training between 1 July 2020 and 31 December 2022. This fund (which is also known as 'free trades training') targets skills needs where demand from employers is expected to be strong or to grow during the recovery period.

The number of people in Auckland undertaking vocational education and training (VET) has declined over time. In 2011, there was a high of 78,260 learners and this has since fallen to 59,350 in 2020 (Figure 78). Aucklanders are also a falling proportion of New Zealanders undertaking VET, from 29%



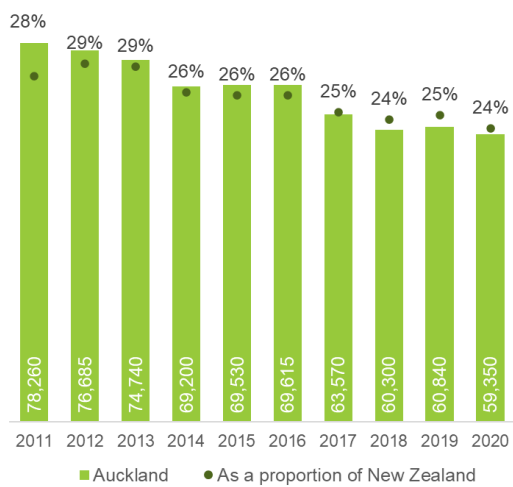
of learners in 2012 and 2013, to 24% in 2020 (noting that the working-age population of Auckland is 32%-33% of New Zealand’s population).

Auckland is the only region that has had such a dramatic decrease in VET learners (Figure 79). Most regions have had steady participation, other than Waikato which also recorded lower participation.

About a third of Auckland’s VET learners are studying in the fields of Engineering and Related Technologies and Architecture and Building (Figure 80). This is consistent with sectors where there are high skills demand in Auckland.

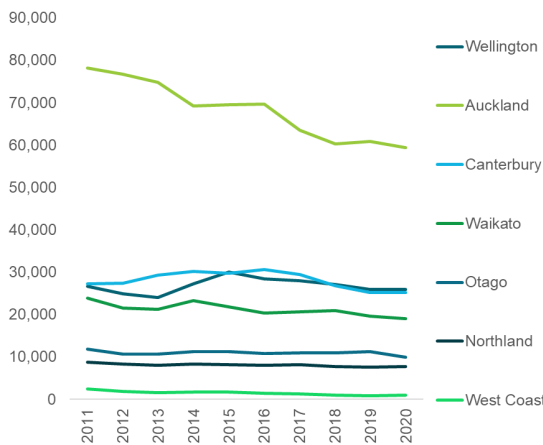
In 2020, most learners were qualifying towards Level 4 Certificates (Figure 81). European students were most represented and were more likely to be studying towards higher level qualifications (Figure 82). Ethnic diversity was greatest at Level 2, and least at Levels 5 and 6, and at diploma level.

Figure 78. Number of VET learners, and as a proportion of New Zealand learners, Auckland, 2011–2020



Source: Participation in vocational education and training programmes, Ministry of Education

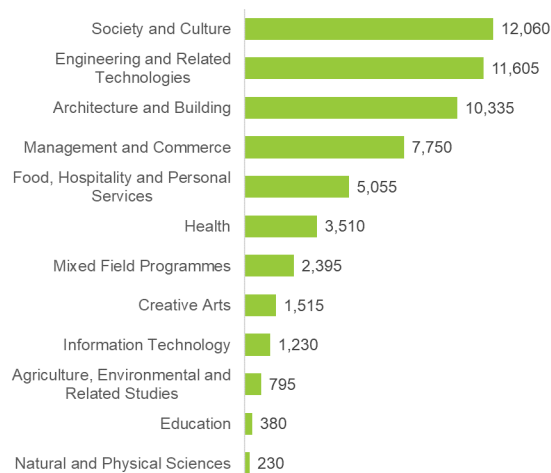
Figure 79. Number of learners participating in vocational education and training, selected regions, 2011–2020



Source: Participation in vocational education and training programmes, Ministry of Education

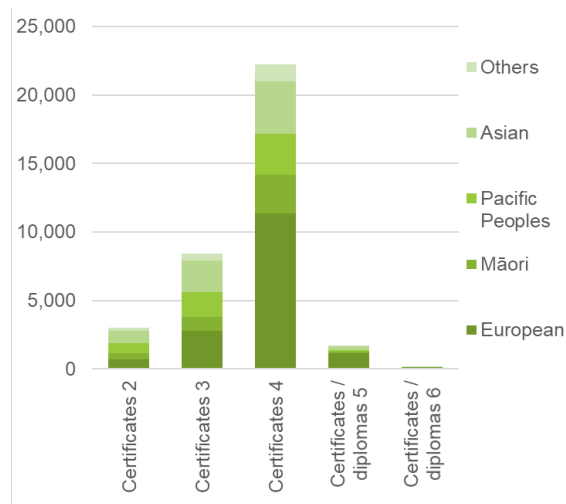


Figure 80. Number of VET learners, by field of study, Auckland, 2020



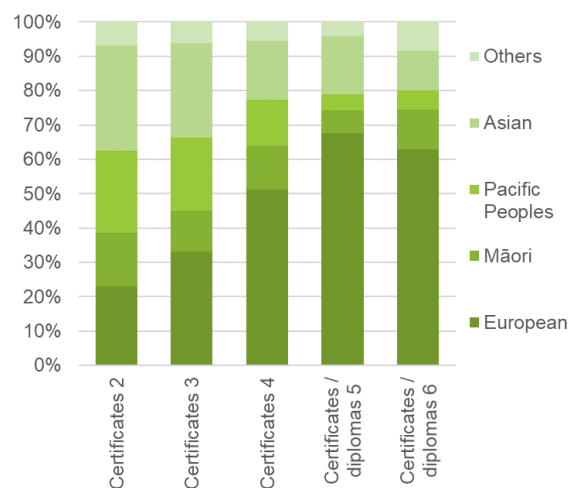
Source: Participation in vocational education and training programmes, Ministry of Education

Figure 81. Number of VET learners, by ethnicity, Auckland, 2020



Source: Participation in vocational education and training programmes, Ministry of Education

Figure 82. Proportion of VET learners, by ethnicity, Auckland, 2020



Source: Participation in vocational education and training programmes, Ministry of Education



Regular school attendance across Auckland is similar to attendance across New Zealand. But attendance rates vary by ethnicity and school decile

Every child has the right to an education and is essential for the development of human potential. The positive long-term impacts of education on current and future wellbeing, income, and employment are well documented.⁷⁴ Ministry of Education analysis also confirms that attending school regularly predicts the best outcomes for wellbeing on average.⁷⁵ The Ministry found that reports by 15-year-old students of skipping a greater number of days in the previous fortnight of school predicted worse average outcomes relating to schoolwork-related anxiety, sense of belonging, bullying, racism and motivation.

Attendance is also linked to student attainment in secondary students. Recent research shows that each additional half day absence from school predicts a consistent reduction in the number of NCEA credits a student subsequently attains – whether that is the student moving from 100% to 99% attendance or moving from 71% to 70% attendance.⁷⁶ Students who are absent even 5-10% of the time (still considered “regular” attendance) obtain fewer NCEA credits than those with slightly higher attendance. There is no “safe” level of non-attendance.

In New Zealand most children start school on the day they turn 5 years old and over 80% stay until at least their 17th birthday. The Education Act 1989 requires that all children in New Zealand attend school from their 6th birthday until their 16th birthday (with limited exemptions).

Regular attendance at school measures the percentage of students who have attended more than 90% of the term. Regular attendance across the Auckland region is similar to attendance across New Zealand (Figure 83 and Figure 84), although is lower than Wellington, Canterbury and Otago. Like New Zealand, Auckland’s attendance has fallen over time, but picked up over 2019-2020.

Annual and regional data masks differences in attendance by territorial authority, ethnicity and decile. It also doesn’t uncover the differences experienced across New Zealand due to COVID-19 related lockdowns and alert levels.

COVID-19 affected attendance, participation, and completion rates throughout 2020 and 2021. There are likely to be longer-term impacts on engagement in education and transitions into employment. Ministry of Education analysis shows the lockdowns disproportionately affected school attendance rates in Auckland.

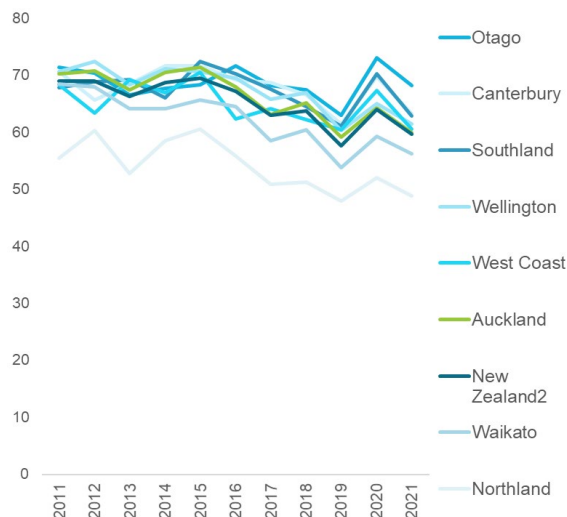
⁷⁴ Department of the Prime Minister and Cabinet, “Regular School Attendance,” Child and youth wellbeing, 2022, [https://childyouthwellbeing.govt.nz/measuring-success/indicators/regular-school-attendance#:~:text=In%20New%20Zealand%20most%20children,birthday%20\(with%20limited%20exemptions\).](https://childyouthwellbeing.govt.nz/measuring-success/indicators/regular-school-attendance#:~:text=In%20New%20Zealand%20most%20children,birthday%20(with%20limited%20exemptions).)

⁷⁵ Ministry of Education, “School Attendance and Student Wellbeing,” He Whakaaro Education Insights (Ministry of Education, 2020), https://www.educationcounts.govt.nz/_data/assets/pdf_file/0010/198019/He-Whakaaro-School-attendance-and-student-wellbeing.pdf.

⁷⁶ Ministry of Education, “What Is the Relationship between Attendance and Attainment?,” He Whakaaro Education Insights (Ministry of Education, 2020), https://www.educationcounts.govt.nz/_data/assets/pdf_file/0004/198013/He-Whakaaro-What-is-the-relationship-between-attendance-and-attainment.pdf.



Figure 83. Regular attendance, selected regions, 2011–2021

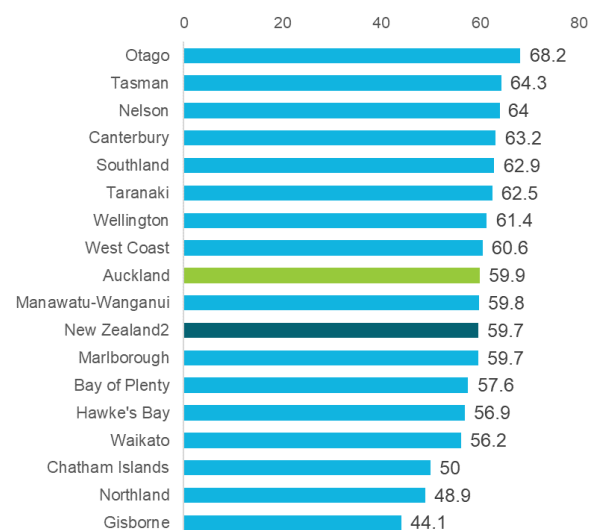


Source: Attendance data, Ministry of Education

Notes: Regular attendance at school measures the percentage of students who have attended more than 90% of the term

Data for term 2

Figure 84. Regular attendance, regions, 2021



Source: Attendance data, Ministry of Education

Notes: Regular attendance at school measures the percentage of students who have attended more than 90% of the term

Data for term 2

Over 2020, the Ministry found that:⁷⁷

- attendance rates following Auckland's Level 3 lockdown were initially about eight percentage points below the same time in 2019 levels, and did not get back up to 2019 levels for four weeks
- attendance rates were most affected in decile one and two schools
- attendance rates for Pacific and Māori students in Auckland were particularly affected, especially following the August Level 3 lockdown. The proportion of students with chronic absence in the month following the August Level 3 lockdown increased from 18% in 2019 to 31% in 2020 for Pacific students, and from 19% to 27% for Māori students
- non-attendance was higher for primary school students, likely reflecting the concerns of parents, while more senior students may have felt pressure to catch up on learning lost during lockdown.

This was consistent with findings by the Education Review Office that three-quarters (74%) of principals in Auckland's low-decile schools thought that students in their school had fallen behind in

⁷⁷ Andrew Webber, "How COVID-19 Is Affecting School Attendance," He Whakaaro | Education Insights (Evidence, Data and Knowledge, Ministry of Education, 2020).



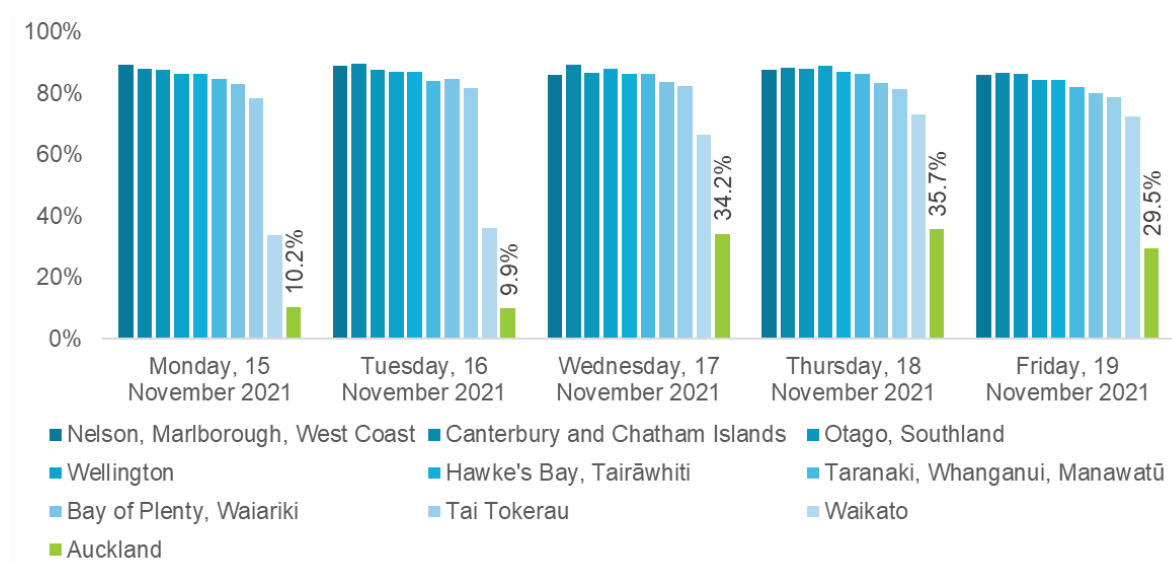
their learning during the lockdowns, compared to 58% of principals in low-decile schools outside Auckland.⁷⁸

Prior to the Auckland and parts of Waikato Level 3 lockdown in 2021, daily onsite attendance rates in primary and high schools in Auckland were in the range of 86-92%:

- In Auckland and Waikato, on Monday and Tuesday of the week beginning 15 November 2021, year 11-13 students could attend in person. As of Wednesday 17 November, students in all year groups could attend in person provided public health measures were followed.
- In preparation for exams, many schools made class changes for senior students this week including offering study leave.

Figure 85 shows the difference in onsite attendance rates in Auckland and Waikato, compared to other education regions. Attendance numbers saw a rise from Wednesday onwards as Year 0 – 10 students were able to return to onsite learning.

Figure 85. Attendance rate, by education region, week of 15 November 2021 to 19 November 2021



Source: Schools weekly attendance data under COVID-19 from 15 Feb 2021 to present date, Ministry of Education

Notes: Proportion of students attending on-site as a proportion of enrolled. Education regions differ from regional council boundaries.

Within the overall attendance rates in Auckland there was substantial variation by decile, with a high of 49.9% of students attending on-site in Decile 10 schools on Wednesday 17 November.⁷⁹ There was a

⁷⁸ ERO, "Learning in a Covid-19 World: The Impact of Covid-19 on Schools" (Education Review Office, Education Evaluation Centre, 2020).

⁷⁹ Ministry of Education, "Auckland Schools On-Site Attendance Report 15 Nov 2021 – 19 Nov 2021, COVID-19 Alert Level 3" (Wellington: Ministry of Education: Evidence, Data and Knowledge, 2021), https://www.educationcounts.govt.nz/_data/assets/pdf_file/0005/209993/2021-11-15-19-Week-Attendance-Schools-Auckland-Report.pdf.



drop in the numbers of senior students attending face to face, from around 5,000-6,000 per year level per day last week, to around 2,000-3,500 per year level per day this week, likely due to preparation for NCEA exams. Students of European/Pākehā ethnicity had the highest attendance this week with a high of 45.7% on Thursday 18 November. On the same day, attendance for Māori students was 28.2%, Pacific students 24.3% and Asian students 31.7%.

Older data shows that Auckland is second behind Waikato for patenting activity. New data techniques are likely to reveal different results

Patent statistics are often used as a proxy for the rate of invention or innovation. There are number of weaknesses to this indicator; for example, it tends to be geared toward the manufacturing sector and technological innovation, and the indicator can be constructed in many ways, for example, as a proportion of billion GDP, per capita, or focusing on how many peer-reviewed journal articles are cited in a patent application.⁸⁰

Compared with most developed countries, New Zealand has low rates of expenditure on R&D (particularly private sector R&D) and has low rates of patenting per capita.⁸¹ However, New Zealand has a number of characteristics that are likely to impact on patenting activity, such as its small economic size, distance from many trading countries, industrial composition and high proportions of micro firms. Studies have found that, once these effects are controlled for, New Zealand has a slightly higher than expected per capita patenting performance.⁸²

There has been increased interest in the effects that regional business environments can have on innovation and knowledge creation and dissemination, and the effects of proximity. The available data on patent applications by region is relatively dated and relates only to Patent Cooperation Treaty (PCT) applications. The PCT allows applicants to file a single application in over 140 participating countries.

New techniques have been developed to regionalise patent data to mitigate bias towards traditional, established patent offices, as well as isolating the locations of patent applicants to mitigate bias toward head office locations.⁸³ These techniques should be applied to New Zealand and international patent data, but are beyond the scope of this report.

When last measured in 2015, Auckland's patent activity was second amongst New Zealand regions, with Waikato having the highest number of patent applications per million people at 104.6 in 2015 (Figure 87). Auckland's patent applications have fluctuated over time, with the highest in 2014 –125.4 applications per million people (Figure 86). Applications were on the rise between 2009 and 2014, but recorded a substantial fall in 2015. More recent data and using the new techniques described above may tell a different patenting story for Auckland.

⁸⁰ Bronwyn H Hall and Adam Jaffe, "Measuring Science, Technology, and Innovation: A Review," A report prepared for the Panel on Developing Science, Technology, and Innovation Indicators for the Future, National Academies of Science (University of California at Berkeley; University of Maastricht and Brandeis University, 2012).

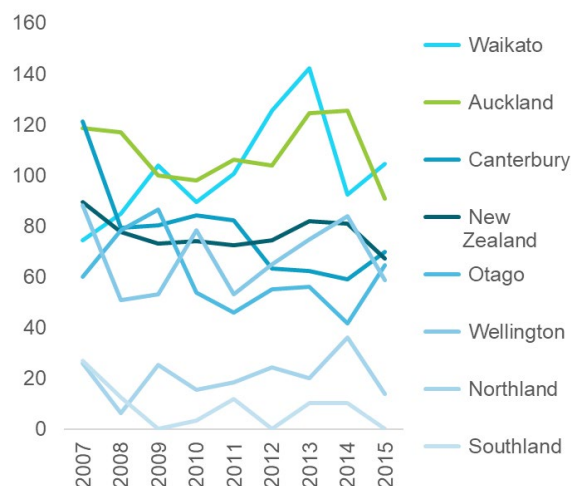
⁸¹ Ron Crawford et al., "National R&D and Patenting: Is New Zealand an Outlier?," *New Zealand Economic Papers* 41, no. 1 (June 2007): 69–90, <https://doi.org/10.1080/00779950709558499>; P Callaghan and S Hendy, *Get off the Grass: Kickstarting New Zealand's Innovation Economy* (Auckland: Auckland University Press, 2014).

⁸² Crawford et al., "National R&D and Patenting."

⁸³ Gaétan de Rassenfosse, Jan Kozak, and Florian Seliger, "Geocoding of Worldwide Patent Data," *Scientific Data* 6, no. 260 (2019): 1–15.



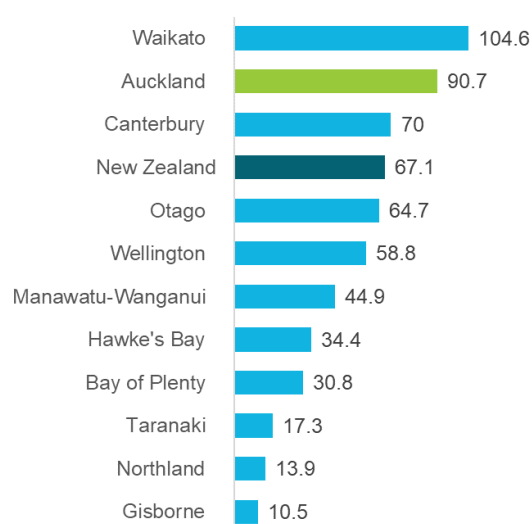
Figure 86. PCT patent applications per million inhabitants, selected regions, 2007–2015



Source: Regional innovation, OECD.Stat

Notes: Fractional count, by inventor and priority year.

Figure 87. PCT patent applications per million inhabitants, New Zealand and regions, 2015



Source: Regional innovation, OECD.Stat

Notes: Fractional count, by inventor and priority year. No data for Southland and West Coast

A recent analysis of patent filing activity in New Zealand found that New Zealand's strongest patent ties are with Australia, the US and the UK. There are few filings for patent protection in the Asia Pacific, beyond Australia.⁸⁴ Of the academic/research institutions, AgResearch was the most prolific patent applicant, followed by the University of Auckland. Others were Waikato University, Fonterra Group, Gallagher Group, Callaghan Innovation and Plant and Food Research.

New Zealand domestic patent applicants tend to file for Agriculture and Food, Industrial Engineering, and Civil Engineering; specifically for building materials, and technologies.⁸⁵ Companies such as Fonterra, Gallagher Group and Carter Holt Harvey submit the bulk of patent applications. Indicators in the analysis suggest that although University of Auckland files a high number of applications it also has a successful subsequent approach to technology commercialisation.⁸⁶

More recent data from the World Intellectual Property Organisation (WIPO) shows that Auckland-based business do file a high proportion of PCTs (Figure 88).⁸⁷ While regional analysis based on older PCT activity show that Waikato performs better than Auckland (Figure 86 and Figure 87), this may have reversed in more recent years.

⁸⁴ Clarivate Analytics IP Consulting, "Survey of New Zealand Patent Activity," For the Intellectual Property Office of New Zealand (Derwent, 2020).

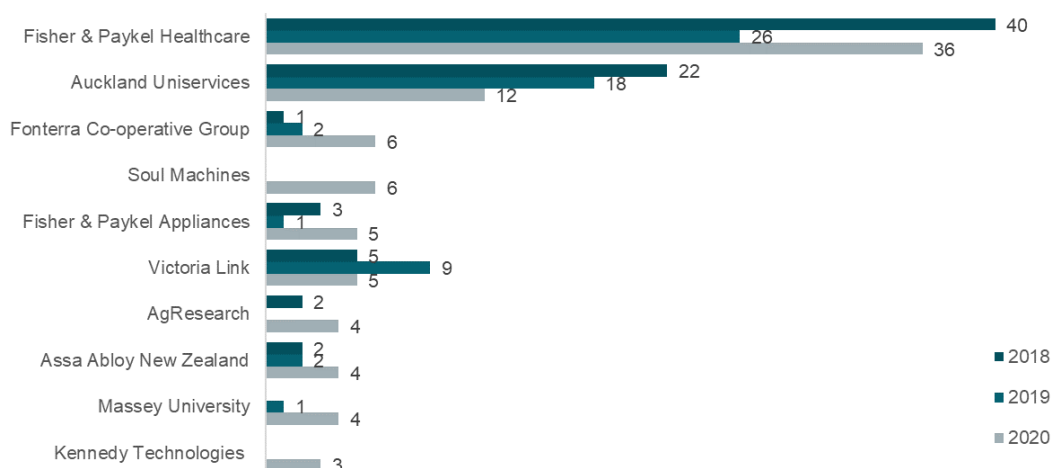
⁸⁵ Clarivate Analytics IP Consulting.

⁸⁶ Clarivate Analytics IP Consulting.

⁸⁷ WIPO, "Statistical Country Profiles: New Zealand," World Intellectual Property Organization, 2022, https://www.wipo.int/ipstats/en/statistics/country_profile/profile.jsp?code=NZ.



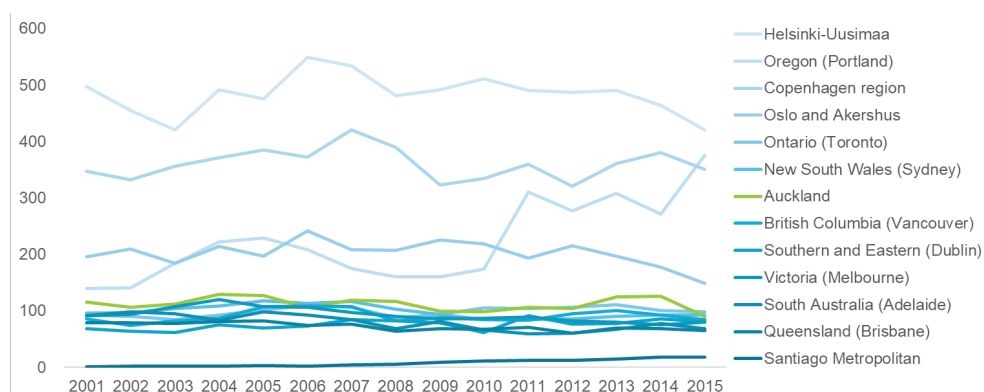
Figure 88. New Zealand PCT applicants by number of PCT applications filed, 2018–2020



Source: WIPO⁸⁸

Comparing Auckland to internationally comparable city-regions, again using the older data source, shows that PCT patent applications are low, relative to high patenting regions like Helsinki, Oregon, and Copenhagen (Figure 89). However, Auckland inventors are seeking patents at about the midpoint of the set of internationally comparable city-regions.

Figure 89. PCT patent applications per million inhabitants (fractional count; by inventor and priority year), selected city-regions, 2001–2015



Source: OECD.Stat, Regions and Cities

Note: OECD classifies the geographic units in this chart as large regions (territorial level 2 or TL2) to help in assessing differences in socio-economic trends in regions, both within and across countries

⁸⁸ WIPO.



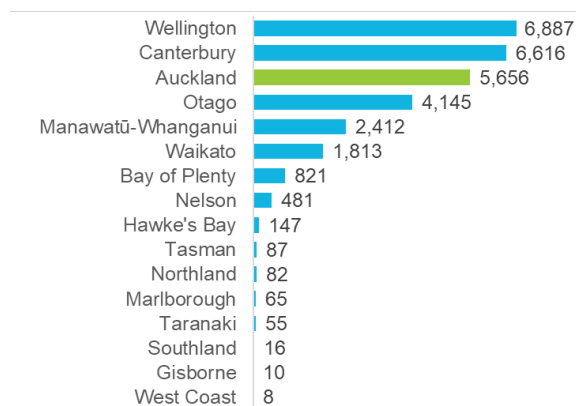
A high number of research, science and innovation workers reside in Auckland, but they only make up a very small proportion of the workforce

Employment in science and technology occupations, and the number of researchers and employment in high-tech occupations are useful indicators of innovation performance. Innovation is critical to a region's success. It leads to increased incomes, productivity and quality of life through the ability to make, organise and market things in a better and smarter way.

It has been estimated that the research, science and innovation (RSI) workforce in New Zealand comprises 26,000 FTEs. This consists of around 9,000 FTEs employees working in the higher education and government sectors, and 17,000 FTEs working on R&D in the business sector.⁸⁹ However, there has been little data available on the attributes and characteristics of that workforce (roles and contract types), information about their workplace, skills and development opportunities, and demographic characteristics. Over 2021/22, MBIE and MartinJenkins developed and implemented an online survey to better understand the workforce.

Auckland has a relatively high number of RSI workers, compared to other regions in New Zealand – over 5,500 (Figure 90). However, RSI workers only make up 0.6% of Auckland's total workforce, which is considerably lower than New Zealand's almost 1%.⁹⁰

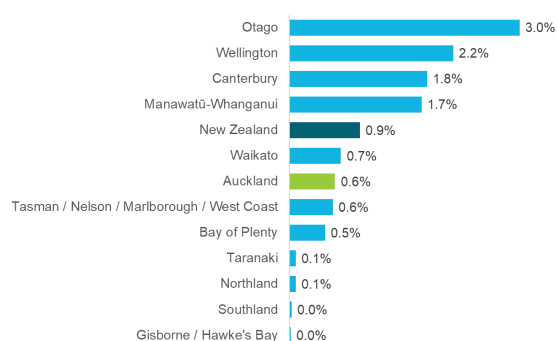
Figure 90. Research, science and innovation workforce, by region based, 2021



Source: MBIE RSI workforce survey

Notes: FTEs

Figure 91. Research, science and innovation workforce, as a proportion of total employment, 2021



Source: MBIE RSI workforce survey and Stats NZ Household Labour Force Survey

Notes: Workforce is a measure of FTEs, total employment uses headcount.

⁸⁹ Stats NZ, "Research and Development Survey: 2020," Stats NZ, April 16, 2021, <https://www.stats.govt.nz/information-releases/research-and-development-survey-2020>.

⁹⁰ This calculation is only a proxy and an under-estimate, as RSI workers is based on FTE count, while total employed is a head count. FTE data via the Stats NZ Quarterly Employment Survey is not provided by region.



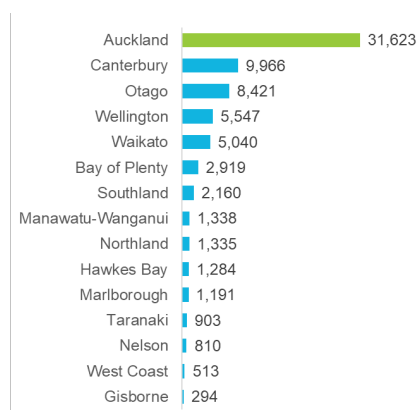
While Auckland has a high absolute number of migrant workers, there are proportionately higher levels in regions like Otago and Southland. Migrant workers in Auckland are mostly from India and the Philippines and are most likely to work as technicians and be in the trades

New Zealand's immigration system aims to enhance wellbeing by promoting economic development, reuniting families and meeting humanitarian objectives. Prior to the closure of the international border as a COVID-19 mitigation strategy, immigration had been high and residence visa granting was based on skill level to ease labour shortages and to enhance economic outcomes. Empirical studies show that immigration has had small positive effects on per capita incomes and has not adversely affected the wage or labour market outcomes of the average NZ-born worker.⁹¹

In 2019, skills shortages lists were regionalised to support skills needed in specific regions. The Immediate Skills Shortage List was renamed the Regional Skill Shortage List (RSSL) and the number of regions from 6 to 15. The RSSL includes occupations where skilled workers are required in particular regions of New Zealand and indicates that there are no New Zealand citizens or residents available to take up the position.

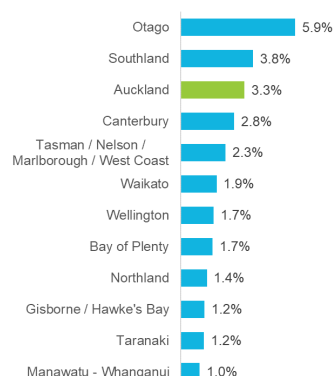
In 2019 (prior to the COVID-19 pandemic), Auckland had the highest absolute number of work-related⁹² visa holders entering its workforce (note that 175,764 visas were also provided to workers where the region was unknown) – 31,623 workers (Figure 92). As a proportion of the total labour force, Otago and Southland had higher proportions of migrant workers approved in 2019 (Figure 93).

Figure 92. Number of approved work visas, by region, 2019



Source: Migration data explorer, Immigration New Zealand

Figure 93. Migrant workers approved as a proportion of the labour force, region, 2019



Source: Migration data explorer, Immigration New Zealand

⁹¹ David Carey, "Improving Well-Being in New Zealand through Migration," Economics Department Working Papers (Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2019); D. C. Maré and S Stillman, "The Impact of Immigration on the Labour Market Outcomes of New Zealanders," Economic Impacts of Immigration Working Paper Series (Wellington: Motu Economic and Public Policy Research, 2009).

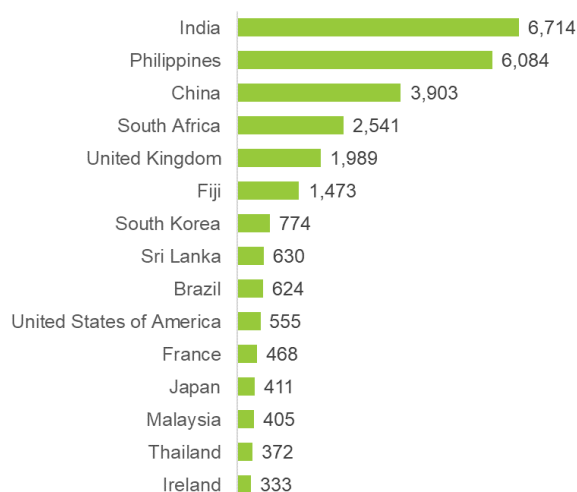
⁹² This does not include student and visitor visas.



The majority of Auckland's migrant workers approved in 2019 were from India or the Philippines (Figure 94). Migrant workers were mostly approved for jobs as technicians and trades workers, and as professionals (Figure 95).

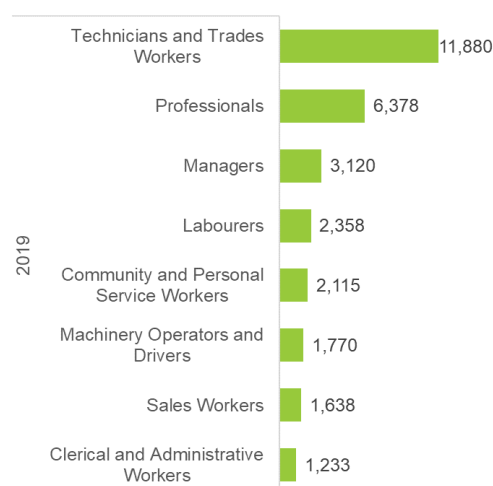
There seem to be specific areas where migrant workers are addressing labour shortages in Auckland, – in building and construction and in aged care (Figure 96), but fewer areas where high level skills are required.

Figure 94. Top 15 nationalities of applicants approved for work visas, Auckland, 2019



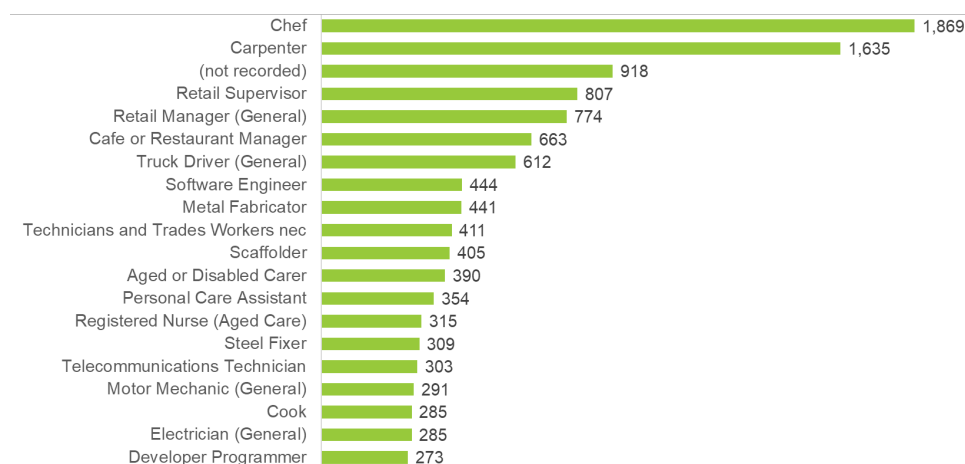
Source: Migration data explorer, Immigration New Zealand

Figure 95. Migrant workers approved by major occupation group, Auckland, 2019



Source: Migration data explorer, Immigration New Zealand

Figure 96. Migrant workers approved by occupation (top 20), Auckland, 2019



Source: Migration data explorer, Immigration New Zealand



Recent analysis suggests that ethnic communities contribute to 20% of the economy, which equates to \$64 billion of contribution to the national economy or gross domestic product in 2021.⁹³ While ethnic communities' contribution to Auckland in particular is not isolated, it can be expected that this will be a substantive part of the \$64 billion of contribution.

Conversely, migrant workers are at risk of exploitation. In 2021, the Government committed to a Plan of Action against Forced Labour, People Trafficking and Slavery. This set out a high-level framework for the actions that agencies will take over 5 years to 2025, to combat these practices. In April 2022, the government launched consultation on proposed legislative responses to modern slavery and worker exploitation, forced labour, people trafficking, and slavery.⁹⁴

⁹³ Sense Partners, "Ethnic Minorities Add \$64b to NZ: Direct Contributions High, Opportunities for More," For Waitakere Ethnic Board (Sense Partners, 2021).

⁹⁴ <https://www.mbie.govt.nz/have-your-say/modern-slavery/>



HEALTH

Being in good mental and physical health and exhibiting health-related behaviours and lifestyles that reduce morbidity and mortality, such as eating well and keeping active.

Health is arguably the single most important aspect of our wellbeing. In a recent public consultation by Statistics New Zealand on what matters most to our wellbeing, health was selected more often than any other category by public respondents.⁹⁷ In empirical analysis, health status often explains as much variation in life satisfaction between individuals as any other variable.⁹⁸

While Auckland generally performs well on health outcomes compared to other parts of New Zealand, suggesting reduced risk of severe COVID-19 complications, health factors at sub-regional levels means some parts of Auckland are particularly at risk of experiencing COVID-19 complications.

Health status	M	▼
Healthy life expectancy	H	▲
Death from non-communicable diseases ⁹⁵	H	▼
Mental health	L	▲
Suicide rate	L	▼
Unmet health needs ⁹⁶	L	~
Physical activity	L	▲

Summary

The proportion of adults in Auckland that indicated that they had good, very good or excellent health, is slightly above the New Zealand average (87.4% compared to 86.9%). There are ethnic differences, which has particular implications for Auckland's performance, and the COVID-19 response. Over 2017-2020, 75.9% of Māori Aucklanders indicated they had good, very good or excellent health, below Māori across New Zealand (78.4%) and more than 10 percentage points below all adults in Auckland.

In the 2017-2019 period, the Auckland region had one of the highest life expectancies at birth (81.0 compared to 80.0 years for males and 84.3 compared to 83.5 years for females). At a local level, females living in the Māngere-Ōtāhuhu Auckland local board area had the lowest life expectancy (79.2 years).

Auckland DHB had a relatively low proportion of premature deaths caused by non-communicable diseases (NCDs) in 2018. However, Counties Manukau DHB and Waitematā DHB had proportions higher than the New Zealand average. Encouragingly, each DHB's proportion of deaths from NCDs

⁹⁵ "Preventable admissions to hospital" was considered as an additional indicator, but Ministry of Health have confirmed that data is not available at the sub-national level.

⁹⁶ Food insecurity should be considered as an additional indicator. Ministry of Health have confirmed that the data collected on this via the New Zealand Health Survey is not of a significant size to report robust data at the regional level. Food bank data could be an alternative data source.

⁹⁷ Stats NZ, "Indicators Aotearoa New Zealand – Ngā Tūtohu Aotearoa: Key Findings from Consultation and Engagement."

⁹⁸ The Treasury, "Our People - Multidimensional Wellbeing in New Zealand," Analytical Paper (The Treasury, 2018), <https://www.treasury.govt.nz/publications/ap/ap-18-04.html>.



has declined since 2014. There are large ethnic differences in premature mortality from NCDs. In 2018, just over half of premature deaths from NCDs of people in Counties Manukau DHB were Māori and Pacific, and 14% were Asian.

There is a relatively low proportion of adults in Auckland who have high levels of psychological distress (in 2019/20, 6.3% of Auckland adults had high levels of psychological distress compared to 8% of adults across New Zealand). The proportion of the adult population that indicated high levels of psychological distress in Auckland has increased over time – from 5.8% between 2011-14 to 7.6% between 2017-20.

Auckland's rate of suicide per 100,000 population sits at the lower end of New Zealand regions. This varies across DHBs – Waitematā was 8 per 100,000; Auckland was 11 per 100,000 and Counties Manukau was 9 per 100,000. The rate of suicide across the Auckland Metro DHB areas has declined over time while New Zealand's rate has been relatively consistent.

Auckland sits below the New Zealand average for percentage of adults who have unmet health needs, however the percentage of adults who have unmet health needs has increased over time.

Auckland adults are not as physically active as adults in most other regions – 43% indicated that they did at least 2.5 hours of physical activity over the last week compared to the New Zealand average of 52%. Levels of physical activity have generally stayed static over time.

COVID-19, and related mitigation measures, have had significant impacts on the health of Aucklanders

The COVID-19 pandemic, and its associated mitigation measures, have had significant impacts on the health of New Zealanders – and particularly Aucklanders where there were more substantial restrictions and for longer periods. There have been more cases per 100,000 people in DHB areas in Auckland (Counties Manukau, Auckland and Waitematā) than other DHB areas.

People with underlying health conditions are most at risk of COVID-19 becoming a severe illness. Vulnerability relates to⁹⁹:

- being over 70 years old with a medical condition
- living in an aged care facility where spread can occur more easily
- having a medical condition and/or compromised immunity
- being pregnant
- risk factors such as ethnicity, smoking and obesity.

In the absence of COVID-19, Auckland's population generally performs well on health outcomes compared to other parts of New Zealand. However, taking into account ethnicity, lack of physical activity, high levels of premature death from non-communicable diseases and pockets of vulnerability at sub-regional levels, parts of Auckland are particularly at risk of experiencing COVID-19 complications.

⁹⁹ Ministry of Health, "About COVID-19," Ministry of Health, September 27, 2021, <https://www.health.govt.nz/our-work/diseases-and-conditions/covid-19-novel-coronavirus/covid-19-health-advice-public/about-covid-19>.



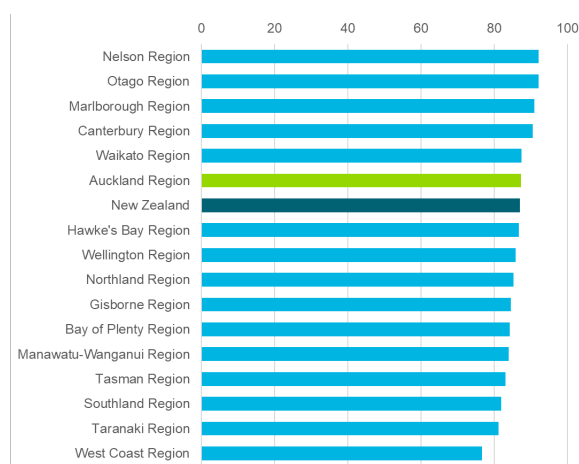
A similar proportion of Aucklanders and New Zealanders indicate that their health is good, very good or excellent – 87%. This proportion has declined over time

Self-rated health is well-established as a predictor of mortality and morbidity and is widely used as a tool in inequality studies. Having fair or poor self-rated health is a strong predictor of future use of health services and mortality.

Over 2017-2020, 87.4% of adults in Auckland indicated that they had good, very good or excellent health, slightly above the New Zealand average (86.9%) (Figure 97). Auckland tends to be near the New Zealand average in self-rated health, with both areas showing declines over time from 90-91% in 2011-2014 to current percentages.

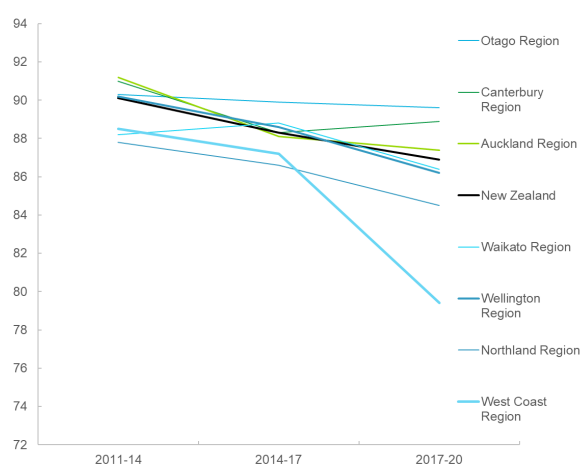
There are ethnic differences, which has particular implications for Auckland's performance, and the COVID-19 response. Over 2017-2020, 75.9% of Māori Aucklanders indicated they had good, very good or excellence health, below Māori across New Zealand (78.4%) and more than 10 percentage points below all adults in Auckland. Over 2014-17 the percentage of Māori in Auckland who had good (or better) self-rated health was also statistically significantly lower than the national percentage for Māori.¹⁰⁰

Figure 97. Percentage of adults reporting good, very good or excellent health, by region, 2017–2020



Source: New Zealand Health Survey, Ministry of Health

Figure 98. Percentage of adults reporting good, very good or excellent health, selected regions, over time



Source: New Zealand Health Survey, Ministry of Health

¹⁰⁰ Independent Māori Statutory Board, "Manaakitanga."

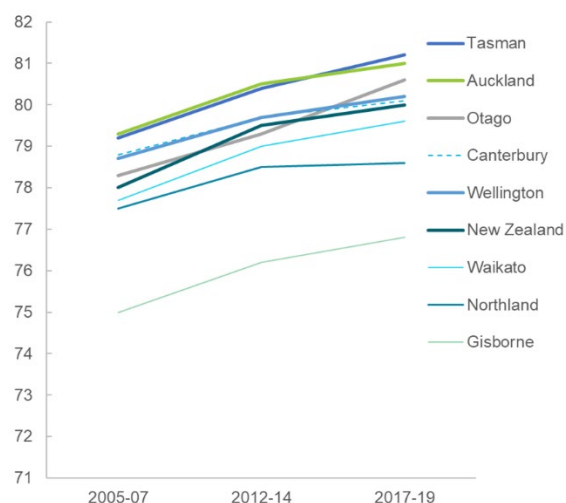


Aucklanders have one of the highest life expectancies, and this has increased over time

Life expectancy in New Zealand continues to increase, but change over time has slowed. Increases in life expectancy were highest in the late 1980s to early 2000s.¹⁰¹

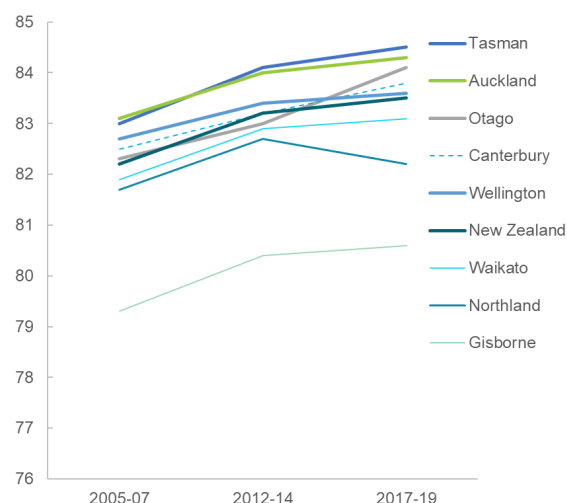
Life expectancy at birth for the New Zealand population as a whole is 80.0 years for males (Figure 99), and 83.5 years for females (Figure 100), based on death rates in 2017–2019. In the 2017–2019 period, males and females in the Auckland region had one of the highest life expectancies at birth (81.0 years for males and 84.3 years for females), just behind the Tasman region (Figure 101 and Figure 102).

Figure 99. Male life expectancy at birth, by region, 2005-07 to 2017-19



Source: National and subnational period life tables 2017-2019, Stats NZ

Figure 100. Female life expectancy at birth, by region, 2005-07 to 2017-19



Source: National and subnational period life tables 2017-2019, Stats NZ

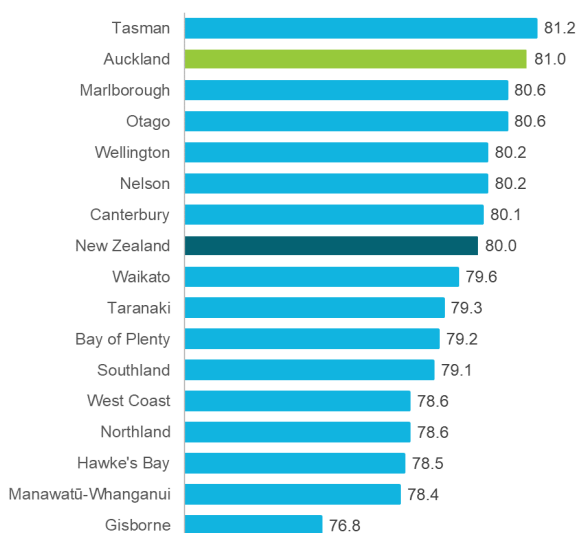
In the 2017–2019 period, males and females in the Queenstown-Lakes district had the highest median life expectancy at birth (84.5 and 87.6 years respectively) among the 87 territorial authority and Auckland local board areas. In contrast, males living in the Wairoa district, and females living in the Māngere-Ōtāhuhu Auckland local board area, had the lowest life expectancy (75.3 and 79.2 years respectively).¹⁰² Patterns at the Auckland local board area are relatively similar between males and females (Figure 103 and Figure 104).

¹⁰¹ Stats NZ, "Growth in Life Expectancy Slows," Stats NZ, April 20, 2021, <https://www.stats.govt.nz/news/growth-in-life-expectancy-slows>.

¹⁰² Stats NZ, "National and Subnational Period Life Tables: 2017–2019," Stats NZ, April 20, 2021, <https://www.stats.govt.nz/information-releases/national-and-subnational-period-life-tables-2017-2019>.

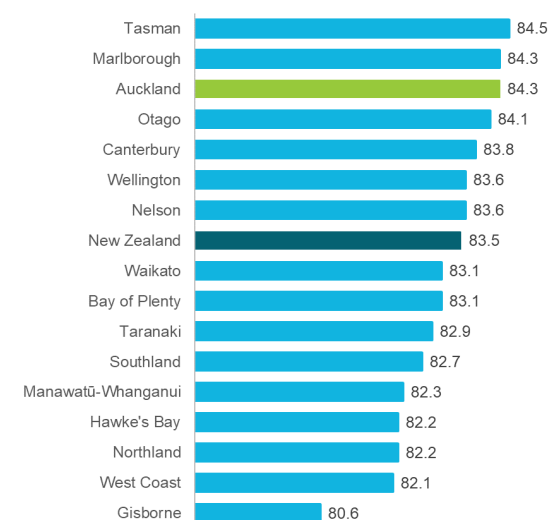


Figure 101. Male life expectancy at birth, by region, 2017-19



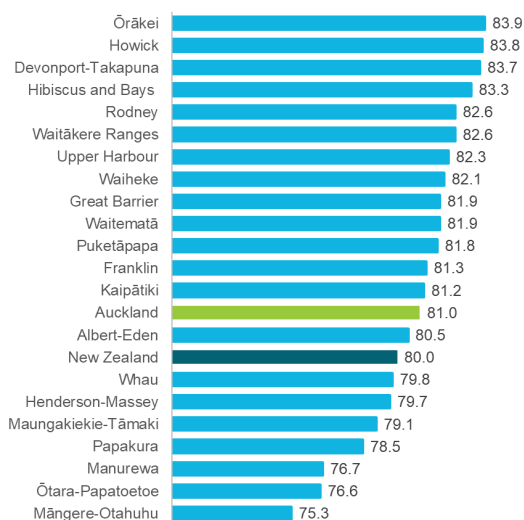
Source: National and subnational period life tables 2017-2019, Stats NZ

Figure 102. Female life expectancy at birth, by region, 2017-19



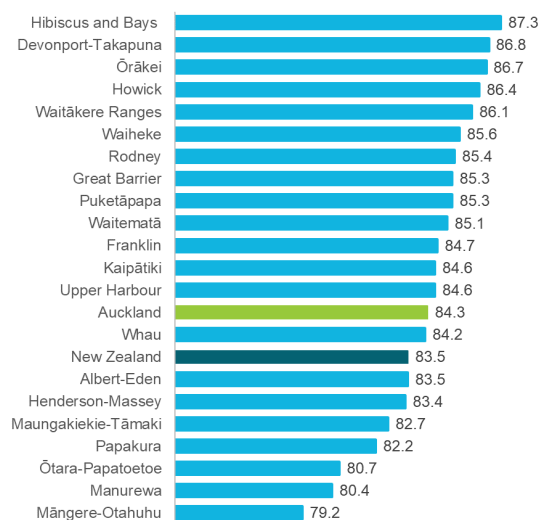
Source: National and subnational period life tables 2017-2019, Stats NZ

Figure 103. Male life expectancy at birth, by Auckland local board, 2017-19



Source: National and subnational period life tables 2017-2019, Stats NZ

Figure 104. Female life expectancy at birth, by Auckland local board, 2017-19

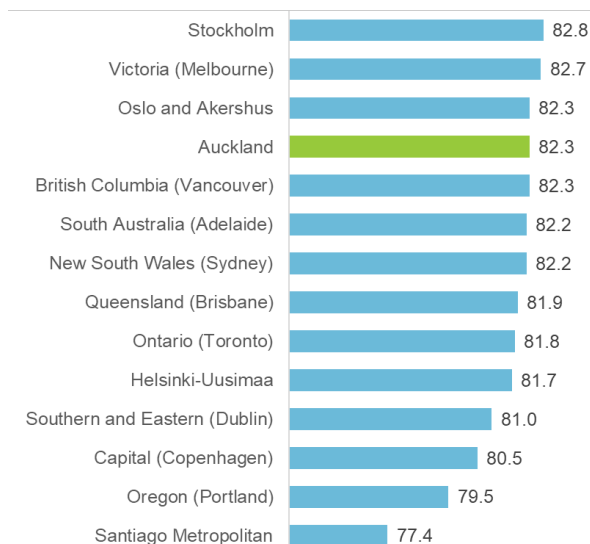


Source: National and subnational period life tables 2017-2019, Stats NZ



Internationally, Aucklanders have one of the highest life expectancies at birth, compared to other regions. In 2014, Stockholm's was the highest at 82.8 years and Santiago was the lowest at 77.4 years (Figure 100).

Figure 105. Life expectancy at birth, selected regions, 2014



Source: OECD.Stat, Regions and Cities

Note: OECD classifies the geographic units in this chart as large regions (territorial level 2 or TL2) to help in assessing differences in socio-economic trends in regions, both within and across countries

There are large ethnic differences in premature mortality from non-communicable diseases. Premature mortality is more likely to occur in residents of the Waitematā and Counties Manukau DHB areas, than the Auckland DHB area

Approximately 41 million of global deaths are attributed to non-communicable diseases (NCDs) – cardiovascular diseases, cancer, diabetes and chronic respiratory diseases – or 71% of all deaths.¹⁰³ NCDs are known as chronic diseases and tend to be long duration and the result of a combination of genetic, physiological, environmental and behavioural factors. They are the leading causes of death in men and women in New Zealand.¹⁰⁴ In 2019, The World Bank estimated that NCDs were the cause of 90% of New Zealand's deaths¹⁰⁵ – however their categorisation of NCDs are broader, including mental and substance abuse disorders, neurological conditions and injuries amongst others.¹⁰⁶

¹⁰³ WHO, "Factsheets: Noncommunicable Diseases," World Health Organization, April 13, 2021, <https://www.who.int/news-room/factsheets/detail/noncommunicable-diseases>.

¹⁰⁴ Chris Bullen et al., "Targets and Actions for Non-Communicable Disease Prevention and Control in New Zealand" 128, no. 1427 (2015): 6.

¹⁰⁵ The World Bank, "Cause of Death, by Non-Communicable Disease (% of Total)," The World Bank, 2020, <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SH.DTH.NCOM.ZS>.

¹⁰⁶ WHO, "WHO Methods and Data Sources for Country-Level Causes of Death 2000-2019," Global Health Estimates Technical Paper (World Health Organization, 2020).

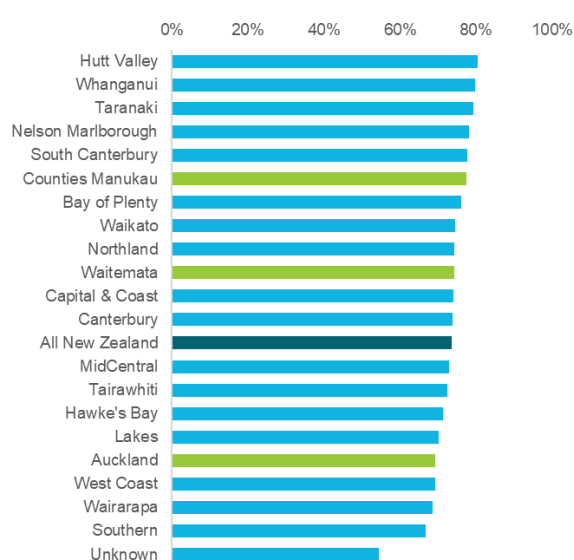


Auckland Metro DHB's deaths by NCDs sit on either side of the New Zealand average of premature mortality by NCD. Auckland DHB had a relatively low proportion of premature deaths caused by NCDs in 2018 (Figure 106). However, Counties Manukau DHB and Waitematā DHB had proportions higher than the New Zealand average. Encouragingly, each DHB's proportion of deaths from NCDs has declined since 2014.

There are large ethnic differences in premature mortality from NCDs. In 2018, just over half of premature deaths from NCDs of people in Counties Manukau DHB were Māori and Pacific, with Pacific overshadowing Māori (Figure 106), and 14% were Asian. This contrasts with Tairāwhiti DHB whereby 63% of premature deaths from NCDs were Māori. Southern DHB had the lowest percentage of premature deaths that were due to NCDs and also had the highest proportion of deaths who were European or other.

It is well established that both Māori and Pacific peoples are significantly more likely to suffer diabetes and other NCD morbidities, complications, and death than European New Zealanders.¹⁰⁷

Figure 106. Premature mortality from NCD, by DHB, 2018

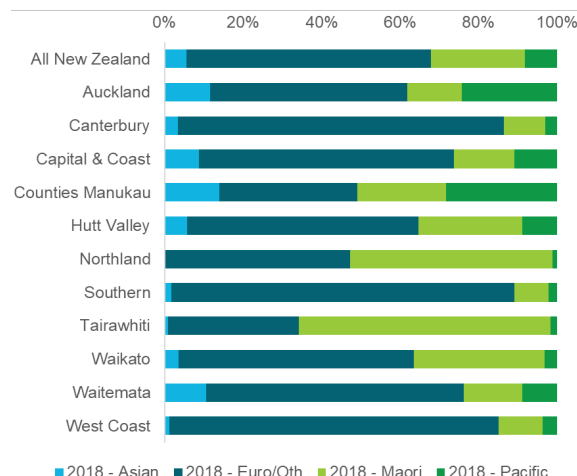


Source: Mortality web tool, Ministry of Health

Note: Codes from ICD-10 used for NCDs were I00 – I99, C00-C96, E09-E14 and J30-J99 as per WHO Global Monitoring Framework.

Premature mortality is based on deaths between the ages of 30 and 70.

Figure 107. Premature mortality from NCD, selected DHBs, by ethnicity, 2018



Source: Mortality web tool, Ministry of Health

Note: Codes from ICD-10 used for NCDs were I00 – I99, C00-C96, E09-E14 and J30-J99 as per WHO Global Monitoring Framework.

Premature mortality is based on deaths between the ages of 30 and 70.

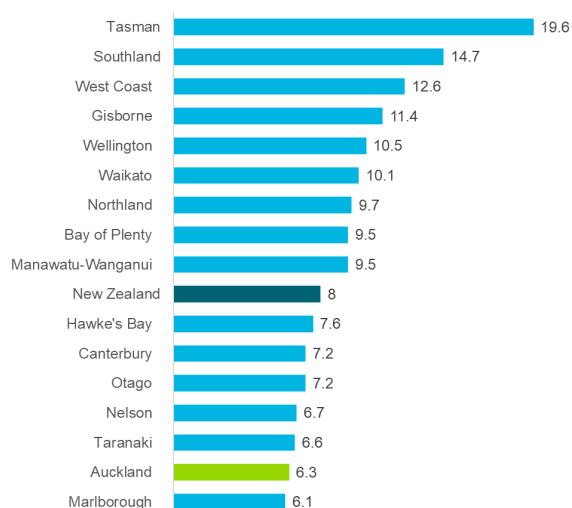
¹⁰⁷ Mathew Hobbs, Annabel Ahuriri-Driscoll, and Philip J Schluter, "Ethnic Differences in Mortality and Hospital Admission in a New Zealand Population with Type 2 Diabetes," *The Lancet Global Health* 9, no. 2 (February 2021): e102–3, [https://doi.org/10.1016/S2214-109X\(20\)30445-9](https://doi.org/10.1016/S2214-109X(20)30445-9).



Fewer adults in Auckland report high levels of psychological distress, compared to most other New Zealand regions

Based on the New Zealand Health Survey, there is a relatively low proportion of adults in Auckland who have high levels of psychological distress – in 2019/20, 6.3% of Auckland adults had high levels of psychological distress compared to 8% of adults across New Zealand (Figure 108). The Tasman region, with 19.6% or almost one in five adults, had the highest proportion of adults who indicated they had high levels of psychological distress. The proportion of the adult population indicating high levels of psychological distress in Auckland has increased over time – from 5.8% between 2011-14 to 7.6% between 2017-20 (Figure 109). Note that 2019/20 data is pre-pandemic.¹⁰⁸

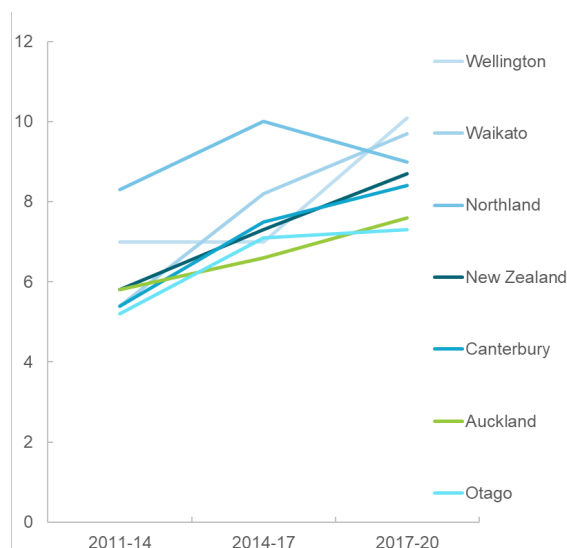
Figure 108. Percentage of adults with high levels of psychological distress, 2019/20



Source: New Zealand Health Survey, Ministry of Health

Note: Psychological distress (high or very high probability of anxiety or depressive disorder, K10 score ≥ 12). Psychological, or mental, distress (aged 15+ years) refers to a person's experience of symptoms such as anxiety, confused emotions, depression or rage.

Figure 109. Percentage of adults with high levels of psychological distress, selected regions, over time



Source: New Zealand Health Survey, Ministry of Health

¹⁰⁸ On 19 March 2020 the interviewing for the New Zealand Health Survey was suspended to reduce any risks of transmitting COVID-19 between interviewers and respondents. The 2019/20 Annual Explorer does not include any data collected since the COVID-19 Alert System was introduced by the Government in March 2020 to manage and minimise the risk of COVID-19 in New Zealand. It therefore does not include any information about people's health during the pandemic.



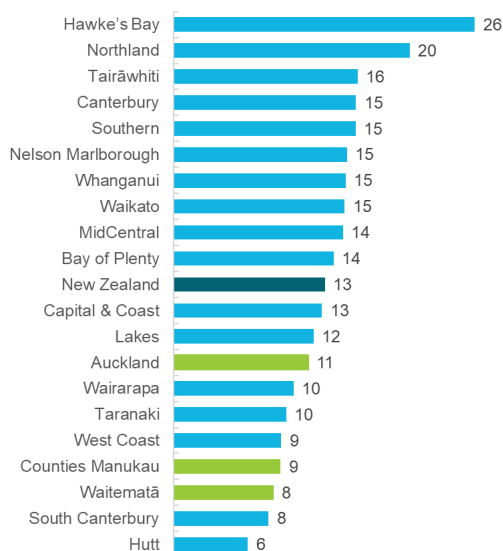
Auckland's suicide rate is at the lower end of New Zealand regions

Auckland's rate of suicide per 100,000 population sits at the lower end of New Zealand regions (Figure 110). All of Auckland's DHBs sit below the New Zealand average (in 2019/20 this was 13 per 100,000 people). In 2019/20, the rate of suicide for each Auckland Metro DHB was:

- Waitematā: 8 per 100,000 people
- Auckland: 11 per 100,000 people
- Counties Manukau: 9 per 100,000 people.

The rate of suicide across the Auckland Metro DHB areas has declined over time (Figure 111), while New Zealand's rate has been relatively consistent.

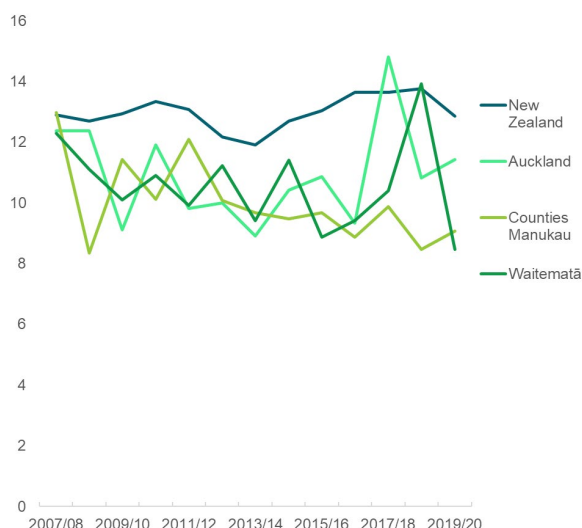
Figure 110. Rate of suicide per 100,000 people, by DHB, 2019/20



Source: Coronial Services Unit at the Ministry of Justice

Note: Deaths caused by intentional self-harm, age-standardised rate per 100,000 people

Figure 111. Rate of suicide per 100,000 people, Auckland Metro DHBs and New Zealand, over time



Source: Coronial Services Unit at the Ministry of Justice



Proportionately less Aucklanders have unmet health needs than other regions, but the proportion has increased over time

Encouragingly, Auckland sits below the New Zealand average for percentage of adults who have unmet health needs (Figure 112). However, the percentage of adults who have unmet health needs has increased over time (Figure 113).

Figure 112. Percentage of adults who experienced one or more types of unmet need for primary health care in the past 12 months, by region, 2017-2020

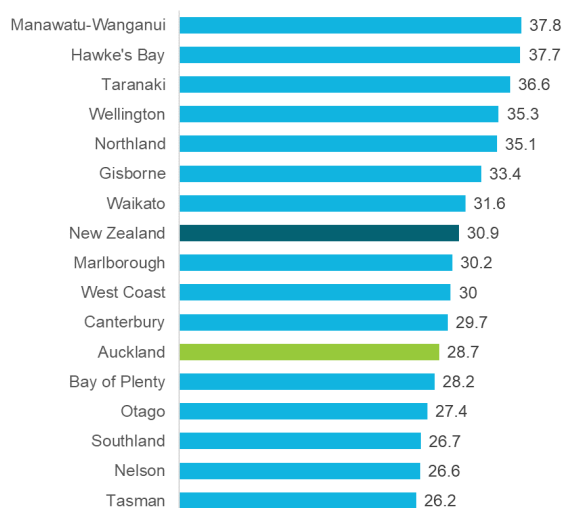
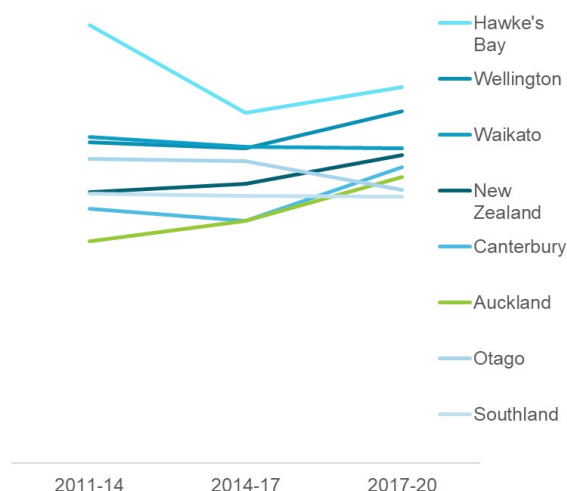


Figure 113. Percentage of adults who experienced one or more types of unmet need for primary health care in the past 12 months, selected regions, over time



Source: New Zealand Health Survey, Ministry of Health

Notes: Reliable regional level statistics can be produced by pooling annual data to improve the range and statistical quality of analyses that can be undertaken at that level. Pooling annual NZHS data sets can also improve the statistical precision of estimates for Māori and ethnic minorities (including Pacific and Asian ethnic groups).

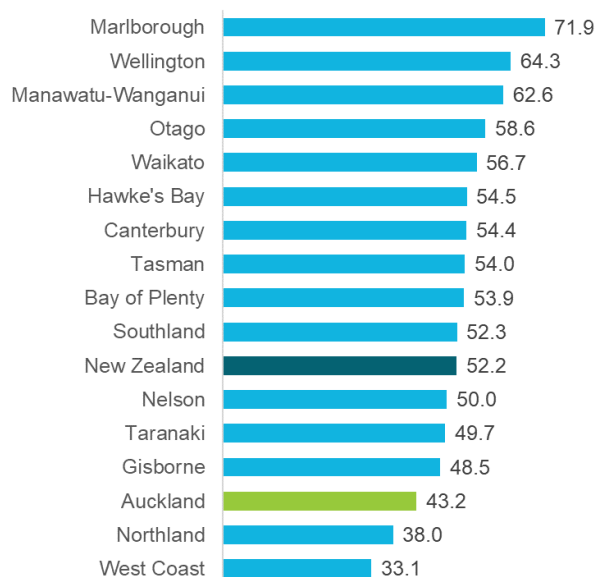
The 2017-2020 pooled data contains about 37,100 adult respondents and 12,500 children.



Aucklanders are not as physically active as they could be

Auckland adults are not as physically active as adults in most other regions – 43% indicated that they did at least 2.5 hours of physical activity over the last week (in surveys run between 2017 and 2020) (Figure 114). This compares to the New Zealand average of 52%, and 72% of the adult population in Marlborough. Levels of physical activity have generally stayed static over time, hovering around 43% and 44% of the adult population being physically active, over the last 10 years (Figure 115).

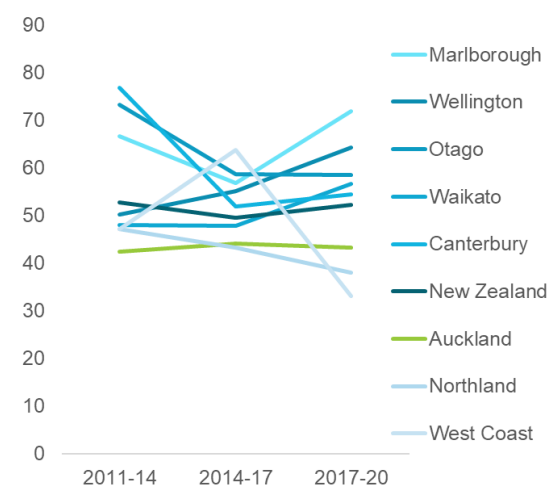
Figure 114. Percentage of adults who are physically active, by region, 2017-2020



Source: New Zealand Health Survey

Notes: Physical activity = did at least 2.5 hours of activity in the past week, spread out over the week

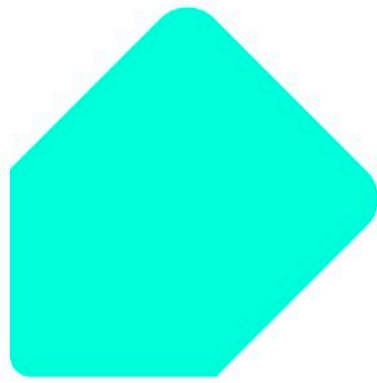
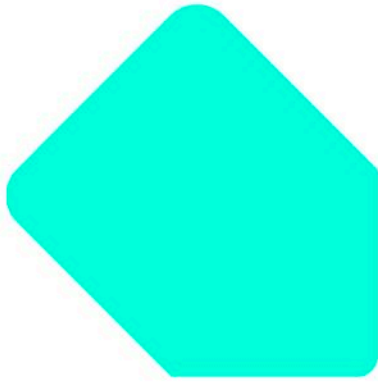
Figure 115. Percentage of adults who are physically active, selected regions, 2011-2020



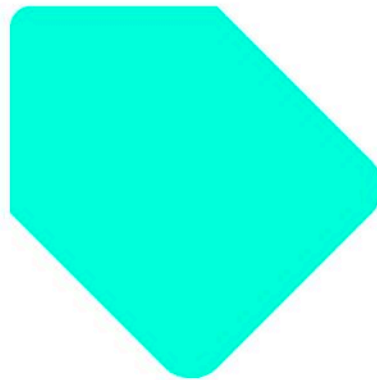
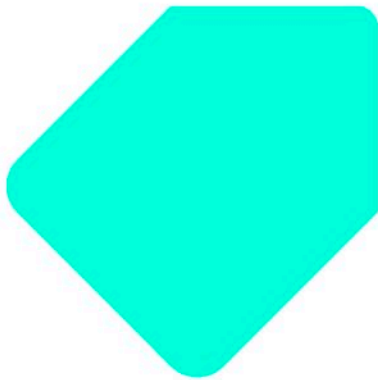
Source: New Zealand Health Survey

Notes: Physical activity = did at least 2.5 hours of activity in the past week, spread out over the week





NATURAL CAPITAL



ENVIRONMENT AND CLIMATE

All aspects of the natural environment needed to support life and human activity, valued for spiritual, cultural, and economic reasons.

Tāmaki Makaurau's natural environment is diverse – from harbours, lakes, and streams, to productive soils, indigenous forest, maunga, ranges, and motu. The environment is a key reason people choose to live, work, and play in the region.

The region has a land area of nearly 5,000 km² spanning from Te Hana in the north to Pukekohe in the south.

However, many of the high quality natural areas are also places that are experiencing the region's three key pressures:

- Urbanisation
- Management of land and water
- The changing climate.

Past decisions and the pressures of rapid population growth have had a negative impact on Tāmaki Makaurau and the current health of the natural environment reflects decades of degradation.¹¹¹

Summary

Across all categories, Aucklanders perceived there to be less issues with the natural environment than New Zealanders in general. Aucklanders were most concerned about the state of rivers, lakes, streams, wetlands, and aquatic life.

Auckland performs near the national average for residents' ability to access their nearest park or green space with 96% indicating it is 'very easy' and 'easy'. However, the percentage of Auckland residents who have visited a local park or reserve in the last 12 months has declined year on year since 2011.

Auckland's annual average particulate matter concentration sits roughly in the middle of all New Zealand regions. It has increased over time, but remains within WHO guidelines. Within Auckland, all

Perceived quality	H	N
Access	L	N
Air quality	M	▼
Swimmability	L	▼
Drinking water	M	N
Biodiversity	No regional data available ¹⁰⁹	
Greenhouse gas emissions	L	▼
Renewable energy	L	▲
Waste management	No regional data available ¹¹⁰	

¹⁰⁹ A national indicator has not yet been identified. See *Environment Aotearoa 2019* for further discussion on the difficulty of monitoring and reporting on ecosystem health and biodiversity.

¹¹⁰ Ministry for the Environment has advised that waste disposed of at levied disposal facilities is regarded as commercially sensitive and cannot be released.

¹¹¹ Auckland Council, "Te Oranga o Te Taiao o Tāmaki Makaurau | The Health of Tāmaki Makaurau / Auckland's Natural Environment in 2020: A Synthesis of Auckland Council's State of the Environment Reporting" (Auckland Council, 2020), <https://knowledgeauckland.org.nz/media/2009/the-health-of-t%C4%81maki-makaurau-auckland-s-natural-environment-in-2020.pdf>.



individual airsheds remain within WHO guidelines but Auckland City's and Penrose's annual average concentrations have increased over the years, likely due to the industrial and highly urbanised nature of those two environments.

In 2017, Auckland's rivers were the least swimmable of all regions, with only 23% of tested river sites being safe to swim in under normal conditions. Most rivers in Tāmaki Makaurau have been rated "poor", 'marginal' or 'fair', and in many cases quality fell over the last few years.

In 2018/19, 97% of Auckland's population received drinking-water that fully met all standards – a similar proportion to the national average.

Tāmaki Makaurau is estimated to be home to over 400 threatened species. Key threats are reduction in indigenous forest (30% of Tāmaki Makaurau is indigenous forest and shrubland), pest plants, animals and pathogens, and changing climate. The majority of birds counted in forest and wetlands are indigenous species.

Auckland is New Zealand's third-highest emitting region in terms of carbon dioxide equivalents. 70% of Auckland's emissions are from industry (mainly manufacturing and the services) and 30% from households. However, Auckland is New Zealand's largest economic region, and has one of the lowest emissions intensities across regions. Over the 2007-2019 period, Auckland's emissions decreased by 4.4 percent mostly due to reductions in industry-related emissions.

Although Auckland residents consume the most electricity on an annual basis in the residential market, average consumption is broadly in the middle of all regions. Auckland's consumption has not decreased as quickly as other regions.

Aucklanders are more likely to perceive the quality of the natural environment to be “good” or “very good”, than residents of other regions

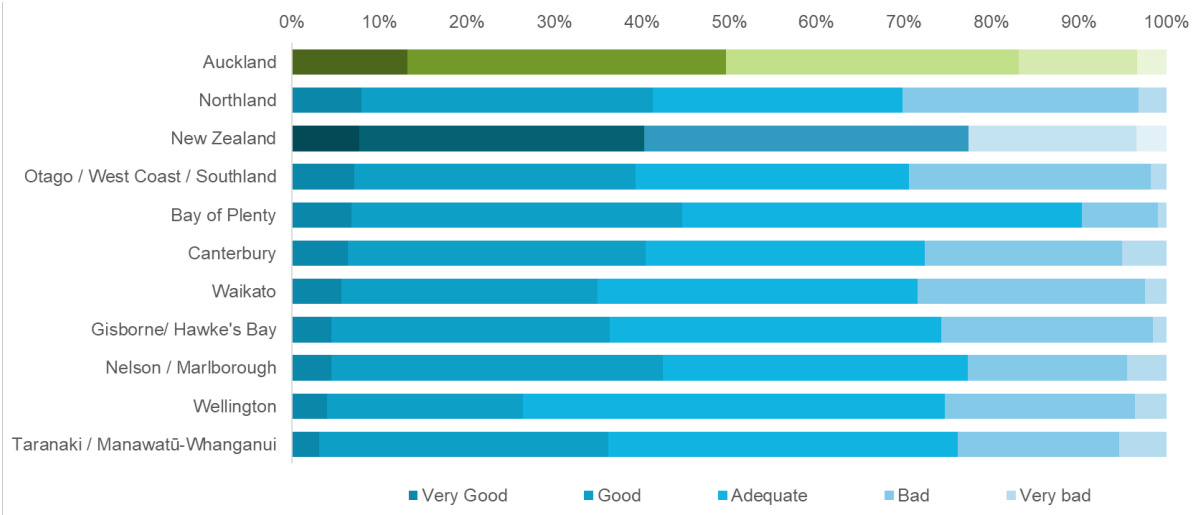
Lincoln University's survey on people's perceptions of the state of the New Zealand environment is the only long-running survey of this type in the world.¹¹² The 2019 survey found that, on average, New Zealanders perceive the state of the country's natural environment to be adequate or good and people consider themselves to have a good knowledge about it. However, concern about climate change has increased dramatically in the past three years (the survey series began in 2000).

There are regional differences in the way people perceive the quality of the natural environment. Aucklanders perceive the natural environment to be “very good” and “good”, at much higher proportions than other regions (Figure 116). In contrast, Wellingtonians were least likely to indicate the natural environment was “very good” or “good”.

¹¹² Kenneth F D Hughey, Geoffrey N Kerr, and Ross Cullen, *Public Perceptions of New Zealand's Environment: 2019* (Christchurch: Lincoln University, 2019).

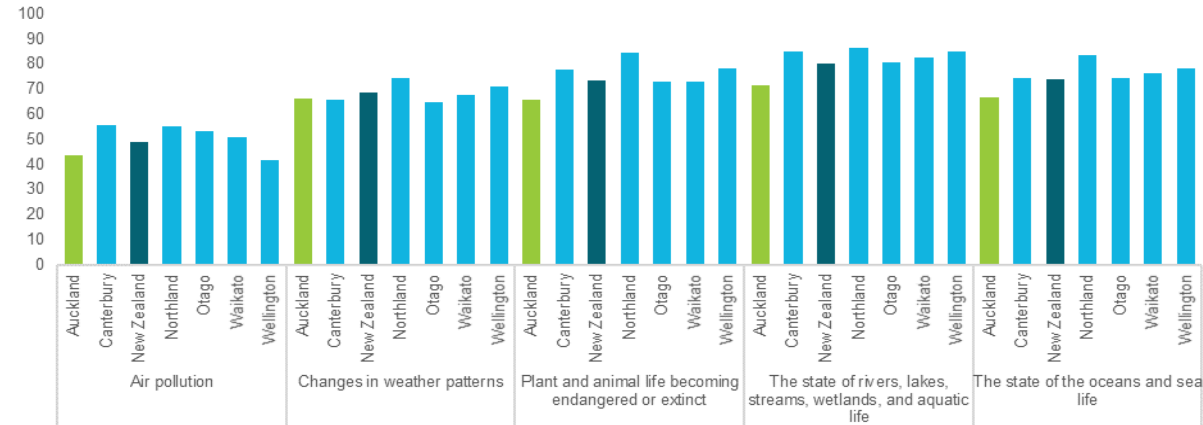


Figure 116. Perceptions of the “overall state of the natural environment in New Zealand”, regions, 2019



Source: Customised data from Lincoln University¹¹³
 Note: Regional data were aggregated into regional groupings so that groupings consisted of at least 50 survey participants.

Figure 117. Proportion of population who think New Zealand has any issues with the following environmental categories, by region, 2018



Source: Stats NZ, New Zealand General Social Survey 2018/19

These results are consistent with findings from Stats NZ’s New Zealand General Social Survey. That survey asks participants whether they “Think New Zealand has any issues with the following”. Out of

¹¹³ Hughey, Kerr, and Cullen.



air pollution, changes in weather patterns, plant and animal life, and the state of our waters – survey respondents were least worried about air pollution (Figure 117).

Across all categories, Aucklanders perceived there to be less issues than New Zealanders in general. Aucklanders were most concerned about the state of rivers, lakes, streams, wetlands and aquatic life.

Aucklanders' accessibility to green spaces and parks is similar to the national average. But the proportion of residents who visit local parks or reserves has fallen year on year

For many communities, a sense of identity and belonging is related to place, to physical geography and geographical boundaries¹¹⁴, and to the natural environment around them.¹¹⁵ There are also many physical, mental, social, cultural, environmental and economic connections between open spaces (such as local parks and reserves) and health and wellbeing:¹¹⁶

- Open spaces increase people's contact with nature and spaces of cultural significance.
- Open spaces promote social interaction and cohesion.
- Open spaces promoting physical activity.
- Open spaces reduce stress and promoting relaxation.

Across New Zealand regions, residents' ability to access their nearest park or green space is high. 96% of residents indicate that it is "very easy" or "easy" to access their nearest park or green space, with individual regions ranging between 93% (Manawatū-Whanganui) and 98% (Southland) (Figure 118). Auckland performs near the national average, with 96% indicating it is "very easy" and "easy".

The percentage of Auckland residents who have visited a local park or reserve in the last 12 months in Tāmaki Makaurau has declined year on year since 2011 (Figure 119). Between 2015 and 2021, the percentage of residents who have visited a local park or reserve in the last 12 months has dropped by 10 percentage points.

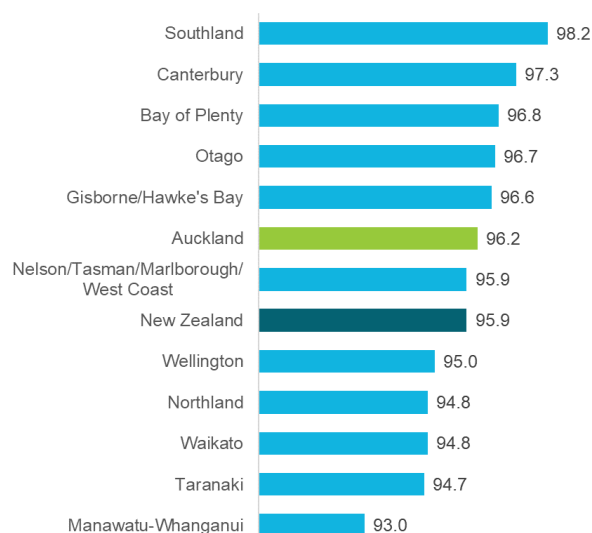
¹¹⁴ Karen Banwell and Simon Kingham, "Community Amenity, Social Connectedness and Resilience: The Informal Response to the 2010/11 Christchurch Earthquakes," in *Urban Challenges in a Complex World: Resilience, Governance and Changing Urban Systems* (IGU Urban Commission Annual Conference, Dublin: Geographical Society of Ireland, 2015).

¹¹⁵ Karen Banwell, "Planning for Resilient Communities and Every Other Day: Learning from the Canterbury 2010-2012 Earthquake Sequence" (Doctor of Philosophy in Geography, Christchurch, University of Canterbury, 2017).

¹¹⁶ Regional Public Health, "Healthy Open Spaces: A Summary of the Impact of Open Spaces on Health and Wellbeing," Regional Public Health Information Paper (Wellington: Regional Public Health, 2010); Paul Blaschke, "Health and Wellbeing Benefits of Conservation in New Zealand," Science for Conservation (Wellington: Department of Conservation, 2013).

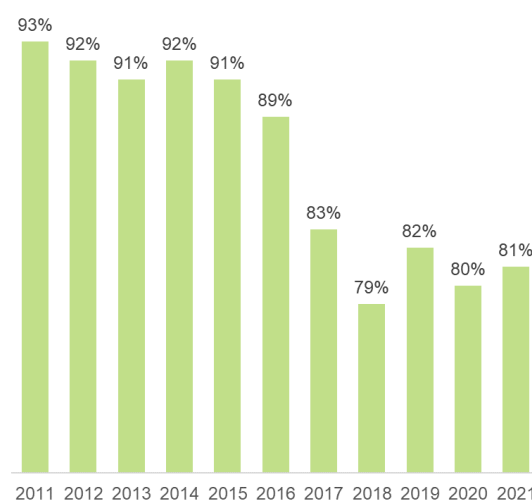


Figure 118. Percentage of people who said it was very easy to get to their nearest park or green space, by region, 2018/19



Source: Stats NZ, New Zealand General Social Survey 2018

Figure 119. Percentage of Auckland residents who have visited a local park or reserve in the last 12 months, 2011 – 2021



Source: Auckland Council annual reports

Notes: Colmar Brunton New Zealand conducts the annual survey of Auckland residents. The survey primarily measures respondents' use of, and satisfaction with, a range of council services. The population used to select respondents was Auckland residents aged 15 and over. Demographic quotas were set by age, gender, ethnicity and local board area to ensure the sample profile matched the population of the Auckland region. In 2017 the sample size was 4,242 with a margin of error ± 1.5 percent.

Air quality in Auckland remains within WHO guidelines

Breathing good quality air is fundamental to our wellbeing. The health effects of polluted air are wide-ranging and mainly affect the elderly, young people, and vulnerable groups. Good air quality is also important for ecosystem health.

Particulate matter (PM) comprises solid and liquid particles in the air. PM₁₀ particles have a diameter less than 10 micrometres. These can be inhaled and generally deposit in the upper airways; finer particles (smaller than 2.5 micrometres) can deposit deep in the lungs where air-gas exchange occurs. Human-generated PM₁₀ sources include dust from unsealed roads and burning wood for home heating. Natural sources include sea salt, dust, and pollen.

The WHO guideline for annual average PM₁₀ is 20 $\mu\text{g}/\text{m}^3$.¹¹⁷

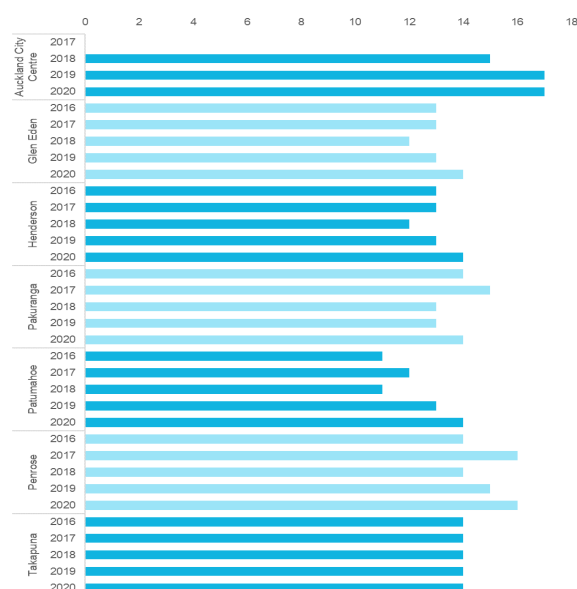
¹¹⁷ World Health Organization, ed., *Air Quality Guidelines: Global Update 2005: Particulate Matter, Ozone, Nitrogen Dioxide, and Sulfur Dioxide* (Copenhagen, Denmark: World Health Organization, 2006).



Auckland's annual average PM₁₀ concentration sits roughly in the middle of all New Zealand regions (Figure 121). It has increased over time, but remains below 15 µg/m³. Note that both Southland and Marlborough exceeded WHO guidelines but have managed to decrease PM₁₀ concentration in the last two years.

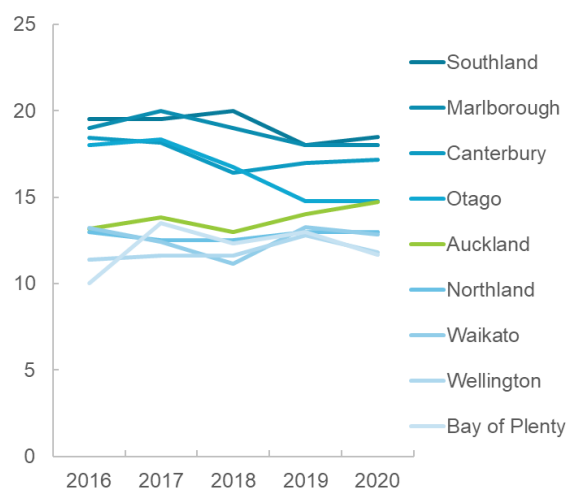
Within Auckland, all individual airsheds remain within WHO guidelines (Figure 120), but Auckland City's and Penrose's annual average PM₁₀ concentrations have increased over the years, likely due to the industrial and highly urbanised nature of those two environments.

Figure 120. Annual average PM₁₀ concentration, Auckland airsheds, 2016–2020



Source: LAWA Land Air Water Aotearoa

Figure 121. Annual average PM₁₀ concentration, selected regions, 2016–2020



Source: LAWA Land Air Water Aotearoa

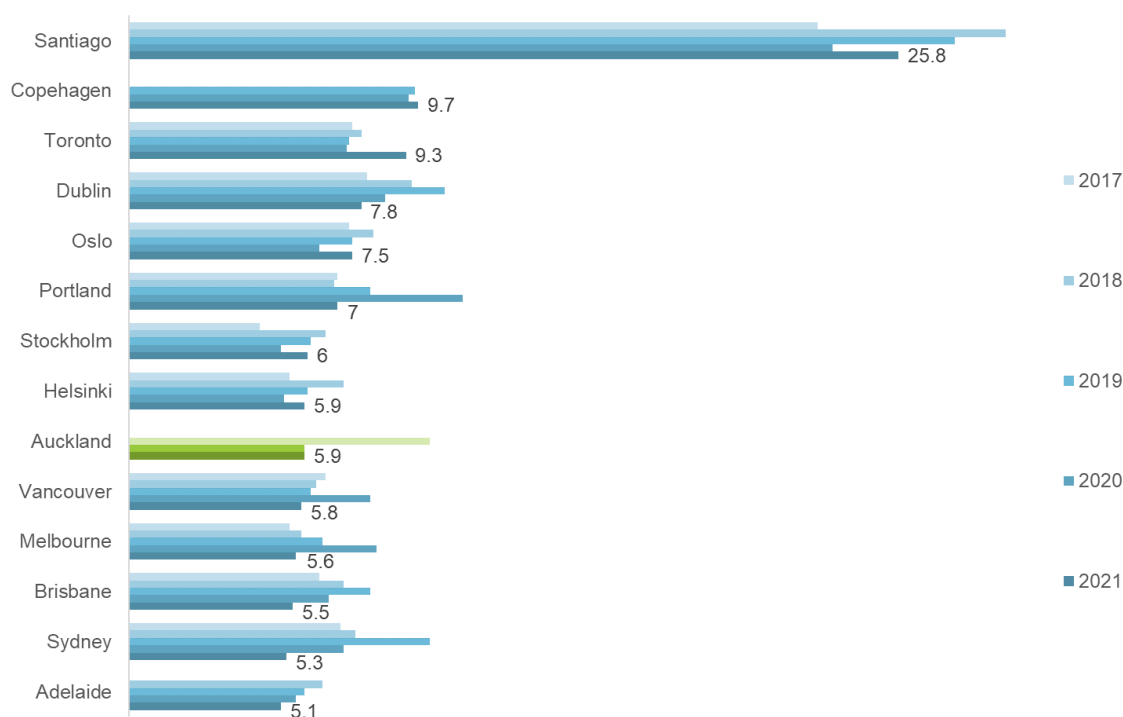
Notes: Airsheds for each region have been combined and averaged for each year

The 2021 WHO guideline for annual average PM_{2.5} is 5 µg/m³, down from the original 2006 guideline of 10 µg/m³.¹¹⁸ Internationally, Auckland performs around the midpoint of comparable city-regions, but is still exceeding the new WHO guideline (Figure 122).

¹¹⁸ IQAir, "2021 World Air Quality Report: Region & City PM_{2.5} Ranking" (IQAir, 2021).



Figure 122. Annual average PM2.5, selected city-regions, 2017–2021



Source: 2021 IQAir World Air Quality Report

Auckland's rivers have been the least swimmable across New Zealand. The quality of Auckland's rivers has also declined over time

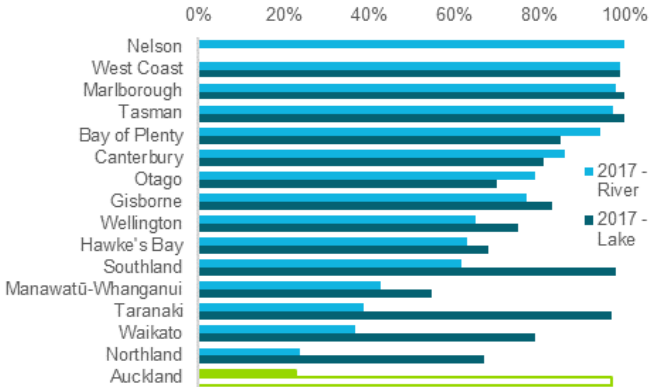
Tāmaki Makaurau is home to twin coasts lined with beaches and estuaries. The region has many great places to swim, collect kaimoana, fish, surf and play, but if the water is contaminated with bacteria from human or animal faeces, there are risks of catching infection.

Auckland Council's Safeswim monitoring programme is designed to provide regular assessments of water quality at popular beaches, lakes and lagoons, so Aucklanders can safely swim in these waters. River quality is measured across regions as part of national environmental policy to increase the swimmability of New Zealand's waters. In 2017, Auckland's rivers were the least swimmable of all regions, with only 23% of tested river sites that were safe to swim in under normal conditions (Figure 123).

Most rivers in Tāmaki Makaurau have been rated "poor", "marginal" or "fair", and in many cases quality fell over the last few years (Figure 124). Urban sites had the lowest ranked water quality, particularly Pakuranga Creek, Ōtaki Creek, Ōtara Creek (South) and Botany Creek. Cascades Stream was the only site classed as having "excellent" water quality between 2014 and 2018.

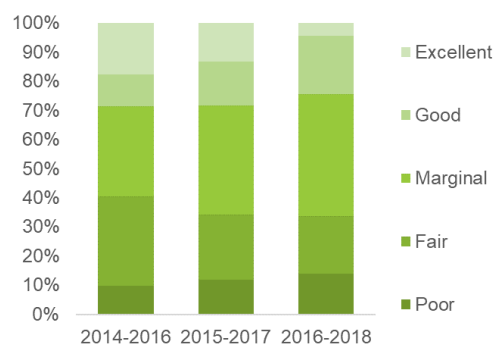


Figure 123. Auckland’s rivers were the least swimmable in 2017



Source: Ministry for the Environment¹¹⁹
Indicator: Percentage of tested river sites that are safe to swim in under normal conditions

Figure 124. The quality of Tāmaki Makaurau’s rivers have declined over time



Source: Auckland Council¹²⁰
Notes: Water Quality Index – this index is used to calculate an overall water quality score based on the scope (# of sites), frequency (# of times), and magnitude of exceedance of water quality objective values for each of 16 water quality parameters.
Water Quality Index score of Greater than 90% = excellent; between 75% and 90% = good; between 60% and 75% = fair; lower than 60% = Poor

¹¹⁹ MfE, “Regional Information for Setting Draft Targets for Swimmable Lakes and Rivers” (Ministry for the Environment on behalf of a joint taskforce of central and local government representatives, 2018), <https://www.nelson.govt.nz/assets/Environment/Downloads/Water/swimmability/Regional-information-for-setting-draft-targets-for-swimmable-lakes-and-rivers.pdf>.

¹²⁰ Kristi R Holland, Anna Kleinmans, and Ebrahim Hussain, “State of the Environment Monitoring: River Water Quality Annual Report 2018,” Technical Report (Auckland: Auckland Council, 2018).

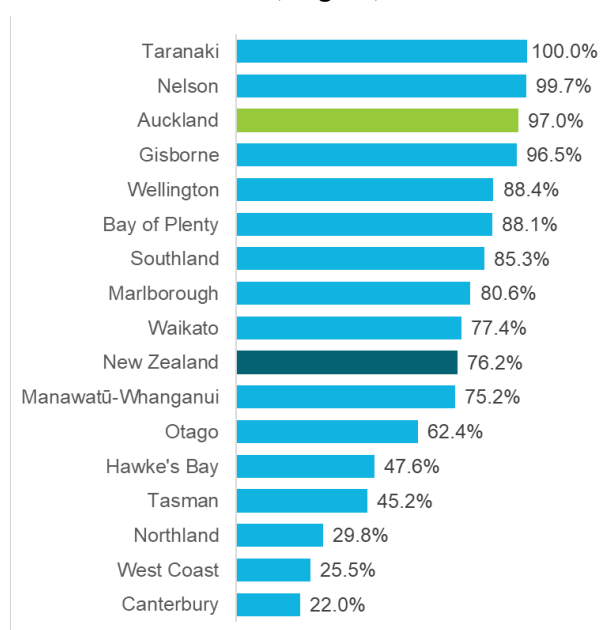


Almost all Aucklanders (97%) receive drinking-water that meets all national standards

The Health Act 1956 requires that drinking-water supplies comply with drinking-water standards. In 2018/19, supplies that met all standards for drinking-water quality increased to 76.2% of the reported population, up 3.6% compared to the previous year.¹²¹ In 2019/20, 78.6% of the reported population received drinking-water that fully met all standards.¹²²

In 2018/19, at the regional level, 97% of Auckland's population received drinking-water that fully met all standards – a similar proportion to the national average (Figure 125). More people in Nelson and Taranaki received drinking-water that fully met all standards. Only 22% of Canterbury's population received drinking-water that fully met all standards.

Figure 125. Population that received drinking-water that fully met all standards, region, 2018/19



Source: BECA¹²³

Less than 30% of Auckland is indigenous forest and shrubland. Urban development, pests, and changing climate, have reduced the ecological integrity of forests and bird diversity

Today less than 30% of Tāmaki Makaurau is indigenous forest and shrubland. Native forest has been replaced over time with exotic grassland and urban development. This has resulted in loss of ecosystems and the diversity it supports. Many species are now threatened, as their habitat has been degraded or removed.¹²⁴

¹²¹ Ministry of Health, "Annual Report on Drinking-Water Quality 2018-19" (Wellington: Ministry of Health, 2020).

¹²² Ministry of Health, "Annual Report on Drinking-Water Quality 2019-20" (Wellington: Ministry of Health, 2021).

¹²³ Ministry of Health, "Annual Report on Drinking-Water Quality 2018-19."

¹²⁴ Auckland Council, "Te Oranga o Te Taiao o Tāmaki Makaurau | The Health of Tāmaki Makaurau / Auckland's Natural Environment in 2020: A Synthesis of Auckland Council's State of the Environment Reporting."



Pest plants, animals and pathogens also threaten survival of many species. Tāmaki Makaurau is estimated to be home to over 400 threatened species. The changing climate will make it even harder for some species to survive.

Monitoring of forest/scrub/shrubland and freshwater wetlands began in 2009 and dune ecosystems were added in 2017. Approximately 400 forest plots, 250 freshwater wetland plots, and 23 dune systems are distributed across the region. Native, exotic and pest plant species are monitored along with bird diversity.

Forests

There are numerous examples of forest and scrub supporting diverse indigenous plant communities with healthy forest structures. These are more common in the large, continuous forest patches with high habitat heterogeneity such as the Waitākere Ranges, Hunua Ranges and Aotea, and at sites with intensive conservation management including Tāwharanui, Shakespear and the offshore island of Te Hauturu-o-Toi.¹²⁵

At a regional scale, the ecological integrity of Auckland's forests is impaired by the absence or reduction of many forest and scrub ecosystem types, the absence of many native bird species, the widespread abundance of pest animal species and the frequency of weed incursions. Indigenous forest ecosystems have been reduced to 23% of their original extent, with some ecosystem types disproportionately affected. For example, only 16% of kauri, podocarp, broadleaf forest, 2% of kahikatea, pukatea forest, and 0.3% of pūriri forest remain.

Much remaining forest and scrub has been disturbed and degraded to such an extent it has been reclassified as regenerating forest and scrub ecosystem types that did not previously occur in the Auckland region.

Bird diversity

The majority of birds counted in forest (70%) and wetlands (55%) were indigenous species (Table 1 and Table 2). Four of the top five bird species counted in forest were indigenous, whereas only two of the top five species were indigenous in wetlands.

Tūi was the most commonly counted species at forest sites, followed by silvereye, grey warbler, North Island fantail and Eurasian blackbird, all detected in greater than 50% of counts. Silvereye was the most commonly counted species at wetland sites, followed by common myna, grey warbler, European goldfinch and house sparrow, all detected in greater than 30% of counts.

¹²⁵ Georgianne Griffiths J. K et al., *Ecological Integrity of Forests in Tāmaki Makaurau / Auckland 2009-2010: State of Environment*, Technical Report, TR2021/01 (Auckland Council, 2021).



Table 1. Status and conservation status of birds at forest sites

Status of species counted at 400 forest sites (1452 total bird counts conducted from 2009-18) in the Auckland region			Conservation status of indigenous species counted at forest sites (1452 total bird counts from 2009-18) in the Auckland region		
Status	Count	Percentage of total birds	Conservation status	Count	Percentage of total birds
Endemic	10,757	47%	Threatened	38	0%
Indigenous	5,071	22%	At risk	1,557	7%
Introduced	7,191	31%	Not threatened	14,235	62%
TOTAL	23,019		TOTAL	15,830	

Source: Auckland Council¹²⁶

Table 2. Status and conservation status of birds at wetland sites

Status of species counted at 187 wetland sites (913 total bird counts from 2011-19) in the Auckland region			Conservation status of indigenous species counted at wetland sites (913 total bird counts from 2011-19) in the Auckland region		
Status	Count	Percentage of total birds	Conservation status	Count	Percentage of total birds
Endemic	3,521	24%	Threatened	5	<0.1%
Indigenous	4,565	32%	At risk	653	8%
Introduced	6,427	44%	Not threatened	7,450	92%
TOTAL	14,513		TOTAL	8,108	

Source: Auckland Council¹²⁷

Auckland has the lowest greenhouse gas emissions intensity of all regions. Emissions intensity takes account of GDP produced within a region

Total net greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions are measured in kilotonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent (kT CO₂-e). 'CO₂ equivalents' are used so that different greenhouse gases can be compared with each other and added together.

Auckland is New Zealand's third highest emitting region in terms of carbon dioxide equivalents (CO₂-e) (Figure 126), but highest for carbon dioxide and fluorinated gases. 70% of Auckland's emissions were from industry and 30% from households. Auckland's emissions are mainly from manufacturing and the services industries, which make up 29% and 19% respectively of Auckland's CO₂-e emissions.

¹²⁶ Todd J Landers et al., *Diversity, Abundance and Distribution of Birds in Tamaki Makaurau / Auckland 2009-2019: State of the Environment Reporting*, Technical Report, TR2021/08 (Auckland Council, 2021), <https://www.knowledgeauckland.org.nz/media/2017/tr2021-08-diversity-abundance-and-distribution-of-birds-in-auckland-2009-2019.pdf>.

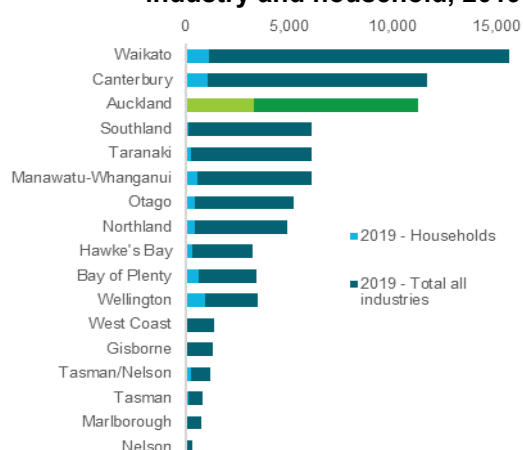
¹²⁷ Landers et al.



However, in economic terms Auckland is New Zealand's largest economic region, accounting for 38% of New Zealand's GDP in 2020 (discussed in the following section of this report). Taking into account regional GDP provides an indication of emission intensity. In 2019, Auckland had one of the lowest emissions intensities across regions, as it produced 91 tonnes of emissions per million dollars of GDP (Figure 128) and 6.7 tonnes of emissions per person.

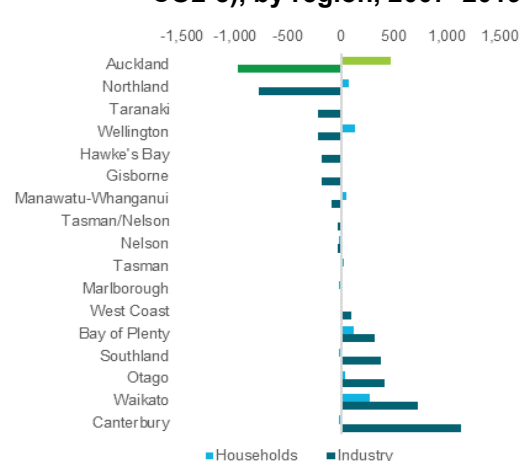
Over the 2007–2019 period, Auckland's emissions decreased by 513 kilotonnes (4.4 percent) (Figure 127), mostly due to reductions in industry-related emissions.

Figure 126. Regional greenhouse gas emissions (kilotonnes CO₂-e), by industry and household, 2019



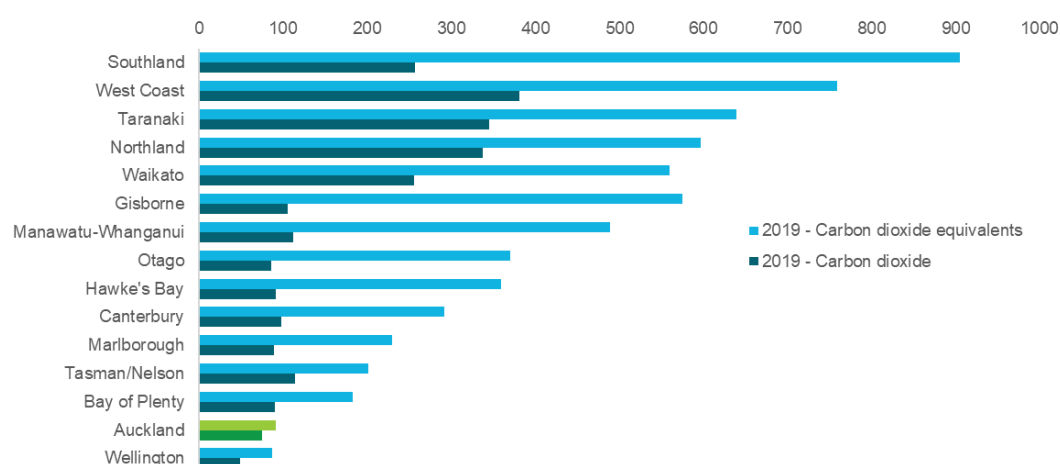
Source: Stats NZ's environmental-economic accounts

Figure 127. Change in household and industry emissions (kilotonnes CO₂-e), by region, 2007–2019



Source: Stats NZ's environmental-economic accounts

Figure 128. Greenhouse gas emissions intensity by region, 2019



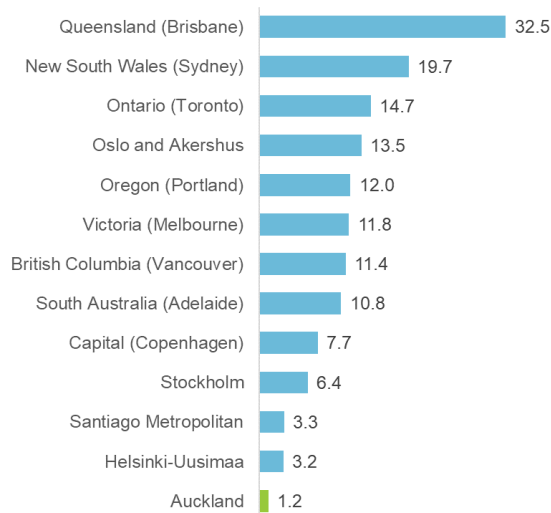
Source: Stats NZ's environmental-economic accounts



Auckland also performs well internationally on CO₂ emissions indicators. In 2008, Auckland had the lowest CO₂ emissions rate of the set of internationally comparable regions (Figure 127).

Queensland typically comprises a third of Australia’s emissions. Those emissions come mainly from coal and gas burned for electricity generation, transport, and from land clearing,

Figure 129. CO₂ emissions rate (in tonnes per capita), 2008



OECD.Stat, Regions and Cities
Note: OECD classifies the geographic units in this chart as large regions (territorial level 2 or TL2) to help in assessing differences in socio-economic trends in regions, both within and across countries

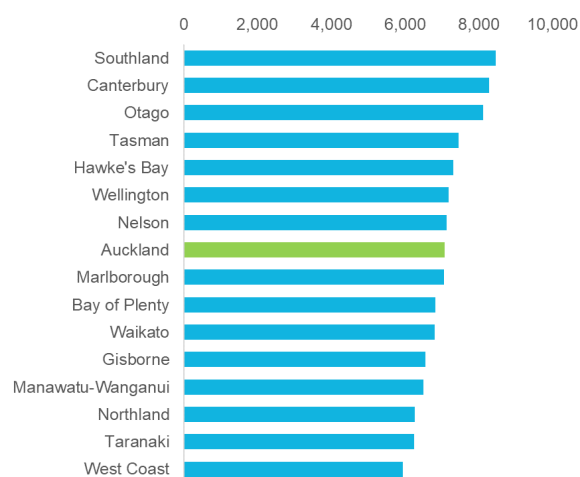
Auckland residential electricity consumption is in the middle of all regions, and demand has not decreased as much as it has in other regions

Although Auckland residents consume the most electricity on an annual basis in the residential market, average consumption sit broadly in the middle of all regions (Figure 130).

All regions have decreased residential electricity consumption over time (Figure 131), but Auckland’s has not decreased as quickly as other regions like Southland and Canterbury (Figure 131). Electricity demand in the industrial sector was highest in the Upper North Island in 2020 (Figure 132), reflecting the larger industrial base, and has stayed at similar levels over the last 10 years (Figure 133).

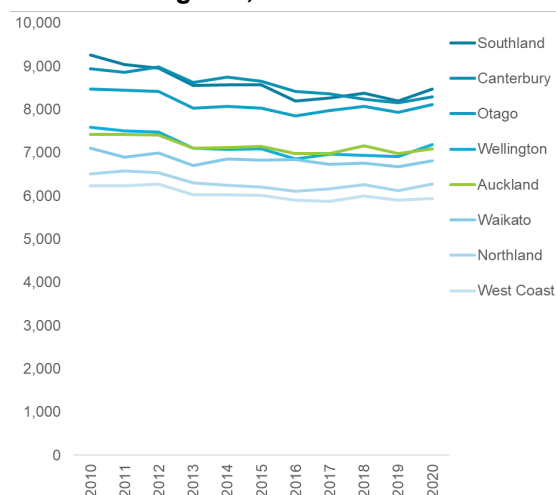


Figure 130. Average residential electricity consumption (kWh), by region, 2020



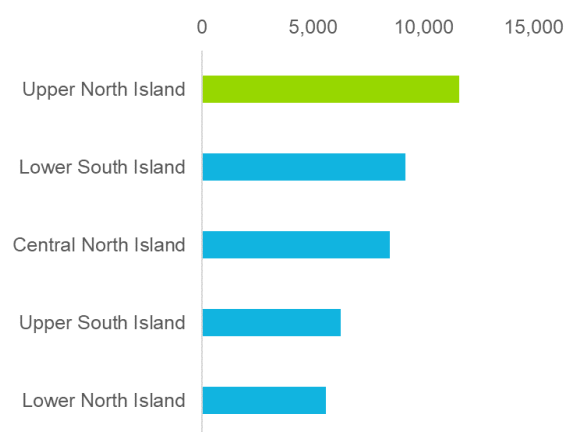
Source: Electricity Authority

Figure 131. Average residential electricity consumption (kWh), selected regions, 2010–2020



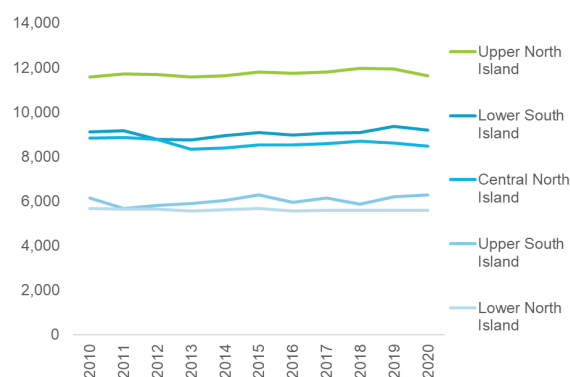
Source: Electricity Authority

Figure 132. Business electricity demand (GWh), by zone, 2020



Source: Electricity Authority

Figure 133. Business electricity demand (GWh), by zone, 2010–2020



Source: Electricity Authority



LEISURE AND PLAY

Using free time to rest, recharge, and engage in personal or shared pursuits.

The ability to combine work, family commitments and personal life is important for the wellbeing of all household members. It is also important for society as a whole, as it ensures that people have sufficient time to socialise and participate in the life of the community. This theme looks at the distribution of people's time between work and play, and their participation and access to recreation.

There is increased complexity of people's lives, with both men and women taking on a wider variety of tasks in the workplace and at home. The distribution of tasks within the family is still influenced by gender roles, and is shaped by culture.

Work-life balance	M	~
Leisure and personal care	M	▼
Sport and recreation	M	~
Arts engagement	M	▼
Heritage places	H	▲

Summary

A slightly lower percentage of Aucklanders indicate they are satisfied with their work-life balance compared with the New Zealand city average and this persists over time

When last measured (2009/10), Aucklanders spent about 5 minutes less on leisure (5 hours and 15 minutes) than the New Zealand average of 5 hours and 20 minutes. Aucklanders spent around the same amount of time on personal care (10:56 hours) as the New Zealand average (10:57 hours). Time spent on leisure and personal care has increased over time, with Aucklanders gaining 10 minutes more leisure and 5 minutes more personal care time between 1998/99 and 2009/10.

Between 2017 and 2019, Aucklanders' participation in sport and recreation sat at the national average, with 73% of residents participating in sport in 2019, compared to 72% nationally. North Harbour residents have the highest participation in sport and recreation (76% in 2019), while participation in Counties Manukau is consistently at the lower end of all the sub-regions (68% in 2019). In Auckland, Samoan males have the highest participation rate (83%), and Chinese women had the lowest participation rate (58%). Europeans and males were more likely to have high participation, and females and older age groups were more likely to have lower participation.

In 2020, close to three-quarters of Auckland residents had engaged with the arts in the last 12 months which is the national average. Results indicate that engagement has declined, that are likely due to COVID-19. In Auckland, young people aged 15 to 17, Waitematā residents, and women, are more likely than average to be engaged with the arts. Conversely, men are less likely than average to be engaged.

Auckland has a high number of places on the heritage list compared with other New Zealand areas. As at December 2021, there were 562 listed places in Auckland.

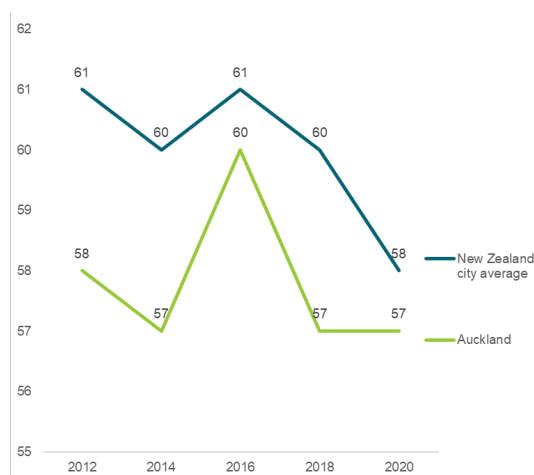


A similar proportion of Aucklanders and New Zealanders are satisfied with their work-life balance

Studies of employees have found positive relationships between work-life balance and job and life satisfaction.¹²⁸ Work-life balance has also been found to be negatively associated with anxiety and depression. These relationships appear to hold across countries and cultures.¹²⁹ A study across six countries – New Zealand, Spain, France, Italy, Malaysia, and China – that also examined whether there are differences between New Zealand Māori and New Zealand Europeans, found that high levels of work-life balance were more positively associated with life satisfaction.¹³⁰

In the Quality of Life survey, a slightly lower percentage of Aucklanders indicate they are satisfied with their work-life balance compared with the surveyed New Zealand city average – and this persists over time (Figure 134). In comparison with residents from other cities and regions in New Zealand, Aucklanders are around the national average (57% compared to 58% in 2020), but lower than Dunedin, Christchurch, and Hamilton, where over 60% indicated satisfaction with work-life balance.

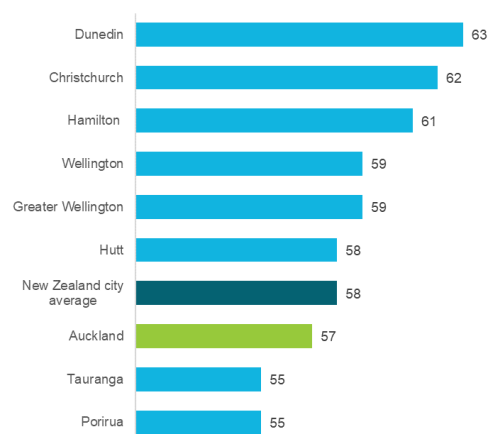
Figure 134. Satisfaction with the balance between work and other aspects of life such as time with family or leisure, Auckland and New Zealand, 2012–2020



Source: Quality of Life Survey

Notes: Participants are asked: Overall how satisfied or dissatisfied are you with the balance between your work and other aspects of your life such as time with your family or for leisure? (1–Very dissatisfied, 2–Dissatisfied, 3–Neither satisfied nor dissatisfied, 4–Satisfied, 5–Very satisfied). Net satisfied is 4+5.

Figure 135. Percentage satisfied with work-life balance, all cities, 2020



¹²⁸ Jarrod M Haar et al., “Outcomes of Work-Life Balance on Job Satisfaction, Life Satisfaction and Mental Health: A Study across Seven Cultures,” *Journal of Vocational Behavior* 85, no. 3 (2014): 361–73.

¹²⁹ Haar et al.; E Hill et al., “A Cross-Cultural Test of the Work-Family Interface in 48 Countries,” *Journal of Marriage and the Family*, 66, no. 5 (2004): 1300–1316; Paula Brough et al., “Work– Life Balance: A Longitudinal Evaluation of a New Measure across Australia and New Zealand Workers,” *The International Journal of Human Resource Management* 25, no. 19 (2014): 2724–44.

¹³⁰ Haar et al., “Outcomes of Work-Life Balance on Job Satisfaction, Life Satisfaction and Mental Health: A Study across Seven Cultures.”



Aucklanders spend less time on personal care and leisure than residents of most other regions

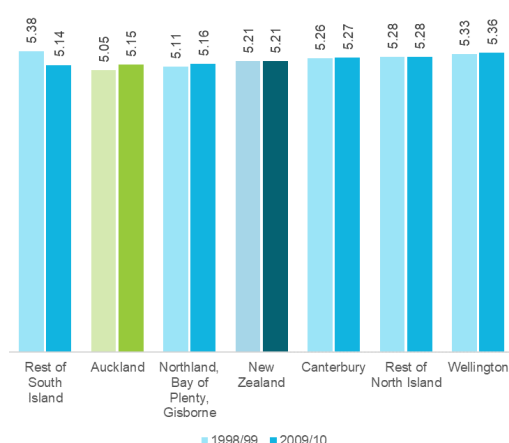
The more people work, the less time they have to spend on other activities, such as time with others, leisure activities, eating, or sleeping. The amount and quality of leisure time is important for people's overall well-being, and can bring additional physical and mental health benefits. In New Zealand, full-time workers devote 62% of their day on average, or 14.9 hours, to personal care (eating, sleeping, etc.) and leisure (socialising with friends and family, hobbies, games, computer and television use, etc.) – slightly less than the OECD average of 15 hours.¹³¹

When last measured in 2009/10, Wellingtonians spent more time a day on leisure – 5 hours and 36 minutes – than all other regions (Figure 136). Aucklanders had about 20 minutes less – 5 hours and 15 minutes – less than the New Zealand average of 5 hours and 20 minutes. In relation to personal care, the South Island (excluding Canterbury) and the grouping of Northland, Bay of Plenty and Gisborne spent the most time on personal care a day – 11:04 hours (Figure 137). Again, Aucklanders spent less time on personal care – 10:56 hours – although this was around the New Zealand average (10:57 hours).

Time spent on leisure and personal care has increased over time, with Aucklanders gaining 10 minutes more leisure and 5 minutes more personal care time between 1998/99 and 2009/10.

Time use was to be next measured in the NZ General Social Survey 2020, but was delayed due to COVID-19.

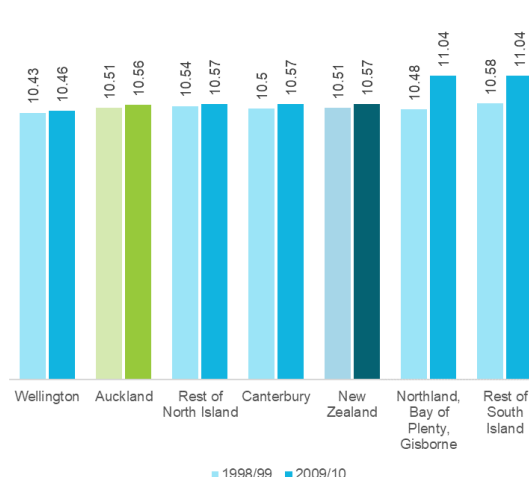
Figure 136. Average time spent on leisure, region, 1998/99 and 2009/10



Source: Time Use Survey, Stats NZ

Notes: Residents 12 years and older.

Figure 137. Average time spent on personal care, region, 1998/99 and 2009/10



Source: Time Use Survey, Stats NZ

¹³¹ OECD, "New Zealand," OECD Better life index, 2020, <https://www.oecdbetterlifeindex.org/countries/new-zealand/>.

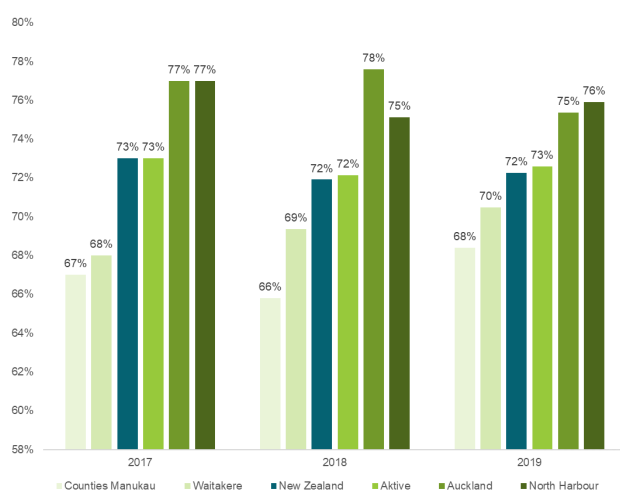


Aucklanders participate in sport and recreation at the same rate as the national average. Participation by residents in the North Harbour area is the highest of all regional sport trust areas

Surveys of New Zealanders finds that the primary reason for participation in sport and recreation is enjoyment, followed closely by health and fitness.¹³² Sport NZ breaks up New Zealand into 18 regional sports trusts.¹³³ In Auckland, Aktive is the collective of four sub-regional sports trusts: Harbour Sport, Sport Auckland, Counties Manukau Sport and Sport Waitākere.

Between 2017 and 2019, the Auckland region's (Aktive) participation in sport and recreation sat at the national average, with 73% of residents participating in sport in 2019 compared to 72% nationally (Figure 138). North Harbour residents have the highest participation (76% in 2019), while participation in Counties Manukau is consistently at the lower end of all the sub-regions (68% in 2019). There has been no statistically significant shift in Auckland regional participation over time.

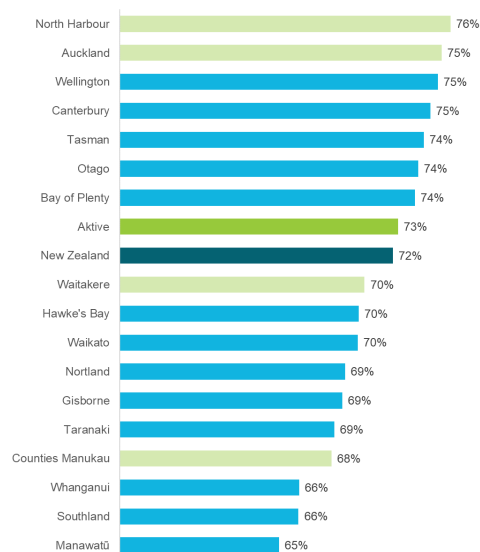
Figure 138. Percentage participating in sport and recreation, Auckland areas, 2017–2019



Source: Active NZ Survey, Sport NZ

Notes: Question – in the last 7 days (not including today) have you done any physical activity specifically for sport, physical education (PE), exercise or fun? Yes, No response.

Figure 139. Percentage participating in sport and recreation, regions, 2019



Source: Active NZ Survey, Sport NZ

¹³² Sport and Recreation New Zealand, "Sport and Active Recreation in the Lives of New Zealand Adults: 2013/14 Active New Zealand Survey Results" (Wellington: SPARC, Sport and Recreation New Zealand, 2015).

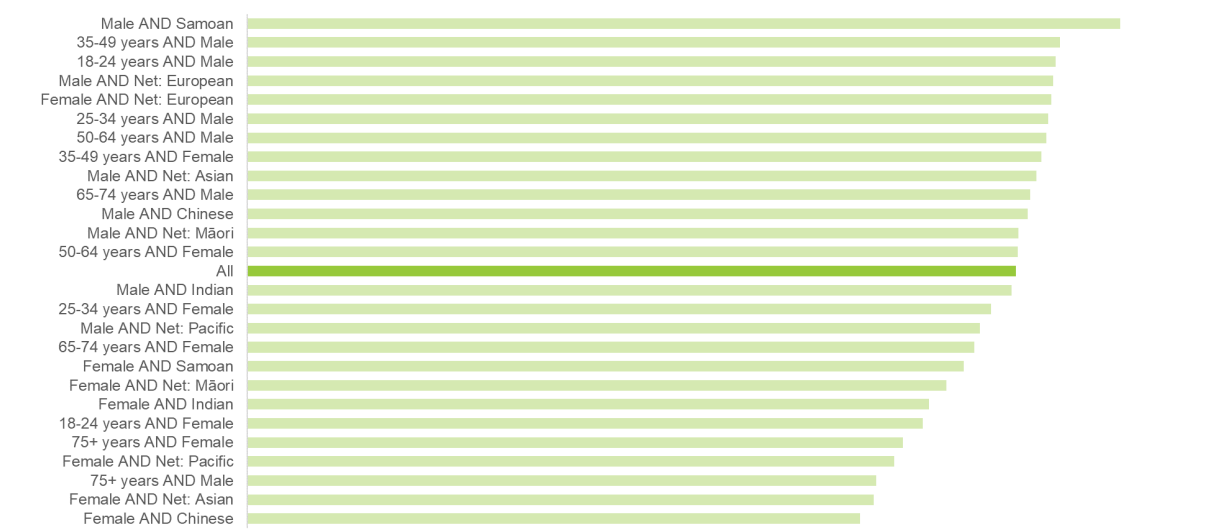
¹³³ Sport Canterbury is split into two sub-regions: Westland District and rest of Canterbury; Aktive includes Harbour Sport, Sport Auckland, Counties Manukau Sport and Sport Waitakere.



In 2019, North Harbour and Auckland areas had the highest participation rates across New Zealand, 76% and 75% respectively (Figure 139). Manawatū had the lowest rate of participation at 65%.

When participation is broken down by age, gender and ethnicity, there is much variability in results. Samoan males had the highest participation rate – 83%, but Chinese women had the lowest participation rate – 58% (Figure 140). Europeans and males were more likely to have high participation, and females and older age groups were more likely to have lower participation.

Figure 140. Sport and recreation participation in the Auckland region, by demography, 2019



Source: Active NZ Survey, Sport NZ
 Notes: Question – in the last 7 days (not including today) have you done any physical activity specifically for sport, physical education (PE), exercise or fun? Yes, No response.

Aucklanders engage in the arts at a similar rate to New Zealanders

Overall engagement is based on all those who have either attended or participated in the following art forms in the last 12 months: Craft & object art, Literature, Ngā Toi Māori (Māori arts), Pacific arts, Performing arts and Visual arts.

In 2020, close to three quarters of Auckland residents had engaged with the arts in the last 12 months. This is lower than in 2017 but around the national average (Figure 141). Wellingtonians in Wellington City Council boundary areas are the most engaged, followed by residents of the Wellington region.

The decline in engagement reflects the national trend (engagement fell from 80% to 75%). The results indicate declines in engagement are a result of lower attendance figures (as opposed to participation) due to COVID-19.

There are sub-group differences in Auckland. The following groups of Auckland residents are more likely than average (74%) to be engaged with the arts:

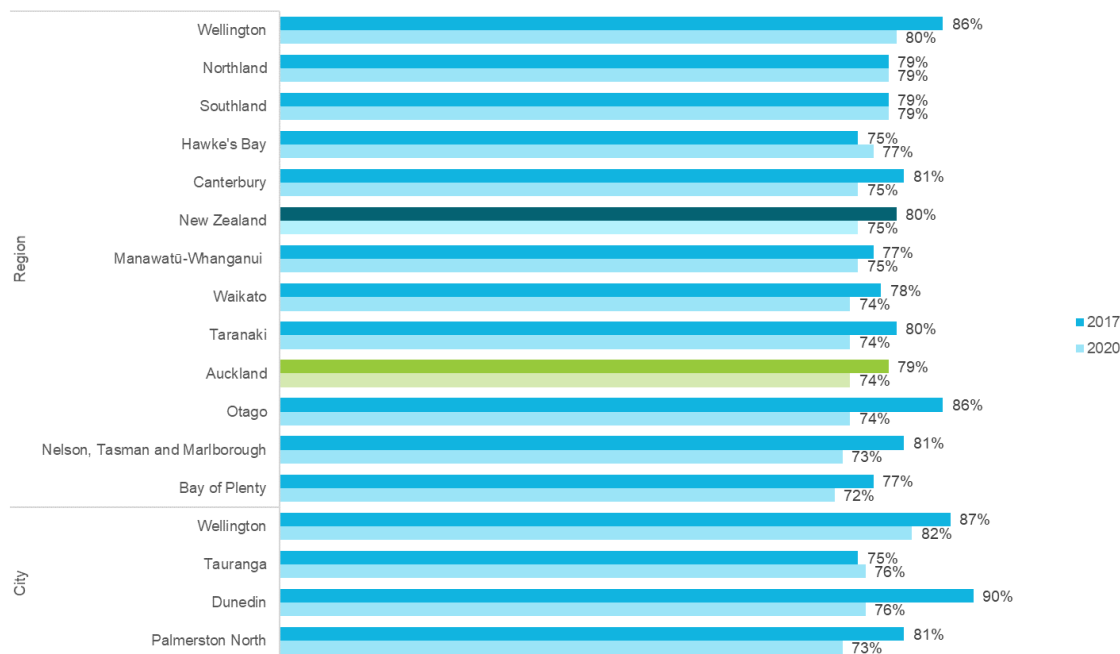
- Young people aged 15 to 17 (89%)
- Waitemata residents (83%)



- Women (78%).

Conversely, men are less likely than average to be engaged.

Figure 141. Engagement in the arts, regions and cities, 2017 and 2020



Source: New Zealanders and the Arts, Creative NZ & Colmar Brunton

Auckland has a high number of heritage listed places compared with other New Zealand areas. There are opportunities to lift the number of listed wāhi tapu and wāhi tupuna places

Places have heritage and they are valued by residents. There are obvious ways heritage is valued and contributes to wellbeing, for example through tourism, but also in ways that are less obvious, such as the value people place on keeping heritage for future generations or the value people place on purely knowing it exists.

Heritage New Zealand Pouhere Taonga (HNZPT, the national heritage agency) maintains a list of heritage places (Rārangī Kōrero), identifying and providing information on significant heritage places throughout New Zealand. Being on this list does not mean protection, but most places (89%) listed by HNZPT in Auckland are protected in the Auckland Unitary Plan (AUP).¹³⁴ In Auckland there are:

- 162 Category 1 listed heritage places (99% protected by the AUP).
- 380 Category 2 listed heritage places (85% protected by the AUP).

¹³⁴ Auckland Council, "Auckland's Heritage Counts: Annual Summary 2021" (Auckland: Auckland Council, 2021).



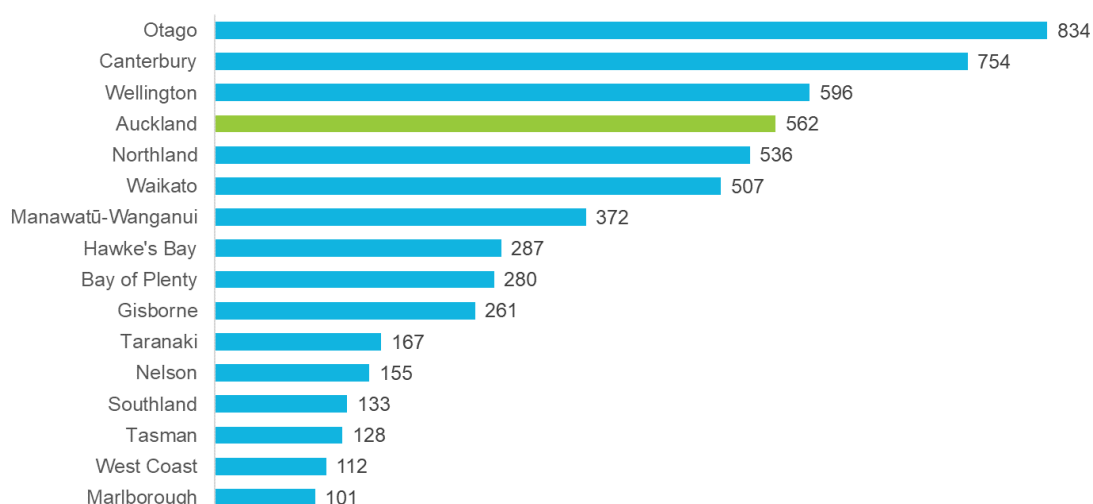
- 11 listed historic areas (73% protected by the AUP).
- 4 wāhi tapu (100% protected by the AUP).
- 4 wāhi tapu areas (33% protected by the AUP).
- 1 wāhi tupuna / tipuna.

There are also 34 private properties in Auckland that are protected under HNZPT covenants.

Auckland has a high number of places on the heritage list compared with other New Zealand areas, with Otago recording the most number of places on the heritage list. As of December 2021, there were 562 listed places in Auckland (Figure 142). Anyone can apply to have a place or area considered for entry on the list. The number of places on the list will be a function of who applies, applications accepted, land area and heritage nature of the region.

However, if listed places are isolated to wāhi tapu, wāhi tapu areas and wāhi tūpuna, Waikato has the most of these types of listed places (Figure 143).

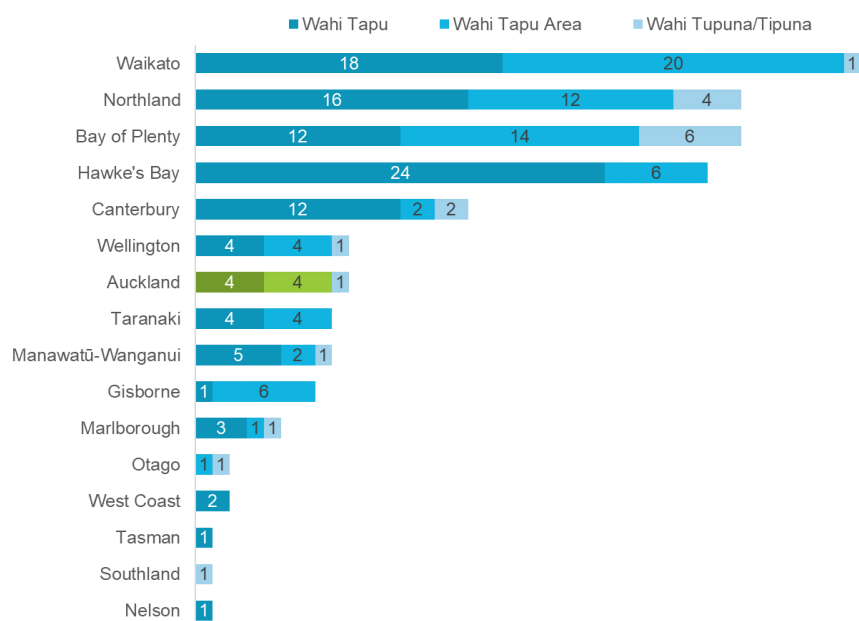
Figure 142. Number of listed places, region, as at December 2021



Source: New Zealand Heritage List/Rārangī Kōrero ('the List')

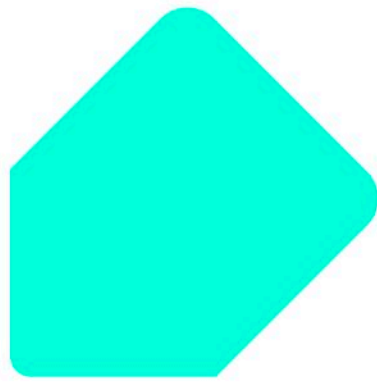
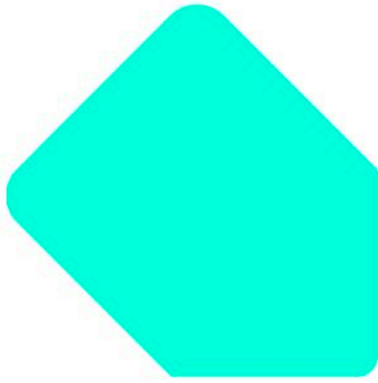


Figure 143. Number of wāhi tapu, wāhi tapu areas and wāhi tūpuna, regions, as at December 2021

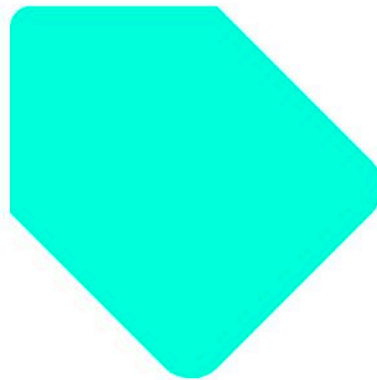
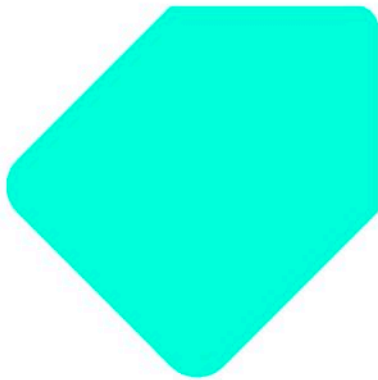


Source: New Zealand Heritage List/Rārangi Kōrero ('the List')





ECONOMIC CAPITAL



ECONOMY AND INDUSTRIAL STRUCTURE

Having a job that matches one's aspirations and competencies, and that pays adequate earnings is a universal aspiration of people.

Summary

Auckland plays an important economic role for New Zealand, accounting for close to 40% of New Zealand's gross domestic product (GDP) and over a third of employment. It has 35% of all businesses and 61% of the top 200 companies. Its economic performance has been mixed – achieving strong outcomes in terms of value add and incomes but more limited employment outcomes, particularly for some populations.

Auckland's GDP has grown more strongly than New Zealand's over the last decade. GDP per capita is relatively high and is around 12% higher than the New Zealand average. GDP per capita growth has been one of the highest of all regions over the last decade. Auckland's median hourly earnings is currently the second highest of all regions but earnings growth has been below most other New Zealand regions.

Auckland's GDP per capita is below the OECD average and comparable cities internationally but the gap with most cities has been shrinking. Over 2008 to 2018, Auckland's GDP per capita overtook Adelaide's and caught up to Melbourne's.

Although employment growth has been relatively strong, Auckland's employment and labour force participation rates have tended to be below New Zealand's and other major-urban regions over time. Similarly, Auckland's unemployment rate has tended to be higher than New Zealand's. Auckland's unemployment rate for 2021 was 5.1%, above the New Zealand rate of 4.7% and higher than many other regions. Auckland youth NEET rate of 13.8% was also about the New Zealand rate of 12.5%. Conversely, Auckland's under-utilisation rate of 11.7% was slightly below the New Zealand rate of 11.9% and one of the lowest of all regions. COVID-19 has adversely impacted labour market outcomes in Auckland over 2020 and 2021.

Labour market outcomes in Auckland vary significantly across ethnicity and location, and these play an important part in explaining Auckland's relativities to New Zealand. In particular, a significant population of Pacific people in Auckland have lower labour participation rates, lower employment rates, higher unemployment rates, and higher NEET rates, than other major ethnic group in Auckland, and compared to Pacific peoples across New Zealand. Māori in Auckland also have lower labour

Regional GDP	H	▲
Hourly earnings	H	▲
Employment rate	M	▼
Unemployment rate	H	▲
Under-utilisation rate	L	▲
NEET rate	H	▲
Industry GDP	Varies across industries	
Ease of doing business	N	▲
Māori asset and enterprise base	No comparable data available	



participation rates, and higher unemployment and NEET rates. These outcomes are also more heavily concentrated in South and West Auckland, reflecting the larger populations of Pacific people and Māori in those areas.

Auckland's industry-mix is different from other regions in New Zealand. Relative to national employment shares and growth, strong performers in Auckland are knowledge intensive service sectors such as financial and insurance services, administrative services, information media and telecommunications, and professional and technical services. However, an increasing proportion of businesses over time consider it is getting harder to be successful in Auckland. Although COVID-19 will have been a contributor to this sentiment, traffic congestion and recruiting labour are the main barriers report to businesses operating in Auckland.

Close to 20% of the Māori asset base and Māori enterprises can be found in Tāmaki Makaurau. The rohe has a significant proportion of Māori assets and enterprise in knowledge-intensive industries such as information media and telecommunications (for example, 50% of the value of Aotearoa's Māori assets), wholesale trade (44%), professional and technical services, construction services and financial and insurance services. This provides a strong base for growing enterprise and labour market opportunities for Māori and the region in future. In general, the economic growth of the past fifteen years has gone in hand with an increase in employment and earnings in urban-regions like Auckland, but these are being put to serious test by COVID-19 and having a job seems to provide less of a shield against the risk of poverty than it did in the past.

A quick overview

In 2020, the Auckland economy generated \$122.56 billion¹³⁵ in regional GDP. In 2021 it employed around 922,300 people. Auckland accounts for around 38% of New Zealand's GDP and 34% of employment.

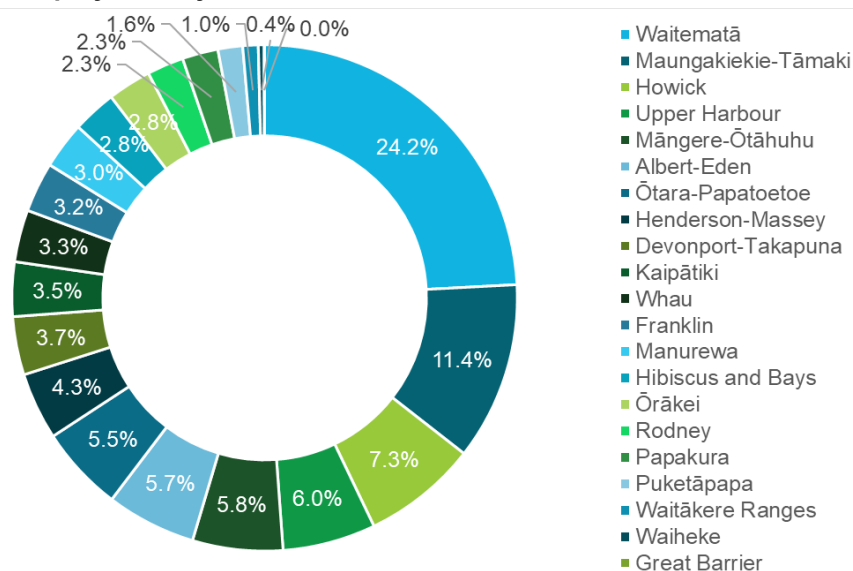
Waitematā is estimated to make the largest contribution to employment in Auckland, at around 24% of persons employed, followed by Maungakiekie-Tāmaki (11%) and Howick (7%) (Figure 144).

Auckland's GDP and employment are well distributed over a large number of sectors. Professional and technical services, manufacturing, financial and insurance services, and rental and real estate services together make up 39% of the value of output (Figure 145). Wholesale trade, information media and telecommunications, construction, owner-occupied property operation, and health care and social assistance each contribute 6-7% of Auckland's GDP. Professional, scientific & technical services, construction, manufacturing, health care & social services and retail trade contribute 48% of jobs (Figure 146).

¹³⁵ In current prices.



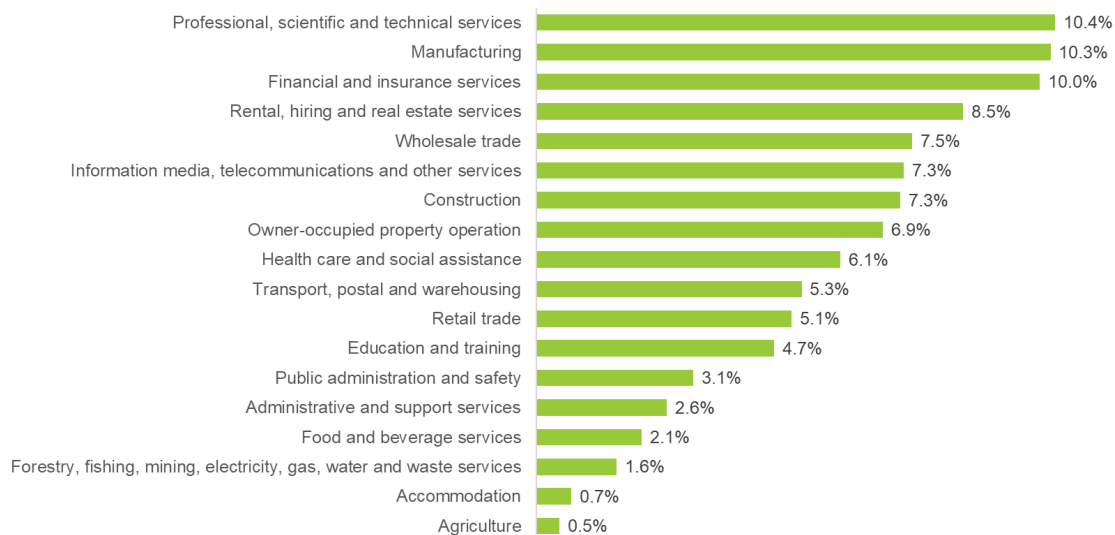
Figure 144. Employment by Auckland local board area, 2020



Source: Infometrics Auckland Economic Profile and Regional Industry Employment Model.

Note: Employment is the average of the four quarters making up the year (year ended March). The model is based on the quarterly and annual Linked Employer Employee Data (LEED) from Stats NZ. Employment includes employees and the self-employed.

Figure 145. Contribution of industries to Auckland's GDP, 2019

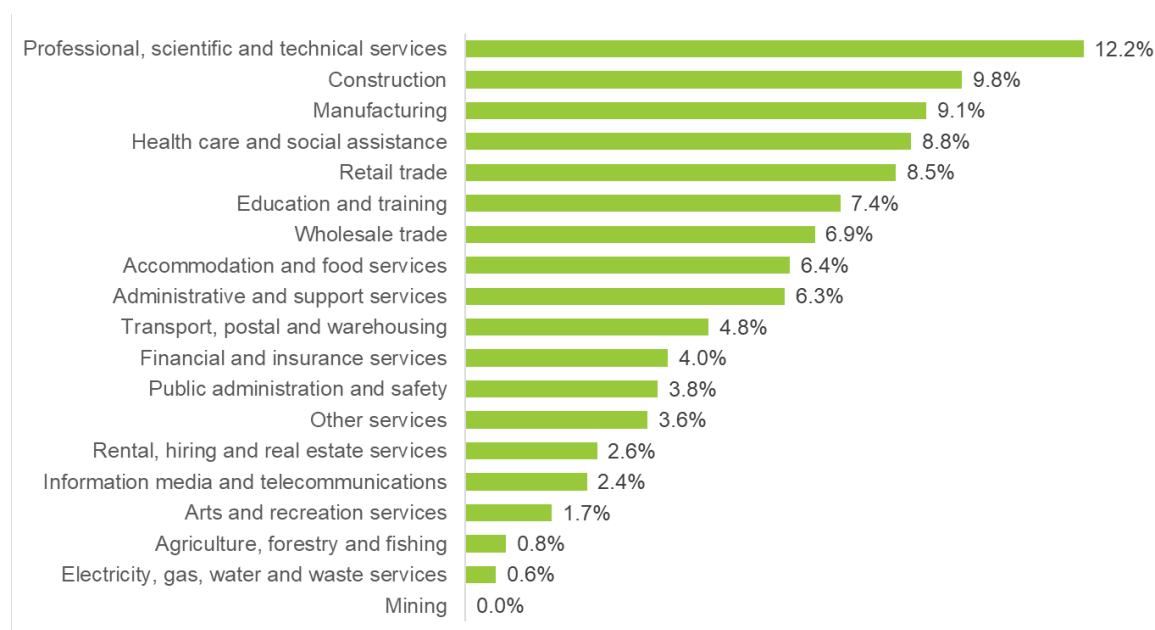


Source: MBIE Regional Activity Data Tool, derived from Stats NZ Regional GDP and MBIE Modelled Territorial Authority GDP

Note: March year



Figure 146. Contribution of industries to Auckland's employment, 2020



Source: Infometrics Auckland Economic Profile and Regional Industry Employment Model

Note: March year

Auckland accounts for around 38% of New Zealand's GDP, and has had strong growth relative to other regions

Gross domestic product (GDP), or the total value added from goods and services produced, is an important indicator of economic activity and provides one indicator of the level of prosperity in Auckland. The region has been performing above national averages on several indicators of value added.

Auckland's GDP grew moderately over 2009-2014, during and following the global financial crisis (Figure 147). Growth accelerated after 2015, with Auckland's GDP growth slightly exceeding national growth since 2016.

The value of the economy is estimated to have been growing at 6.7% per year over the last five years in nominal terms compared with 5.9% nationally and at 6.0% per year over the last decade compared to 5.2% nationally. From 2010 to 2020, Auckland's GDP increased from \$68.46 billion to \$122.56 billion, an increase of \$54.10 billion, which represented 42% of the increase in national GDP over the period.

Auckland's GDP has grown more strongly than New Zealand's over a 10 and 5 year period. Auckland's annual average GDP growth has surpassed all regions other than Bay of Plenty over the last decade and all regions other than Bay of Plenty and Tasman/Nelson over the last five years (Figure 148).



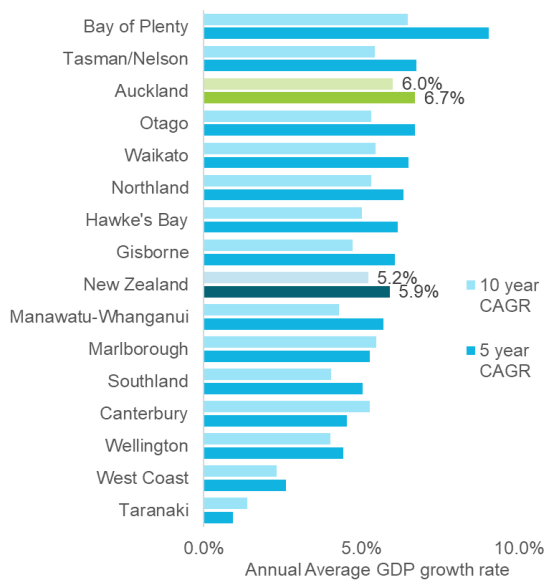
The strong GDP growth has been driven by growth in construction, real estate services and significant knowledge-intensive sectors in Auckland, such as financial services, professional and technical services, and information media and telecommunications (discussed later in this section).

Figure 147. GDP growth, Auckland and New Zealand, 2006–2020



Source: MartinJenkins calculations based on Stats NZ Regional GDP
 Note: March years, current prices

Figure 148. GDP growth, Auckland compared to New Zealand and other regions, 2010-2020 and 2015-2020



Source: MartinJenkins calculations based on Stats NZ Regional GDP
 Note: GDP growth in current prices

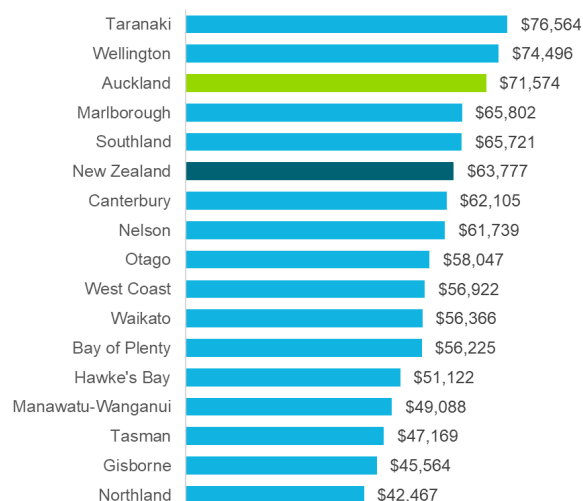
In relation to New Zealand regions, Auckland’s GDP per capita is relatively high and has been growing strongly over the last 10 years.

Auckland’s GDP per capita in 2020 was relatively high at around \$71,600, only lower than Wellington and Taranaki, and well above the New Zealand average of \$63,800 (Figure 149).

From 2006 and prior to the GFC, Auckland’s GDP per capita was between 8% to 12% higher than New Zealand’s average. This margin fell sharply over the GFC and remained at around 5%-6% higher than the New Zealand average over 2009-2015 (Figure 150). The margin rebounded strongly over 2015-2016 and has remained around 12% higher since 2017.



Figure 149. GDP per capita, Auckland compared to New Zealand and other regions, 2020



Source: MBIE Regional Activity Data Tool, derived from Stats NZ Regional GDP and MBIE Modelled Territorial Authority GDP

Note: March years

Figure 150. GDP per capita, Auckland as a proportion of the rest of New Zealand, 2006–2020

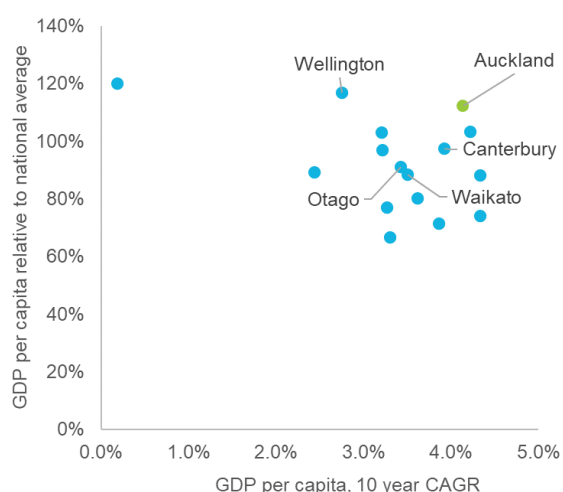


Source: MBIE Regional Activity Data Tool, derived from Stats NZ Regional GDP and MBIE Modelled Territorial Authority GDP

Note: March years

Not only is Auckland above the national average for GDP per capita but GDP per capita growth over 2010–2020 has been one of the highest of all regions (Figure 151). Over this period, GDP per capita growth was 4.1% per year, just below growth achieved in Bay of Plenty, Tasman and Marlborough.

Figure 151. GDP per capita by region (2020) and growth (2010–2020)



Source: MartinJenkins calculations based on Stats NZ Regional GDP and MBIE Regional Activity Data.

Note: GDP growth in current prices

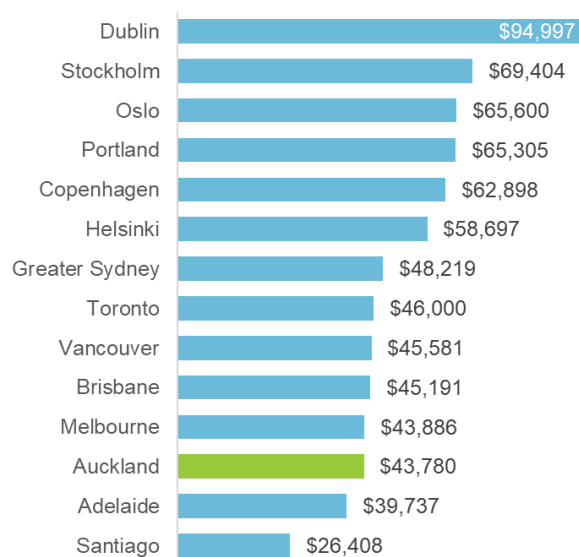


There has been a major change in Auckland's relative position over the decade. The previous Auckland Story in 2017 noted that Auckland had been the worst performing region on GDP per capita growth over the long-term and this was largely due to Auckland's population growth exceeding the rest of New Zealand's. However, over 2015 to 2020, Auckland's GDP grew relatively strongly but its population growth largely tracked New Zealand's, leading to strong growth in GDP per capita. There was slower population growth as outward migration from Auckland increased and international migration declined.

Auckland's GDP per capita lags behind the OECD average but is catching up

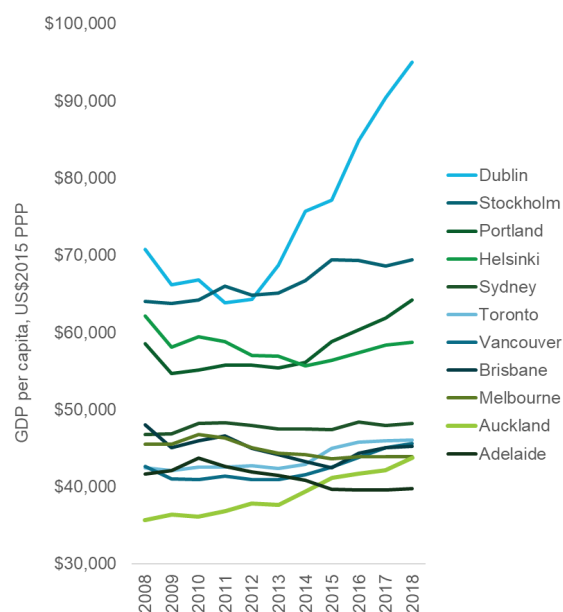
Internationally, Auckland's current GDP per capita is below the OECD average and comparable cities internationally (Figure 152), although the level is similar to several other smaller international cities such as Adelaide, Melbourne, Brisbane and Vancouver.

Figure 152. GDP per capita of selected cities, 2018, \$2015 US ppp



Source: OECD Regions and Cities data, OECD.Stat

Figure 153. GDP per capita of selected cities, 2008-2018, \$2015 US ppp



Source: OECD Regions and Cities data, OECD.Stat

However, Auckland has been catching up, particularly over 2013 to 2018 (Figure 153). Auckland's GDP per capita growth rate over that period was higher than almost all comparable international cities other than Dublin. Auckland's GDP per capita leap-frogged Adelaide's over the period and the gap between Auckland and close competitor cities reduced significantly in some cases. For example, the difference in GDP per capita between Melbourne and Auckland fell from more than \$US 9,800 in 2008 to just over \$US 100 in 2018. The difference between Brisbane and Auckland fell from close to \$US 12,400 to around \$US 1,400.



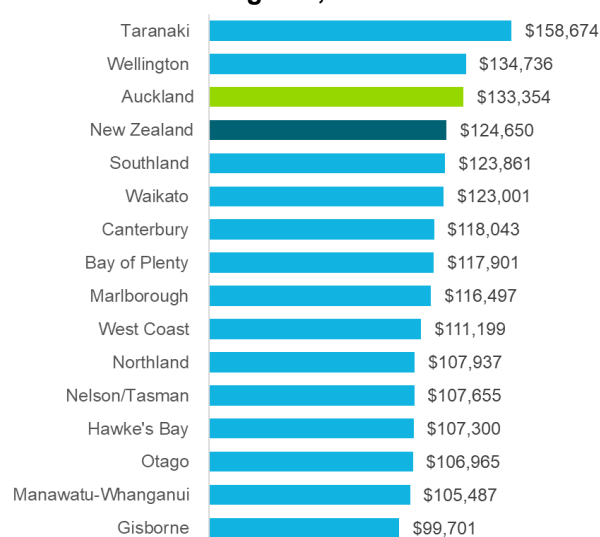
There has been high labour productivity and labour productivity growth in Auckland. Auckland firms attract a labour productivity premium, much higher than other urban areas

Labour productivity is a direct contributor to gross value add, and Auckland's growth and wellbeing. GDP per employee provides a rough approximation of labour productivity (it is typically measured by the value of output per hour worked).

Compared to other regions, Auckland's GDP per employee in 2020 was high at \$133,350 and above the New Zealand average of \$124,650 (Figure 153). Only Taranaki (due to the high productivity mining and utilities industries) and Wellington have higher estimated productivity.

Auckland's GDP per employee growth performance over 2010 to 2020, and 2015 to 2020, has been around the middle of New Zealand regions at 3.6% per year and 3.3% per year respectively (Figure 154). However, this is stronger productivity growth than that achieved in several other urban-regions (for example, Wellington, Canterbury, Otago) and was only slightly below growth achieved in Waikato. Provincial areas have achieved the strongest growth in GDP per employee.

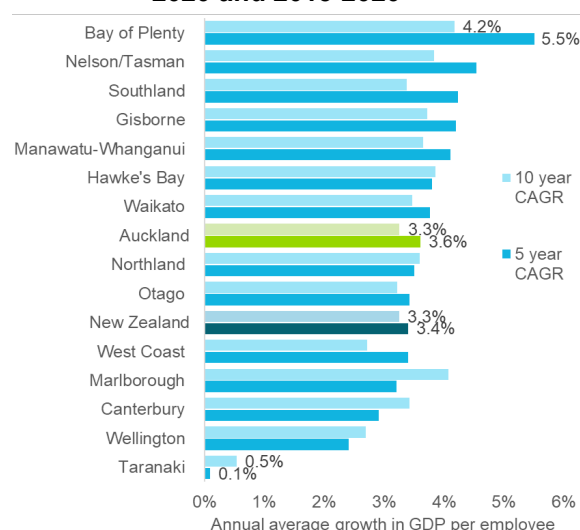
Figure 154. GDP per employee, Auckland compared to New Zealand and other regions, 2020



Source: GDP data from Stats NZ regional GDP statistics; employment data from Infometrics Auckland economic profile.

Note: March year.

Figure 155. Growth in GDP per employee, Auckland compared to New Zealand and other regions, 2010-2020 and 2015-2020



Source: MartinJenkins calculations based on GDP data from Stats NZ regional GDP statistics; employment data from Infometrics Auckland economic profile.

Note: March years; current prices



The last research on Auckland’s productivity premium over other New Zealand cities was in 2016.¹³⁶ That study found that Auckland firms had labour productivity that was 17.9% higher than that of firms in other urban areas. Some of this premium was due to Auckland having a disproportionately high share of employment in industries that have above average labour productivity. Adjusting for this indicated that Auckland had a productivity premium of 13.5% relative to other urban areas. The research estimated that 5.7% of this could be attributed to the higher quality of Auckland workers and 5.6% could be attributed to the greater quantity of other inputs used by Auckland.¹³⁷

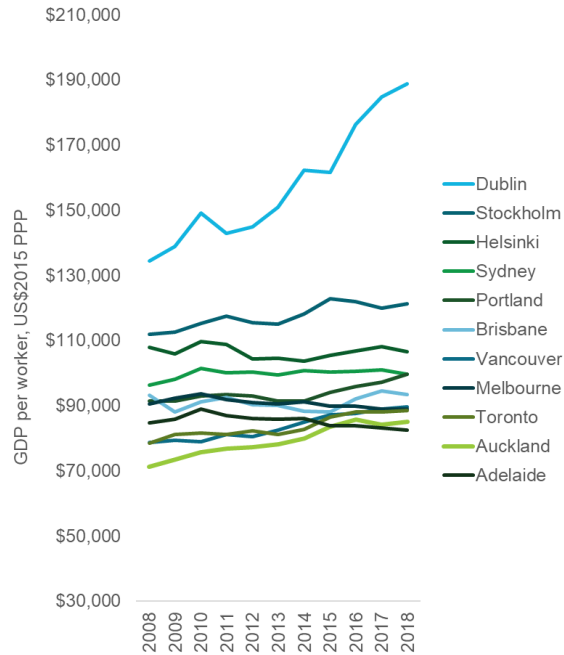
Internationally, Auckland’s GDP per worker is below the OECD average and most comparable cities internationally (Figure 152), although it has been catching up to several cities and has overtaken Adelaide (Figure 157). Over 2013 to 2018, Auckland’s growth in GDP per worker was higher than growth in Adelaide, Melbourne and Brisbane and about the same as growth in Toronto, Vancouver and Portland. Across comparable cities, only Dublin achieved very strong growth in GDP per worker over the five years.

Figure 156. GDP per worker of selected cities, 2018, \$2015 US ppp



Source: OECD Regions and Cities data, OECD.Stat

Figure 157. GDP per worker of selected cities, 2008-2018, \$2015 US ppp



Source: OECD Regions and Cities data, OECD.Stat

¹³⁶ David C Maré, “Urban Productivity Estimation with Heterogeneous Prices and Labour,” Motu Working Paper (Motu Economic and Public Policy Research, 2016).

¹³⁷ Maré.



Auckland's median hourly earnings have increased steadily over the last 15 years, consistently about 5% higher than the New Zealand median

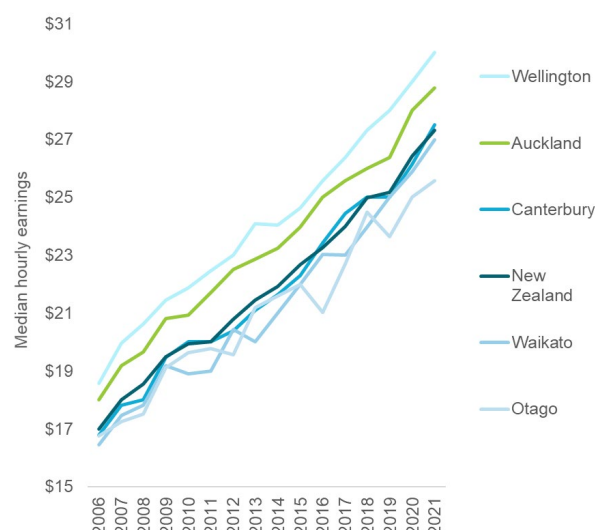
Earnings are a good measure of wellbeing because they capture what people receive out of the value generated in an economy. Median earnings, in particular, is a preferred measure because it shows what the “typical” person or household receives in a region and is not affected by extremes. It is indicative of people’s ability to pay for products and services.

Auckland’s median hourly earnings have tracked relatively steadily upwards over the last 15 years, consistently being around 5%-6% higher than the New Zealand median (Figure 156).



The median hourly earnings in Auckland in 2021 was \$28.80, above the New Zealand median of \$27.30. This level was the second highest of all New Zealand regions (Figure 157), with only the Wellington median of \$30 per hour surpassing Auckland, which will likely reflect the high proportion of relatively well-paid public servants in Wellington. However, Auckland's annualised growth in median hourly earnings has been below New Zealand average growth rate over the last five years (2.8% per year compared to 3.3% per year) and below most other New Zealand regions (Figure 158). Other major urban-regions have also experienced relatively low growth in median hourly earnings over the last five years.

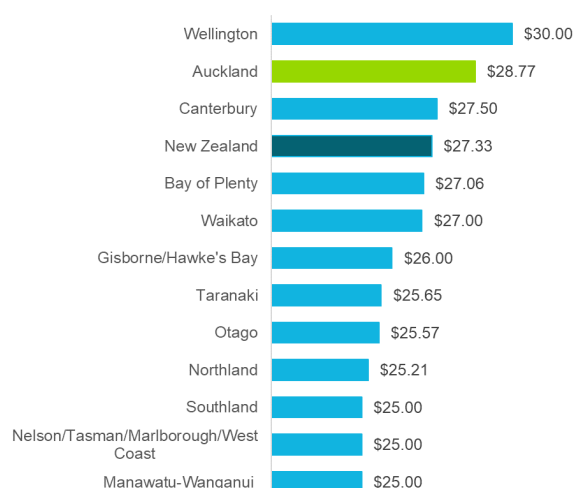
Figure 158. Median hourly earnings, Auckland compared to New Zealand and other major urban-regions, 2006 – 2021



Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey.

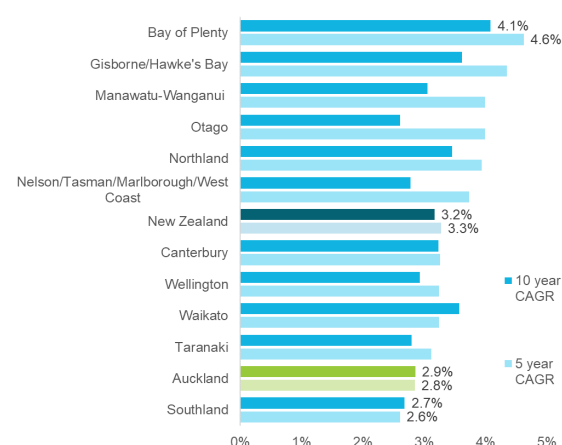
Note: Earnings are for those in paid employment (including self-employment)

Figure 159. Median hourly earnings in Auckland compared to New Zealand and other regions, 2021



Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey

Figure 160. Annual average growth in median hourly earnings, Auckland compared to New Zealand and other regions, 2011-2021 and 2016-2021



Source: MartinJenkins calculations based on Stats NZ Household Labour Force Survey

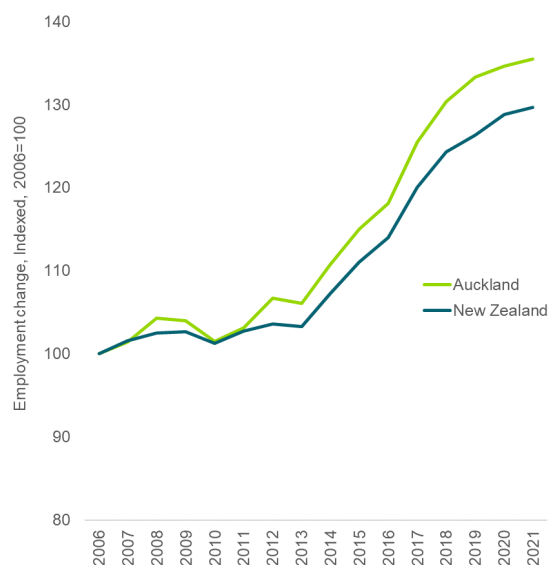


Auckland's employment growth has exceeded most other major urban regions in New Zealand over the last five years

Under-employment and unemployment will limit the performance of Auckland and undermine the quality of life of its residents.

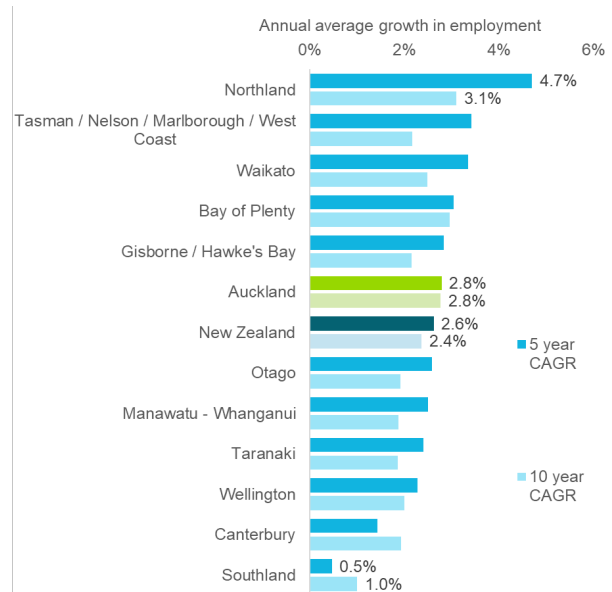
As noted earlier, the number of employed persons in Auckland was close to 922,000 in 2021. The change in the number employed in Auckland has followed a similar, but accelerated trajectory, to change across New Zealand (Figure 159). There was limited growth to a slight decline in jobs during the global financial crisis (2008-2010), followed by further limited growth in the following years, before stronger growth resumed over 2013-2015 and accelerated over 2016-2018. Job growth has again been more limited since 2019, undoubtedly reflecting the impacts of COVID-19.

Figure 161. Employment change, Auckland and New Zealand, 2006 – 2021



Source: Infometrics Auckland economic profile

Figure 162. Growth in employment, Auckland compared to New Zealand and other regions, 2011-2021 and 2016-2021



Source: MartinJenkins calculations based on employment data from Infometrics Auckland economic profile

In compound annual terms, employment in Auckland has grown an average of 2.8% per year over the last decade (an increase of 220,300 employed over the period) and 2.8% per year over the last five years (an increase of 118,300 employed over the period). This represents comparatively strong growth over 10 years – across New Zealand, employment increased by 2.4% over 2011-2021 and only the Bay of Plenty and Northland achieved stronger employment growth than Auckland over the



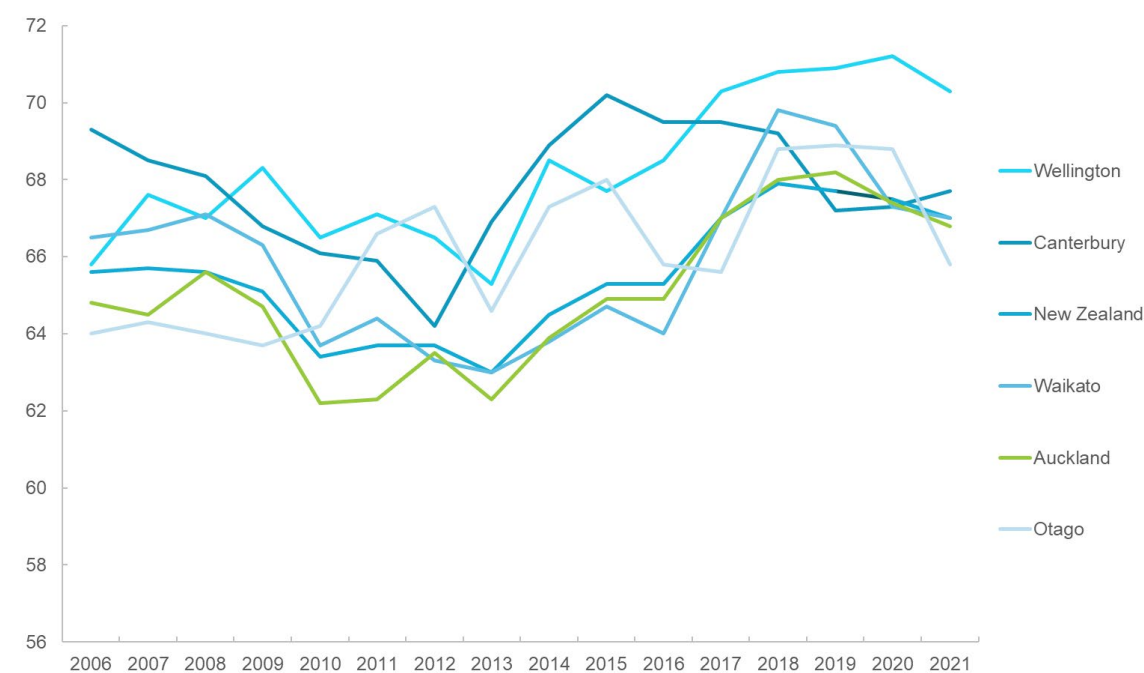
period (Figure 160). Auckland's employment growth has exceeded most other major urban regions in New Zealand, with the exception of Waikato, over the last five years.

Auckland's growth in employment over 2011-2021 represents around 39% of employment growth across New Zealand.

Auckland's employment and labour force participation rates are broadly at the New Zealand average, but there are large variations between ethnic groups

Auckland's employment rate (the proportion of working age people 15 years and over who are employed) has tended to be below New Zealand's over time, and often well below several other major urban-regions in New Zealand (Figure 161). The employment rate fell during the GFC and remained at relatively low levels before improving from 2013 (with a particularly steep increase over 2016 and 2017). From 2019 the employment rate in Auckland has fallen again, reflecting the impact of COVID-19 (which has seen employment rates fall in most urban regions across New Zealand).

Figure 163. Employment rate, Auckland compared to New Zealand and other major urban-regions, 2006–2021



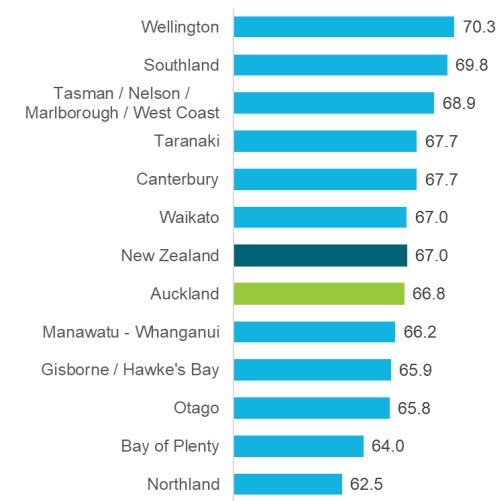
Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey

In 2021, Auckland's employment rate, at 66.8% was just below the New Zealand rate of 67%, and below employment rates in Wellington, Canterbury and Waikato (Figure 162).



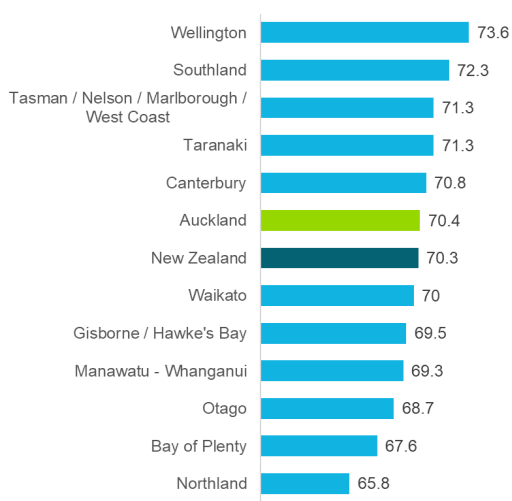
Auckland’s labour force participation rate (the proportion of working age people 15 years and over that are either employed or actively looking for work) of 70.4% in 2021 was very close to the New Zealand rate and around the middle of New Zealand’s regions (Figure 163).

Figure 164. Employment rate (%), Auckland compared to New Zealand and other regions, 2021



Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey

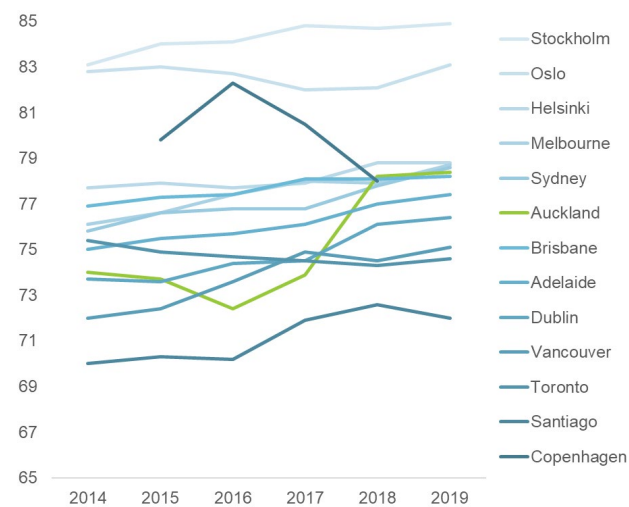
Figure 165. Labour force participation rate (%), Auckland compared to New Zealand and other regions, 2020



Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey

Internationally, Auckland’s labour force participation rate has previously tended to be relatively low but has increased in recent years and by 2019 was sitting around the middle of comparable cities (Figure 164).

Figure 166. Labour force participation rate, selected cities, 2014 to 2019



Source: OECD.Stat, OECD Regions and Cities



Employment rates and participation rates differ across ethnic groups in Auckland, as they do nationally. Major differences between Auckland and New Zealand as a whole across ethnicities are the much lower employment and labour participation rates of Pacific peoples in Auckland, and the lower labour participation rate of Māori in Auckland. In 2021, the employment rate of Pacific peoples in Auckland was 56.8% compared to 60.3% for Pacific people in New Zealand, which was also well below the rate for European people (68.8%) and Asian people (69.8%) in Auckland (Figure 165). The labour force participation rate of Pacific people in Auckland was 62.5% compared to 66.3% for Pacific people in New Zealand, again well below the labour participation rates of European people (71.5%) and Asian people (73.6%) in Auckland (Figure 166).

Figure 167. Employment rates (%) across ethnic groups, Auckland and New Zealand, 2021



Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey

Figure 168. Labour participation rates across ethnic groups, Auckland and New Zealand, 2021



Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey

Unemployment rates in Auckland tend to be just higher than the national rate, while labour underutilisation tends to be just under. Again there is variability at the ethnic group level

Unemployment represents unfulfilled potential in Auckland. The underutilisation rate gives a broader measure of this untapped capacity and represents a combination of the unemployed, those employed part-time but who want to increase the number of hours they work, those available to work but not currently looking for a job, and those currently unavailable to start work but who will be available in the next month.

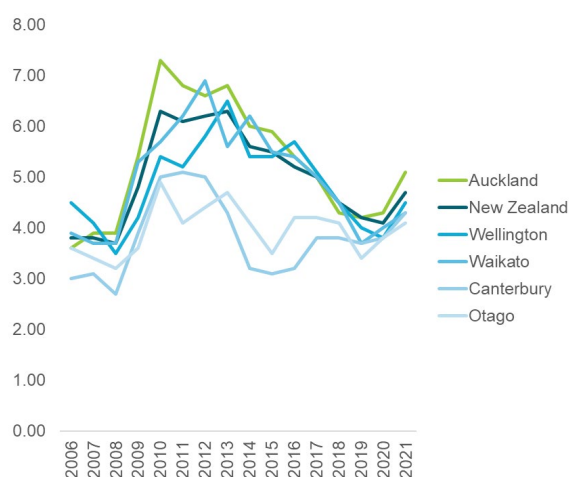
Auckland's unemployment rate has tended to be higher than the New Zealand rate and other major urban regions (other than for short periods). It increased significantly over the period of the GFC to reach a peak of 7.3% in 2010 and remained high for a few years before declining steadily between



2013 and 2019, reaching a low of 4.2% in 2019 (Figure 167). Unemployment has increased over 2020-2021 as a result of COVID-19.

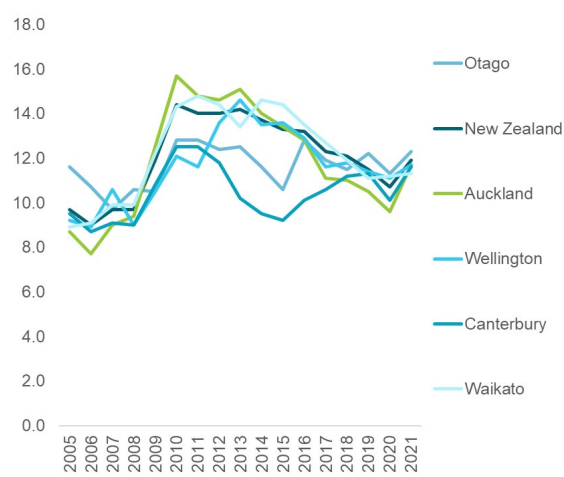
Auckland underutilisation rate has followed a similar trajectory, reaching a peak of 15.7% in 2010 and then declining over 2013-2019 to reach a low of 9.6% in 2020 (Figure 168). It has increased over the 2021 year. Waikato, Wellington and Otago had higher rates of underutilisation than Auckland over 2016-2020. Canterbury has experienced higher underutilisation than Auckland over 2018-2021.

Figure 169. Auckland's annual unemployment rate compared to New Zealand and major urban-regions, 2006–2021



Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey

Figure 170. Auckland's labour underutilisation rate compared to New Zealand and major urban-regions, 2005–2021

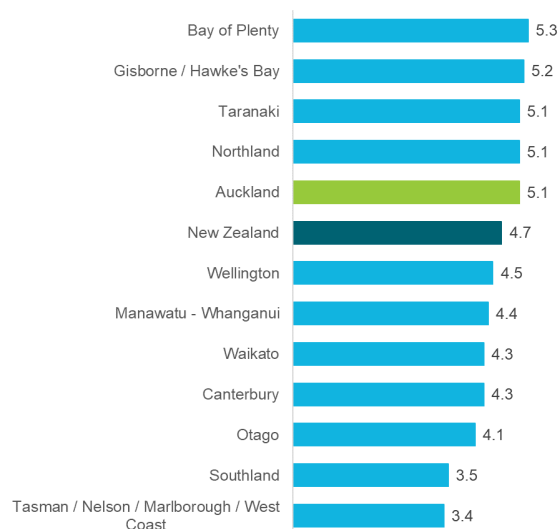


Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey

Auckland's unemployment rate in 2021 at 5.1% was above the New Zealand rate of 4.7% and was higher than many other regions (other than Northland, Taranaki, Gisborne/Hawke's Bay and Bay of Plenty) (Figure 169). Conversely, Auckland's underutilisation rate in 2021 of 11.7% was slightly below the New Zealand rate of 11.9% and one of the lowest of all regions (only Canterbury and the Waikato had lower rates) (Figure 170).

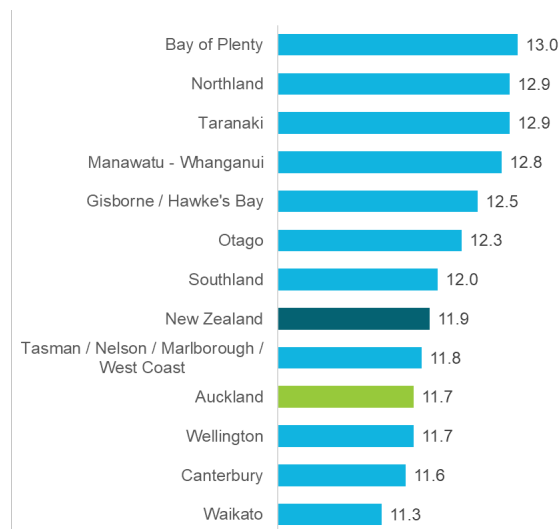


Figure 171. Unemployment rate, Auckland compared to New Zealand and other regions, 2021



Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey

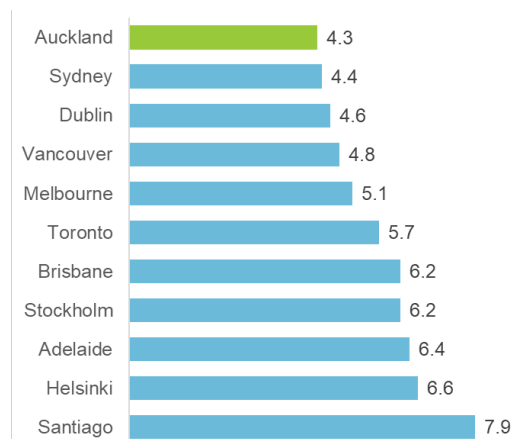
Figure 172. Labour underutilisation rate, Auckland compared to New Zealand and other regions, 2021



Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey

Auckland's unemployment rate is lower than all internationally comparable city-regions. In 2019, it had the lowest unemployment rate (4.3%) of comparable cities for which data was available (Figure 173). Santiago's was highest (7.9%), followed by Helsinki (6.6%).

Figure 173. Unemployment rate in selected cities, 2019



Source: OECD.Stat, OECD Regions and Cities

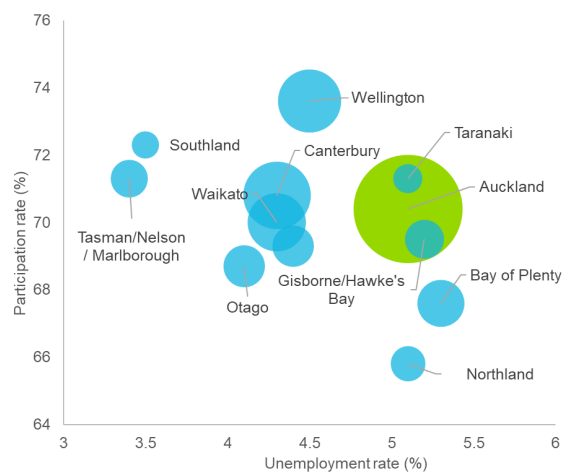
Auckland's position relative to other New Zealand regions in 2021 on a combination of unemployment and labour participation is shown in Figure 172. Due to its large employment contribution, Auckland's position at the higher end of regions on unemployment and towards the middle of regions on labour participation is a significant contributor to New Zealand's labour market performance.



Unemployment and underutilisation also vary considerably across ethnicities. In 2021, the unemployment rate for Māori in Auckland was 8.6% and for Pacific people was 9.2%, compared to 3.9% for European and 5.2% for Asian.

Figure 173 illustrates the significance of ethnic differences in unemployment and labour participation in Auckland, with Pacific people and Māori experiencing higher levels of unemployment and labour participation compared to European and Asian people.

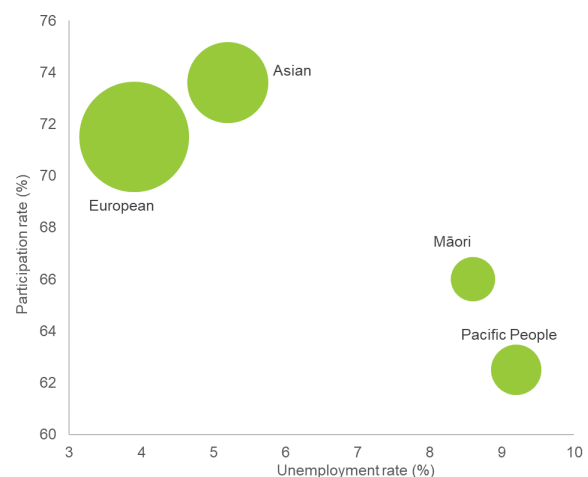
Figure 174. Labour participation, unemployment and employment size by region, 2021



Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey and Infometrics regional economic profile.

Note: Size of bubbles represents employment size

Figure 175. Labour participation, unemployment and employment size by ethnic groups, Auckland, 2021



Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey and Infometrics regional economic profile.

Note: Size of bubbles represents employment size

Auckland's youth not in education and employment (NEET) rate tends to be below New Zealand's, but rose over 2019-2021 as youth were disproportionately impacted by COVID-19

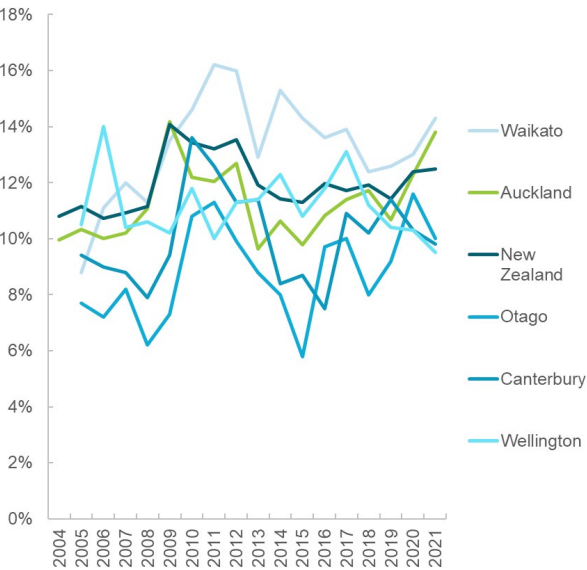
Youth exclusion, disengagement, and overall underutilisation in the labour market have costs both to the individual, and the economy or society at large. The youth NEET rate measures non-utilised youth labour potential and young people who are at risk of becoming disadvantaged or marginalised in the future. Youth are defined as being between 15 and 24 years old.

Auckland's NEET rate has tended to be below the New Zealand NEET rate over time and in the middle of major urban regions in New Zealand. It reached a peak during the GFC of 14.2% in 2009, before declining to a low of around 10% over 2013 to 2015, and has climbed again since then (Figure 174). There has been a rapid increase in Auckland's NEET rate over 2019-2021.



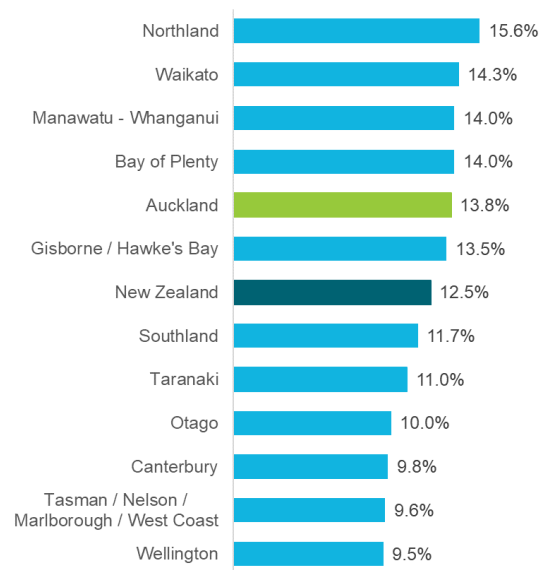
In 2021 Auckland’s annual average NEET rate was 13.8%, above the New Zealand rate of 12.5% (Figure 175). Auckland’s rate is in the top third of New Zealand regions, only below Bay of Plenty, Manawatū-Wanganui, Waikato and Northland.

Figure 176. Youth NEET rate, Auckland compared to New Zealand and major urban-regions, 2006–2021



Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey

Figure 177. Auckland’s annual average NEET rate compared to New Zealand and other regions, 2021



Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey

There are wide variations in youth NEET rates by ethnicity and location

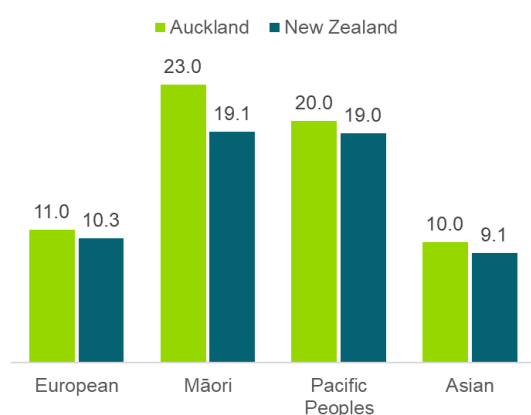
Ethnic differences play an important part in Auckland’s NEET rate. The NEET rate for Māori and Pacific people is significantly higher than for European and Asian people. Auckland’s Māori NEET rate of 23% in 2021 was also well above the New Zealand rate of 19.1%, with the NEET rates for the other major ethnic groups in Auckland being only slightly higher than the relevant national rates (Figure 176).

Within Auckland, northern and central areas tend to have lower youth NEET rates than those to the south and west (Figure 177). Papakura and Manurewa had the highest NEET rates in 2021 (over 21%), whereas Hibiscus and Bays, Albert Eden, Howick and Ōrākei had the lowest NEET rates (10%



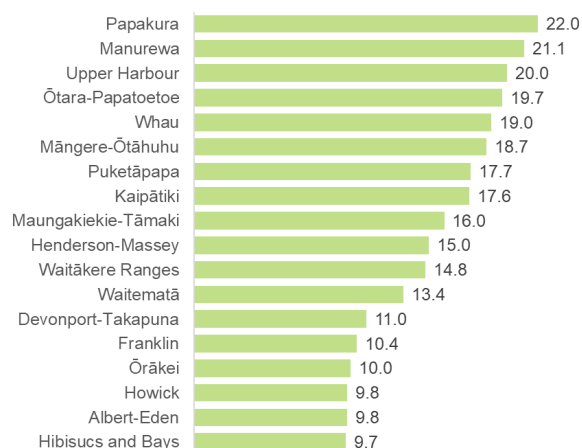
or less). The area covered by the Western Initiative¹³⁸ had a NEET rate of 15% and the Southern Initiative¹³⁹ area had a NEET rate of 20.3% compared to 11.6% in the rest of Auckland.¹⁴⁰

Figure 178. Annual average NEET rates by major ethnic groups, Auckland and New Zealand, 2021



Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey

Figure 179. Annual average NEET rates, Auckland local board areas, 2021



Source: Stats NZ, Household Labour Force Survey

¹³⁸ The Western Initiative was launched in 2018 and is an Auckland Council innovation unit which aims to improve the prosperity of west Auckland communities, including reducing youth unemployment. It supports businesses to generate quality jobs and supports west Aucklanders into those career opportunities.

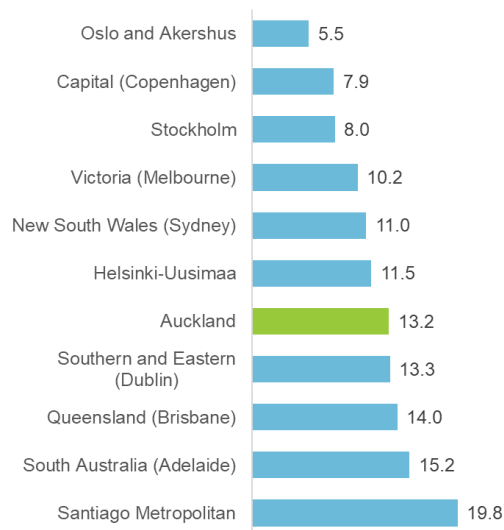
¹³⁹ The Southern Initiative (TSI) is a place-based initiative that stimulates, enables and champions social and community innovation across the Local Board areas of Papakura, Manurewa, Ōtara-Papatoetoe, and Māngere-Ōtāhuhu. As a part of Auckland Council, TSI works to find radical solutions to some of South Auckland's most pressing social and economic challenges.

¹⁴⁰ Ting Huang, "Youth Not in Employment, Education or Training (NEET) in Auckland: Trends June 2011 to June 2021" (Auckland Council Research and Evaluation Unit, RIMU, 2021), <https://knowledgeauckland.org.nz/publications/youth-not-in-employment-education-or-training-neet-in-auckland-trends-june-2011-to-june-2021/>.



Internationally, Auckland sits about the midpoint of comparable regions. In 2017, Auckland's youth NEET rate was 13.2% while it was 19.8% in Santiago, but 5.5% in Oslo (Figure 178).

Figure 180. Youth NEET rate, comparable international regions, 2017



Source: OECD.Stat, Regions and Cities

Note: OECD classifies the geographic units in this chart as large regions (territorial level 2 or TL2) to help in assessing differences in socio-economic trends in regions, both within and across countries

Auckland has a different industrial mix to the rest of the country. It has relatively large professional and technical services, wholesale trade, transport and warehousing, financial and insurance services, and information media and telecommunications sectors

Auckland has 35% of all businesses in New Zealand and 38% of businesses with 100 plus staff¹⁴¹, has 61% of the top 200 companies¹⁴² and is the departure point for 18% of the value of exports.¹⁴³

Auckland has a different industrial mix to the rest of the New Zealand (Figure 179). It has a small agriculture, forestry and fishing sector (representing less than 1% of Auckland employment compared to close to 8% of employment outside of Auckland) and a relatively small health care and social assistance sector (8.8% of employment compared to 10.4% outside of Auckland) and public administration sector (3.8% of employment compared to 5.8% outside of Auckland). It has relatively

¹⁴¹ Stats NZ Business Demography Statistics.

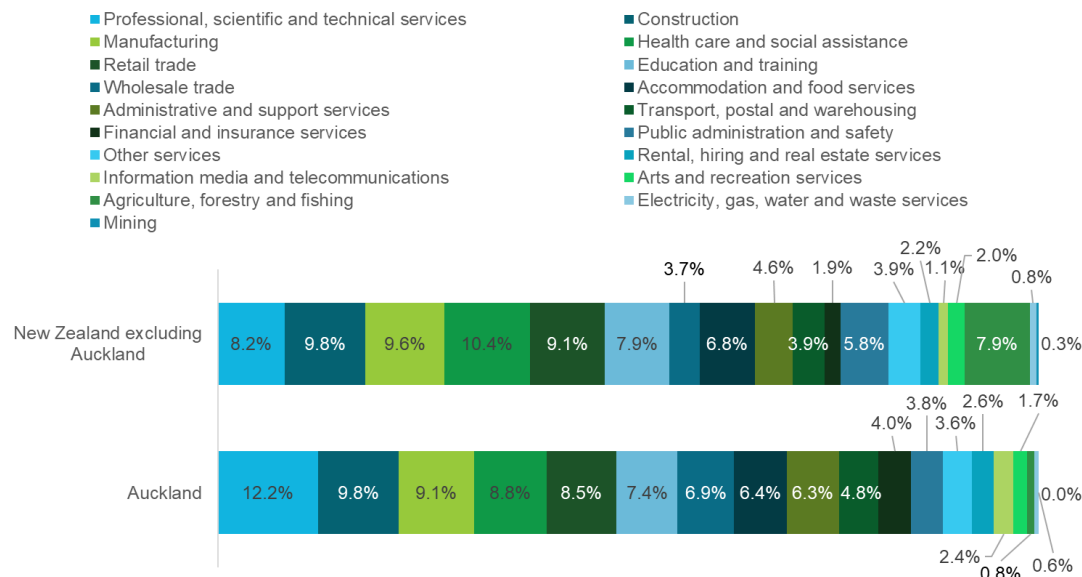
¹⁴² DeloitteAccess Economics, "Analysis of the Top 200 Firms and Top 10 Māori Businesses," Report for the Productivity Commission (DeloitteAccess Economics, 2020).

¹⁴³ Auckland Unlimited – Auckland Index, Export statistics.



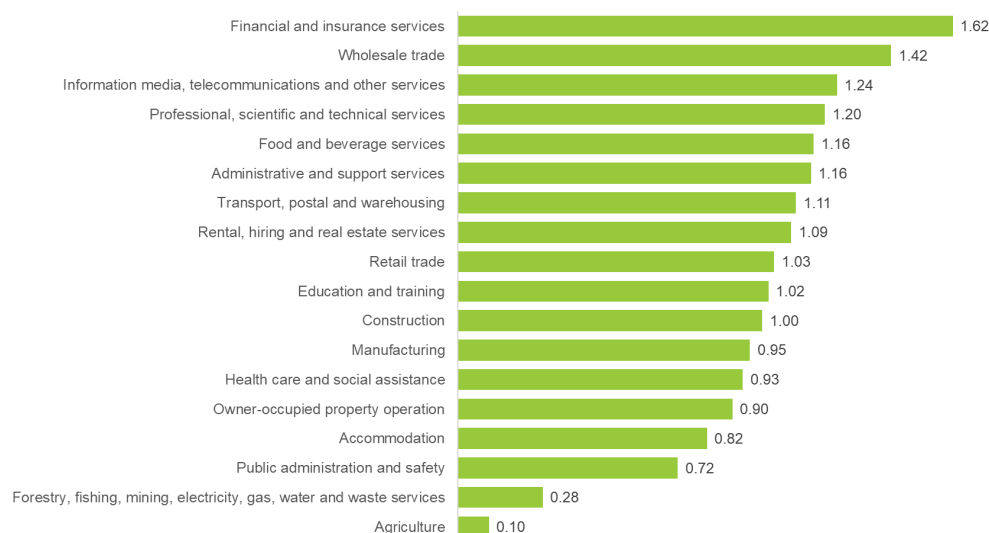
large professional and technical services, wholesale trade, transport and warehousing, financial and insurance services, and information media and telecommunications sectors.

Figure 181. Industry share of employment, Auckland compared to the rest of New Zealand outside Auckland, 2020



Source: Infometrics Auckland economic profile

Figure 182. Auckland industry GDP location quotients, 2019



Source: MartinJenkins calculations based on industry GDP figures from MBIE Regional Activity Data Tool.

Note: March year

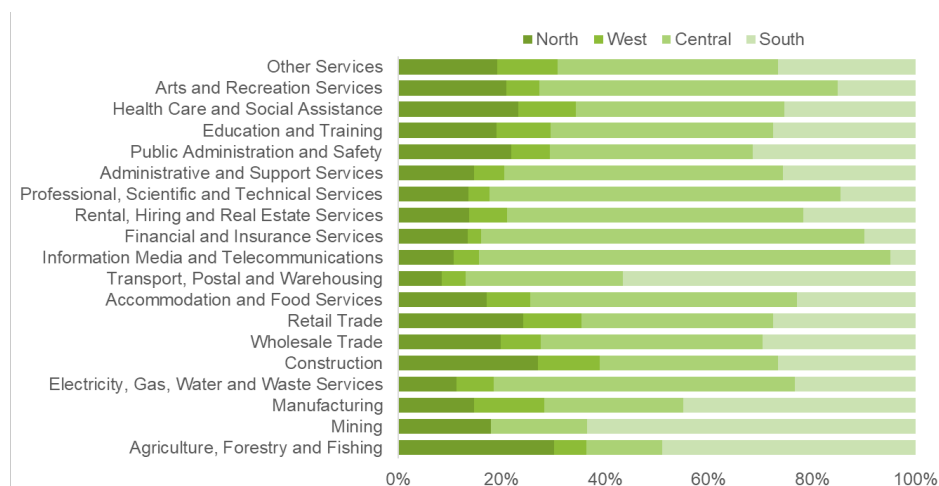


Auckland has a particular concentration of service industries, with financial and insurance services, wholesale trade, information media and telecommunications, and professional and technical services being relatively highly concentrated (all with location quotients of 1.2 and above) (Figure 180).

There are differences in the industrial mix across different areas of Auckland¹⁴⁴ (Figure 181 and Figure 182), as would be expected given the nature of the locations, land availability and cost, zoning etc. On the basis of employment:

- The Central area employs the largest proportion of most service industries in Auckland. The area has a very high proportion of professional & technical services, with a range of other industries relatively evenly weighted in the local economy, including accommodation & food services, health care, administrative & support services, construction, education & training and wholesale trade.
- The Southern area contains a significant proportion of the transport and warehousing sector and manufacturing sector in Auckland and much of the limited amount of agriculture and quarrying industries that Auckland has. Manufacturing, transport & warehousing, construction and retail make up relatively large proportions of the southern economy, followed by health care, education & training and wholesale trade.
- The Western area has a relatively high proportion of manufacturing and construction, with health care and retail also making up large proportions of the local economy, followed by education & training.
- The Northern area has high relative shares of construction, retail and health care, followed by professional & technical services and education & training.

Figure 183. Industry share of employment across major areas of Auckland

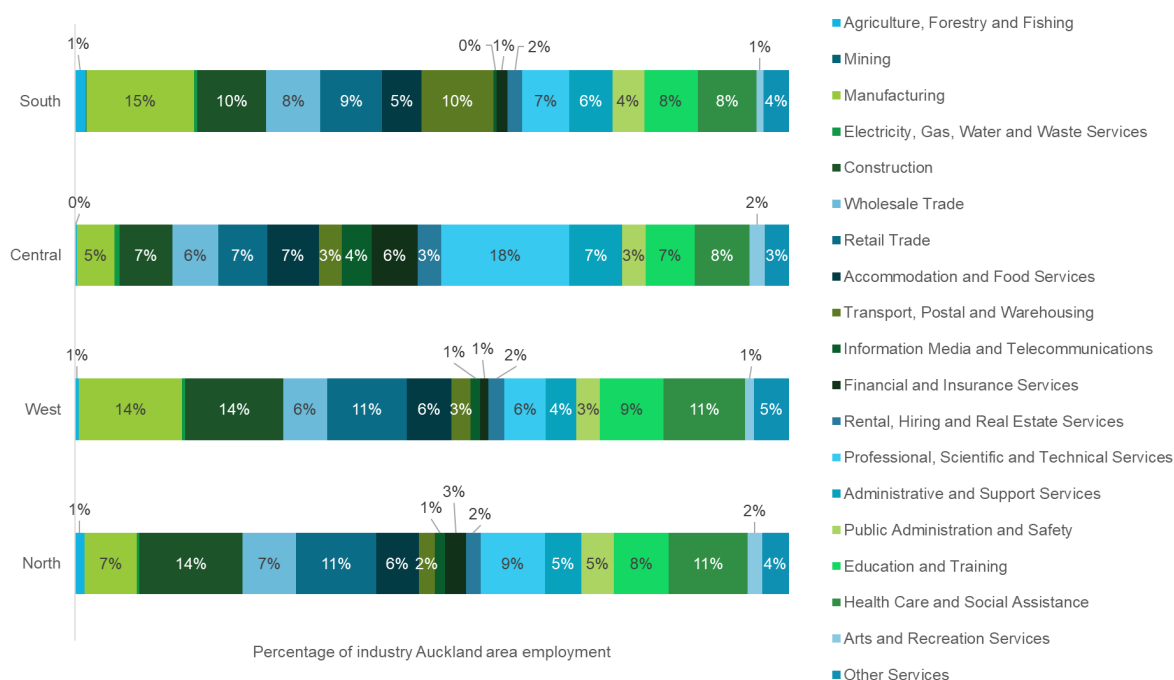


Source: MartinJenkins calculations based on employment figures from Infometrics Auckland economic profile

¹⁴⁴ North includes Local Board areas of Rodney, Hibiscus and Bays, Upper Harbour, Kaipātiki, Devonport-Takapuna; West includes Local Board areas of Henderson-Massey, Waitakere Ranges and Whau; Central includes Local Board areas of Albert-Eden, Puketāpapa, Waitemātā, Waiheke, Orakei, Maungakiekie-Tāmaki; South includes Local Board areas of Franklin, Papakura, Manurewa, Ōtara-Papatoetoe, Mangere-Otahuhu, Howick



Figure 184. Auckland area share of industry employment, 2020



Source: MartinJenkins calculations based on employment figures from Infometrics Auckland economic profile

Financial and insurance services and construction experienced very strong growth in value-add in Auckland over 2009 to 2019 (8.2% per year and 8.9% per year respectively) and contributed significantly to Auckland's overall growth in GDP over the period (Figure 183 and Figure 184). Rental and real estate services and transport and warehousing also achieved relatively strong growth and made important contributions to Auckland's performance. Professional and technical services and manufacturing achieved more limited growth (5.2% per year and 3.6% per year respectively) but still made a major contribution to Auckland's overall growth because of their relative size. Food and beverage services achieved the strongest growth in GDP (8.9% per year) but made a relatively small contribution to Auckland's overall growth.

Relative to national employment shares and growth in New Zealand's employment, the star performers are knowledge-intensive service sectors such as financial and insurance services, administrative services, information media and telecommunications, and professional and technical services (Figure 185). Transport and warehousing is also a relatively strong performer. Construction has achieved strong employment growth over the last decade, although Auckland's proportion of employment in the construction sector is about the same as that nationally.



Figure 185. Auckland industry GDP and 10 year annual growth rates



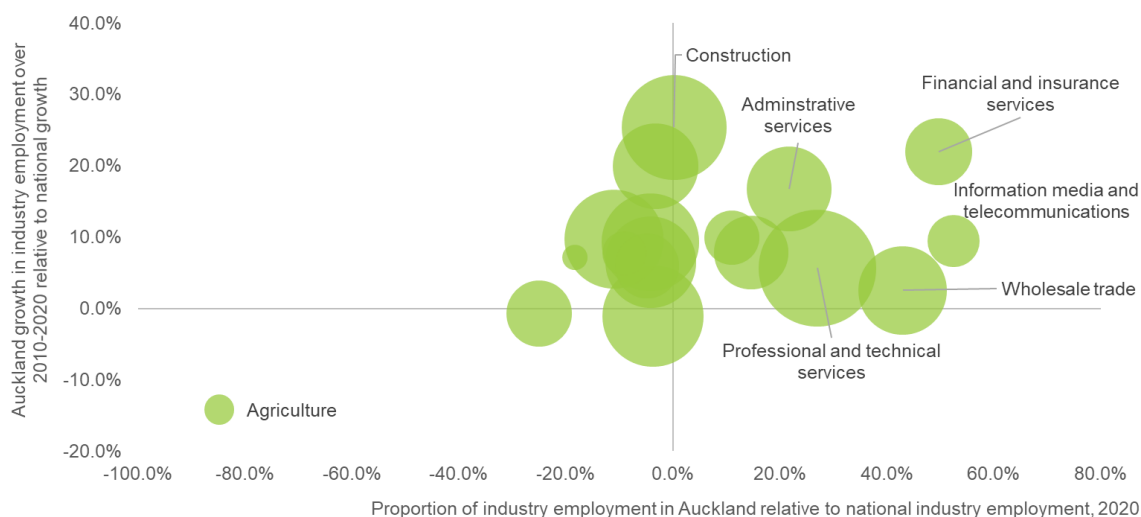
Source: MartinJenkins calculations based on GDP data from MBIE Regional Activity Tool

Figure 186. Contribution of Auckland industries to growth in Auckland's GDP over 2009-2019



Source: MartinJenkins calculations based on GDP data from MBIE Regional Activity Tool

Figure 187. Employment and growth by industry in Auckland relative to national employment and growth



Source: MartinJenkins calculations based on employment data from Infometrics Auckland economic profile.

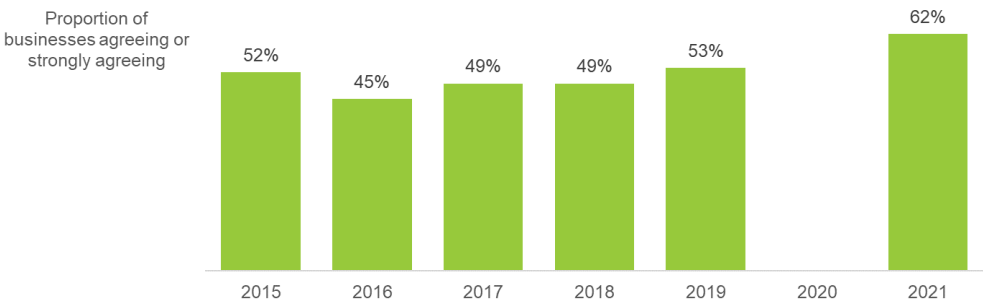


While New Zealand often ranks highly in world rankings on ease of doing business, the proportion of Auckland businesses who indicate that business is getting harder continues to rise

New Zealand often ranks at or near the top of the world rankings on the ease of doing business in the World Bank’s annual assessment of the time and costs faced in starting up a business across economies. Although such an indicator isn’t available at the regional level in New Zealand, Auckland Council and Auckland Unlimited survey businesses annually on a range of measures, including on whether they consider that being successful as a business is getting harder in Auckland.

Since 2016 there has been a general increase in the proportion of surveyed businesses indicating that it is getting harder to be successful in Auckland (increasing from 45% in 2016 to 53% in 2019 and to 62% in 2021) (Figure 186). The large increase between 2019 and 2021 will undoubtedly be partly due to the impact of COVID-19 (for example, 16% of respondents in 2021 indicated that accessing materials was a major barrier when in previous years only 1% to 4% had), although the largest proportions of respondents indicated that traffic congestion (39% of respondents) and hiring staff (30%) were main barriers to operating their business in Auckland.

Figure 188. Proportion of respondents reporting that being successful as a business in Auckland is getting harder



Source: IPSOS¹⁴⁵
Note: Representative sample of 500 businesses

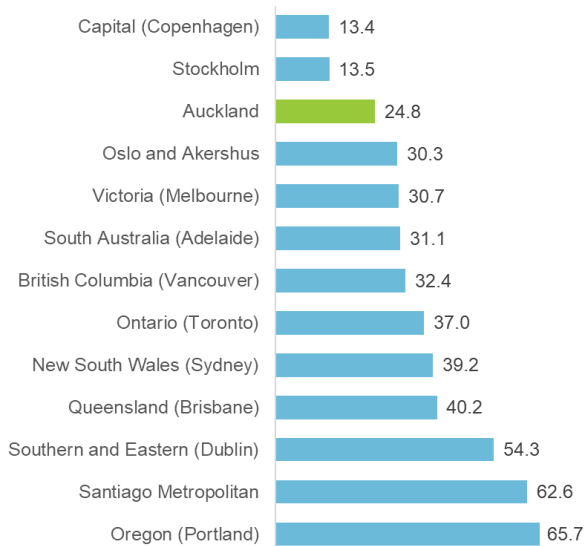
¹⁴⁵ J Dodd et al., “Auckland Council Business Survey 2021.” Prepared for Auckland Council & Auckland Unlimited. (IPSOS, 2021).



New Zealand regularly achieves top rankings on world government anti-corruption indexes. New Zealand was placed in the top spot, with Denmark and Finland, on Transparency International's Corruption perceptions index 2021 with a score of 88 out of 100.¹⁴⁶

In 2014, 24.8% of Aucklanders replied "Yes" to the following question: Is corruption widespread throughout the government in this country, or not? (Figure 187). This was a low percentage of residents, compared to other regions such as Portland where 65.7% responded "Yes", and in Santiago where a high percentage of respondents thought the same.

Figure 189. Perception of corruption, selected regions, 2014



Source: OECD.Stat, Regions and Cities

Note: OECD classifies the geographic units in this chart as large regions (territorial level 2 or TL2) to help in assessing differences in socio-economic trends in regions, both within and across countries

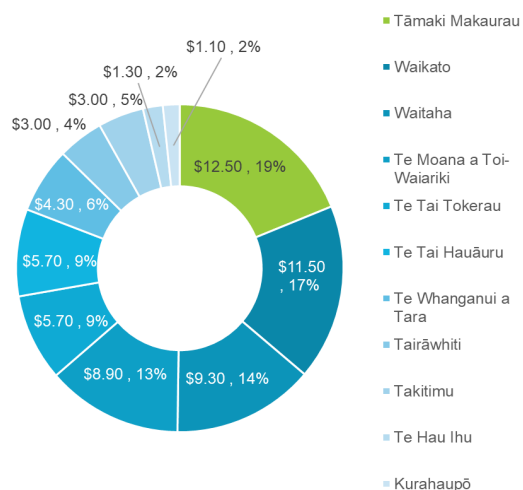
Almost 20% of the total Māori asset base is located in Tāmaki Makaurau. Māori enterprise in Tāmaki Makaurau differs from the rest of Aotearoa. There is a significant asset base in the services sectors, rather than agriculture, forestry and fishing as it is in other parts of the rohe

Māori participation and contribution to industry and enterprise in Tāmaki Makaurau is becoming more significant, as it is across Aotearoa. The value of the Māori asset base in Tāmaki Makaurau is estimated to be around \$12.5 billion or close to 19% of the total Māori asset base (Figure 188). Reflecting the rohe's different industrial mix, the composition of the Māori asset base in Tāmaki Makaurau is quite different from the Māori asset base nationally, which is dominated by primary industries. In Tāmaki Makaurau, the largest value of Māori assets is in a combination of rental and real estate, transport and warehousing, manufacturing and construction, which together represent over 60% of the asset base (Figure 189).

¹⁴⁶ Transparency International, "Corruption Perceptions Index 2021" (Transparency International, 2022), https://images.transparencycdn.org/images/CPI2021_Report_EN-web.pdf.

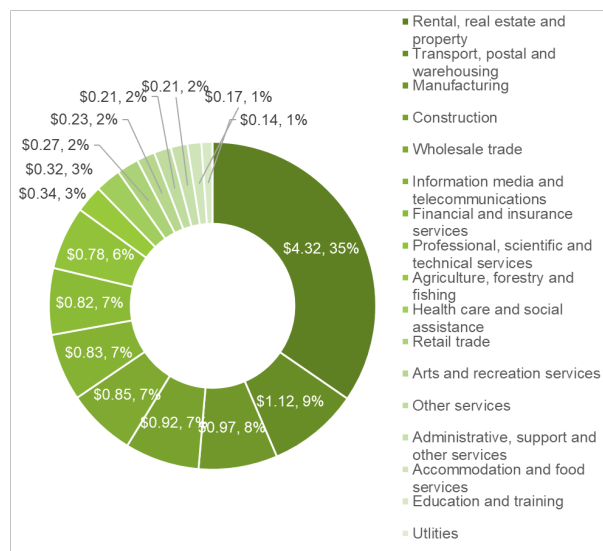


Figure 190. Contribution of different rohe to the value of the Māori asset base, 2018 (\$b)



Source: BERL ¹⁴⁷

Figure 191. Contribution of Auckland industries to the Māori economy in Tāmaki Makaurau, 2018 (\$b)



Source: BERL ¹⁴⁸

Tāmaki Makaurau has over 50% of the value of Aotearoa's Māori assets in information media and telecommunications and close to 44% of the value of assets in wholesale trade (Figure 190). Other sectors that have a significant asset base in Tāmaki Makaurau on a national scale are professional and technical services, construction and financial and insurance services. Apart from agriculture, forestry and fishing, other sectors that are under-represented in the Tāmaki Makaurau asset base are education and training and accommodation and food services. The large majority of the rohe's asset base is held by Māori employers (almost \$9.0 billion of assets, or 72% of the total) (Figure 191). A relatively small proportion is held by collectives in Tāmaki Makaurau (\$1.38 billion or 7% compared to 31% nationally).

Around 20% of Māori enterprises (Māori-owned, sole traders and significant employers of Māori) that can be allocated to a region are in Tāmaki Makaurau. Over half of these are sole traders (close to 3,800), with over a quarter being significant employers of Māori (1,890) and around 20% Māori owned businesses (1,390).¹⁴⁹ Tāmaki Makaurau has over a quarter of Aotearoa's Māori sole traders and close to a quarter of Māori-owned businesses that can be allocated to a region (Figure 192).

¹⁴⁷ BERL, "Te Ōhanga Māori 2021.," Report prepared for the Reserve Bank of New Zealand. (BERL Economics, 2021).

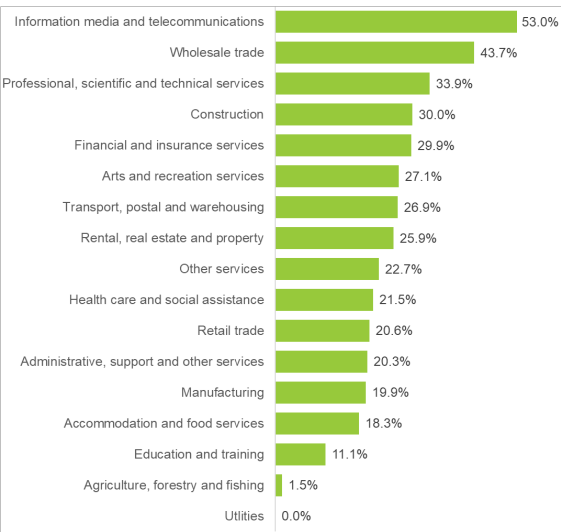
¹⁴⁸ H Schulze, K Hurren, and C McIndoe, "Te Ōhanga Māori – Tāmaki Makaurau. Auckland's Māori Economy.," BERL report for The Southern Initiative and The West Initiative (BERL Economics, 2018).

¹⁴⁹ The proportions are not exact as there are overlaps between significant employers of Māori and Māori-owned businesses.



It is important to continue to encourage Māori enterprise as recent research found that Māori-owned businesses employ 43% Māori on average, three times the rate as for non-Māori businesses.¹⁵⁰

Figure 192. Value of the Māori asset base in Tāmaki Makaurau as a proportion of the total Māori asset base by sector, 2018



Sources: Data from BERL (2021) and Schulze et al (2021)

Figure 193. Value of the Māori asset base in Tāmaki Makaurau by enterprise type, 2018 (\$b)

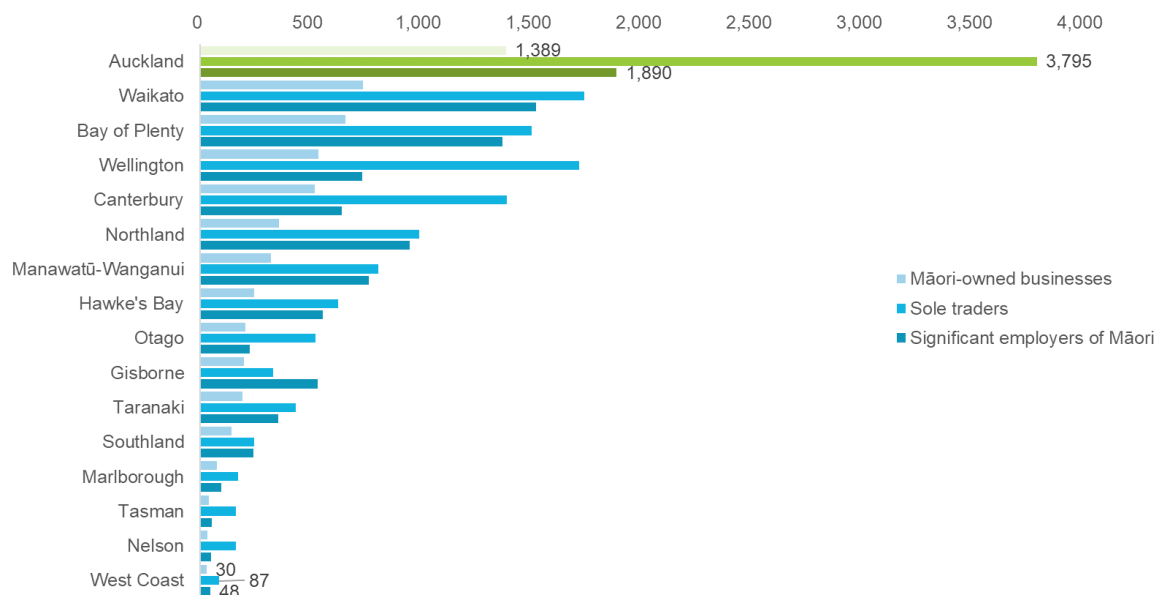


Source: Schulze et al (2021)

¹⁵⁰ Nicholson Consulting, “Te Matapaeroa 2019 – Looking toward the Horizon. Some Insights into Māori in Business.,” Report prepared for Te Puni Kōkiri. (Nicholson Consulting, 2021).



Figure 194. Number of Māori enterprises across regions by type of enterprise



Source: Nicholson Consulting, 2021¹⁵¹

Note: not all Māori enterprises can be allocated to a region. There are overlaps between significant employers of Māori and Māori owned businesses.

As at September 2021, there were 24 claimant groups seeking, or with already completed, Treaty of Waitangi settlements within the Tāmaki Makaurau and Hauraki regional grouping areas.¹⁵² The existing settlements, as well as those to progress and be finalised, present significant economic, social, cultural, and environmental opportunities for Māori in Tāmaki Makaurau.

¹⁵¹ Nicholson Consulting.

¹⁵² Te Arawhiti, "Te Kāhui Whakatau (Treaty Settlements) Year-to-Date Progress Report 1 July – 30 September 2021" (Te Arawhiti, 2021), <https://www.govt.nz/assets/Documents/OTS/Quarterly-reports/Quarterly-report-to-30-September-2021.pdf>.



INCOME, CONSUMPTION, AND WEALTH

Using income or in-kind transfers to meet today's needs and save for future needs, as well as being protected from future shocks by adequate wealth, private insurance, and public insurance.

Income and wealth are essential components of individual well-being. Income allows people to satisfy their needs and pursue many other goals that they deem important to their lives, while wealth makes it possible to sustain these choices over time.

Both income and wealth enhance individuals' freedom to choose the lives that they want to live, though there are some aspects of their lives that cannot be bought by money.

Summary

Compared to other regions, Auckland households have the highest net worth.

In the year ended June 2020, Auckland's average annual household equivalised disposable income was well above the New Zealand average. Auckland incomes increased by 4% in the year ended June 2020.

Auckland tends to have stronger growth in income, in particular for wage and salary workers, than other regions. Auckland's average weekly household income in 2021 was higher than the New Zealand average. Auckland also has proportionately higher income from self-employment compared to other regions.

While the percentage of Aucklanders who indicate they do not have enough money to meet everyday needs has declined over time, the Auckland region has the highest percentage of people who feel they do not have enough money – 14% compared to 10% nationally. During the Level 4 lockdown in April 2020, a survey found that 34% of households were in difficulty and 40% were at risk of tipping into hardship. Māori, Pacific Peoples and young people were most affected.

At the regional level, the percentage of children living in Auckland households experiencing material hardship declined between 2019 and 2020. The percentage of households in Auckland is near the national average, but the percentage hasn't fallen as much between 2019 and 2020 at the national level.

Household net worth	H	▲
Disposable income	H	▲
Sources of income	H	▲
Financial wellbeing	L	▲
Child poverty	M	▼
Benefit recipients	M	▲
Consumption	H	▲
Household indebtedness	H	▲
Income protection, superannuation	M	▲



The proportion of working-age people in Auckland receiving income support was at the lower end of regions in 2016 but has climbed since the onset of the COVID-19 pandemic to near the national average. The COVID-19 pandemic has had a disproportionate effect on Aucklanders, particularly in relation to loss of employment. The proportion of Aucklanders accessing Jobseeker Support surpassed national averages for the first time in five years in the March 2021 quarter.

Auckland was the region with the highest levels of weekly household expenditure in 2019. Auckland's weekly household expenditure has grown by 3.2% per annum over the last 12 years, while New Zealand's has grown by 2.8%.

Mean household debt increased in Auckland from 2015 to 2018 and is still significantly higher than the rest of New Zealand. A recent survey found that renters and home-owners in Auckland were disproportionately impacted by housing arrears during the pandemic.

The percentage of Aucklanders who are members of KiwiSaver has increased steadily over time. The percentage of Aucklanders having a KiwiSaver account is similar to the national percentage but lower than the proportion of people in other major urban regions. In recent years, over-represented amongst those considering hardship withdrawal were young people (18 to 34 years old), Māori, Pacific peoples, renters, Auckland residents and those experiencing financial hardship. Auckland household's income protection insurance use is similar to national insurance behaviour, which is low.

Compared to other regions, Auckland households have the highest net worth

There are a number of relationships between income and whānau/individual wellbeing, including:

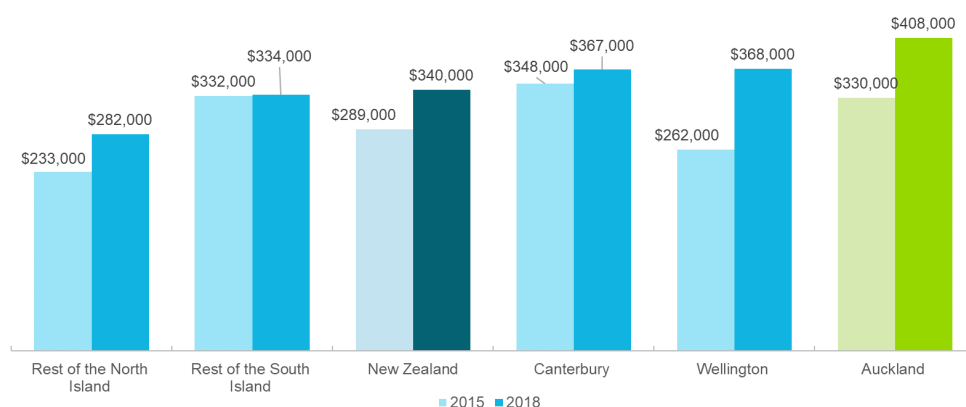
- the ability to purchase resources which are integral components of wellbeing. It enables individuals and whānau to obtain the material goods they need for their health and wellbeing.
- enhancing choice and facilitating participation in society. It increases people's options in leisure time, health, and in some part, education.
- influencing subjective feelings, norms and values of family members within households. Those in poverty experience constant physical, mental and emotional stress that affects their health and wellbeing.¹⁵³

Compared to other regions, Auckland households have the highest household net worth (Figure 193). This is an improvement since 2015, when Auckland was third ranked, behind Canterbury and the rest of the South Island.

¹⁵³ Milligan et al., "Family Wellbeing Indicators from the 1981–2001 New Zealand Censuses."



Figure 195. Median household net worth, regions, 2015 and 2018



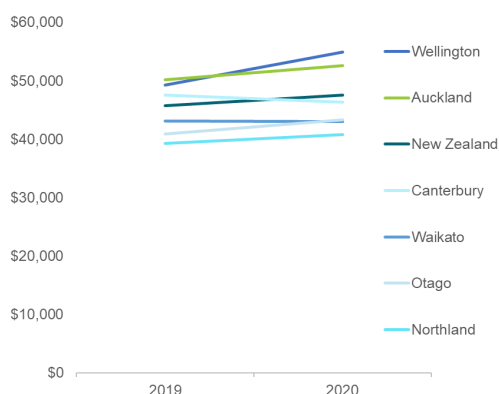
Source: Household economic survey, Stats NZ

Notes: HES is run every year, but it collects additional data on individual and household assets, liabilities, and net worth every three years. 2018 was the second time information about net worth was collected as part of the HES, with the first during the year ended June 2015.

Aucklanders, on average, have high household disposable income

In the year ended June 2020, Auckland's average annual household equivalised disposable income (before housing costs are deducted) was \$52,636, well above the New Zealand average of \$47,517 (Figure 195). Household equivalised disposable incomes increased significantly in two regions over 2019 and 2020 (Figure 194). Wellington incomes increased to \$54,874 (up 10%), and Auckland incomes increased to \$52,636 (up 4%) compared with the year ended June 2019. No other regions had significant increases in household equivalised disposable incomes.

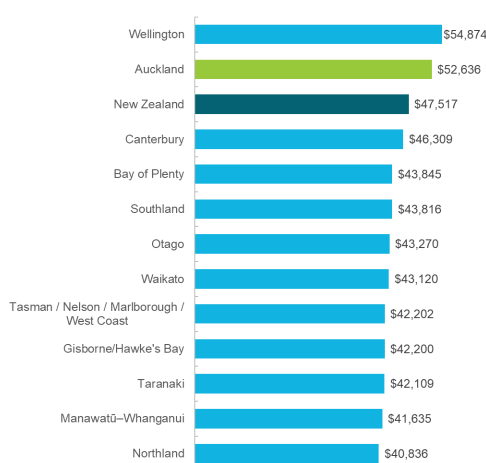
Figure 196. Average household equivalised disposable income, selected regions, 2019 and 2020



Source: Household economic survey, Stats NZ

Note: Measure is average real equivalised household income after taxes and transfers, and before housing costs

Figure 197. Average household equivalised disposable income, regions, 2020



Source: Household economic survey, Stats NZ

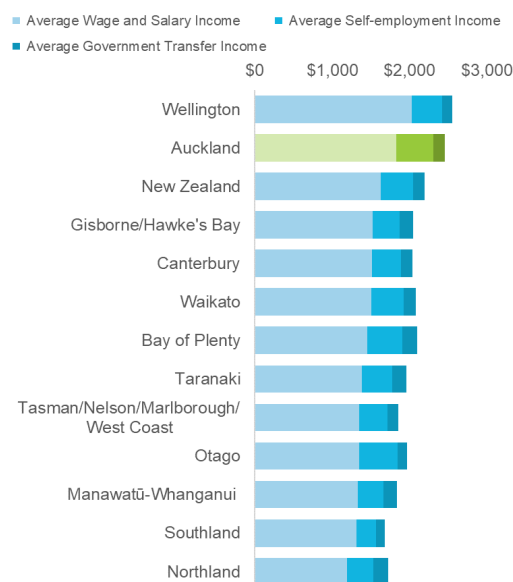


Average weekly household income in Auckland is high, mostly due to high income from wage and salary earners

Older studies, prior to the availability of official regional economic performance data, have shown that Auckland tends to have stronger growth in income, particularly for wage and salary workers, than other regions.¹⁵⁴ These differences remain even after controlling for differences in population attributions across regions.

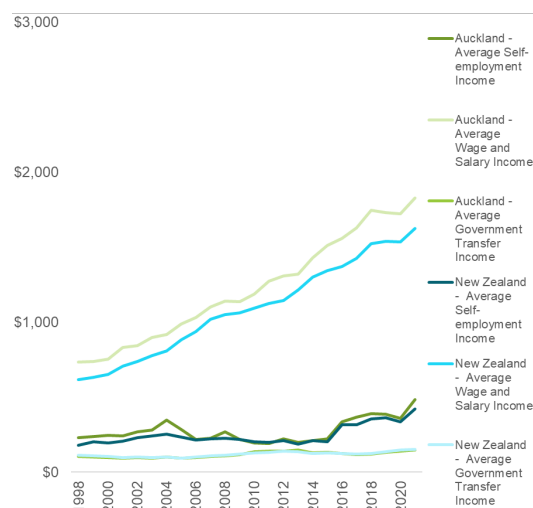
Consistent with those older studies, Auckland's average weekly household income of \$2,457 in 2021 was higher than the New Zealand average of \$2,198. Figure 196 shows that weekly household income was highest in Wellington and Auckland, and most of this was due to income from wages and salaries. Auckland also has proportionately higher income from self-employment compared to other regions. Figure 197 shows that wages and salaries have climbed over time across New Zealand and Auckland, at similar rates – Auckland's wages and salaries grew by 3.4% per year over the last 10 years (compound average growth rate), and 3.6% in New Zealand over the same years. Self-employment income shows some increases from 2015 onwards, but not at the same rate as wages and salaries.

Figure 198. Average weekly household income by source of household income, regions, 2021



Source: Household economic survey, Stats NZ

Figure 199. Average weekly household income by source of household income, Auckland and New Zealand, 1998–2021



Source: Household economic survey, Stats NZ

Note: Average weekly household income is total weekly household income, divided by the number of households

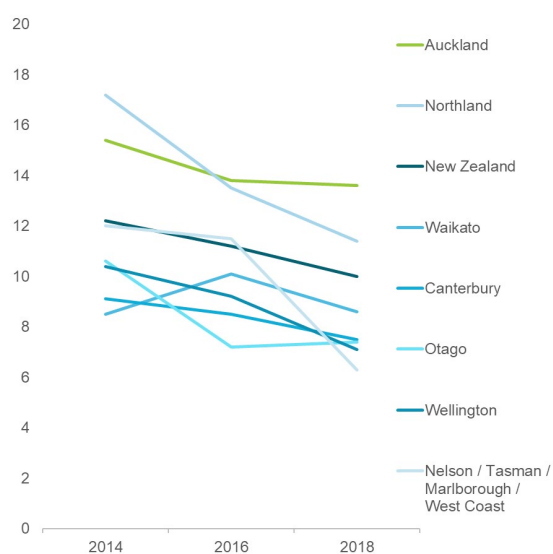
¹⁵⁴ Geoff Lewis and Steven Stillman, "Regional Economic Performance in New Zealand: How Does Auckland Compare?," Working Paper (Wellington: New Zealand Treasury, November 2008).



Aucklanders are most likely to say they do not have enough money to meet everyday needs

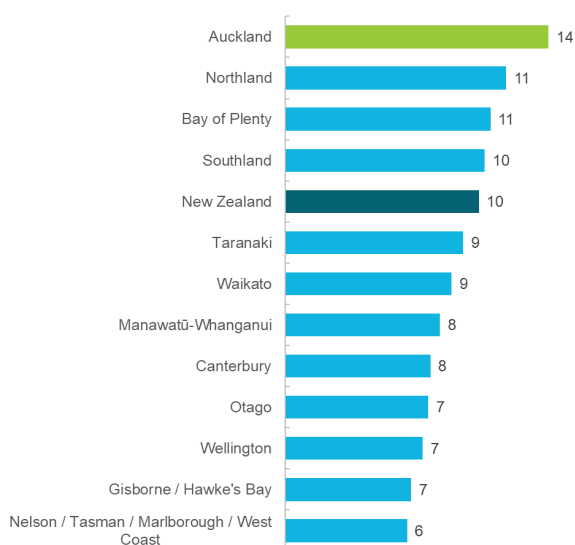
While the percentage of Aucklanders who indicate they do not have enough money to meet everyday needs has declined over time (Figure 194), the Auckland region has the highest percentage of people who feel they do not have enough money – 14% compared to 10% nationally (Figure 199).

Figure 200. Percentage of adults who report they do not have enough money to meet everyday needs, selected regions, 2014–2018



Source: NZGSS, Stats NZ

Figure 201. Percentage of adults who report they do not have enough money to meet everyday needs, regions, 2018



Source: NZGSS, Stats NZ

This indicator does not yet have data on the impact of COVID-19. The Commission for Financial Capability took part in a study of COVID-19 pandemic impacts on personal and household finances that was also run in the UK and Norway. In New Zealand, 3,085 people were surveyed on how their personal and household finances were affected by the COVID-19 pandemic in April 2020.

The survey found that during the Level 4 lockdown in April 2020, 34% of households were in difficulty and 40% were at risk of tipping into hardship.¹⁵⁵ In the UK, 28% of respondents were in difficulty and 37% at risk; in Norway only 8% of people were in difficulty and 30% were at risk. The survey also found that:

- 10% of households had already missed a rent or mortgage payment, and housing stress was highest in Auckland
- Māori, Pacific peoples and young people were worst affected

¹⁵⁵ Celestyna Galicki, "Impact of COVID-19 on Financial Wellbeing" (Commission for Financial Capability, May 2020).



- workers in insecure forms of work before the crisis were among the worst affected, and they were disproportionately young and non-European
- free financial guidance, and the option to negotiate with creditors, were under-utilised.

The results account for the 40% of all households surveyed in which at least one member was receiving the wage subsidy.

In September 2021, ASB Bank reported that their average customer cash balances were 60% higher than those of the first 2020 level 4 lockdown, but 40% had less than \$1,000 available to spend.¹⁵⁶ The ASB Bank financial wellbeing survey found that overall wellbeing is low, with 38% living pay-day to pay-day, and 49% were having trouble or just coping. Customer spending in Auckland dropped 22%, compared with 5% for the rest of New Zealand. Aucklanders increased their average cash balances by 5.4% in September 2021, while those outside of Auckland increased by 4.8%.

The level of child poverty in Auckland is similar to that across New Zealand. Reductions in child poverty are not occurring in Auckland as fast as they are in other regions, and nationally

The Office of the Children's Commissioner engaged with over 6,000 children and young people across New Zealand to inform advice to the Prime Minister about 2018's ten-year Child and Youth Wellbeing Strategy. The most common theme identified in postcards to the Prime Minister was that "everyone should have their basic needs met". Children understood what it means to struggle daily, and that having enough is important for wellbeing.¹⁵⁷

At a national level there has been progress toward the child poverty reduction targets set by Government as required in the Child Poverty Reduction Act 2018. However, progress toward Government targets has not been equitable between groups of children. In the 2019/20 Household Economic Survey year, for children aged under 18 years:¹⁵⁸

- There were 17.1% of Māori children living in households with equivalised disposable income before housing costs below 50% of the contemporary median (2020/21 target is 10.5%).
- For Pacific children, 19.1% were living in households with equivalised disposable income before housing costs below 50% of the contemporary median (2020/21 target is 10.5%)
- The difference was even greater for material hardship, with 19.5% of Māori children and 26.1% of Pacific children living in households experiencing material hardship (2020/21 target is 10.3%).

Material hardship is defined as having a DEP-17 score of six or more.¹⁵⁹

¹⁵⁶ RNZ, "ASB Bank's Financial Wellbeing Survey Finds Customers Better Prepared for Latest Lockdowns," *Radio New Zealand*, October 28, 2021, <https://www.rnz.co.nz/news/business/454406/asb-bank-s-financial-wellbeing-survey-finds-customers-better-prepared-for-latest-lockdowns>.

¹⁵⁷ M Duncanson et al., "Child Poverty Monitor: Technical Report 2021" (New Zealand Child and Youth Epidemiology Service, 2021).

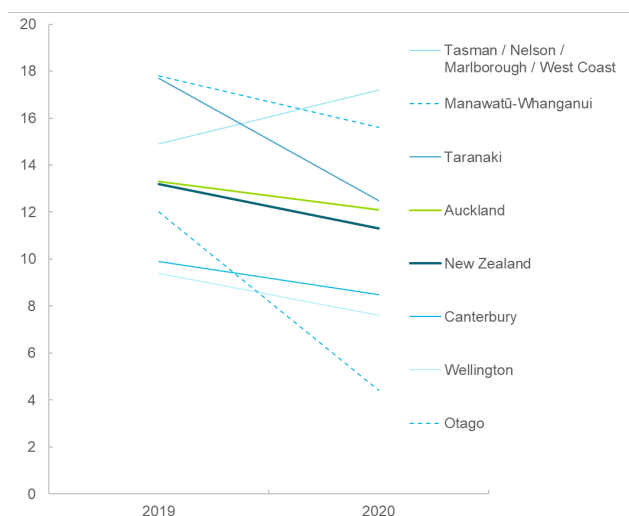
¹⁵⁸ Duncanson et al.

¹⁵⁹ DEP-17 is a well-established deprivation index developed by the Ministry of Social Development. Thresholds have been set at a DEP-17 score of 6 or more for material hardship, and at a DEP-17 score of 9 or more for severe material hardship. The DEP-17 index focuses on the low living standards end of the spectrum and includes questions about 'enforced lack of essentials', 'economised, cut back, or delayed purchases a lot', 'in arrears more than once in last 12 months', and 'financial stress and vulnerability'.



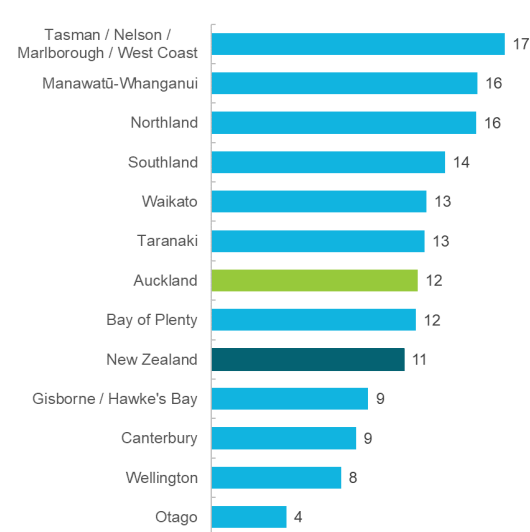
At the regional level, the percentage of children living in Auckland households experiencing material hardship declined between 2019 and 2020 (Figure 200). The percentage of households in Auckland is near the national average (Figure 201), but the percentage hasn't fallen as much between 2019 and 2020 as the national level.

Figure 202. Percentage of children living in households experiencing material hardship, selected regions, 2019 and 2020



Source: Household economic survey, Stats NZ

Figure 203. Percentage of children living in households experiencing material hardship, regions, 2020



Source: Household economic survey, Stats NZ

COVID-19 has led to a rise in the levels of Aucklanders accessing welfare support. Aucklanders usually access Jobseeker Support at rates below the national average. They are now accessing it at levels above the national average

The welfare system supports the wellbeing of New Zealanders. The most important elements are to replace or supplement incomes when they are insufficient to enable an adequate standard of living, and to support participation, especially through paid employment, but also in other ways, including parenting or caring for others.¹⁶⁰

The purpose of the welfare system is to support wellbeing by:¹⁶¹

- providing social and financial security sufficient for an adequate standard of living

¹⁶⁰ Welfare Expert Advisory Group, "Whakamana Tāngata: Restoring Dignity to Social Security in New Zealand" (Welfare Expert Advisory Group, 2019).

¹⁶¹ Welfare Expert Advisory Group.



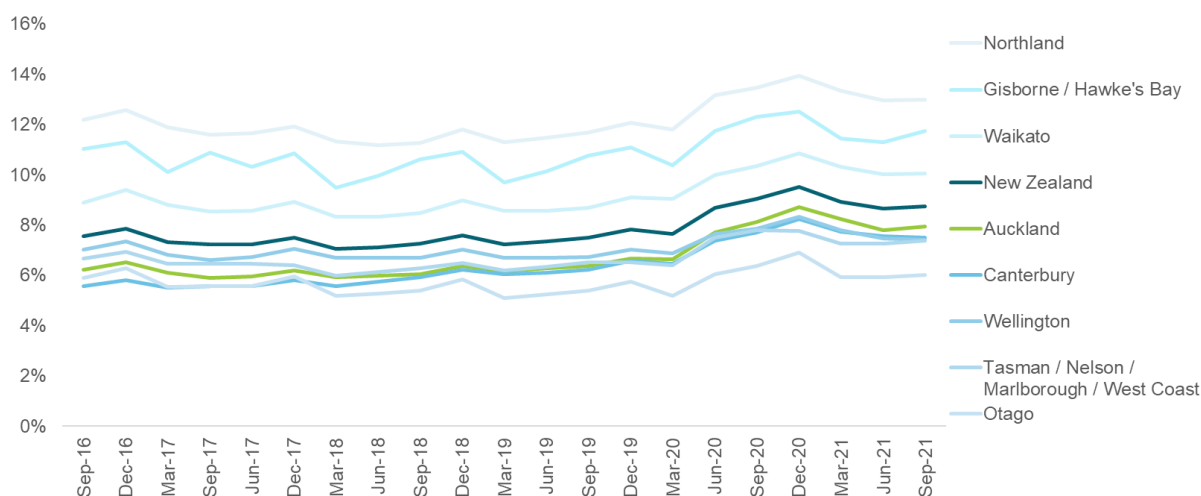
- supporting people to achieve their potential for learning, caring or volunteering, and earning through good and appropriate work, and ensuring a dignified life for people for whom these options are not possible.

Main benefits include Jobseeker Support (JS), Sole Parent Support (SPS), Supported Living Payment (SLP), and other main benefits (Emergency Benefit and working-age Youth Payment/Young Parent Payment). There are regional differences in access and use of all main benefits and to Jobseeker Support.

The proportion of working-age people in Auckland on main benefits was at the lower end of regions in 2016 but has climbed since the onset of the COVID-19 pandemic to near the national average (Figure 202 and Figure 203). In September 2021, the proportion in Auckland was 7.9% compared to 8.7% nationally.

In the last five years, Northland and Gisborne/Hawke's Bay consistently have higher proportions of working-age people on main benefits (Figure 202).

Figure 204. Proportion of working-age recipients of all main benefits, selected regions, 2016–2021

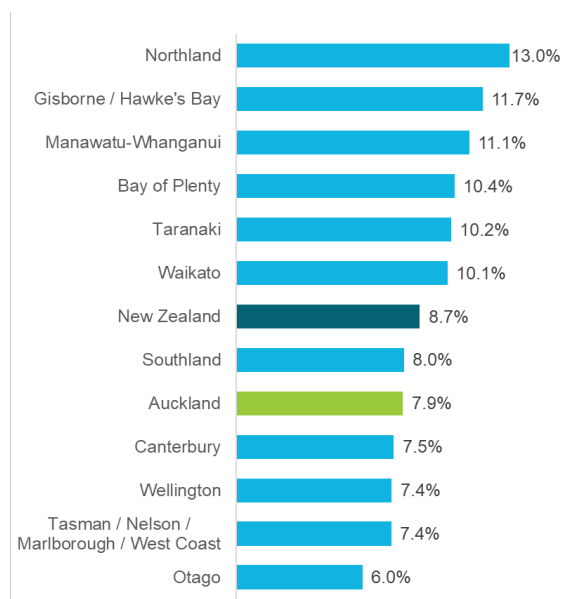


Source: Ministry of Social Development Benefit fact sheets

The COVID-19 pandemic has had a disproportionate effect on Aucklanders, particularly in relation to loss of employment. Access to Jobseeker Support by Aucklanders surpassed national averages for the first time in five years in the March 2021 quarter (Figure 205). While Auckland workers historically access Jobseeker Support below national rates, the region now sits at the national rate of 4.7% of the working age population (Figure 204).

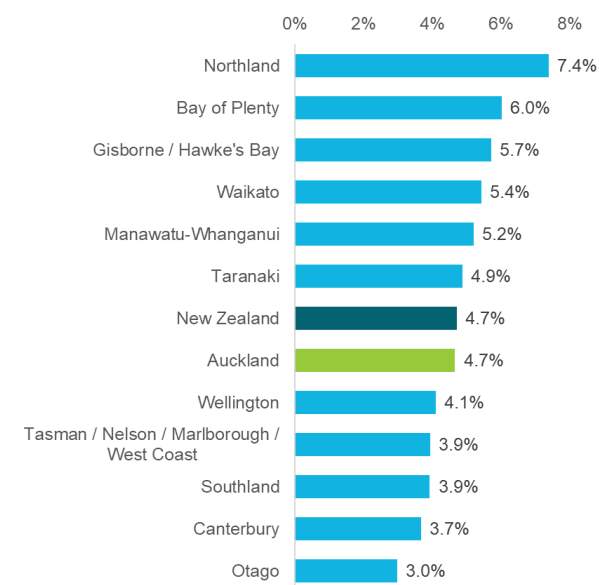


Figure 205. Proportion of working-age recipients of main benefits, regions, September 2021



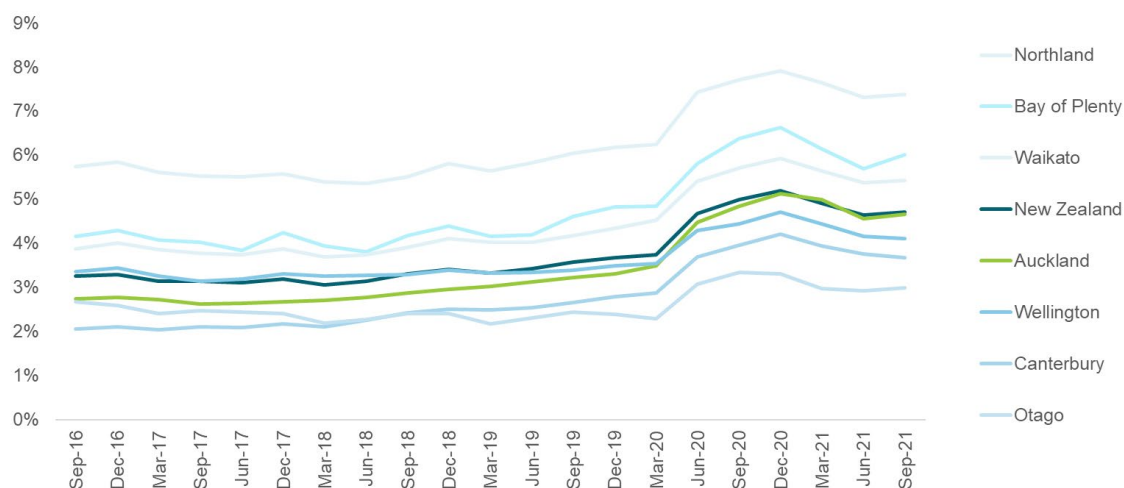
Source: Ministry of Social Development Benefit fact sheets

Figure 206. Proportion of working-age recipients of Jobseeker Support, regions, September 2021



Source: Ministry of Social Development Benefit fact sheets

Figure 207. Proportion of working-age recipients of Jobseeker Support, selected regions, 2016–2021



Source: Ministry of Social Development Benefit fact sheets

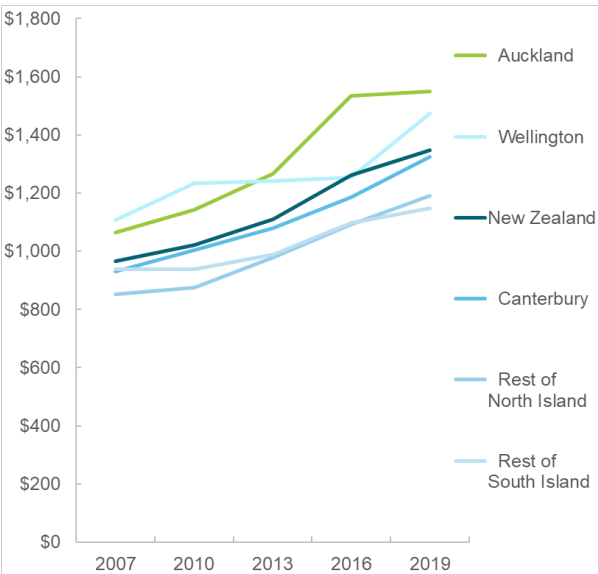


Auckland households have higher household expenditure than all other households, and expenditure is increasing at a faster rate

The positive relationship between income and subjective wellbeing has been well documented. New Zealand research, using the Stats NZ General Social Survey finds that consumption measures out-perform income in predicting subjective wellbeing. The study found that when objective measures of consumption are combined with self-assessments of a household’s standard of living (giving an Economic Living Standards Index score¹⁶²), they measure better predicted subjective wellbeing than household income.¹⁶³

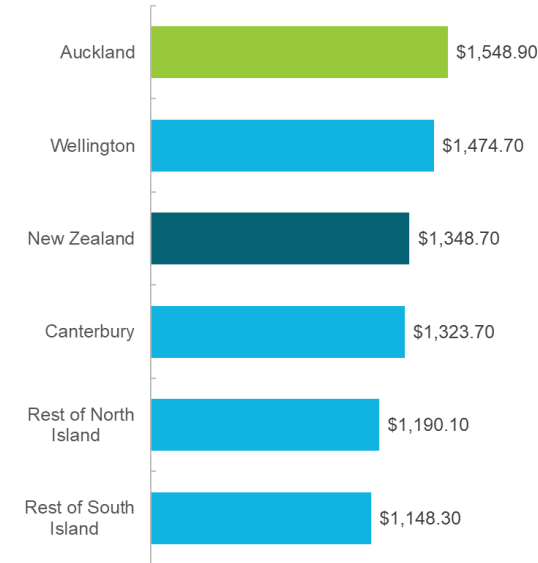
In the absence of the indexed data at a regional level, consumption over time suggests that Aucklanders would have the highest levels of household expenditure (Figure 206). While Wellingtonian households had greater levels of weekly household expenditure prior to 2013 (Figure 206), Auckland has since surpassed Wellington and remains the region with the highest levels of weekly household expenditure in 2019 – \$1,548.90 a week (Figure 207). Auckland’s weekly household expenditure has grown by 3.2% per annum over the last 12 years (compound average growth rate), while New Zealand’s has grown by 2.8% (Wellington’s grew by 2.4%).

Figure 208. Average real weekly household expenditure, regions, 2007–2019



Source: Stats NZ, Household Economic Survey

Figure 209. Average real weekly household expenditure, regions, 2019



Source: Stats NZ, Household Economic Survey

¹⁶² The New Zealand General Social Survey introduced a measure called the ‘Economic Living Standard Index’ (ELSI), a consumption-based measure of living standards. ELSI assessed a household’s level of consumption and, to a lesser extent, wealth via a combination of objective and self-rated questions.

¹⁶³ Tom Carver and Arthur Grimes, “Income or Consumption: Which Better Predicts Subjective Wellbeing?,” Motu Working Paper (Motu Economic and Public Policy Research, August 2016).

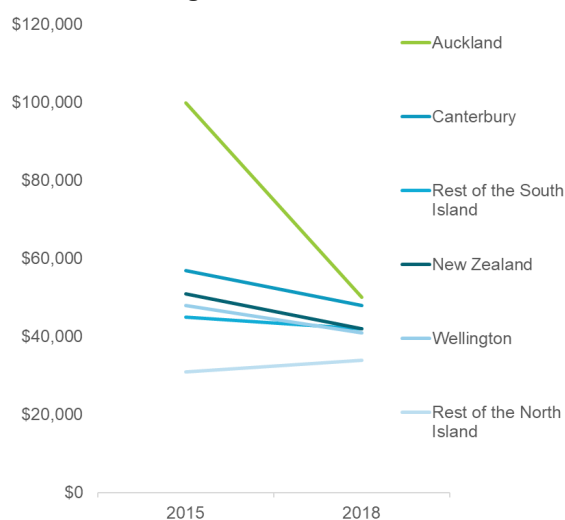


The average household debt of Aucklanders is much higher than all other regions, and rises over time. 1 in 10 Auckland households missed a rent or mortgage payment during the pandemic

New Zealanders have traditionally had high levels of household debt.¹⁶⁴ Household debt includes mortgage loans, consumer loans (such as personal loans for cars and other items), credit cards and student loans. As at the June 2021 quarter, total household financial liabilities (including loans for rental properties) totalled \$262.8 billion.¹⁶⁵ This level of household debt is equivalent to 127% of household disposable income (the highest level of debt as a proportion of household income since the series commenced in 1998).¹⁶⁶

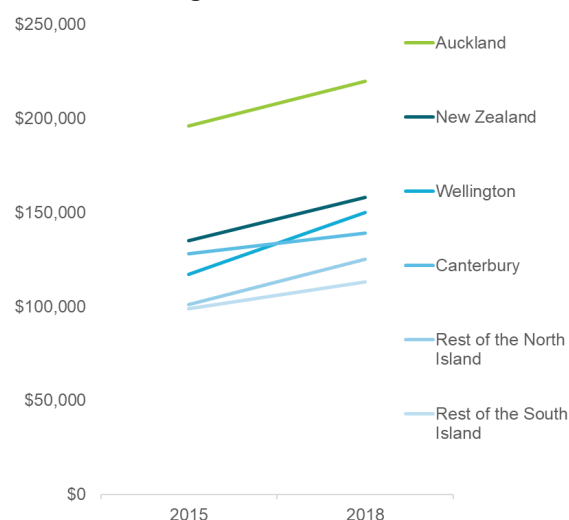
At the regional level, Auckland's median household debt was the highest of all regions in 2015 at \$100,000, but halved to \$50,000 by 2018 (Figure 208). Conversely, mean household debt increased in Auckland from \$196,000 in 2015, to \$220,000 in 2018 and is still significantly higher than the rest of New Zealand (Figure 209).

Figure 210. Median household liabilities, regions, 2015 and 2018



Source: Stats NZ, Household Economic Survey

Figure 211. Mean household liabilities, regions, 2015 and 2018



Source: Stats NZ, Household Economic Survey

Despite the increase in New Zealand's household debt, serviceability of that debt has improved over recent years due to lower interest rates. Following the outbreak of COVID-19 in New Zealand, the Reserve Bank provided regulatory guidance to banks so they could offer loan deferral schemes. This

¹⁶⁴ Parliamentary Service, "Crown and Household Debt," Library research brief (Parliamentary Service, October 2020).

¹⁶⁵ Reserve Bank of New Zealand et al., "Household Balance Sheet (C22)," Reserve Bank, September 3, 2021, <https://www.rbnz.govt.nz/statistics/c22>.

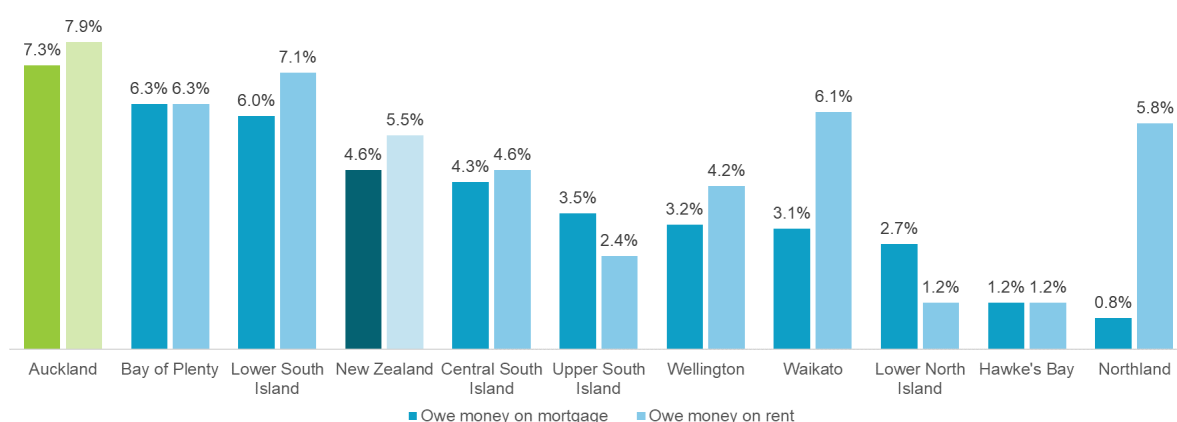
¹⁶⁶ Reserve Bank of New Zealand, Stats NZ, and CoreLogic, "Key Household Financial Statistics (C21)," Reserve Bank, September 3, 2021, <https://www.rbnz.govt.nz/statistics/c21>.



allowed banks to treat loans on which repayments had been deferred as performing (non-defaulted) loans.

A survey on the financial impacts of COVID-19 found that housing arrears were most common in Auckland and Bay of Plenty (Figure 210).¹⁶⁷ Both renters and home owners were disproportionately impacted in Auckland. In the lower South Island, Waikato and Northland, the majority of those in arrears were renters.

Figure 212. 1 in 10 households have missed a rent or mortgage payment, April 2020



Source: Commission for Financial Capability¹⁶⁸

Aucklanders have signed up to KiwiSaver at rates similar to the national average. Auckland residents were over-represented in those seeking hardship withdrawal in April 2020

Saving by New Zealanders in the March 2021 quarter fell to its lowest level in two years after rising in 2020.¹⁶⁹ Household spending increased in the March 2021 quarter, after a period of limited spending over much of 2020 due to COVID-19 restrictions. New Zealanders tend to spend almost everything they earn.¹⁷⁰

KiwiSaver is a voluntary, work-based savings scheme, designed to help people prepare for their retirement. It also makes provisions for the self-employed and children. The percentage of Aucklanders who are members of KiwiSaver has increased steadily over time (Figure 213). As at June 2021, 61% of all Aucklanders had a KiwiSaver account (Figure 214). This is similar to the percentage

¹⁶⁷ Galicki, "Impact of COVID-19 on Financial Wellbeing."

¹⁶⁸ Galicki; Celestyna Galicki, "Impact of the Covid-19 Crisis on Financial Wellbeing in New Zealand: Preliminary Data from an International Study" (National Strategy for Financial Capability partners, Wellington, May 20, 2020).

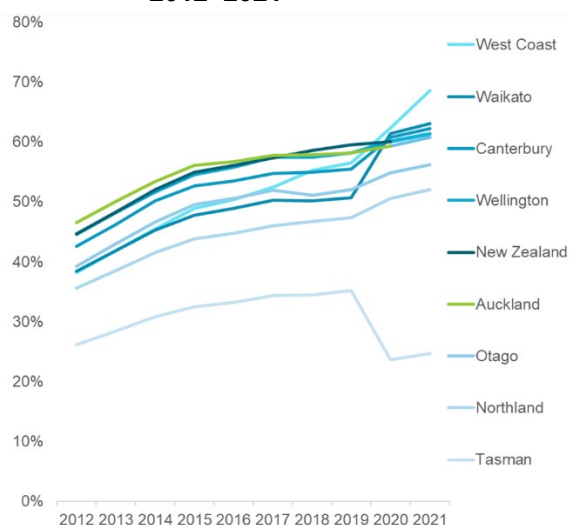
¹⁶⁹ Stats NZ, "Household Saving Falls in the March 2021 Quarter," Stats NZ, July 2021, <https://www.stats.govt.nz/news/household-saving-falls-in-the-march-2021-quarter>.

¹⁷⁰ Stats NZ, "Household Saving Only Just Positive," Stats NZ, November 20, 2020, <https://www.stats.govt.nz/news/household-saving-only-just-positive>.



of members nationally but lower than the proportion of people in the other major urban regions of Wellington, Canterbury and the Waikato.

Figure 213. Active or provisional KiwiSaver members as a proportion of the population, selected regions, 2012–2021

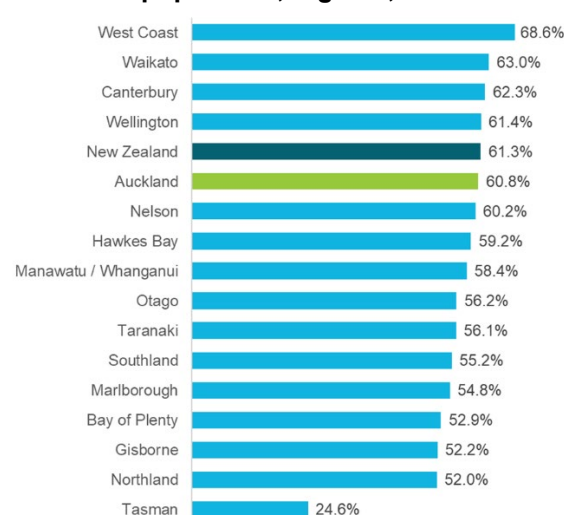


Source: Inland Revenue

Notes: Population estimates were used as a proxy due to data availability. KiwiSaver is available to those under 65 years old.

Chatham Islands is included in the Canterbury region.

Figure 214. Active or provisional KiwiSaver members as a proportion of the population, regions, 2021



Source: Inland Revenue

Notes: Population estimates were used as a proxy due to data availability. KiwiSaver is available to those under 65 years old.

Chatham Islands is included in the Canterbury region.

There has been significant movement in KiwiSaver membership since the start of the COVID-19 pandemic. In a survey for the Commission for Financial Capability in April 2020, 3% of KiwiSaver members had applied for hardship withdrawal, and 17% intended to do so in the near future.¹⁷¹

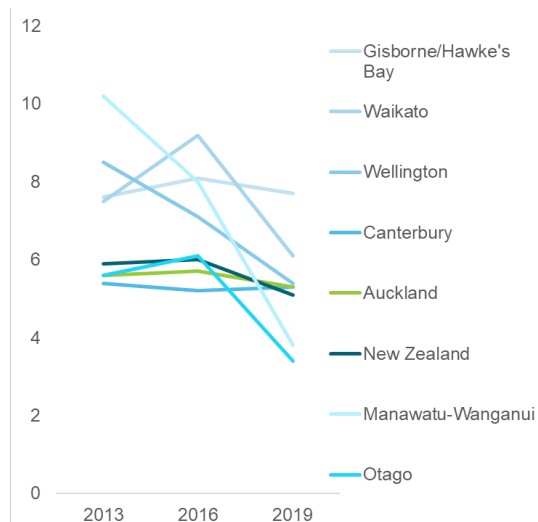
Over-represented amongst those considering hardship withdrawal were young people (18 to 34 years old), Māori, Pacific Peoples, renters, Auckland residents and those experiencing financial hardship. 7% had already switched to a lower risk fund.

Household use of life and income protection insurance appears to be low in New Zealand, and has fallen over time (Figure 213). Auckland household's insurance behaviour is similar to the national insurance behaviour (5.3% of Auckland households had life or income protection insurance in 2019 compared to 5.1% of New Zealand households). In contrast, Northland and Gisborne/Hawke's Bay were the most insured, and households in Otago and Manawatu-Whanganui were least insured (Figure 214).

¹⁷¹ Galicki, "Impact of COVID-19 on Financial Wellbeing."

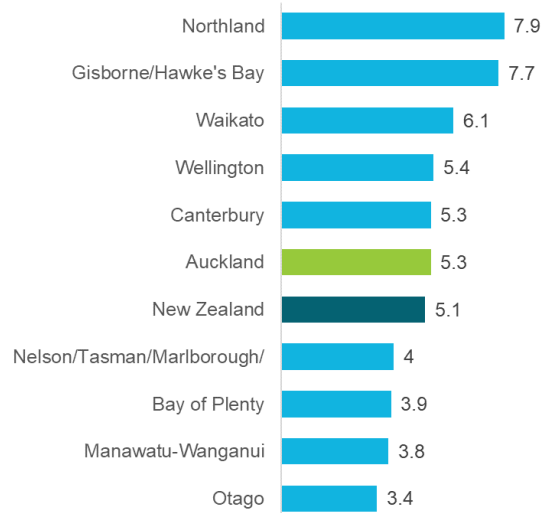


Figure 215. Percentage of households that have whole of life, endowment or income insurance, selected regions, 2013–2019



Source: Customised data from Stats NZ, Household Economic Survey
 Notes: Some data for Northland, Bay of Plenty and Southland, Taranaki, and Nelson/Tasman/Marlborough were suppressed

Figure 216. Percentage of households that have whole of life, endowment or income insurance, regions, 2019



Source: Customised data from Stats NZ, Household Economic Survey
 Notes: Data for Southland and Taranaki were suppressed



HOUSING AND HOME

Having a place to call home that is healthy, suitable, affordable, and stable.

Quality housing and communities of high amenity value and good urban design can positively impact on social cohesion, perceptions of safety and broader social outcomes. For example, empirical research finds that attributes of housing and place can reduce social cohesion inequalities as well as improve social cohesion. The type of housing a person lives in and their experience of it influences the way a person interacts with and feels about others.¹⁷³

Poor quality housing or overcrowded housing can have negative impact on health outcomes due to a higher incidence of communicable disease.¹⁷⁴

Security of tenure can have a positive impact on social outcomes including educational attainment.¹⁷⁵

Summary

Auckland's housing affordability measure has risen over time, and is consistently higher than the national measure. Comparing all of New Zealand's regions, the Auckland region is the least affordable.

Aucklanders are more likely to be renting than owning a house, and rental affordability in Auckland was at the national midpoint in 2018. Many of Auckland's local boards are amongst the least affordable areas. Rental costs typically make up a greater proportion of total housing costs for Māori households and beneficiaries.

A growing number of Aucklanders can't afford to buy a home and will therefore not benefit from the financial security, social connections, and sense of belonging, that home ownership traditionally

Housing affordability	H ▲
Rental affordability	M ▼
Home ownership	L ▼
Housing quality	M ▲
Household crowding	H ▲
Homelessness	H ▲
Housing density	H ▲
Housing supply shortfall	Not currently available ¹⁷²

¹⁷² See discussion at the end of this chapter.

¹⁷³ W Stone and K Hulse, "Housing and Social Cohesion: An Empirical Exploration" (Melbourne: Australian Housing and Urban Research Institute Swinburne-Monash Research Centre, 2007), https://melbourneinstitute.unimelb.edu.au/assets/documents/hilda-bibliography/other-publications/pre2010/Stone_et_al_Housing_and_social_cohesion_an_empirical_explorationpdf.pdf.

¹⁷⁴ M G Baker et al., "Infectious Diseases Attributable to Household Crowding in New Zealand: A Systematic Review and Burden of Disease Estimate" (Wellington: He Kainga Oranga / Housing and Health Research Programme University of Otago, 2013); M D Keall et al., "A Measure for Quantifying the Impact of Housing Quality on Respiratory Health: A Cross-Sectional Study," *Environmental Health* 11, no. 33 (2012).

¹⁷⁵ Beacon Pathway, "The Determinants of Tenure and Location Choices of 20-40 Year Old Households in the Auckland Region" (Wellington: Centre for Housing Research, Aotearoa New Zealand, 2010), <http://www.chranz.co.nz/pdfs/tenure-location-choices-20-40-year-old-households-auckland-region-report.pdf>; C Waldegrave and M Urbanová, "Social and Economic Impacts of Housing Tenure," For the New Zealand Housing Foundation (Wellington: Family Centre Social Policy Research Unit (FCSPRU), 2016).



provides. Aucklanders consistently have the lowest proportions of home ownership over time compared to all New Zealand. There is also variability within Auckland. Great Barrier and Waitākere Ranges had the highest levels of home ownership in 2018 at 75% each, while Waitemata and Māngere-Ōtāhuhu had the lowest at 40% and 41% respectively.

Over the next 30 years, the group of people that will be aged 65 years and over will make up a larger proportion of Auckland's population and the available housing stock often does not meet their needs. Māori and Pacific peoples have seen no increase in home ownership over the past 30 years which has negative implications for security of tenure, social mobility and levels of wellbeing.

Auckland had the third highest regional proportions of damp homes in 2018. Within Auckland, rates of dampness and mould were highest in Māngere-Ōtāhuhu and Ōtara-Papatoetoe. Over 2 in 5 Māori and Pacific peoples live in damp housing. A strong relationship has been found between life satisfaction and housing problems.

Of New Zealand's territorial authorities, Auckland had the highest proportion of household crowding, and crowding has increased overtime. The highest rates of household crowding were in south Auckland. Crowding was highest for people with Pacific, Māori or Asian ethnicity.

One of the worst impacts of Auckland's housing challenges is homelessness. Auckland's rate was well above the New Zealand rate. The rate of severe housing deprivation had increased by about 4,400 people from 2013 to 2018. People identifying as Pacific, Māori, or Asian are over-represented in the homeless population, as well as migrants. At the local board level, severe housing deprivation was highest in Māngere-Ōtāhuhu and Ōtara-Papatoetoe.

Auckland's housing typology is changing. New consented stand-alone dwellings decreased from 84% in 2010 to 47% in 2018. New multi-units residential builds increased from 32% in 2000 to 61% in 2020. New multi-unit homes consented as a proportion of new residential buildings is highest in Auckland.

Areas in and around the CBD are becoming more intensively developed and there has been significant growth in apartments. Ōtara-Papatoetoe, Maungakeikei-Tāmaki, Māngere-Ōtāhuhu, Waitākere Ranges and Manurewa tend to have more townhouse development.

Ministry of Business, Innovation and Employment (MBIE) estimated the current housing supply shortage to be approximately 71,000 homes around the country, over half of which were needed in Auckland (45,000 homes).

Auckland is the least affordable housing region in New Zealand. Auckland regularly ranks as one of the least affordable housing markets in the world

Determining affordability depends on each household's circumstances and expectations of what qualifies as a socially acceptable standard of living. An experimental housing percentage measure developed by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Development (MHUD) is housing affordability measure buy (HAM Buy) which is an estimate of how many renters would spend more than 30% of their income if they bought a lower quartile house with the same number of bedrooms as their current



house, in the area that they currently live in. HAM Buy helps understand whether many renters can afford to buy a home in their area.¹⁷⁶

Auckland’s HAM Buy has risen over time, and is consistently higher than the national HAM Buy. In the 2003 March quarter, 78% of Auckland potential first home buyer households would be spending over 30% of their income on housing costs (Figure 215). By 2018 December quarter, this rose to 86% of potential first home buyers, while nationally, 75% were spending more than 30% of their income on housing costs.

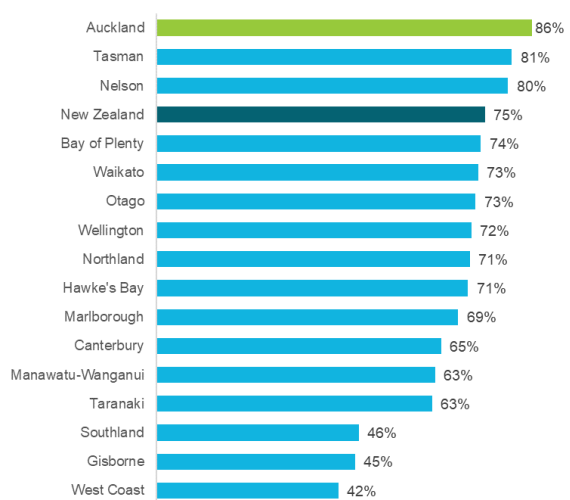
Comparing all of New Zealand’s regions, Auckland region is the least affordable (Figure 216), followed by Tasman and Nelson. West Coast and Gisborne had the lowest proportion of potential first home buyers who would have spent more than 30% of their income on housing.

Figure 217. Housing affordability measure (HAM Buy), Auckland and New Zealand, 2003–2018



Source: Ministry of Housing and Urban Development¹⁷⁷

Figure 218. Proportion of first home buyer households who would be spending more than 30% of their income on housing costs, 2018



Source: Ministry of Housing and Urban Development¹⁷⁸

According to data from the 2018 New Zealand General Social Survey (NZGSS), sole parents reported the highest rate of unaffordable housing (defined as an affordability rating of 0-3 out of 10). Recent migrants, Māori, Pacific peoples, low-income earners, non-owner-occupiers, Aucklanders, the

¹⁷⁶ Ministry of Business, Innovation and Employment, “Housing Affordability Perspective: Housing Percentage Measure” (Wellington: Ministry of Business, Innovation & Employment, 2018). The rent version of the HAM identifies the proportion of renters in an area (region, territorial authority and Auckland wards) whose rent is more than 30% of their household income. It helps us to understand housing affordability pressures experienced by renters in local areas around New Zealand and whether these are improving or not.

¹⁷⁷ HUD, “Housing Affordability Measure Download” (Ministry of Housing and Urban Development, 2019), <https://www.hud.govt.nz/research-and-publications/statistics-and-research/housing-affordability-measure-ham/housing-affordability-measure-downloads-and-notes-of-interest/>.

¹⁷⁸ HUD.



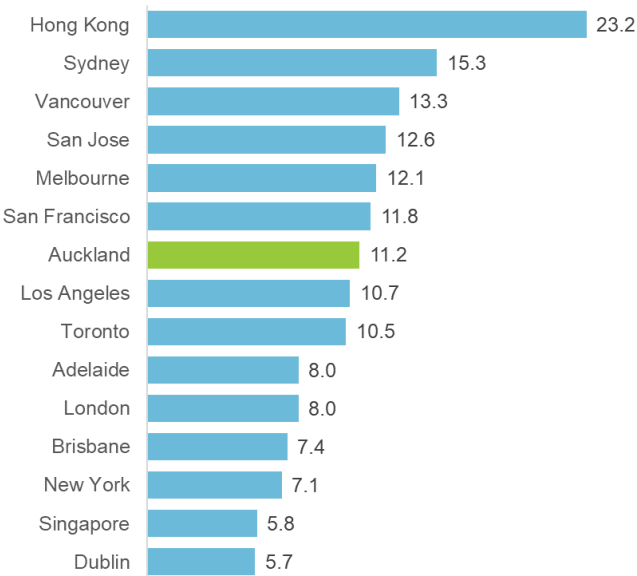
unemployed, disabled people, and those with no qualifications also reported high rates of unaffordable housing.¹⁷⁹

Demographia’s international housing affordability report ranks Auckland as one of the least affordable housing markets in the world. The 2022 report ranked Auckland as the seventh least affordable housing market in the world, behind Hong Kong, Sydney, Vancouver, San Jose, Melbourne, and San Francisco (Figure 217).¹⁸⁰ In the 2021 rankings, Auckland was fourth least affordable.¹⁸¹

In the 2022 report, Auckland’s median multiple (median house price divided by gross median household income) was reported at 11.2, up from 10.0 in 2021 and 8.6 in 2020. Aucklanders, whether buying or renting, pay more for housing than most other New Zealanders.

Note that the Demographia report includes a limited number of housing markets – US, UK, Australia, Singapore, Canada and China, and there have been methodological criticisms of the Demographia rankings related to the measures used.¹⁸²

Figure 219. Median multiple, selected regions including first seven highest median multiples, third quarter 2021



Source: 2022 Demographia international housing affordability

¹⁷⁹ Stats NZ, “Housing in Aotearoa: 2020,” Updated in 2021 (Stats NZ, 2021).

¹⁸⁰ Urban Reform Institute and Frontier Centre for Public Policy, “Demographia International Housing Affordability, 2022 Edition” (Houston, Texas: Urban Reform Institute and the Frontier Centre for Public Policy, 2022), <http://www.demographia.com/dhi.pdf>.

¹⁸¹ Urban Reform Institute and Frontier Centre for Public Policy, “Demographia International Housing Affordability 2021 Edition” (Urban Reform Institute (URI) and Frontier Centre for Public Policy (FCPP), 2021).

¹⁸² The Demographia series focuses solely on the September quarter each year. Demographia uses a whole-of-population median which results in a lower overall income. The income data is also based on Census data for all age-groups, which can become dated. This also does not include income support payments. Additionally, using the median house price and median income to calculate the measure only allows for a very broad-brush view of affordability, as these median amounts do not necessarily reflect the purchasing intentions or incomes of aspiring first home buyers. The measure does not capture differences in affordability for households of varying sizes.



Aucklanders are more likely to be renting than owning a house, but rental affordability is at the national average

Aucklanders are more likely to be renting than owning a house. In September 2021, property data company Valocity reported that 38% of Auckland homes are owned by investors, with similar proportions in Waikato, Bay of Plenty and Gisborne.¹⁸³ In Queenstown, 48% were owned by investors.

The rental affordability measure is the same as the housing affordability measure and uses the 30% indicator. In contrast to the housing affordability measure, the proportion of households spending more than 30% of their income on renting has decreased over time in Auckland and across New Zealand (Figure 97). The highest proportion in recent years was 40% of renting households in Auckland in the first and second quarter of 2003, falling to 31% by the end of 2018. The proportion of renting household spending 30% of their income on rent in December 2018 was the same in Auckland and New Zealand – 31%.

In 2018, rental affordability in Auckland was at the national midpoint (Figure 219). Again, Tasman and Nelson had a higher proportion of households spending more than 30% of their income on rent, while Gisborne and Hawke's Bay were the most affordable regions.

At the sub-regional level, Stats NZ's housing report noted that Waiheke and Tauranga had the highest rent-to-income ratios of 34% and 30% respectively, in 2018.¹⁸⁴ Additionally, many of Auckland's local boards are amongst the least affordable areas.¹⁸⁵

Housing costs are typically a more significant outgoing for low spending households and beneficiaries. Rental costs typically make up a greater proportion of total housing costs for Māori households and beneficiaries.¹⁸⁶

¹⁸³ G Cann, "Mega Landlords: New Parents Sell Home, Instantly Priced out of Moving up Ladder," *Stuff.Co.Nz*, November 28, 2021, sec. Life & Style, <https://www.stuff.co.nz/life-style/homed/housing-affordability/300451785/mega-landlords-new-parents-sell-home-instantly-priced-out-of-moving-up-ladder?cid=app-iPhone>.

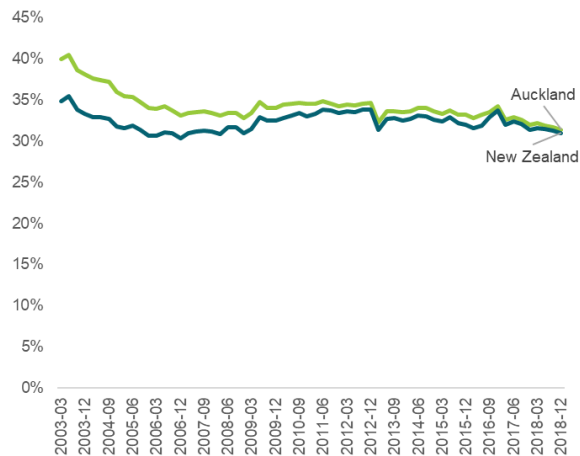
¹⁸⁴ Stats NZ, "Housing in Aotearoa: 2020."

¹⁸⁵ Stats NZ.

¹⁸⁶ Stats NZ.

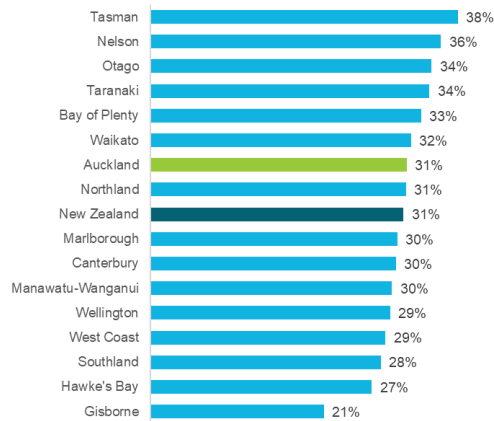


Figure 220. Rental affordability measure, Auckland and New Zealand, 2003–2018



Source: Ministry of Housing and Urban Development¹⁸⁷

Figure 221. Proportion of households spending more than 30% of their household income on rental costs, 2018



Source: Ministry of Housing and Urban Development¹⁸⁸

Aucklanders consistently have the lowest proportions of home ownership

A growing number of Aucklanders cannot afford to buy a home and will therefore not benefit from the financial security and wider advantages like social connection and sense of belonging, that home ownership traditionally provides. This puts them at a significant disadvantage in both the short and long-term. At the regional level, Aucklanders consistently have the lowest proportions of home ownership over time – in 2018 59% of Aucklanders owned or partly owned their own home, compared to 65% across New Zealand (Figure 220). The Tasman region had the highest levels of home ownership with 76% of households owning their own home.

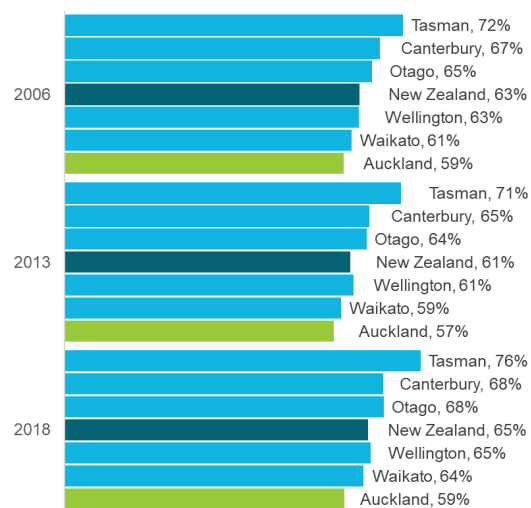
Figure 221 shows that in 1986, Auckland and New Zealand households had similar levels of homeownership, but this gradually diverges so that by 2018, the difference between Auckland and New Zealand is about 5%.

¹⁸⁷ HUD, "Housing Affordability Measure Download."

¹⁸⁸ HUD.



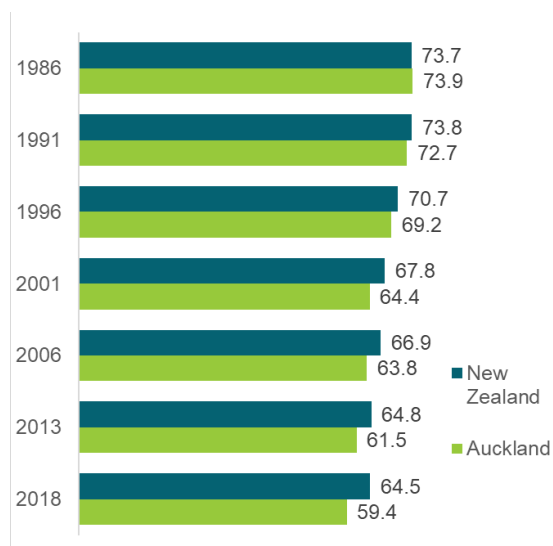
Figure 222. Proportion of households who own their own home, selected regions, 2006, 2013 and 2018



Source: Census of Population and Dwellings, Stats NZ

Notes: Includes those who own or partly own their house and those held in a family trust

Figure 223. Household home ownership (%), Auckland and New Zealand, 1986–2018

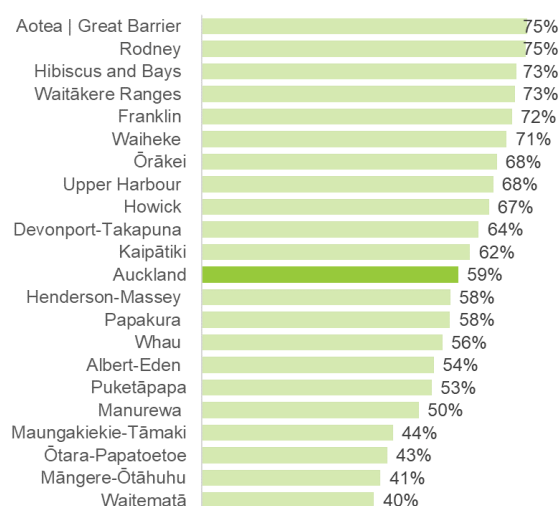


Source: Housing in Auckland: Trends in housing from the Census of Population and Dwellings 1991 to 2013, Stats NZ; Census of Population and Dwellings, Stats NZ



There is variability within Auckland. Great Barrier and Rodney had the highest levels of home ownership in 2018 at 75% each (Figure 222), while Waitemata and Māngere-Ōtāhuhu had the lowest at 40% and 41% respectively. The Waitemata local board area includes the city centre, fringe retail and commercial areas (including Newmarket), and the inner city residential suburbs where there is higher density, and apartment and townhouse rental is more common.

Figure 224. Proportion of households who own their own home, Auckland local boards, 2018



Source: Census of Population and Dwellings, Stats NZ

Auckland's and New Zealand's population is ageing. Over the next 30 years, a larger number of people will be aged 65 years and over. This group will also make up a larger proportion of Auckland's population than ever before. The ability to find suitable and affordable housing in Auckland is not always straightforward for older people. The available housing stock often does not meet their needs, and the costs of owner-occupied and private and social rental housing are increasing. Also, the overall quality of the housing stock is poor, particularly the quality of rental stock, which has both health and safety implications (discussed further below).

Māori and Pacific peoples have seen no increase in home ownership over the past 30 years. This has traditionally provided households with both a secure home and greater intergenerational wealth.

If Māori and Pacific peoples are to enjoy the security of tenure, social mobility and levels of wellbeing in line with other groups, their poor housing outcomes cannot continue for the next 30 years.

Around 1 in 4 occupied private dwellings in Auckland were damp, and over 1 in 5 were affected by mould

The framework for housing quality covers four interconnected elements: housing habitability, housing functionality, environmental sustainability, and social and cultural sustainability.¹⁸⁹ Housing quality plays an important role in keeping its occupants healthy.¹⁹⁰ Housing quality is linked to respiratory illnesses, with a New Zealand study finding that an improvement in housing quality is associated with

¹⁸⁹ Stats NZ, "Framework for Housing Quality" (Stats NZ, 2019).

¹⁹⁰ Alan Johnson, Philippa Howden-Chapman, and Shamubeel Eaqub, *A Stocktake of New Zealand's Housing*, 2018, <https://www.beehive.govt.nz/sites/default/files/2018-02/A%20Stocktake%20Of%20New%20Zealand%27s%20Housing.pdf>.



a 33% reduction in respiratory symptoms.¹⁹¹ Improvements in housing quality has also been linked to improved mental health outcomes. Poor physical condition of a property is strongly predictive of mental health problems and can have impacts on mental health and recovery.¹⁹²

Both Census and the New Zealand General Social Survey (NZGSS) showed that dampness and mould are common in New Zealand homes. Nationally, the 2018 Census data showed that 318,891 homes in New Zealand (21.5%) were affected by dampness (that is, sometimes or always damp) and 252,855 (16.9%) had visible mould larger than A4 size at least some of the time. Constant dampness was a feature of 3.0% of New Zealand homes (44,520) and visible mould larger than A4 size was always present in 4.3% of homes (64,536).¹⁹³

Census data shows variation in dampness and mould by region, and at territorial authority level. Northland and Gisborne, followed by Auckland, were the regions with the highest proportions of damp homes in 2018.¹⁹⁴ Around 1 in 4 occupied private dwellings in Auckland region were damp, and over 1 in 5 were affected by mould. Within Auckland, rates of dampness and mould were highest in Māngere-Ōtāhuhu and Ōtara-Papatoetoe. Dampness was lowest in Hibiscus and Bays and Upper Harbour. Housing problems are also more common for renters. Worryingly, over 2 in 5 Māori and Pacific peoples live in damp housing.

The NZGSS also found a strong relationship between life satisfaction and four key housing problems – living in a home that:

- was always damp
- was always or often too cold
- had mould that was always larger than an A4 sheet of paper;
- required major repairs or maintenance.¹⁹⁵

The survey also found that owner-occupied dwellings were twice as likely to need no immediate repairs or maintenance, while rentals were twice as likely to require major repairs or maintenance at the time of assessment.¹⁹⁶

Encouragingly, the proportion of houses needing major repairs in Auckland has declined over time (Figure 223), but is still higher than the New Zealand average.

¹⁹¹ Keall et al., “A Measure for Quantifying the Impact of Housing Quality on Respiratory Health: A Cross-Sectional Study.”

¹⁹² J Diggle et al., “Brick by Brick: A Review of Mental Health and Housing” (London: Mind, 2017).

¹⁹³ Stats NZ, “Housing in Aotearoa: 2020.”

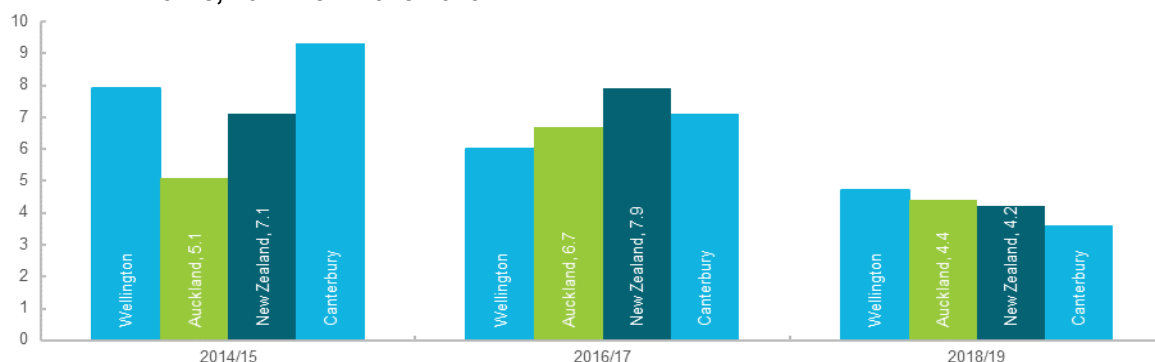
¹⁹⁴ Stats NZ.

¹⁹⁵ Stats NZ.

¹⁹⁶ Stats NZ.



Figure 225. The proportion of houses needing major repairs in Auckland has declined over time, 2014/15 – 2018/2019



Source: New Zealand General Social Survey, Stats NZ

Almost half of all crowded homes were in Auckland

Overcrowding has been linked to respiratory illnesses with a study identifying that 9.8% of hospital admissions are attributed to household crowding.¹⁹⁷ Research from the New Zealand Healthy Homes study identified that reduced overcrowding was associated with 61% reduction in acute and arranged hospital admissions for children in the area of study.¹⁹⁸

In New Zealand, the number of rooms per person has remained relatively stable since 2005, and above the OECD average.¹⁹⁹ In 2013, the average New Zealand home contained 2.4 rooms per person, more than the OECD average of 1.8 rooms per person and one of the highest rates in the OECD.²⁰⁰

Data is only provided on 'number of rooms' at the sub-national level for numbers of rooms up to eight only (compared with up to 20 nationally). However, this does show relatively between regions. At the regional level, Auckland consistently has less rooms per person, and is below the national average (Figure 224). In 2018, Auckland's rooms per capita was 1.9 compared to 2.1 nationally.

At the local board level, there is high variability. Residents of Great Barrier had 3.2 rooms per person, and those on Waiheke had 2.4 rooms per person (Figure 225). This contrasted with those in Māngere-Ōtāhuhu with 1.3 per person and Ōtara-Papatoetoe with 1.4 per person.

¹⁹⁷ Baker et al., "Infectious Diseases Attributable to Household Crowding in New Zealand: A Systematic Review and Burden of Disease Estimate."

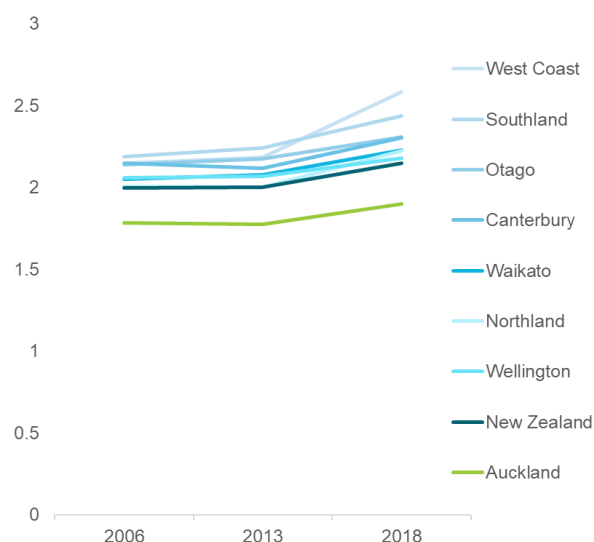
¹⁹⁸ M G Baker, Jane Zhang, and P Howden-Chapman, "Health Impacts of Social Housing: Hospitalisations in Housing New Zealand Applicants and Tenants, 2003-2008" (Wellington: He Kainga Oranga / Housing and Health Research Programme University of Otago, 2010).

¹⁹⁹ OECD, "New Zealand," OECD Better life index, 2014, <http://www.oecdbetterlifeindex.org/countries/new-zealand/>.

²⁰⁰ OECD, "New Zealand," 2020.

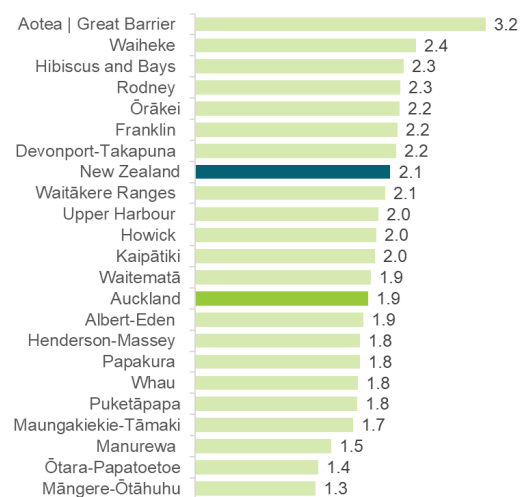


Figure 226. Estimated number of rooms per person, selected regions, over time



Source: Census, Stats NZ

Figure 227. Estimated number of rooms per person, Auckland local boards, 2018



Source: Census, Stats NZ

There are high levels of reported and unreported overcrowding. Household crowding is defined as needing one or more bedrooms; severe household crowding is defined as needing two or more bedrooms. Household crowding is measured with Census data, using the Canadian National Occupancy Standard.

Around 1 in 9 New Zealanders (10.8%) lived in a crowded house in 2018, and almost half of all crowded homes were in Auckland. Of New Zealand's territorial authorities, Auckland had the highest proportion of household crowding across all Census years (2006, 2013 and 2018), and crowding has increased overtime (Figure 226).

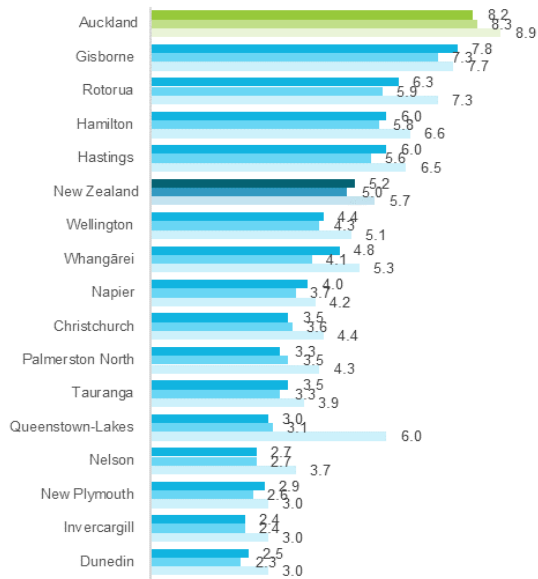
The highest rates of household crowding were in south Auckland (Figure 227). A quarter of households in Māngere-Ōtāhuhu and Ōtara-Papatoetoe were considered crowded.

Household crowding varies by ethnicity. Crowding was highest for people with Pacific ethnicity (39.7%), followed by people with Māori (20.0%) or Asian (18.4%) ethnicity.²⁰¹

²⁰¹ Stats NZ, "Living in a Crowded House: Exploring the Ethnicity and Well-Being of People in Crowded Households" (Wellington: Stats NZ, 2018).



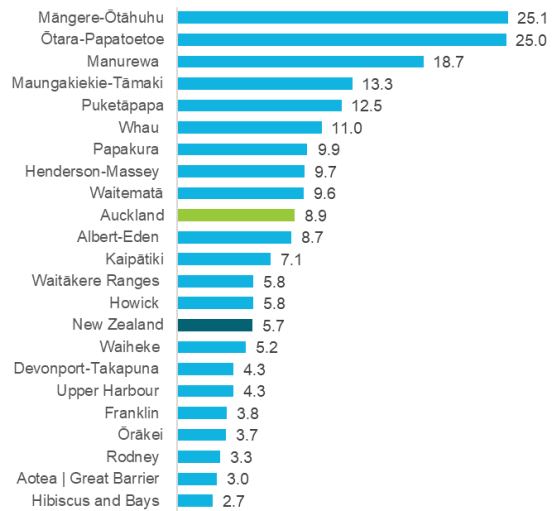
Figure 228. Household crowding, selected territorial authorities, 2006, 2013, 2018



Source: Census, Stats NZ

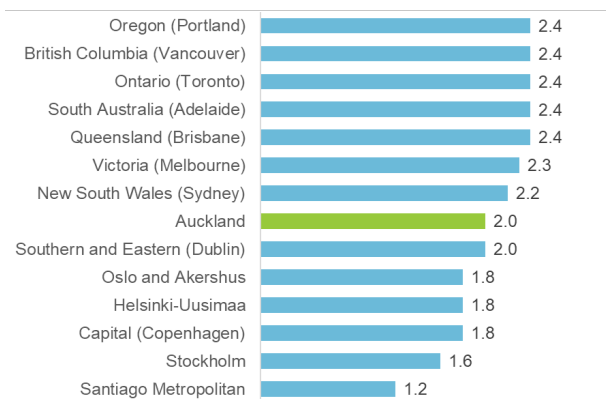
Internationally, Aucklanders have about the same number of rooms per person at the midpoint of comparable regions. In 2014, Aucklanders had 2.0 rooms per person (Figure 228), the same as Dublin and just below Sydney.

Figure 229. Household crowding, Auckland local boards, 2018



Source: Census, Stats NZ

Figure 230. Number of rooms per person, selected regions, 2014



Source: OECD.Stat, Regions and Cities

Note: OECD classifies the geographic units in this chart as large regions (territorial level 2 or TL2) to help in assessing differences in socio-economic trends in regions, both within and across countries



Auckland's rate of homelessness is well above the New Zealand rate, and third only to Northland and Gisborne

One of the worst impacts of Auckland's housing challenges is homelessness. Stats NZ defines the state of homelessness as a living situation where people, with no other options to acquire safe and secure housing, are²⁰²:

- without shelter – for example, sleeping rough or living in a car
- living in temporary or emergency accommodation – such as night shelters, refuges, hotels/motels, motor camp sites and boarding houses, or sharing accommodation temporarily with others
- living in uninhabitable housing, such as dilapidated dwellings or those not intended for human habitation, like garages.

A key driver is a lack of social and affordable housing. The most at-risk groups include those with mental health issues or alcohol and drug addictions, and those experiencing family violence. Homelessness is increasingly affecting groups who have not traditionally been at risk.

The number of homeless people in Auckland and across New Zealand is likely to be understated due to:

- the unknown number of people living in uninhabitable dwellings
- the complexities involved in reaching the homeless
- a reluctance by households to reveal their true circumstances
- problems with the 2018 Census (and previous Census) impacting on the quality of the data collected.

Analysis of Census data and supplemented with administrative data from emergency accommodation providers by the He Kāinga Oranga | Housing & Health Research Programme Department of Public Health at the University of Otago, Wellington, identified²⁰³:

- On Census night 2018, 102,123 people were identified as severely housing deprived, which is nearly 2.2% of the population. This figure includes people living in 'Uninhabitable housing', which was measured for the first time in the 2018 Census.
- Auckland's rate of 115.5 per 10,000 people was well above the New Zealand rate of 88.6, and third only to Northland and Gisborne. The lowest rates were in Canterbury, Taranaki and Southland (Figure 230).
- Compared with 2013, the rate of severe housing deprivation in 2018 had increased by 0.9 per 10,000 people, an increase of about 4,400 people (Figure 229). This increase was largely due to

²⁰² Stats NZ, "New Zealand Definition of Homelessness: 2015 Update," October 23, 2015, <https://www.stats.govt.nz/methods/new-zealand-definition-of-homelessness-2015-update>.

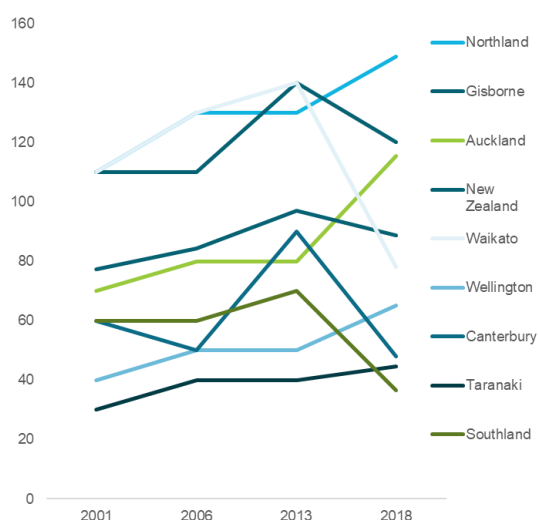
²⁰³ Kate Amore, "Severe Housing Deprivation in Aotearoa/New Zealand 2001-2013" (Wellington: He Kāinga Oranga / Housing & Health Research Programme Department of Public Health University of Otago, 2016); Kate Amore, Helen Viggers, and Philippa Howden Chapman, "Severe Housing Deprivation in Aotearoa New Zealand, 2018" (He Kāinga Oranga / Housing & Health Research Programme Department of Public Health University of Otago, Wellington, 2021).



more people sharing accommodation in severely crowded houses. There was a reduction of about 1,700 severely housing deprived people living in commercial accommodation (e.g. boarding houses and motels). These comparisons are indicative only, given a range of methodological limitations and differences in practice between censuses that limit meaningful comparison over time.

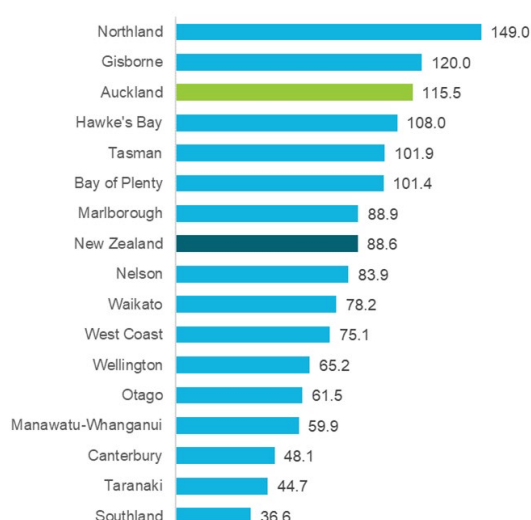
- As in previous years, the severely housing deprived population was disproportionately young, with nearly 50% aged under 25 years of age. Rates of severe housing deprivation are highest among Pacific and Māori young people.
- In 2013, more than half (52%) of homeless adults were working, studying, or both.²⁰⁴
- Similar numbers of males and females were severely housing deprived overall.

Figure 231. Homelessness prevalence rate per 10,000 population, selected regions, 2001, 2006, 2013, 2018



Source: He Kainga Oranga | Housing & Health Research Programme²⁰⁵

Figure 232. Homelessness prevalence rate per 10,000 population, regional councils, 2018



Source: He Kainga Oranga | Housing & Health Research Programme²⁰⁶

- People identifying as Pacific, Māori, or Asian groups are over-represented in the homeless population. For every 10,000 people, 41 will be European and homeless, while 246 will be Pacific peoples and homeless.

²⁰⁴ Amore, "Severe Housing Deprivation in Aotearoa/New Zealand 2001-2013."

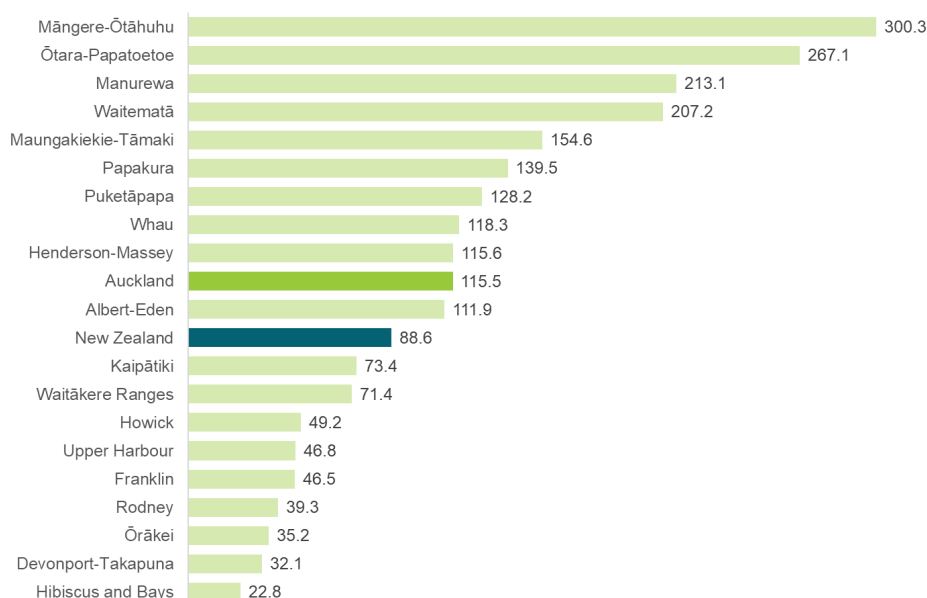
²⁰⁵ Amore; Amore, Viggers, and Howden Chapman, "Severe Housing Deprivation in Aotearoa New Zealand, 2018."

²⁰⁶ Amore, "Severe Housing Deprivation in Aotearoa/New Zealand 2001-2013"; Amore, Viggers, and Howden Chapman, "Severe Housing Deprivation in Aotearoa New Zealand, 2018."



- Migrants, especially new migrants, are at particular risk of homelessness.²⁰⁷
- In 2018, at the local board level, severe housing deprivation was highest in Māngere-Ōtāhuhu and Ōtara-Papatoetoe, where, for every 10,000 people, 300 were homeless and 267 were homeless respectively (Figure 231). Conversely, Hibiscus and Bays and Devonport-Takapuna were well below the New Zealand average.

Figure 233. Homelessness prevalence rate per 10,000 population, Auckland local boards, 2018



Source: He Kainga Oranga | Housing & Health Research Programme²⁰⁸

More apartments, townhouses and units are being consented in Auckland than ever before. Stand-alone houses are now less than half of new building consents, down from almost 85% in 2010

Empirical research has consistently stated that Auckland needs greater variety in price and typology for developments across the city.²⁰⁹ Dwelling size is a strong demand factor, with many people moving to bigger homes and a desire to exit multi-unit dwellings to acquire detached or semi-detached dwellings. Mixed tenure, and higher density communities can bring about a number of benefits including de-stigmatisation of an area, social cohesion and better health outcomes.²¹⁰

²⁰⁷ Amore, "Severe Housing Deprivation in Aotearoa/New Zealand 2001-2013."

²⁰⁸ Amore; Amore, Viggers, and Howden Chapman, "Severe Housing Deprivation in Aotearoa New Zealand, 2018."

²⁰⁹ Beacon Pathway, "The Determinants of Tenure and Location Choices of 20-40 Year Old Households in the Auckland Region."

²¹⁰ K Saville-Smith, N Saville-Smith, and B James, "Neighbourhood Social Mix and Outcomes for Social Housing Tenants: Rapid Review" (Wellington: Superu and Centre for Research, Evaluation and Social Assessment (CRESA), 2015), http://www.superu.govt.nz/sites/default/files/Social%20Housing%20Rapid%20Review%20Report_1.pdf.



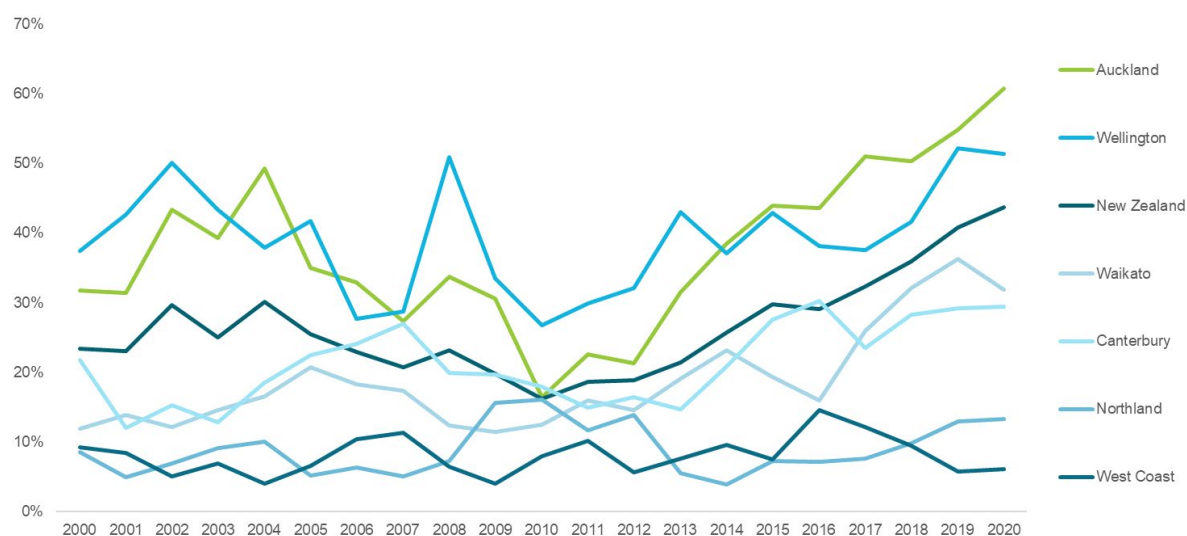
Special Housing Areas (SHAs) have been established across Auckland where fast-track development of housing, including affordable housing, could take place. Most SHAs had to have a percentage allocated to affordable housing for any consented development over 14 dwellings. Some SHA developments voluntarily provided more than the criteria required.

The Auckland Unitary Plan also changed what could be built and where. Most of Auckland received zoning that allowed for more dwellings to be built than before. This allowed for many more apartments, townhouses, and other attached dwellings than under the old zoning regulations.²¹¹

In 2010, 84% of all new dwellings consented were stand-alone homes. By 2018, stand-alone houses accounted for 47% of all dwellings consented. As house prices have increased, people have been making the trade-off to apartment or townhouse living to overcome budget constraints.²¹²

New multi-unit homes consented as a proportion of new residential buildings is highest in Auckland (Figure 232). Multi-unit homes include apartments, townhouses and units. In 2000, 32% of Auckland's new residential builds were multi-units. At the end of 2020, this almost doubled to 61%. Across New Zealand, the proportion of new multi-unit homes increased from 23% in 2000 to 44% in 2020. Multi-unit dwelling has increased over time across New Zealand's regions, except for Northland and the West Coast where it has been reasonably static.

Figure 234. Proportion of new multi-unit homes consented, selected regions, 2000–2020



Source: Building consents, Stats NZ

At the local board level, the development pattern is what would be expected of a city. Local boards close to the CBD are more intensively developed – in 2020, 97% of Waitematā residential consents

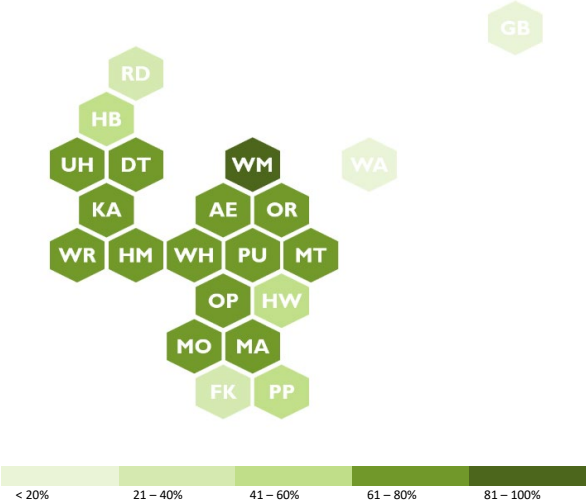
²¹¹ Shane Martin and David Norman, "What Are We Building and How Has It Changed?," Insights - Topical Commentary on the Auckland Economy (Auckland Council, September 2018).

²¹² Martin and Norman.



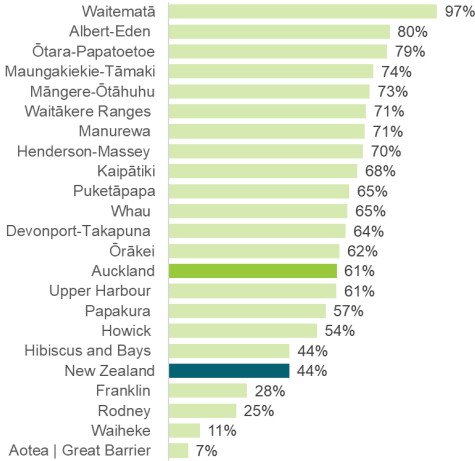
were for apartments, townhouses and units. Areas in and around the CBD are becoming more intensively developed and there has been significant growth in apartments – Albert-Eden is the next highest proportion at 80%. Others like Ōtara-Papatoetoe, Maungakeikei-Tāmaki, Māngere-Ōtāhuhu, Waitākere Ranges and Manurewa tend to be driven by townhouse development.

Figure 235. Proportion of new multi-unit homes consented, Auckland local boards, 2020



Source: Building consents, Stats NZ

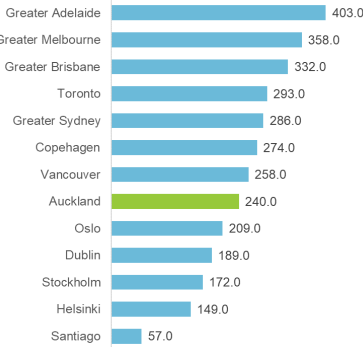
Figure 236. Proportion of new multi-unit homes consented, Auckland local boards compared to Auckland region and New Zealand, 2020



Source: Building consents, Stats NZ

While the data is somewhat dated, Figure 235 shows that Auckland still has some way to go before it reaches the density of other urban centres internationally. Auckland sits roughly at the mid-point of a range of comparable international cities.

Figure 237. Urbanised area per capita (m² per capita), selected regions, 2014



Source: OECD.Stat, Cities and Regions



Local boards on the edges of the region like Franklin and Rodney are below the New Zealand average proportion of multi-unit homes, and will have large shares of stand-alone houses being consented.

There may be benefit in developing and regularly publishing a measure of housing supply shortfall

In 2017, MBIE estimated the current housing supply shortage in New Zealand using a mixture of Census data, building consents data and population estimates data at the Territorial Authority level. This method estimated the housing shortage to be approximately 71,000 homes around the country, over half of which were needed in Auckland (45,000 homes). This number was reported in a NZ Herald article in November 2017 (which referenced the Briefing for the Incoming Minister for Housing and Urban Development in October 2017).

The Ministry of Housing and Urban Development does not currently produce a housing supply shortfall estimate due to limitations of current approaches. There may be benefit in undertaking further work to develop this to direct housing activity, especially at sub-national levels.



ACCESS AND CONNECTIVITY

Our wealth includes tangible, man-made assets such as buildings, machinery and infrastructure, including physical taonga such as marae, which provide vital connections between people and places.

Planning, mobility, and service systems, allow us to move around and outside of the region, and access the types of places and services we need, when we need them.

Access is not just about how people move around physically – connecting online is becoming increasingly important to our wellbeing. Accessing the benefits of the digital world requires timely and reliable access to digital services, regardless of where you work or live.

Summary

In Auckland, the proportion of adults who travel to work via a vehicle has been relatively static over time – between 73% and 75% in the years between 2001 and 2018. Residents of local boards in south Auckland are more likely to travel to work by car, which suggests a lack of alternative options for the journey to work. Those in the Waitematā local board area were least likely to drive, likely due to greater walking, cycling and public transport options.

Regional comparisons of accessibility are challenging given Auckland's unique needs and disparity across the region. Research shows that the affordability of public transport, the fuel tax, and transport in general, has a disproportional effect on Māori.

Auckland experiences the highest level of congestion compared to New Zealand's cities and the three highest ranked Australian cities. Auckland's travel time predictability on key urban journeys is 80%, which is at the mid-point of areas data is collected for.

Auckland's connectivity has increased, in line with national averages, and is the third most connected region with 81% of households having internet access in 2018. Internet access varies across Auckland; 90% of households in Ōrākei have access to the internet, but only 40% of households on Great Barrier and 66% of households in Māngere-Ōtāhuhu have the same. During COVID-19 associated lockdowns, this meant that a significant proportion of households were unable to participate in online learning and working from home without further assistance.

In 2021, almost \$7 billion of New Zealand's goods exports departed via Auckland Airport which reduced from \$7.6 billion in 2019 due to COVID-19 related impacts. There had been strong growth in exports via Auckland's sea port to 2011 (by value) but since then it has dropped to levels seen in the late 1980s (\$4.7 billion in 2019). Ministry of Foreign Affairs and Trade estimates that \$32.2 billion (17%) of Auckland's regional gross output is exported. On a proportional basis, comparing against

Mode share	M	~
Public transport accessibility	Not currently available	
Congestion	H	~
Household internet access	H	▲
Exports and export growth	M	N
Port passenger movements	H	▲
Tourism	L	▲



other regions in New Zealand, Auckland falls in the lower half of the group. Export-related jobs in Auckland are only about 22% of the total; Auckland's largest industry is private services.

Auckland is the main port of arrival for international visitors. Departures and arrivals via Auckland Airport had upward trends up until 2019, before international borders were restricted.

Tourism is a relatively small part of Auckland's economy (7%) compared to other regions. When looking at the absolute amount of expenditure from international visitors, Auckland international expenditure is much higher than other regions. This spend is higher in summer and lower in winter, and fell recently due to the COVID-19 border closures.

A similar proportion of Auckland workers travel to work by car as New Zealanders as a whole

New Zealand requires more accessible, frequent and affordable multi-modal transport choices, including walking and cycling, public transport, mass transit, and would benefit from a reduction in single private vehicle use.

Transport is the second highest cost to households after housing. The wider economic costs of congestion and a car-centric lifestyle are well documented. Additionally, there are environmental and social costs from car use, such as greenhouse gas emissions, air and water pollution, marginalisation of people who are unable to drive and reduced time availability for family and community activities.²¹³ Providing good public transport and creating an environment where people can meet their day to day needs locally will help reduce these costs.

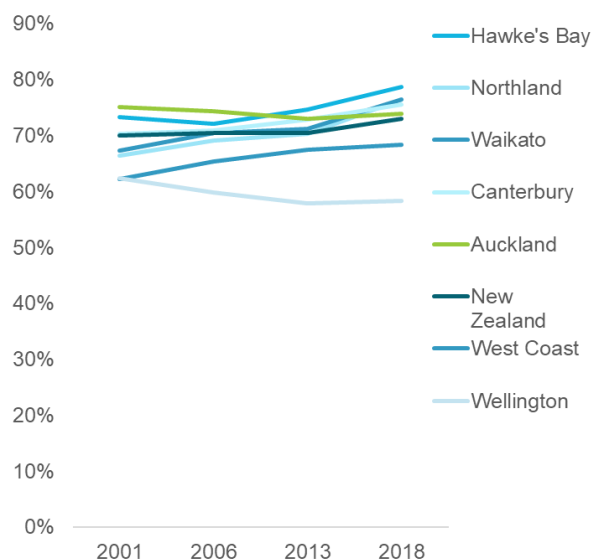
In Auckland, the proportion of adults who travel to work via a vehicle has been relatively static over time – between 73% and 75% in the Census years between 2001 and 2018 (Figure 236).

Encouragingly, this stability in mode share is against a backdrop of an increase in vehicle travel to work nationally. The Wellington region has made the most notable change, with the lowest proportion of people travelling by car and further reductions over time. In 2018, 58% of adults in Wellington indicated that they made the journey to work by car, van or truck. Larger proportions of workers walk or jog to work, or take the train in Wellington (Figure 238).

²¹³ HLC, "Sustainable Development Framework for Hobsonville Point" (Auckland: HLC, 2015).



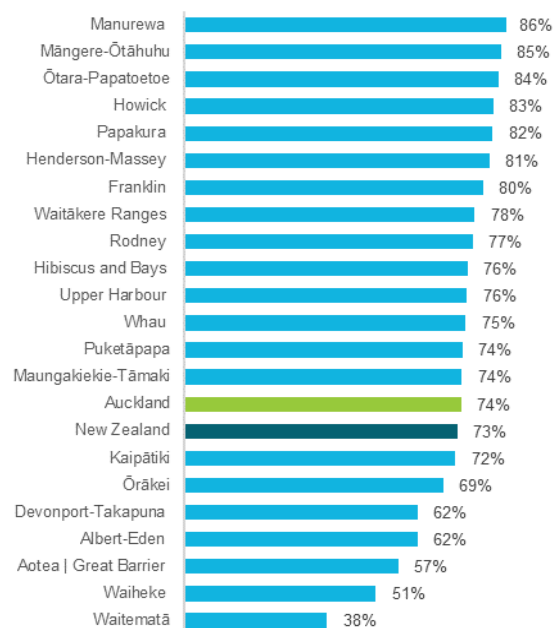
Figure 238. Percentage of adults who travel to work by car, truck or van, selected regions, 2001–2018



Source: Census of population and dwellings, Stats NZ

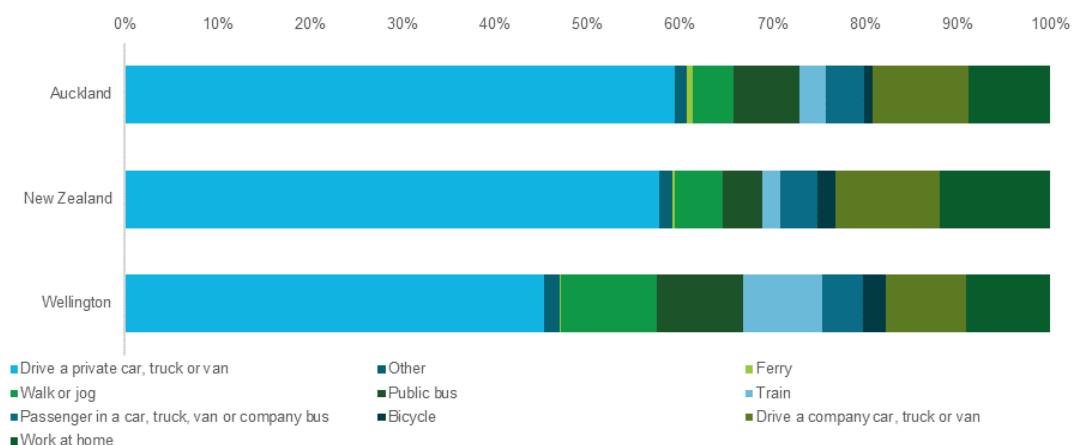
Notes: Includes private and company vehicles, and as driver or passenger

Figure 239. Percentage of adults who travel to work by car, truck or van, Auckland local boards, 2018



Source: HLFS supplement, Stats NZ

Figure 240. Mode share for journey to work, Auckland, New Zealand and Wellington, 2018



Source: Census of population and dwellings, Stats NZ



At the local board level, residents of boards in South Auckland are more likely to travel to work by car, which suggests a lack of alternative options for the journey to work (Figure 238). Unsurprisingly, those in the Waitematā local board area were least likely to drive, likely due to greater walking, cycling and public transport options.

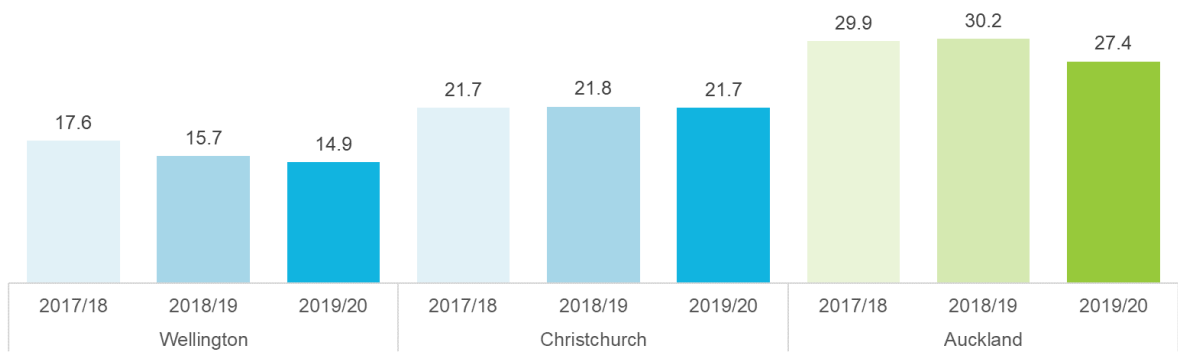
Regional comparisons of accessibility are challenging given Auckland’s unique needs and disparity across the region

Access to transport contributes to building strong, healthy and vibrant whānau and communities by providing people with services that enable us to connect with whānau, friends, employment and the wider community. Good public transport also enables participation in a wide range of economic, social, cultural, art and recreational activities. These activities foster improved lifestyles and a sense of belonging.

There are currently no appropriate indicators for public transport accessibility at the regional level. This is due to the vastly different public transport networks in Auckland compared to other regions, as well as suitable indicators and data.

The available data shows that in 2019/20, 27% of people in Auckland had access to frequent public transport services during weekday morning peaks (Figure 239). The percentage of people with access to frequent public transport services fell between 2018/19 and 2019/20. However, the percentage was higher than Christchurch or Wellington.

Figure 241. Population with access to frequent public transport services, three cities, 2017–2020



Source: Waka Kotahi NZ Transport Agency
Note: Frequent services is defined as scheduled every 30 minutes for ferry and every 15 minutes for other modes

Over 2020/21, data on mode share of people into the Auckland CBD showed that car use is increasing, while bus use is decreasing.²¹⁴ However, travel into the Auckland central city dropped

²¹⁴ Waka Kotahi, “Pūrongo Ā-Tau a Waka Kotahi NZ Transport Agency Annual Report for the Year Ended 30 June 2021” (Wellington: Waka Kotahi NZ Transport Agency, 2021), <https://www.nzta.govt.nz/assets/resources/annual-report-nzta/2020-21/nzta-nltf-annual-reports-2021-complete.pdf>.



across all modes as a result of COVID-19 disruptions. Car travel recovered at a faster rate than public transport. The result is an increase in car mode share relative to other modes. This reversed previous trends of declining car mode share. Analysis of public transport data suggests the results are influenced by an increase in work-from-home behaviour, whereby many public transport customers are travelling into the central city less frequently than before COVID-19.²¹⁵

Affordability of public transport, and transport in general, has a disproportional effect on Māori. Research commissioned by the Independent Māori Statutory Board showed that households across Auckland feel the impacts of the fuel tax in different ways.²¹⁶ The research found that the regional fuel tax is likely to have greater, negative, impacts on lower-income households, probably with most impact on Māori households, especially in South and West Auckland. At the same time, the costs of public transport have increased significantly above the Consumer Price Index.

Australasian indexes find that Auckland has high congestion and is comparable to Sydney and Melbourne. COVID-19 has not decreased congestion in Auckland to the large extent it has in Australian cities

Auckland’s predictability on key urban journeys is 80%, which is at the mid-point of areas data is collected for. Travel time reliability is lowest in Hamilton (62%) and highest in Queenstown (85%).

Figure 242. Travel time reliability within metropolitan and high growth areas, 2019/20



Source: Waka Kotahi NZ Transport Agency
Note: This was sourced from a predictability analysis of key urban routes based on TomTom data on key urban journeys (am peak, interpeak, and pm peak averaged across urban routes in 2019/20).

The term “congestion” is used frequently by all sections of society including academics, the media, policy makers and the public. However, there is no universally accepted definition of traffic congestion.²¹⁷

Traffic congestion is a condition on road networks that occurs as use increases, and is characterised by slower speeds, longer trip times, and increased queuing. Travelling on a congested road increases

²¹⁵ Waka Kotahi.
²¹⁶ G Blick, C Comendant, and Preston Davies, “Analysis of the Regional Fuel Tax and Increase to National Fuel Excise Duty,” Report prepared for the Independent Māori Statutory Board (Wellington: Sapere Research Group, 2018).
²¹⁷ Auckland Council et al., “Defining Congestion,” The Congestion Question (New Zealand Government, 2019).

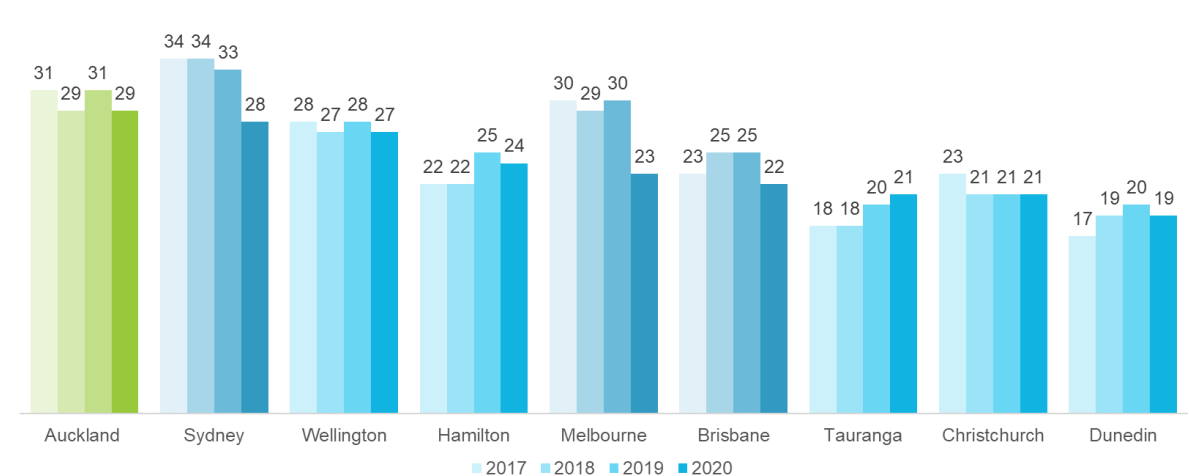


the overall cost that drivers face. Increased fuel and maintenance costs are incurred, as well as the additional time it takes and the reduced reliability of the journey time.

Regular recurring congestion is restricted almost exclusively to cities.²¹⁸ This is a direct result of a city’s defining characteristic, proximity. Cities, and their attraction as places to live and work, rely on a density of people that makes some form and level of congestion unavoidable. It is a result of our desire for social and economic interaction and the benefits we gain from living and working in close proximity to each other. As the population of a city grows, the number of vehicles travelling on a road network increases and further traffic congestion is experienced.

Comparing Auckland’s performance on TomTom’s traffic or congestion index, Auckland experiences the highest level of congestion compared to New Zealand’s cities and the three highest ranked Australian cities (Figure 241). The TomTom Traffic Index²¹⁹ rates congestion levels in over 400 cities around the world. Over 2020, 93% of cities recorded a decrease in congestion, mostly due to the impact of COVID-19. While Auckland recorded a decrease from 2019, it wasn’t as pronounced as that experienced in Sydney and Melbourne.

Figure 243. TomTom Traffic Index, Auckland and New Zealand cities, 2017–2020



Source: TomTom²²⁰

Auckland is the third most digitally connected region – 81% of households have internet access. There is wide variability at the local board level

The internet has become an important means of accessing a wide range of information and services and maintaining social connectedness. The internet also allows connection and participation in global

²¹⁸ Auckland Council et al.

²¹⁹ TomTom, “Traffic Index,” TomTom, 2021, https://www.tomtom.com/en_gb/traffic-index/ranking/.

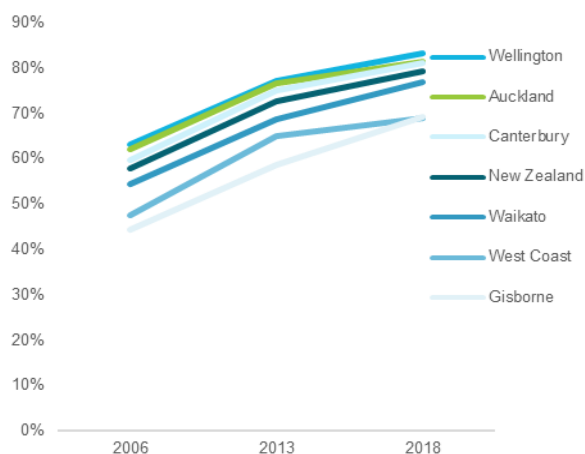
²²⁰ TomTom.



communities, and breaks down the barriers that can stop contact such as geography and/or lack of time.

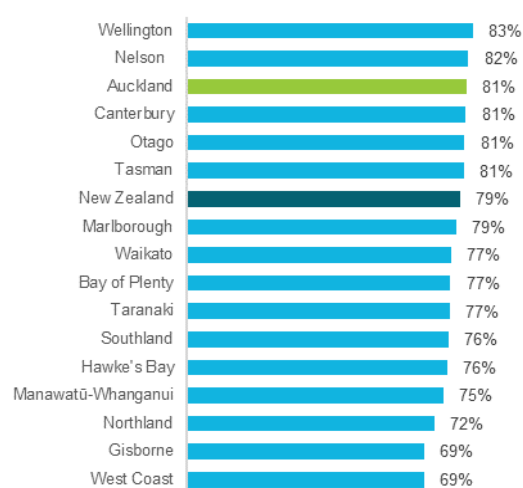


Figure 244. Percentage of households who have access to the internet, selected regions, 2006, 2013, 2018



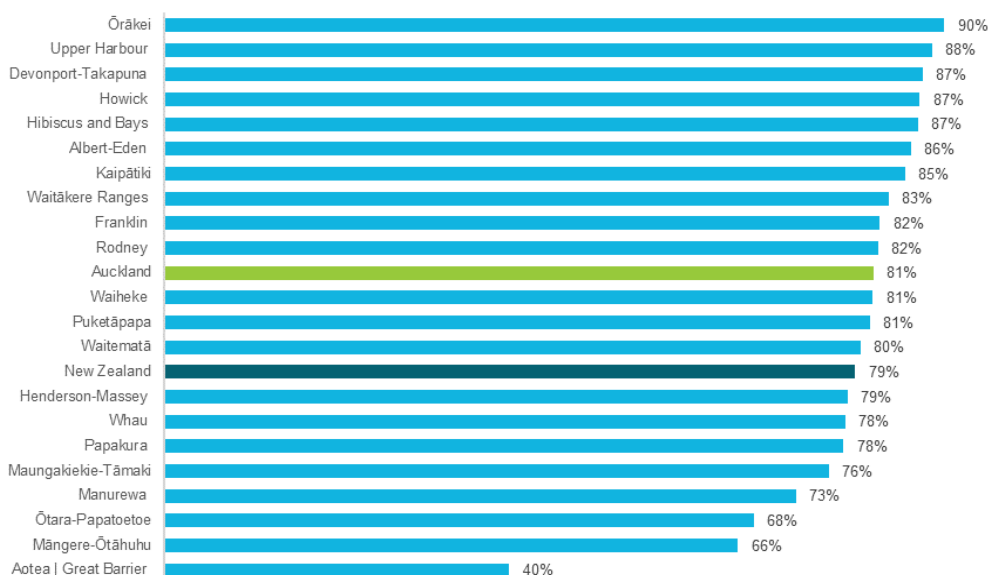
Source: Census of population and dwellings, Stats NZ

Figure 245. Percentage of households who have access to the internet, regions, 2018



Source: Census of population and dwellings, Stats NZ

Figure 246. Percentage of households who have access to the internet, Auckland local boards, 2018



Source: Census of population and dwellings, Stats NZ

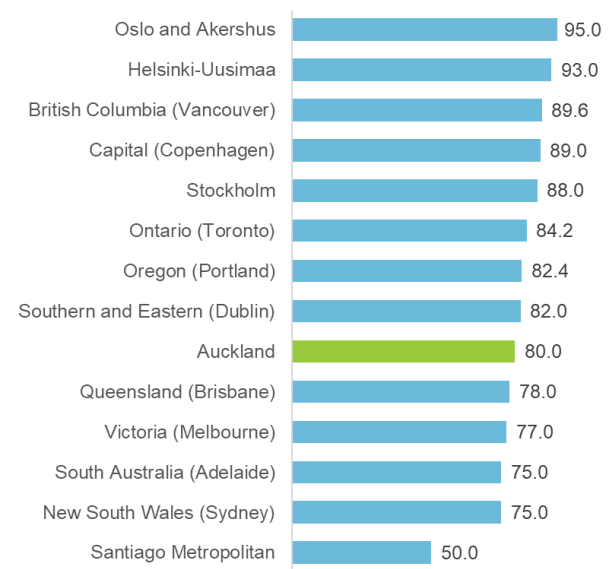


COVID-19 measures have made internet access even more essential. Internet access in households across New Zealand have increased over time (Figure 236). Auckland's has increased, in line with national averages, and is the third most connected region, with 81% of households having internet access in 2018, behind Wellington and Nelson, but above the New Zealand level of 79% (Figure 243).

Internet access varies across Auckland, 90% of households in Ōrākei have access to the internet, but only 40% of households on Great Barrier and 66% of households in Māngere-Ōtāhuhu have the same (Figure 244). During COVID-19 associated lockdowns, this meant that a significant proportion of households were unable to participate in online learning and working from home.

Compared to other regions around the world, Auckland household's access to broadband is just below the median, at 80% of households (Figure 245). In 2014, Oslo had the highest broadband connectivity, at 95% of all households.

Figure 247. Share of households with internet broadband access, selected regions, 2014



Source: OECD.Stat, Regions and Cities
 Note: OECD classifies the geographic units in this chart as large regions (territorial level 2 or TL2) to help in assessing differences in socio-economic trends in regions, both within and across countries

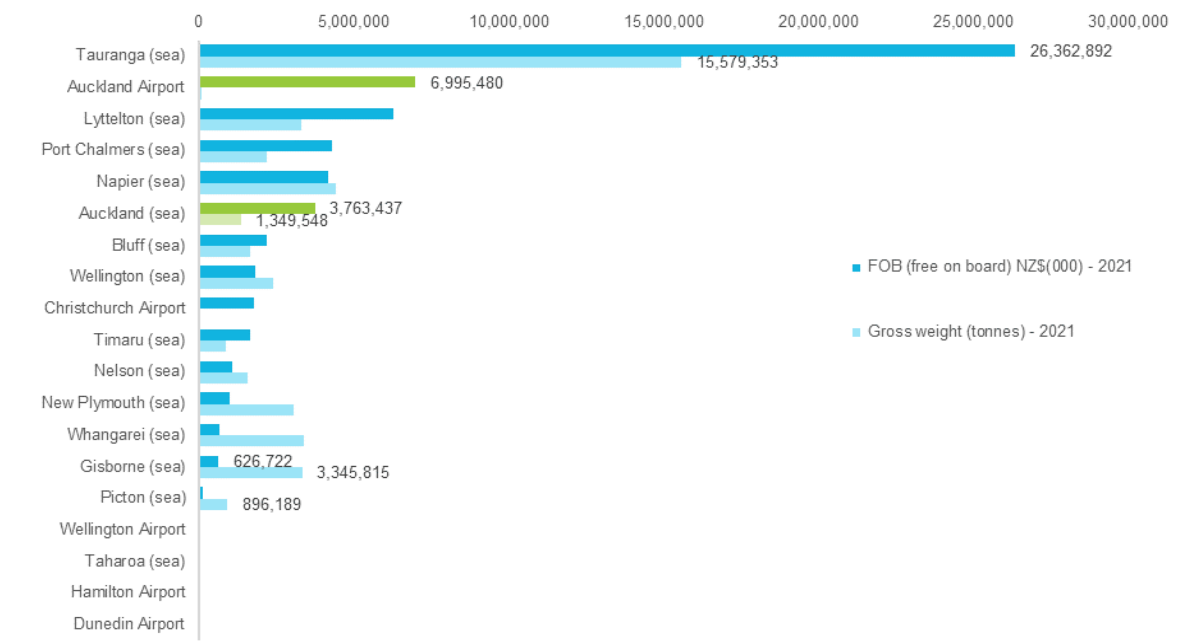
Auckland is a critical hub for cargo exports. Modelling of regional GDP exported finds that Auckland holds its own with other more traditional primary produce exporting regions

Auckland is New Zealand's major hub, both as a source of international connectivity and domestic activity. In 2021, almost \$7 billion of New Zealand's goods exports departed via Auckland Airport and \$3.7 billion via Ports of Auckland (Figure 246). COVID-19 has impacted supply chains. In 2019, \$7.6 billion was exported through Auckland Airport, and \$4.7 billion through Ports of Auckland. There had been strong growth in exports via Auckland's sea port to 2011 (by value) but since then has



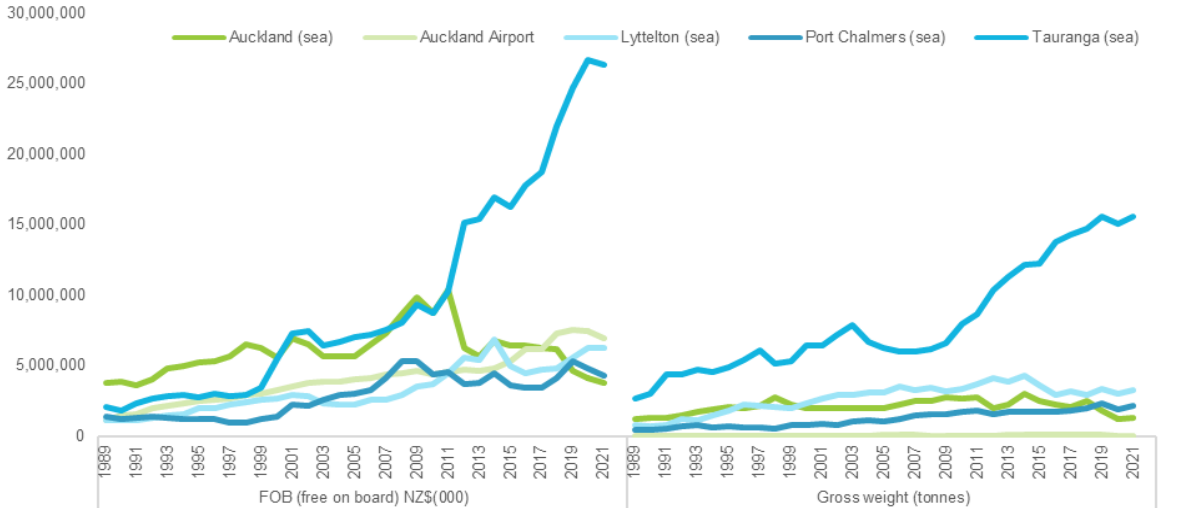
dropped to levels seen in the late 1980s (Figure 247). In contrast, exports via Auckland Airport have grown fairly consistently over time.

Figure 248. Exports of overseas cargo by New Zealand port, 2021



Source: Overseas Cargo Statistics, Stats NZ

Figure 249. Exports of overseas cargo by selected ports, 1989–2021



Source: Overseas Cargo Statistics, Stats NZ



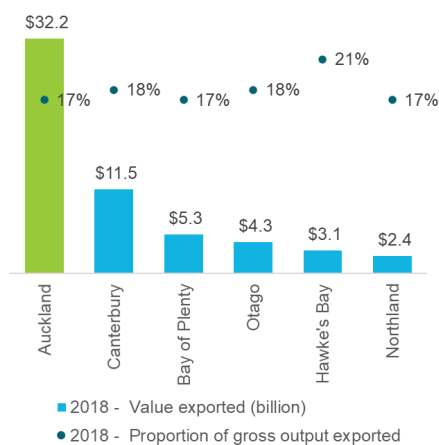
The main export destinations that are important to Auckland are: the EU, Australia and China, which take over half of its exports.²²¹

Understanding what is exported via ports only provides a perspective on goods, but not services. In the absence of official trade statistics at the regional level, Ministry of Foreign Affairs and Trade commissioned a model to link regional GDP by industry to exports. The model estimates that \$32.2 billion (17%) of Auckland's regional gross output is exported (Figure 248). On a proportional basis, compared to other regions in New Zealand, Auckland is similar to primary producing regions like Canterbury, Bay of Plenty, Otago, and Northland.

Despite accounting for the greatest share of export-oriented employment among the regions, export-related jobs in Auckland are only about 22% of the total (202,000) (Figure 249). Southland is the region with the highest share of employment producing exports.²²² 20% of Southland workers are employed in agriculture, forestry, and fisheries (the highest export intensity industry). This compares with about 2% employment in that sector in Wellington, and 1% in Auckland.

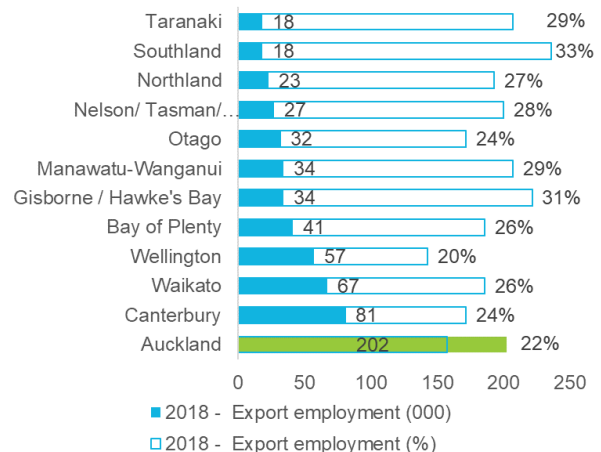
Note that a reasonable proportion of Auckland's service industries will be servicing export-facing industries, which would not be included as export-oriented employment in that model.

Figure 250. Value exported and proportion of gross output exported, by region, 2018



Source: Sense Partners Trade Opportunities and Risks Model (STORM), Ministry of Foreign Affairs and Trade

Figure 251. Export employment and proportion of export-oriented employment, by region, 2018



Source: Ministry of Foreign Affairs and Trade²²³

²²¹ MFAT, "Regional Summaries: Auckland," Research report (Wellington: Ministry of Foreign Affairs and Trade, Economic Division, 2020).

²²² Peter Bailey and Dean Ford, "Estimating Employment in New Zealand Producing Goods and Services for Export," Working Paper (Wellington: Ministry of Foreign Affairs and Trade, 2018).

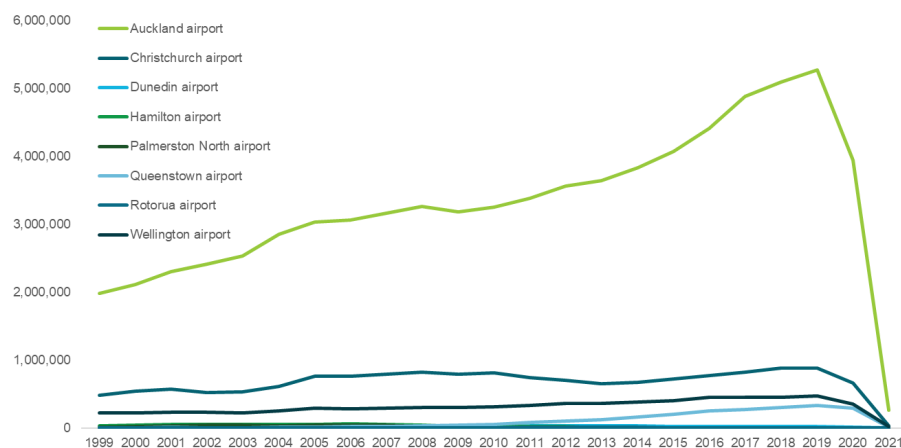
²²³ Bailey and Ford.



Auckland Airport typically processes 75% of all of New Zealand's arrivals and departures

The economic and physical connections Auckland maintains with other countries enables the two way movement of people, social connections, goods and services, workers and capital. Auckland is the main port of arrival for international visitors. Prior to the COVID-19 pandemic, Auckland International Airport processed 75% of all of New Zealand's arrivals and departures. Both Figure 250 and Figure 251 show that departures and arrivals via Auckland International Airport had upward trends up until 2019, before international borders were restricted to New Zealand citizens and residents.

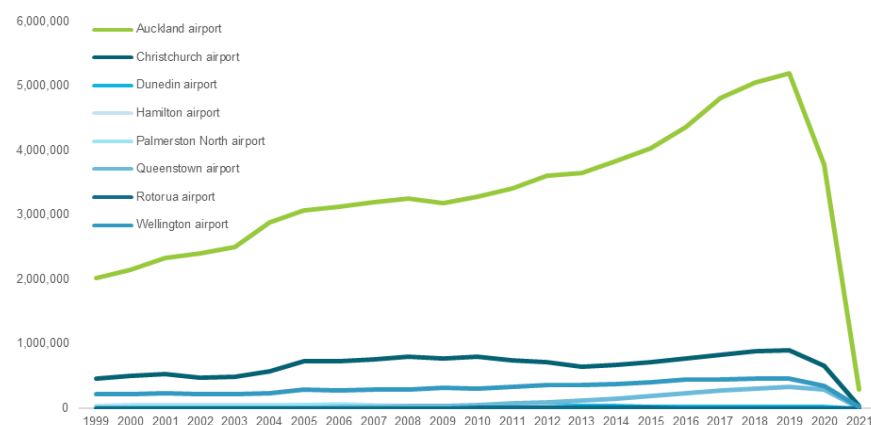
Figure 252. Passenger arrivals by New Zealand airport, 1999–2021



Source: International travel and migration, Stats NZ

Note: Annual-June year

Figure 253. Passenger departures by New Zealand airport, 1999–2021



Source: International travel and migration, Stats NZ

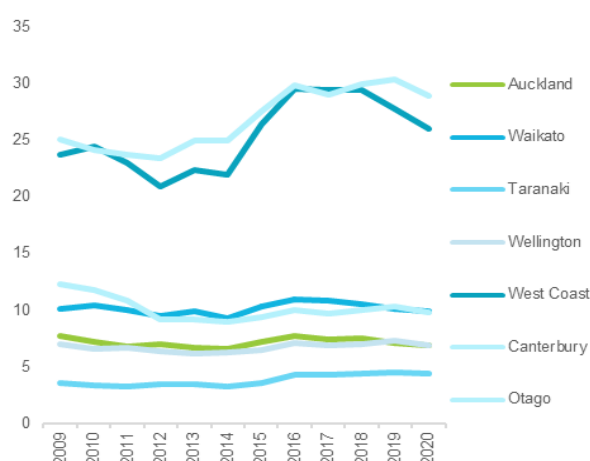
Note: Annual-June year



While Auckland receives the lion's share of international tourism dollars, tourism is a relatively small part of the regional economy

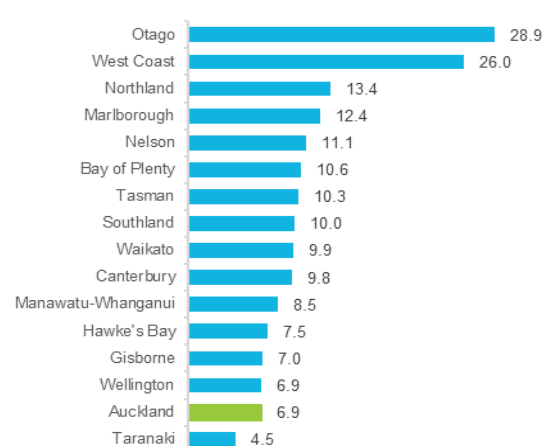
Figure 252 shows the proportion of regional GDP attributed to tourism expenditure in that region over time – a proxy for a region's economic reliance on tourism. These data are derived from the Monthly Regional Tourism Estimates (MRTes) and the Modelled Territorial Authority Gross Domestic Product (MTAGDP), both produced by MBIE. Tourism is a relatively small part of Auckland's economy (7%) compared to other regions like Otago (29%) and the West Coast (26%) (Figure 253).

Figure 254. Tourism expenditure as a proportion of regional GDP, selected regions, 2009–2020



Source: Sustainable Tourism Explorer, MBIE

Figure 255. Tourism expenditure as a proportion of regional GDP, regions, 2020



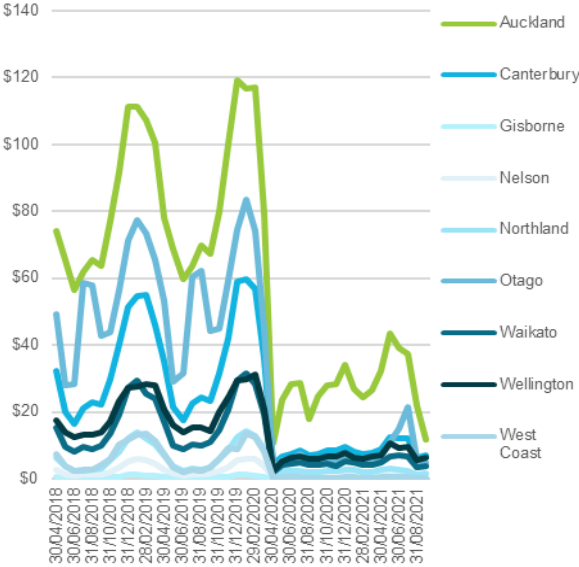
Source: Sustainable Tourism Explorer, MBIE

Figure 254 shows the amount of tourism electronic card transaction expenditure from international visitors – those who spend on international cards. The data come from the Tourism Electronic Card Transactions (TECTs), produced by MBIE as an interim replacement to the MRTes.²²⁴ When looking at the absolute amount of expenditure, Auckland international expenditure is much higher than other regions – \$119 million for the month of December 2019 (Figure 255), compared to \$75 million for Otago. Figure 254 shows the seasonal fluctuations of tourism dollars – higher in summer and lower in winter – as well as the fall-off due to the COVID-19 border closures.

²²⁴ The Tourism Electronic Card Transactions (TECTs) move away from estimating all tourism spend (as in the MRTes) and does not include other forms of spending such as cash, pre-purchases or online. Therefore the figures in the TECTs will be smaller than those of the MRTes, as they only represent part of total tourism spend, and comparing them will not be meaningful.

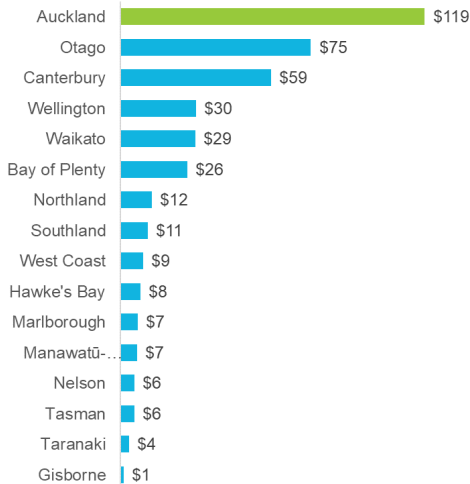


Figure 256. Monthly international tourism electronic card transaction expenditure (\$, million), selected regions, 2018–2021



Source: Sustainable Tourism Explorer, MBIE

Figure 257. International tourism electronic card transaction expenditure (\$, million), regions, month of December 2019



Source: Sustainable Tourism Explorer, MBIE



APPENDIX 1: INDICATORS WHICH UNDERPIN THE AUCKLAND WELLBEING AND PROSPERITY FRAMEWORK

Social capital			Human capital			Natural capital		Economic capital			
Social connection and cohesiveness	Governance institutions and civil society	Safety	Identity, cultural capability and belonging	Knowledge and skills	Health	Environment and climate	Leisure and play	Economy and industrial structure	Income, consumption and wealth	Housing and home	Access and connectivity
Loneliness Percentage of adults who felt lonely at least some of the time in the last four weeks	Voter turnout Percentage of enrolled electors who voted in the general election	Family violence Percentage of people aged 15 years and over who were victims of family violence.	Ability to express identity Percentage of adults who said it was easy or very easy to express their identity in New Zealand	Level 7+ qualification Percentage of adults aged 25-64 with a Bachelor's degree or higher qualification	Health status Percentage of adults reporting good or very good health	Access to the natural environment Percentage of people who said it was very easy to get to their nearest park or green space	Satisfaction with work-life balance Balance between work and other aspects of life (%)	Employment rate Percentage of adults who are employed	Child poverty (material hardship) Percentage of children living in households experiencing material hardship	Household crowding Percentage of people living in a crowded house Average rooms per person	Public transport accessibility Population with access to frequent public transport services
Social network support Percentage of adults who had face to face contact with friends who do not live with them at least once a week.	Trust in government institutions Percentage of adults who, overall, trust the public service	Feeling safe Percentage who feel safe walking alone in the neighbourhood after dark	Te reo Māori speakers Percentage of people who can converse about a lot of everyday things in te reo Māori	Level 2+ qualification Percentage of adults aged 25-64 with at least an upper secondary education (equivalent to NCEA Level 2)	Healthy life expectancy Number of years an infant under 1 year old can expect to live in good health	Air quality Annual average PM10 concentration	Leisure and personal care Daily participation rates	Hourly earnings Median hourly earnings for people in paid employment	Consumption Average real weekly household expenditure	Housing affordability Percentage of households with housing costs greater than 30% of income	Household internet access Percentage of households with access to the internet
Someone to count on Proportion of children and young people who report having an adult they can turn to if they were going through a difficult time and needed help	Total local authority net worth: Total local government net worth as a percentage of GDP	Intentional homicide rate Murder rate per 100,000 population	Māori connection to marae Percentage of Māori adults who feel strongly connected with their ancestral marae	Regular school attendance Proportion of students attending regularly	Mental health Percentage of adults with high levels of psychological distress	Perceived environmental quality Percentage of people who rated the "overall state of the natural environment in New Zealand" as very good or good	Participation in sport and recreation Physical activity that was specifically for the purpose of sport, exercise or recreation (last 7 days, %)	Unemployment rate Percentage of labour force who are unemployed	Disposable income Average real equivalised household income after taxes and transfers, and before housing costs	Housing quality Percentage of people reporting major repairs needed	Port passenger movements Passenger movements at New Zealand airports (domestic and international)
Feeling loved Proportion of children and young people who feel they are loved by the people who look after or care for them	Public service satisfaction Public service quality score	Workplace accident rate Fatal and serious non-fatal work-related injuries per 1,000 FTE employees	Pacific language speakers Proportion of people who can speak a Pacific language	Patent applications Geocoded worldwide patent data	Suicide rate Deaths caused by intentional self-harm, age-standardised rate per 100,000 people	Water quality (swimmability) Percentage of tested river sites that are safe to swim in under normal conditions	Arts participation Participated 1- 12 times, and participated 13+ times, in the last 12 months	NEET rate Percentage of young people aged 15–24 years who are not in employment, education or training (NEET)	Financial wellbeing Percentage of adults who report they do not have enough money to meet everyday needs	Home ownership rate Proportion of households that own their own home	Exports and export growth Exports for Overseas Cargo (fob NZ\$) by NZ Port Export-related jobs
Family and whānau wellbeing Percentage of people with a score of 7/10 or higher for family wellbeing Proportion who indicate whānau wellbeing is better than 12 months ago	Volunteering Percentage of population that volunteered – over previous four weeks	Offending rates Recorded offences rate per 10,000 population	Sense of belonging to New Zealand Proportion of people who have a sense of belonging to NZ	Research, science and technology workforce Proportion of the research, science and technology workforce	Food insecurity Percentage of children living in households reporting that food runs out often or sometimes	Biodiversity and genetic resources Status (endemic, indigenous, introduced) and conservation status (Threatened, At risk, Not threatened) of species (count and percentage)	Heritage places Number of protected historic heritage places % relate to Māori-origin archaeology	Hours worked Average actual weekly hours worked by employed adults	Household net worth Average household net worth	Homelessness Percent of the population who are severely housing deprived	Congestion Travel time reliability within metropolitan and high growth areas
Trust held in others Percentage of people with a score of 7/10 or higher for trust in other people in NZ	Non-profit economic contribution Non-profit institutions contribution to GDP		Sense of belonging to region Proportion of people who have a sense of belonging to the region they live in	Migrant workforce Proportion of labour force and types of occupations	Unmet health needs Proportion of adults who experienced one or more types of unmet need for primary health care in the past 12 months	Drinking water Percentage of people served with drinking water that met all standards		Productivity growth Annual percentage growth in regional GDP	Income protection/ superannuation Annual household balance sheets – Insurance, pension, and standardised guarantee schemes	Rental affordability Housing cost to income ratio for households who rent	Mode share for journey to work Main mode of travel to work
Discrimination Percentage of adults who experienced discrimination in the past 12 months in NZ	Culture, sport and arts non-profits Economic value, total hours worked, and FTE volunteers		General life satisfaction Percentage of people with a score of 7/10 or higher for life satisfaction	Skill levels Percentage of workforce in highly skilled occupations; percentage in low skilled occupations	Physical activity Proportion of adults who were physically active (did at least 2.5 hours of activity in the past week, spread out over the week)	Net greenhouse gas emissions Carbon dioxide equivalents (tonnes) per \$(million) of GDP (<i>this differs from LSF indicator</i>)		Ease of doing business Proportion of businesses who indicate that being successful as a business in Auckland is getting harder	Household indebtedness Household liabilities	Housing density Proportion of multi-unit homes consented	Visitor arrivals / tourism - Overseas visitor arrivals - Tourism expenditure as a proportion of regional GDP International tourism electronic card transaction expenditure
	Donations Percentage of population that donated money or goods – over previous four weeks		Sense of purpose in one's life Percentage of people with a score of 7/10 or higher for feeling that life is worthwhile	Industry training Percentage of people participating in industry training and apprenticeships	Non-communicable diseases Premature mortality from non-communicable diseases	Renewable energy Electricity demand, households and businesses (<i>this differs from LSF indicator</i>)		Industry GDP Contribution of industry to regional GDP	Benefit recipients Proportion of working-age recipients of main benefits		



	Participation in local government decision-making Trust in council decision-making					Waste management <i>Needs to be developed</i>		Māori asset base and enterprises Value of Māori asset base Number and proportion of Māori enterprises	Sources of income Household income by source of household income		
								Underutilisation rate Measure of unemployed, underemployed, available potential jobseeker and unavailable jobseeker in the labour market			

Indicators in blue are in addition to the LSF 2021 indicators.

Contextual	Age and sex structure
	Disability status
	Ethnic composition
	Geographic distribution
	Household and family composition
	Overseas born population
	Sexual identity
	Urban/rural distribution



